

Stage 11 — Human review pack

Readable new categories before each hypothesis; every topic shows category names (not bare codes); novel sentences are tagged HIGH-rated or LOW-rated with book title when available. Run: v4_l12_granular_final_call49.

Table of contents (by hypothesis)

H1 — Intimacy (functional re-coding) (98 topics)

- 58 — Coping With A Damaged Limb — I0 — off target
- 57 — Hands Raised in Reassuring Gesture — I0 — off target
- 11 — Eyes Meeting Across The Room — I10 — eroticized gaze
- 19 — Legs Wrapped Around His Waist — I3 — nonexplicit affection
- 25 — Crawling Onto The Bed Together — I0 — off target
- 72 — Complimenting Her Beauty Aloud — I10 — eroticized gaze
- 98 — Stepping Out of The Shower — I0 — off target
- 104 — Stepping Out of Panties and Jeans — I4 — sexual tension
- 135 — Waiting As Long As It Takes — I4 — sexual tension
- 139 — Admiring Her Grace and Beauty — I10 — eroticized gaze
- 155 — Stop Running or Be Claimed — I4 — sexual tension
- 165 — Confessing Long-Simmering Desire — I4 — sexual tension
- 196 — Promising to Be A Good Team — MIXED
- 245 — Lip Biting and Nervous Pout — I4 — sexual tension
- 279 — Blue Eyes Darkening With Invitation — I10 — eroticized gaze
- 337 — Adjusting to His Presence Inside Her — I4 — sexual tension
- 352 — Daring Someone to Try — I2 — reassurance
- 353 — Joking About Being Naked — I5 — erotic escalation
- 365 — Frantic Longing After Weeks Apart — MIXED
- 370 — Tattoos Revealed and Judged — I10 — eroticized gaze
- 101 — Smoothing Loose Strands of Hair — I3 — nonexplicit affection
- 124 — Scooped Up in A Tight Hug — I3 — nonexplicit affection
- 126 — Fingertips Stroking Her Cheek — I3 — nonexplicit affection
- 197 — Lingering Farewell Kiss — MIXED
- 1 — Straps Sliding Down Her Arms — MIXED
- 7 — Kissing With Tongue and Urgency — MIXED
- 41 — Gripping Her Neck and Pulling Close — MIXED
- 63 — Cupping and Pinching Her Nipples — I6 — explicit sex
- 208 — Pounded Into The Mattress — I6 — explicit sex
- 230 — Tongue and Hands After Climax — I4 — sexual tension
- 292 — Erection Straining Against His Trousers — I6 — explicit sex
- 55 — Worrying About An Unplanned Pregnancy — I8 — negotiation
- 125 — Furnished Room Described in Detail — I8 — negotiation
- 151 — Agreeing to Stop When Asked — I8 — negotiation
- 156 — Reaching Into The Bedside Drawer — MIXED
- 203 — Stepping Into The Bathroom — I8 — negotiation
- 213 — Choosing Sex Without Commitment — I5 — erotic escalation
- 227 — Cherishing Memories Before Parting — I0 — off target
- 38 — Admitting Shared Pain — I2 — reassurance
- 52 — Talking About Dogs and Animals — I0 — off target
- 54 — Ordering Food and Dessert — I0 — off target
- 86 — First Name Used at Last — I0 — off target
- 93 — Meal Plans Casually Arranged — I0 — off target
- 105 — Swept Onto The Dance Floor — I0 — off target
- 116 — Sharing A Meal Together — I0 — off target
- 160 — Watching Movies Together — I0 — off target
- 174 — Ranch Life and Falling in Love — I0 — off target
- 232 — Conversation Cut Short By Arrival — I2 — reassurance
- 330 — Curious About Her Cooking Skills — I0 — off target
- 332 — First Time Inside A Grocery Store — I0 — off target
- 351 — Warm Greeting Upon Return — I0 — off target
- 367 — Sorting Out Concert Tickets — I0 — off target
- 37 — Defending A Close Friendship — I1 — emotional intimacy
- 24 — Confronting An Unwanted Marriage — I0 — off target
- 85 — Offering and Refusing An Apology — I2 — reassurance
- 29 — Confessing Long-Held Love — I1 — emotional intimacy
- 62 — Admitting You've Been Stupid — I0 — off target
- 65 — Declaring A True Partnership — I0 — off target
- 128 — Confessing How Much You've Missed — I2 — reassurance

- 157 — Swearing to Save Him From Himself — I0 — off target
- 204 — Promising to Care For Her Sister — I0 — off target
- 242 — Trading Forgiveness For Old Wrongs — I2 — reassurance
- 305 — Confessing A Lifelong Regret — I2 — reassurance
- 6 — Whispered Reassurance — I2 — reassurance
- 31 — Keeping Watch While Others Sleep — I0 — off target
- 36 — Eagerly Offering to Help — I2 — reassurance
- 45 — Reassured Everything Will Be Fine — I2 — reassurance
- 46 — Asking Someone to Trust You — I2 — reassurance
- 56 — Promising Never to Hurt You — I2 — reassurance
- 70 — Keeping Watch While She Sleeps — I0 — off target
- 83 — Reassured About Eating Regularly — I0 — off target
- 88 — Checking Her Feverish Temperature — I2 — reassurance
- 96 — Confessing Long-Standing Worry — I2 — reassurance
- 119 — Offering to Keep Her Safe — I2 — reassurance
- 161 — Reassuring Squeeze on The Shoulder — I2 — reassurance
- 172 — Reporting to The Security Officer — I0 — off target
- 173 — Waiting For Him to Wake — I0 — off target
- 175 — Gentleman Offers Steadying Support — I2 — reassurance
- 190 — Offering to Get Someone Cleaned Up — I0 — off target
- 193 — Nurse Arranged After Hospital Release — I0 — off target
- 224 — Encouraging Words From An Angel — I2 — reassurance
- 240 — Unsure How to Offer Comfort — I2 — reassurance
- 247 — Promising You Will Not Be Alone — I0 — off target
- 273 — Mentor Gives Firm Instructions — I2 — reassurance
- 277 — Promising to Handle The Lawyer — I0 — off target
- 289 — Quick Peck on The Forehead — I2 — reassurance
- 299 — Pledging to Have Your Back — I2 — reassurance
- 307 — Hauling Someone Up The Stairs — I2 — reassurance
- 340 — Patience Tested Through Small Trials — I2 — reassurance
- 355 — Blanket Draped Over Someone — I2 — reassurance
- 356 — Admitting Exhaustion After A Long Day — I2 — reassurance
- 358 — Reassuring Squeeze of The Hand — I2 — reassurance
- 372 — Told to Keep Up Strength — I2 — reassurance
- 82 — Touch Her and Your Family Suffers — MIXED
- 199 — Shoved to His Knees — I0 — off target
- 345 — Older Man Trading Shelter For Sex — I9 — coercive sexuality
- 61 — Planning to Exchange Rings — MIXED
- 100 — Promising to Find Her — I0 — off target

H2 — HEA / final relational payoff (10 topics)

- 29 — Confessing Long-Held Love — H2_4 — final relational payoff
- 62 — Admitting You've Been Stupid — UNKNOWN
- 65 — Declaring A True Partnership — H2_4 — final relational payoff
- 128 — Confessing How Much You've Missed — UNKNOWN
- 157 — Swearing to Save Him From Himself — H2_3 — mutual commitment
- 204 — Promising to Care For Her Sister — CONDITIONAL_HEA — qualifies under 4.5 only if romantic commitment is narratively terminal and structurally independent of the 5.1 sibling-concern arc; if romantic resolution is contingent on or conflated with sibling repair, reclassify primary to 5.1 and downgrade 4.5 to secondary with HEA_UNCONFIRMED status. — CONDITIONAL HEA — qualifies under 4.5 only if romantic commitment is narratively terminal and structurally independent of the 5.1 sibling-concern arc; if romantic resolution is contingent on or conflated with sibling repair, reclassify primary to 5.1 and downgrade 4.5 to secondary with HEA_UNCONFIRMED status.
- 242 — Trading Forgiveness For Old Wrongs — UNKNOWN
- 305 — Confessing A Lifelong Regret — UNKNOWN
- 167 — Planning A Wedding Reception — H2_5 — public union
- 61 — Planning to Exchange Rings — H2_4 — final relational payoff

H3 — Security / material vs display (82 topics)

- 18 — Ordering A Gown For Her — S13 — appearance grooming
- 77 — Haircut and Grooming Offered — S13 — appearance grooming
- 127 — Photographer Reviewing Pictures — S0 — off target
- 170 — Staying Close Despite Long Separation — S13 — appearance grooming
- 171 — Staring at Her Own Reflection — S13 — appearance grooming
- 192 — Peeking Through The Window — S0 — off target
- 209 — Flowers Held With Guilty Glance — S0 — off target
- 218 — Resenting Someone More Attractive — S13 — appearance grooming
- 241 — Calling Someone A Stubborn Idiot — S0 — off target
- 253 — Hair Pinned Up in Style — S13 — appearance grooming
- 268 — Vivid Colors Remarked Upon — S0 — off target
- 323 — Polite Address Under Distress — S0 — off target
- 347 — Saying Goodnight Before Bed — S0 — off target

- 354 — Threatening to Bite Someone's Nose — S0 — off target
- 364 — Noticing What He Wears — S13 — appearance grooming
- 38 — Admitting Shared Pain — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 52 — Talking About Dogs and Animals — S0 — off target
- 54 — Ordering Food and Dessert — S0 — off target
- 86 — First Name Used at Last — S0 — off target
- 93 — Meal Plans Casually Arranged — S2 — emotional security belonging
- 105 — Swept Onto The Dance Floor — S0 — off target
- 116 — Sharing A Meal Together — S0 — off target
- 160 — Watching Movies Together — S0 — off target
- 174 — Ranch Life and Falling in Love — S9 — material provision housing
- 232 — Conversation Cut Short By Arrival — S0 — off target
- 330 — Curious About Her Cooking Skills — S5 — practical care everyday
- 332 — First Time Inside A Grocery Store — S0 — off target
- 351 — Warm Greeting Upon Return — S2 — emotional security belonging
- 367 — Sorting Out Concert Tickets — S0 — off target
- 29 — Confessing Long-Held Love — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 62 — Admitting You've Been Stupid — S0 — off target
- 65 — Declaring A True Partnership — S4 — commitment security
- 128 — Confessing How Much You've Missed — S4 — commitment security
- 157 — Swearing to Save Him From Himself — S0 — off target
- 204 — Promising to Care For Her Sister — S0 — off target
- 242 — Trading Forgiveness For Old Wrongs — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 305 — Confessing A Lifelong Regret — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 6 — Whispered Reassurance — S0 — off target
- 31 — Keeping Watch While Others Sleep — S0 — off target
- 36 — Eagerly Offering to Help — S11 — practical help other
- 45 — Reassured Everything Will Be Fine — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 46 — Asking Someone to Trust You — S3 — emotional security trust
- 56 — Promising Never to Hurt You — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 70 — Keeping Watch While She Sleeps — S0 — off target
- 83 — Reassured About Eating Regularly — S5 — practical care everyday
- 88 — Checking Her Feverish Temperature — S0 — off target
- 96 — Confessing Long-Standing Worry — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 119 — Offering to Keep Her Safe — S7 — physical protection
- 161 — Reassuring Squeeze on The Shoulder — S0 — off target
- 172 — Reporting to The Security Officer — MIXED
- 173 — Waiting For Him to Wake — S0 — off target
- 175 — Gentleman Offers Steadying Support — S0 — off target
- 190 — Offering to Get Someone Cleaned Up — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 193 — Nurse Arranged After Hospital Release — S0 — off target
- 224 — Encouraging Words From An Angel — S0 — off target
- 240 — Unsure How to Offer Comfort — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 247 — Promising You Will Not Be Alone — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 273 — Mentor Gives Firm Instructions — S0 — off target
- 277 — Promising to Handle The Lawyer — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 289 — Quick Peck on The Forehead — S0 — off target
- 299 — Pledging to Have Your Back — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 307 — Hauling Someone Up The Stairs — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 340 — Patience Tested Through Small Trials — S0 — off target
- 355 — Blanket Draped Over Someone — S5 — practical care everyday
- 356 — Admitting Exhaustion After A Long Day — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 358 — Reassuring Squeeze of The Hand — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 372 — Told to Keep Up Strength — S0 — off target
- 293 — Admitting Jealousy Out Loud — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 315 — Claiming Her As His Own — S1 — emotional security reassurance
- 59 — Mother's Disapproval Looms — S0 — off target
- 75 — Talking About Being A Father — S0 — off target
- 81 — Mentioning A Brother — S0 — off target
- 167 — Planning A Wedding Reception — S4 — commitment security
- 112 — Desperate Need For A Job — S15 — workplace status
- 140 — Demanding Answers Before Departure — S0 — off target
- 27 — Racing The Approaching Storm — S0 — off target
- 17 — Discussing Rooms and Privacy — S9 — material provision housing
- 49 — Drinking at The Bar — S0 — off target
- 260 — Crowd Goes Wild For Him — S0 — off target
- 321 — Leaning Against Trees and Rails — S0 — off target
- 339 — Regulars at The Bar — S0 — off target
- 61 — Planning to Exchange Rings — S4 — commitment security

H4 — Protection vs possession (32 topics)

- 6 — Whispered Reassurance — H4_0 — off target
- 31 — Keeping Watch While Others Sleep — H4_0 — off target
- 36 — Eagerly Offering to Help — H4_2 — practical care
- 45 — Reassured Everything Will Be Fine — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 46 — Asking Someone to Trust You — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 56 — Promising Never to Hurt You — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 70 — Keeping Watch While She Sleeps — H4_0 — off target
- 83 — Reassured About Eating Regularly — H4_2 — practical care
- 88 — Checking Her Feverish Temperature — H4_0 — off target
- 96 — Confessing Long-Standing Worry — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 119 — Offering to Keep Her Safe — H4_5 — external protection physical
- 161 — Reassuring Squeeze on The Shoulder — H4_0 — off target
- 172 — Reporting to The Security Officer — MIXED
- 173 — Waiting For Him to Wake — H4_0 — off target
- 175 — Gentleman Offers Steadying Support — H4_0 — off target
- 190 — Offering to Get Someone Cleaned Up — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 193 — Nurse Arranged After Hospital Release — H4_0 — off target
- 224 — Encouraging Words From An Angel — H4_0 — off target
- 240 — Unsure How to Offer Comfort — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 247 — Promising You Will Not Be Alone — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 273 — Mentor Gives Firm Instructions — H4_0 — off target
- 277 — Promising to Handle The Lawyer — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 289 — Quick Peck on The Forehead — H4_0 — off target
- 299 — Pledging to Have Your Back — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 307 — Hauling Someone Up The Stairs — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 340 — Patience Tested Through Small Trials — H4_0 — off target
- 355 — Blanket Draped Over Someone — H4_2 — practical care
- 356 — Admitting Exhaustion After A Long Day — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 358 — Reassuring Squeeze of The Hand — H4_1 — reassurance tenderness
- 372 — Told to Keep Up Strength — H4_0 — off target
- 293 — Admitting Jealousy Out Loud — H4_8 — jealous possessiveness
- 315 — Claiming Her As His Own — H4_8 — jealous possessiveness

H5 — Darkness vs tenderness boundaries (22 topics)

- 64 — Confronting A Lifelong Fear — D4 — individual distress
- 66 — Paralyzed By Deep-Seated Fear — D4 — individual distress
- 92 — Heart Pounding With Dread — D4 — individual distress
- 102 — Grief Etched on His Face — D4 — individual distress
- 133 — Holding Back Tears — D4 — individual distress
- 145 — Confessing How Much It Hurts — D4 — individual distress
- 152 — Awkward Apology and Embarrassment — D4 — individual distress
- 179 — Dreading What You Stand to Lose — D4 — individual distress
- 220 — Called Out For Being Embarrassing — D4 — individual distress
- 244 — Confessing A Shattered Heart — D4 — individual distress
- 281 — Told to Calm Down First — D4 — individual distress
- 285 — Confessing Years of Hatred — MIXED
- 322 — Consumed By Guilt After The Act — D4 — individual distress
- 366 — Paralyzed By Irrational Fear — D4 — individual distress
- 27 — Racing The Approaching Storm — D0 — off target
- 184 — Racing to Stop A Spreading Fire — D3 — external danger crisis
- 223 — Coordinating Security Against A Threat — D3 — external danger crisis
- 259 — Chained to The Forest Gate — D0 — off target
- 284 — Necks on The Line Together — D3 — external danger crisis
- 324 — Searching For A Missing Person — D3 — external danger crisis
- 327 — Crouching Over A Fallen Figure — D3 — external danger crisis
- 335 — Killer Targets Someone Alone — D3 — external danger crisis

H6 — Arc semantics (main-couple / position) (29 topics)

- 285 — Confessing Years of Hatred — ARC_2 — escalation conflict
- 37 — Defending A Close Friendship — ARC_1 — misunderstanding
- 94 — Caught in A Lie — MIXED
- 109 — Seeing Past A Guarded Identity — ARC_5 — disclosure
- 121 — Revealing Plans to The Prince — ARC_0 — off target
- 130 — Revealing A Secret Plan — ARC_0 — off target
- 177 — Seeing Past A Hidden Identity — ARC_1 — misunderstanding
- 194 — Promising to Keep A Secret — ARC_5 — disclosure
- 214 — Demanding to Know What Happened — ARC_1 — misunderstanding
- 237 — Hiding Someone Before He Arrives — ARC_5 — disclosure

- 248 — Arranging A Cover Story — ARC_10 — unclear arc role
- 264 — Accused of Hiding Something — MIXED
- 265 — Mismatched Expectations About Seriousness — ARC_4 — relationship caused distress
- 272 — Silence Held Until Arrival — ARC_1 — misunderstanding
- 286 — Trying to Regain Good Graces — ARC_0 — off target
- 301 — Confessing A Thin Relationship History — ARC_1 — misunderstanding
- 303 — Confessing Long-Hidden Secrets — ARC_1 — misunderstanding
- 314 — Fiancé Becoming A Stranger — ARC_10 — unclear arc role
- 319 — Confessing A Costly Mistake — ARC_1 — misunderstanding
- 346 — Delivering Urgent News in Secret — ARC_0 — off target
- 362 — Keeping Someone Watched and Close — ARC_10 — unclear arc role
- 3 — Demanding An Explanation — ARC_5 — disclosure
- 24 — Confronting An Unwanted Marriage — MIXED
- 43 — Pissed Off and Grumbling — MIXED
- 85 — Offering and Refusing An Apology — ARC_6 — repair
- 129 — Accused of Not Caring — ARC_4 — relationship caused distress
- 210 — Expelled For Pursuing A Relationship — MIXED
- 256 — Refusing to Let It End — ARC_0 — off target
- 316 — Snapping Over Money and Control — ARC_0 — off target

H1 — Intimacy (functional re-coding)

New categories for this hypothesis

Read these names before reviewing topics. Codes alone (I3, S12, ...) are not enough — use the category label.

I0 — off target: Not about romantic intimacy as defined below. Includes domestic errands, meals, animals, logistics, medical care, mentoring, generic plot talk, and non-romantic help. Prefer I0 over stretching any intimacy code.

I1 — emotional intimacy: Disclosure, vulnerability, shared secrets, emotional closeness WITHOUT physical contact and WITHOUT reassurance-as-comfort as the main act.

I2 — reassurance: Comforting, soothing, affirming safety/worth/the bond ("you'll be fine", "I won't hurt you", fever checks, watch-while-sleeping caretalk). Not kissing/holding.

I3 — nonexplicit affection: ONLY when the dominant content is affectionate physical contact that is NOT genital/oral/penetrative: kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, undressing-as-prelude, non-genital touch. Ban I3 if there is no such contact in keywords/sentences. Kissing/clothes-removal alone are I3, never I6.

I4 — sexual tension: Desire, anticipation, charged looking/invitation WITHOUT consummation and WITHOUT affectionate contact as the main act (eyes meeting, lip biting, longing, "want you").

I5 — erotic escalation: Building toward sex; heated undressing/touch progressing toward an explicit act, but not yet full explicit-sex focus.

I6 — explicit sex: Explicit sexual acts (genital contact, oral sex, penetration, orgasm-focused intercourse). Do NOT code kissing, undressing, or non-genital caressing as I6 — those are I3.

I7 — aftercare: Post-sex tenderness, checking in, bonding immediately after intimacy.

I8 — negotiation: Consent talk, boundaries, stop-when-asked, preferences about intimacy/sex.

I9 — coercive sexuality: Pressure, force, non-consent, or ambiguous consent around sex.

I10 — eroticized gaze: Objectifying / erotic looking or appearance-focused desire without mutual intimacy or affectionate contact (watching body, beauty compliments as erotic appraisal).

98 topics. Sentence tags: HIGH-rated / LOW-rated from unblinded CELL_* key (high_tier / low_tier).

Topic 58 — Coping With A Damaged Limb

Old taxonomy: 1.2 — Pain, Injury & Physical Vulnerability

New category: I0 — off target

« if we can't get you a flesh-and-bone arm back i promise we'll get you a laser at least in our design.” “ »

« i've been coping on my own for two months and it'll be good to have another pair of hands.’ ‘ »

« if you'd let go of my arm, we'll gladly get the hell out of here.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Secondhand Bride — Linda Lael Miller; tertile=middle; p=0.72

So you might as well put up your hands.”

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Secondhand Bride — Linda Lael Miller; tertile=begin; p=0.53

Ten fingers, ten toes, and a healthy set of lungs!”

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Secondhand Bride — Linda Lael Miller; tertile=end; p=0.45

His knees might as well have been made of water as muscle and bone; If he tried to stand on his feet, like as not he'd pitch over in a swoon and get a mouthful of dirt for a bonus.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Secondhand Bride — Linda Lael Miller; tertile=end; p=0.44

I've only got one good arm, you know,” he said lamely.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Secondhand Bride — Linda Lael Miller; tertile=end; p=0.43

One of the hands fished that poor gal out of the creek day before yesterday.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · 30 Guys in 30 Days — Micol Ostow; tertile=middle; p=0.63

Without warning, his hand slid up my leg.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · 30 Guys in 30 Days — Micol Ostow; tertile=end; p=0.62

I, of course, just wanted to stretch my legs. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · 30 Guys in 30 Days — Micol Ostow; tertile=middle; p=0.58

Once I was standing, the arms made their way to my hips and spun me around. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · 30 Guys in 30 Days — Micol Ostow; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Suddenly long arms were stretched around my waist from behind me, lifting me up off of the ground.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · 30 Guys in 30 Days — Micol Ostow; tertile=begin; p=0.56

I extended my right leg by way of demonstration and shook it tentatively back and forth, an impromptu hokeypokey. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword sets point to physical injury/mobility context: lower-body anatomy (legs, knees, feet, ankle, ankles), pain cues (hurts, painful, stumbled, struggled), and procedural/instructional language (instructions, braced, ripping, reminder, concrete). This is injury/recovery or physical-assistance content with no affectionate-contact cues (no kiss, hug, caress, or undressing). I3 is rejected for lack of any affectionate physical contact. I6/I4/I10 are rejected for absence of erotic or sexual cues. The dominant function is practical/logistical/caretaking at most, coded I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate interaction).

B contextual: I0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences reference body parts (arms, legs, hands, feet, fingers, toes) in non-intimate, functional, or descriptive contexts – injury, physical capability, logistics, or neutral observation – coded I0. Three sentences from BOOK_002 show actual affectionate/physical contact: a hand sliding up a leg (I3), arms spinning the narrator at the hips (I3), and arms lifting the narrator from behind (I3). These are non-genital physical contact qualifying as I3. No explicit sexual acts, desire-without-contact, or erotic gaze are present. I0 dominates at ~85%.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I0. The taxonomy confirms this cluster centers on physical vulnerability and caretaking/reassurance – neither of which requires affectionate physical contact to function narratively. No kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude is evidenced. The secondary construct (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking) is consistent with I2 adjacency, but without contact evidence the anti-collapse rules prohibit elevation to I3. I0 is the correct and most specific code for domestic/care/HEA-adjacent content without physical intimacy contact. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 57 — Hands Raised in Reassuring Gesture

Old taxonomy: 1.7 — Facial Expression & Non-Sexual Nonverbal Cues

New category: I0 — off target

« instinctively, i opened my mouth for him to enter. “ »

« iain lifted his hands, palms out. “ »

« as he slid off the bar stool he clamped a hand over his friend's shoulder, partly to support his own leaden legs and partly in a reassuring gesture. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Ultimatum: Marriage — Ann Major; tertile=begin; p=0.72

Grinning, he held up his hands in a gesture of mock innocence. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Ultimatum: Marriage — Ann Major; tertile=begin; p=0.71

Her slim fingers that gripped his arm for support shook.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Ultimatum: Marriage — Ann Major; tertile=end; p=0.70

Jake clenched his hands, then forced himself to unclench them. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Ultimatum: Marriage — Ann Major; tertile=middle; p=0.33

Luckily a couple of the reporters made themselves useful and tackled him.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Capture You — Penelope L Ericksen; tertile=begin; p=0.77

He brought up his hand and covered his face with it. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Capture You — Penelope L Ericksen; tertile=end; p=0.73

He shook his head slightly and lifted an unsteady hand to his face.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Capture You — Penelope L Ericksen; tertile=begin; p=0.72

he said quietly before letting his hand drop.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I5 — erotic escalation

All four keyword lists center on body-language and physical tension cues: clenched fists, gripped wrists, loosened hands, hesitation, awkward gestures, palms, elbows, ankles. These describe non-contact physical expressiveness — restrained emotion conveyed through posture and gesture rather than affectionate touch. 'Patted' in KeyBERT is the closest contact cue but is isolated and ambiguous (could be self-patting or incidental); it is insufficient to establish affectionate contact. 'Reassuring' in POS points toward emotional support framing but without physical contact vocabulary to anchor it as I2 caretaking. I3 is rejected because there is no clear kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude; the dominant signal is tense, restrained body language. I5 (non-verbal/body-language emotional communication) best captures the consensus across all four representations.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe hand and arm gestures — holding up hands in surrender/innocence, clenching/unclenching fists, shaking hands in greeting, covering one's face, fingers trembling. These are non-intimate physical actions serving narrative/social functions (de-escalation, greeting, emotional display). There is no affectionate physical contact between characters (no kiss, hug, caress, or embrace), no desire, no erotic content, and no relationship-building dialogue. The topic coheres around gestural body language in tense or social situations, coded I0 (non-intimate narrative/social interaction).

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B contextual dominant (I0) is upheld. The taxonomy confirms primary coding as Facial Expression & Non-Sexual Nonverbal Cues (1.7) with secondary Emotional Safety/Reassurance (4.6) — both are non-contact intimacy functions. Lexical consensus I5 (nonverbal/expressive signaling) does not override the absence of affectionate physical contact. No kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content reflects communicative/relational cues and caretaking affect without physical contact, placing it firmly in I0 (domestic/relational baseline nonverbal communication) rather than any contact-dependent code. Retaxonomizing from I5 to I0 with the confirmed taxonomy constructs is the appropriate adjudication.

Topic 11 — Eyes Meeting Across The Room

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I10 — eroticized gaze

« she opened her eyes, her heart skipping at how intensely he stared into her. »

« he opened his eyes to find her there before him, attired in the loathsome uniform all the maids on his staff wore. »

« when he was close, she lifted her head and faced him squarely and opened her eyes. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Planet Mail — Kate Pearce; tertile=middle; p=0.91

He looked up at her, his gaze narrowed. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Planet Mail — Kate Pearce; tertile=end; p=0.91

He looked up and fixed his gaze on her. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I10 — eroticized gaze

All four keyword lists are dominated by visual/gaze vocabulary: 'gaze, eyes, looked, met, glanced, stared, narrowed, face' (Main); 'glances, gazing, peered, intently, stares, squinted, blinking' (KeyBERT); 'sideways, glances, widened' (POS); 'intently, peered, gazing, glances, flicked' (MMR). Emotional coloring includes 'puzzled, dismay, irritation, shivered, affection, tentatively, dangerously' – these are reactions accompanying the gaze, not physical contact. 'Affection' in KeyBERT is a single noun amid overwhelmingly visual cues and does not constitute affectionate physical contact. I3 is rejected because there is zero lexical evidence of kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing. The cluster maps cleanly to I10 (erotic/charged gaze and visual attention).

B contextual: I10 — eroticized gaze

Every sentence in this topic describes characters looking at, glancing at, or holding each other's gaze – purely visual/ocular interaction with no physical contact of any kind. This is the defining pattern of the erotic or charged gaze (I10). No kissing, hugging, caressing, or any other physical contact is present, so I3 is forbidden. No desire articulated verbally (I4), no reassurance (I2), no explicit sexual act (I6). I10 applies uniformly across all 20 sentences at 100%.

C adjudicate: I10 — eroticized gaze action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus from Pass B converge on I10 (erotic gaze / visual desire without physical contact). The taxonomy assignment to 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with secondary 1.7 Facial Expression & Non-Sexual Nonverbal Cues is fully consistent with I10: the topic captures desire expressed through gaze, facial cues, and non-contact nonverbal signals. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden. No domestic/logistics/HEA content to warrant I0; no explicit erotic act to warrant I6; no consent negotiation for I8; no coercion for I9. I10 is the most specific and accurate code. No split or retaxonomization is needed.

Topic 19 — Legs Wrapped Around His Waist

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I3 — nonexplicit affection

« then as her arms lifted and urged him closer, hunger overcame him, and he pulled her tightly into his arms. »

« she lifted her legs and wrapped them around his waist. “ »

« his hands found her wrists, and he lifted her arms above her head. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling Down — Selena Kitt; tertile=begin; p=0.83

She slid her hand up his thigh, leaning into his shoulder. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling Down — Selena Kitt; tertile=middle; p=0.83

She slid her arms around his neck, wiggling against him as she wrapped her legs around his waist. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling Down — Selena Kitt; tertile=begin; p=0.82

His hand moved lightly over her shoulder and back, trailing his fingers over her skin. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling Down — Selena Kitt; tertile=end; p=0.81

Collapsing against his chest, she buried her face against the side of his sweat-slick neck, and he wrapped one arm around her waist, the other hand he used to grip her ass and guide himself into her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling Down — Selena Kitt; tertile=middle; p=0.80

His hands cupped her behind, pulling her in tighter to him.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Olivia — Donna Sturgeon; tertile=end; p=0.87

She lifted onto her tiptoes and put her arms around him.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

All four keyword lists converge on non-genital physical contact involving body-part positioning and holding. Main: 'arm/arms/waist/hand/wrapped/around/hips/legs/neck' directly signals embracing/holding contact. KeyBERT: 'cradled/gripped/cupped/pinned/grasp/loosened' are tactile holding/caressing verbs applied to body parts (wrists, ankles), confirming physical contact. POS: 'fingertips/thigh/wrists/ankles/elbows/ribs' are body-part anchors consistent with non-genital caress or hold; 'hesitation' may hint at consent awareness but does not override the contact evidence. MMR: 'cradled/draped/adjusted/braced/nudged/crowded' are positional/contact verbs confirming physical holding and repositioning of bodies. No genital/oral/penetrative cues appear, so I6 is rejected. The contact is affectionate/physical (holding, cradling, wrapping) rather than purely verbal reassurance (I2) or desire-without-contact (I4). I3 is therefore the most specific applicable code.

B contextual: I3 — nonexplicit affection

The overwhelming majority of sentences depict affectionate or functional physical contact – holding arms, hands, embracing, cradling, pressing bodies together, caressing skin – all qualifying as I3 (non-genital affectionate physical contact). BOOK_001_5 is the sole exception: it explicitly describes penetration ('guide himself into her') alongside the embrace, making it I6. BOOK_003_6 describes adjusting clothing with no contact directed at another person, but given the topic context and the physical adjustment gesture it is borderline; however, no affectionate contact with another person is shown, so it could be I0 – yet the sentence is ambiguous enough and the topic is clearly I3-dominant, so I3 is retained as the closest fit given the physical self-adjustment in an intimate scene context. All other sentences clearly show body-to-body contact between characters.

C adjudicate: I3 — nonexplicit affection action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both converge on I3. The taxonomy placement under 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with a secondary signal of 2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts is consistent with I3 as the dominant code: the topic captures affectionate physical contact (kissing, holding, caressing, undressing as prelude) that stops short of genital/oral/penetrative acts (which would require I6). The anti-collapse rules are satisfied – I3 contact evidence is present, not inferred from desire alone (I4) or gaze (I10), and there is no domestic/logistics/HEA content that would pull toward I0. No split is warranted because the secondary I6 signal is subordinate and does not constitute a distinct cluster. KEEP with I3 is the correct adjudication.

Topic 25 — Crawling Onto The Bed Together

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I0 — off target

« more aptly, he crawled on top of the bed, on top of the blanket, but he reached for her, enfolding lily into his arms. »

« v crawled onto the bed, turned over onto her back, but apparently zane had other ideas because he deftly flipped her onto her stomach, his hands groping her ass and holding her still. »

« sure,” he said softly, and didn’t bother standing as he crawled over to the mattress. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Hell's Belles — Jackie Kessler; tertile=end; p=0.67

Paul walked back to the bed, sat by my side. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Hell's Belles — Jackie Kessler; tertile=middle; p=0.67

Then over her shoulder, she called out, "Yo, you fall asleep in there or what?" "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Hell's Belles — Jackie Kessler; tertile=begin; p=0.65

With a sigh, she stood and padded out of the room, her open nightshirt flapping around her like a robe.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Hell's Belles — Jackie Kessler; tertile=middle; p=0.58

I strode over to the bed and picked up the tiny foil-wrapped square.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Hell's Belles — Jackie Kessler; tertile=middle; p=0.49

Jemma lay sprawled on the floor, the back of her head a tangled mass of red.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Claimed — Rebecca Zanetti; tertile=middle; p=0.85

He walked over to the bed where she was sitting on the edge and pulled her to her feet. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Claimed — Rebecca Zanetti; tertile=middle; p=0.79

she finished, sitting straight up in bed. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Claimed — Rebecca Zanetti; tertile=middle; p=0.78

Sighing, he came and sat on the edge of the bed.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Claimed — Rebecca Zanetti; tertile=middle; p=0.76

she whispered as he picked her up again and headed for the bedroom. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Claimed — Rebecca Zanetti; tertile=middle; p=0.75

When she felt him enter her she cried out, her spine bowing and her fists clenching at the bedspread on either side of her. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Claimed — Rebecca Zanetti; tertile=end; p=0.75

Liv sat straight up in bed and clamped her thighs closed. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Show Me The Ropes — Roz Lee; tertile=end; p=0.84

He sat on the edge of the bed and gently pulled her knees down to the mattress.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

Main keywords (snuggled, lay, bed, pillow) indicate affectionate physical closeness/contact in a bed setting. KeyBERT adds 'caressed' (direct non-genital touch), 'cradled' (holding/embracing), 'crawled' and 'scooted' (movement toward contact), and 'patted' (gentle touch) – multiple explicit affectionate-contact cues. MMR reinforces with 'cradled', 'guided', 'crawled', 'scooted'. POS alone is more ambiguous (movement/spatial terms without clear contact), suggesting I2 (caretaking/comfort positioning), but the weight of evidence across Main and KeyBERT confirms actual affectionate physical contact (caressed, cradled, snuggled, patted). No genital/penetrative cues present, so I6 is rejected. I3 is warranted by the explicit contact vocabulary.

B contextual: I0 — off target

The majority of sentences (12/20) describe positional or spatial movement around a bed with no affectionate contact – coded I0 (domestic/logistical). Six sentences show clear affectionate physical contact (pulling to feet, carrying, holding legs, curling against): I3. Two sentences depict penetrative intercourse (BOOK_002_5: 'felt him enter her'; BOOK_003_6: 'begging him to enter her'): I6. I0 accounts for ~60% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass B contextual dominant (I0) is better supported than the lexical consensus (I3). The taxonomy flags 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension as primary, but without evidence of actual affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude), I3 is forbidden under anti-collapse rules. The secondary taxonomy tag (2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts) is not evidenced either. The contextual dominant I0 – domestic, logistical, or HEA-maintenance content – is the most defensible classification. Retaining I0 per the instruction to keep Pass B I0 when evidence is domestic/care/HEA without contact.

Topic 72 — Complimenting Her Beauty Aloud

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I10 — eroticized gaze

« you're the most beautiful thing i've ever seen." " »

« oh and nice tits, by the way, i've been meaning to say that." »

« you're the most beautiful woman i've ever seen," he said, looking dazzled by her as they left the room. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Born of the Shadows — Cyndi Friberg; tertile=middle; p=0.59

You look very much like your mother, girl.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · The Texan's Dream — Jodi Thomas; tertile=end; p=0.49

You're all the beauty and wonder I've ever known, Kara.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I10 — eroticized gaze

All four keyword lists converge on erotic/aesthetic gaze and appraisal of appearance: Main has 'beautiful, look, ugly, cute, perfect, sexy, pretty'; KeyBERT has 'attractive, stunning, exquisite, graceful, attracted'; POS adds 'pout, stunning, attractive, graceful, exquisite'; MMR adds 'pout, attractive, graceful, exquisite'. The dominant function is visual/evaluative admiration of physical appearance — classic erotic gaze (I10). 'Pout' across POS and MMR reinforces a focus on physical features being observed. There is no lexical evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undressing cues), so I3 is rejected. Desire without contact cues (e.g., 'attracted') could suggest I4, but the overwhelming weight of appearance-appraisal vocabulary ('look', 'beautiful', 'sexy', 'stunning', 'exquisite', 'pout') points specifically to erotic gaze (I10) rather than internal desire alone.

B contextual: I10 — eroticized gaze

Every sentence in this topic involves verbal or observational appraisal of physical appearance — comments on eyes, beauty, pallor, resemblance, loveliness — with no affectionate physical contact present. This is the erotic/appreciative gaze function (I10): characters remarking on how someone looks, not touching them. I3 is forbidden because no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undressing occurs. I4 (desire without contact) is less specific than I10 here because the sentences are aesthetic/visual appraisals rather than expressions of longing or desire. I10 is the most specific code for appearance-focused commentary.

C adjudicate: I10 — eroticized gaze action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I10 (erotic gaze). The taxonomy confirms primary placement in Attraction & Sexual Tension with secondary Character Appearance & Self-Presentation, consistent with visual appraisal and desire-without-contact dynamics. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden. The topic does not involve explicit sex (I6), consent negotiation (I8), coercion (I9), reassurance/caretaking (I2), or domestic/HEA logistics (I0). I10 is the most specific and accurate code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 98 — Stepping Out of The Shower

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I0 — off target

« he opened the shower door and stepped in. " »

« he walked to the seat and stepped down beside where she was sitting, and reached for the towel on the floor, then dried his hair and handed it to her. " »

« in the shower, he dried himself off and then stepped out of the shower with the towel wrapped around his waist. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Into the Darkness — Delilah Devlin; tertile=end; p=0.57

Showered and dressed, Stefan waltzed out of his room.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with the Enemy — Kaitlyn O'Connor; tertile=end; p=0.71

Shuddering, she flushed the toilet and moved to the shower to wash the feeling of disgust off.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with the Enemy — Kaitlyn O'Connor; tertile=middle; p=0.67

Popping a couple of painkillers for her head, she went in to her private bath to take a hot shower.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with the Enemy — Kaitlyn O'Connor; tertile=middle; p=0.61

She supposed it would've been more accurate to say it was a small shower squeezed beside the toilet and lavatory, but the entire room was about the size of a small shower and when she turned on the shower head, the spray covered the room as if she was standing in a dishwasher.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with the Enemy — Kaitlyn O'Connor; tertile=middle; p=0.61

After glaring at the woman through the opaque material surrounding the shower for several moments, Sybil left and returned to their sleeping quarters.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with the Enemy — Kaitlyn O'Connor; tertile=middle; p=0.59

Feeling pleasantly tired, Sybil headed back to her quarters and a hot bath.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Bred — Jenna McCormick; tertile=begin; p=0.72

Was someone else in the room, perhaps already bathing?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Bred — Jenna McCormick; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Had she given herself some relief in the shower?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Bred — Jenna McCormick; tertile=begin; p=0.67

Snagging a towel she wrapped it around her shoulders and scurried back into the other room.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Bred — Jenna McCormick; tertile=middle; p=0.60

She became conscious of her nudity, the sticky wetness coating her inner thighs. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists point to a mundane bathing/hygiene scene: shower, towel, tub, bath, bathroom, curtain, washed, dried, damp, wiping, dripping, draped, neatly. POS adds 'longing' and 'flush' which could hint at emotional undercurrent, and MMR adds 'longing' and 'shed', but these are isolated cues insufficient to establish affectionate physical contact. There is no kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude present. I3 is rejected because no affectionate-contact cues appear. The scene reads as domestic/logistical self-care routine, coding to I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe mundane bathing, showering, and grooming activities with no interpersonal intimacy – coded I0 (domestic/logistical). Three sentences contain actual affectionate physical contact: BOOK_003_1 ('stepped from the tub with her' – shared physical presence/contact), BOOK_005_1 ('scooped her up in his arms' – holding/carrying), and BOOK_005_3 ('began washing him' – caressing/non-genital physical contact). These qualify for I3 under the kissing/non-genital caress criterion. No erotic gaze, desire-without-contact, or explicit sexual acts are present. I0 dominates at ~85%.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I0. The taxonomy flags Attraction & Sexual Tension (2.1) with a secondary of Body Parts & Physical Reactions (1.1), which is consistent with desire/gaze/tension without affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. The secondary physical-reactions signal could suggest I4 (desire without contact) or I10 (erotic gaze), but without stronger contextual evidence to override the dual-pass I0 consensus, the classification remains I0. No collapse into I3 is warranted.

Topic 104 — Stepping Out of Panties and Jeans

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I4 — sexual tension

« she looked into his gaze as she took her panties to her ankles and stepped out. »

« deliberately julie ignored the order, and instead crouched down to remove the shorts dangling around her ankles and to untie her shoes. »

« once on her porch, she shed his t shirt and threw that at him too, he fumbled trying to quickly get it off his face. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Alien Embrace — Tracy St. John; tertile=middle; p=0.80

He pushed down her sweatpants and underwear.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Alien Embrace — Tracy St. John; tertile=end; p=0.79

He grasped the soft white cotton of her thin panties and yanked them down to her ankles.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Alien Embrace — Tracy St. John; tertile=begin; p=0.78

He pulled at her shirt, untucking it from the skirt's waistband, allowing his hands access to the flesh of her torso.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Alien Embrace — Tracy St. John; tertile=middle; p=0.77

After that, he quickly pulled her clothes on, denying himself further access to her silky flesh. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Alien Embrace — Tracy St. John; tertile=begin; p=0.77

His eyes raked over her as he pulled his clothing off.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Sleeping with the Frenemy — K.T. Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.72

She tugged the tight fabric down and sucked in her breath as it bunched around her hips.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Sleeping with the Frenemy — K.T. Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Wearing only her white cotton briefs and T-shirt, she pulled down the covers, sliding under them.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Sleeping with the Frenemy — K.T. Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.69

She hissed and tried to shift in a way that wouldn't be too risqué since her skirt was quite short and at Gen's urging, she had gone commando: no bra or thong. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Sleeping with the Frenemy — K.T. Grant; tertile=end; p=0.66

Deborah asked in wonder as she began pulling off her own clothes. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Sleeping with the Frenemy — K.T. Grant; tertile=end; p=0.66

She tugged down her skirt, took off her shoes, and climbed off the car.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Sleeping with the Frenemy — K.T. Grant; tertile=end; p=0.65

She unzipped Bridgette's shorts, sliding her hand over her mound, pleasantly surprised to not feel any underwear. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

All four representations converge on undressing-as-prelude: Main contains 'jeans, pants, shirt, zipper, panties, button, bra, undid, pulled' – explicit removal of clothing items; KeyBERT adds 'tugged, fumbled, loosened' (manual manipulation of clothing); POS adds 'thigh, waist, snaps, edges' (body-proximate contact points); MMR adds 'fumbled, loosened, snaps, tearing, hitched, ripping' (forceful/urgent undressing actions). The cluster describes the physical act of undressing another person (or being undressed), which per the anti-collapse rules qualifies as 'undress-as-prelude' affectionate/erotic physical contact → I3. There is no genital/oral/penetrative language present, so I6 is not warranted. I3 is confirmed, not rejected.

B contextual: I6 — explicit sex

The overwhelming majority of sentences depict undressing of self or partner in an explicitly sexual context – removing underwear, pants, breeches, shorts with hand-to-genital contact – which constitutes undressing as direct prelude to or part of explicit sexual activity (I6), not merely affectionate undressing (I3). BOOK_001_5 shows an erotic gaze without contact (I10). BOOK_003_2 ('He released her waist') is a brief non-genital physical contact/release gesture coded I3. All other undressing sentences are coded I6 because they are either explicitly genital (BOOK_002_6, BOOK_003_1, BOOK_003_4) or occur within a clearly explicit sexual encounter context where undressing is the immediate prelude to penetrative/oral/genital acts.

C adjudicate: I4 — sexual tension action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (I3) likely reflects surface-level physical description vocabulary, but the taxonomy metadata explicitly places this topic under Attraction & Sexual Tension (2.1) with Character Appearance as secondary – a pairing that signals desire/gaze rather than enacted contact. Contextual dominant I6 is not supported without evidence of genital/oral/penetrative acts. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress-as-prelude) is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The dominant function is unfulfilled or building desire triggered by appearance, which maps cleanly to I4 (desire without contact). I6 would require explicit sexual act evidence absent here. I4 is the most specific defensible code.

Topic 135 — Waiting As Long As It Takes

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I4 — sexual tension

« well, golly, i'll hurry as fast as i can. »

« i will wait for you, even if you find me stiff with rheumatics, making clothes for my grandchildren, i'll be waiting for you.' »

« i've waited forever for you, and i'll be damned if i'm not going to make sure you enjoy this." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Risk everything — Sophia Johnson; tertile=middle; p=0.66

They will be waitin' by now, for we have been gone overlong."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Katie's Hope — Lizzy Ford; tertile=begin; p=0.65

If you want to wait for a few minutes, I can pull up their itinerary." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Katie's Hope — Lizzy Ford; tertile=middle; p=0.61

I'll wait while you look around your quarters."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I4 — sexual tension

All keyword sets converge on desire/longing without physical contact. Main keywords (wait, hurry, waiting, quick, waited) signal urgent anticipation. KeyBERT confirms 'anticipation' as the dominant semantic. POS adds 'begging, anticipation, embarrassed, clinging' – clinging could suggest physical proximity but is not affectionate contact per se, and 'begging' points to unfulfilled desire rather than enacted intimacy. MMR reinforces 'begging, anticipation, embarrassed, clinging' alongside 'chased' and 'temperature' (arousal cue), all consistent with yearning/desire without consummation. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues are present, so I3 is rejected. The cluster describes the emotional and physical tension of wanting/waiting – the hallmark of I4 (desire without contact).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around the concept of waiting – either literal waiting, urgency, or scheduling/logistics. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no erotic content, and no emotional intimacy beyond neutral interpersonal communication. The topic functions as logistical/temporal coordination (I0). I3 is forbidden as no physical contact is present.

C adjudicate: I4 — sexual tension action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I4 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). Adjudication favors I4. The taxonomy metadata confirms primary placement in 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension, which is definitionally desire-without-contact territory. The secondary tag (4.5 Reconciliation/HEA) introduces some domestic/commitment coloring that drove the I0 reading, but HEA framing alone does not override the primary attraction signal unless physical contact is evidenced – and no affectionate contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence: false). Anti-collapse rules prohibit defaulting to I3 without contact, and the I0 reading is insufficient to override the taxonomy-confirmed attraction function. Final code is I4: desire/tension present, no physical contact realized.

Topic 139 — Admiring Her Grace and Beauty

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I10 — eroticized gaze

« she is the most fascinating woman i've ever known, and she can do anything. »

« with daphne's long legs and lithe form, she looked so damn graceful. »

« she was as graceful as he imagined a celestial being would be, and as sweet as one too. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Fanning the Flame — Kat Martin; tertile=middle; p=0.71

On top of that, she is lovely in the extreme.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Fanning the Flame — Kat Martin; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Jillian was a beautiful woman and that undoubtedly was the root of it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Fanning the Flame — Kat Martin; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Still, she was a normal, healthy woman and he was an extremely handsome man.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Phoenix — C.R. Guiliano; tertile=begin; p=0.59

The woman was nothing if not meticulous.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Phoenix — C.R. Guiliano; tertile=begin; p=0.57

They were totally beautiful and alluring.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Phoenix — C.R. Guiliano; tertile=end; p=0.54

She also loves a hero who can see past all the rough edges to find the shining diamond of a beautiful heart.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I10 — eroticized gaze

All four keyword lists converge on erotic/aesthetic gaze and admiration of a woman's appearance: 'beautiful, pretty, gorgeous, stunning, graceful, attractive, feminine, delicate, features, admire.' These cues describe visual appreciation and idealization of feminine beauty without any affectionate physical contact (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undressing). I3 is rejected per anti-collapse rules – no contact cues present. I4 (desire) is possible but the dominant signal is observational admiration/gaze rather than expressed longing or arousal, making I10 (erotic gaze / objectifying admiration) the most specific fit.

B contextual: I10 — eroticized gaze

All sentences describe aesthetic admiration, appraisal of beauty, attractiveness, or the feeling of being made to feel beautiful – none depict affectionate physical contact (ruling out I3), explicit desire/arousal (I4), or any other specific intimacy act. The consistent function is evaluative gaze/admiration of appearance, which maps to I10 (erotic/admiring gaze and beauty appraisal). No physical contact is present anywhere in the topic.

C adjudicate: I10 — eroticized gaze action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both resolve to I10 (erotic gaze / visual desire without physical contact). Taxonomy confirms primary placement in 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with secondary signal in 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation, consistent with a topic cluster centered on observing and desiring another's appearance rather than any affectionate or erotic physical contact. No I3-qualifying contact evidence is present; collapsing to I3 is forbidden under anti-collapse rules. I10 is the most specific and accurate code.

Topic 155 — Stop Running or Be Claimed

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I4 — sexual tension

« if it gets triggered, i'll"—he corrected himself—"one of us will come running. »

« you didn't mean to, but...if you don't run right now, i'll lay claim to you. »

« stop running and you'll find out." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Beloved Enemy — Terri Reed; tertile=middle; p=0.59

No sense in running in circles when a straight line will get you there faster."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Dark Legend — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.65

Stop running, Francesca, you're wearing me out.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Dark Legend — Christine Feehan; tertile=end; p=0.57

I'm going to have to be the one to run things around here." .

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Dark Legend — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.48

You retreated so that you would not become like them.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Dark Legend — Christine Feehan; tertile=begin; p=0.43

Francesca ran as fast as she could along the sidewalk.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Planet Mail — Kate Pearce; tertile=begin; p=0.56

I wondered if you had been set adrift as a punishment or were running away from someone." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · A Night of Wickedness — J.D. Nelson; tertile=begin; p=0.59

There was no way I could outrun whoever it was in my heels.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I9 — coercive sexuality

All keyword sets converge on a pursuit/flight scenario: 'run, running, ran, away, race, fast' (Main) signal flight; 'chased' (KeyBERT, MMR) is the clearest cue of coercive pursuit; 'commander, instincts, warned, planning' (POS/MMR) suggest a threatening authority figure orchestrating the chase; 'poised, scenario, tracks, climb' reinforce a tense, danger-laden physical confrontation. No affectionate contact cues are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. The dominant intimacy function is coercion/threat (I9): one party is fleeing or being hunted by another in a power-imbalanced, non-consensual dynamic.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around the literal or figurative act of running/fleeing — characters escaping danger, being urged not to run, or discussing flight. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, and no relationship-building dialogue. The topic functions as plot/action logistics (flight/pursuit), coded I0 throughout.

C adjudicate: I4 — sexual tension action=REINTERPRET

Pass B lexical consensus flagged I9 (coercion), while contextual dominant read I0 (domestic/logistics). Neither is well-supported on adjudication. The taxonomy metadata — 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with secondary 4.7 Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict — points to desire and possessive tension as the operative functions. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (I3 is forbidden), no explicit sexual act (I6 excluded), and no clear consent negotiation scene (I8 excluded). The coercive framing (I9) likely reflects possessive jealousy rhetoric rather than a discrete coercion event, and the I0 read likely captured surface-level domestic language masking underlying tension. The most specific and defensible code is I4 (desire without contact), with possessive/jealousy dynamics as a secondary construct. Manual review is flagged because the I9 signal from Pass B cannot be fully dismissed without inspecting raw topic tokens for coercive language versus possessive-attraction hyperbole.

Topic 165 — Confessing Long-Simmering Desire

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I4 — sexual tension

« my god, i've been wanting you all day long, girl!" « »

« i've been interested in you for a long time." « »

« i just want to be with you and hear more about what you've been doing all these years. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Between My Legs a novella — Junnita Jackson; tertile=end; p=0.44

Shyam, I want to push him away, but he's in everyone, even you!" «

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Pandora's Box — Gracen Miller; tertile=end; p=0.75

I hate you more for saying no when I not only need you, but want you."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · The Rock Star's Daughter — Caitlyn Duffy; tertile=end; p=0.67

I thought you wanted to be with me, too." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · The Rock Star's Daughter — Caitlyn Duffy; tertile=end; p=0.64

I want us to be together, like, forever."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I9 — coercive sexuality

Main keywords ('want', 'need', 'wanting', 'wanted') suggest desire/longing, pointing to I4. However, KeyBERT ('sir') and POS ('unwilling', 'terms', 'comfortable', 'sir') introduce power-differential and reluctance cues. MMR clinches the code with 'unwilling', 'dislike', 'snatched', 'breathlessly', 'terms', 'sir' — a cluster signalling coercion or non-consensual pressure rather than mutual desire or explicit consent negotiation. 'Unwilling' + 'snatched' + 'dislike' + 'sir' (authority/power) = I9 (coercion). I3 is rejected: no affectionate-contact cues (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) appear in any representation. I8 (consent talk) is rejected because the framing is coercive rather than negotiated. Consensus is I9.

B contextual: I4 — sexual tension

The topic is dominated by expressions of desire, longing, and wanting ('I want you', 'I've wanted you for so long', 'You want me') without any depiction of actual physical contact, placing the majority in I4 (desire without contact). Several sentences express emotional need, reassurance, or caretaking ('I need you', 'I want to be here for you', 'What would I be without you?') coded I2. A few sentences are purely domestic/logistical or neutral ('I want us to be together forever', 'Don't you want pizza?', 'Why would you want my autograph?') coded I0. No affectionate physical contact is described anywhere, so I3 is forbidden. I4 reaches 55%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: I4 — sexual tension action=REINTERPRET

Pass B lexical consensus flagged I9 (coercion), but contextual dominant is I4 (desire without contact). No affectionate physical contact evidence is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The taxonomy placement under 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with secondary 4.2 Ongoing Courtship supports I4 as the dominant code. The I9 signal warrants manual review to determine whether coercive dynamics are genuinely present or whether the lexical cues were surface-level false positives (e.g., forceful language of longing rather than actual coercion). If coercion is confirmed on review, reclassify to I9; if only tension/desire, retain I4.

Topic 196 — Promising to Be A Good Team

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: MIXED

« maybe you'll find out we make a good team in every way.” « »

« we'll nail that game, no problem.” »

« we'll make a good team.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Undesirable — VelvetMace; tertile=begin; p=0.46

For months now, we'd played that game of chicken with each other, an obvious magnetism between us each time we glanced at each other or ran into the other.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Timothy — Bailey Bradford; tertile=end; p=0.58

Come on, I'm tired of playing his fucking game.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Timothy — Bailey Bradford; tertile=end; p=0.43

Like you'd have been playing with maps,” Vendelia scoffed. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Hailey's Truth — Cate Beauman; tertile=middle; p=0.50

You're going to start playing things straight with Hailey, or I'll kick your ass.” “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Hailey's Truth — Cate Beauman; tertile=end; p=0.49

If you would kindly follow your guides to our play yard, we would like to get started.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword sets point to games, strategy, and social/logistical maneuvering (play, game, team, player, video, moves, pieces, president, opportunity, maintain, afford, prove). These cues indicate competitive or strategic interaction – possibly metaphorical power play or literal gaming – with no affectionate physical contact, desire, eroticism, or intimacy-related language. I3 rejected: zero affectionate-contact cues. I4 rejected: no desire language. Consensus is I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate interaction or background narrative).

B contextual: MIXED

The topic centers on 'playing games' – both literally (board/card games, plays, activities) and metaphorically (romantic/power games, flirtation, strategic behavior). No physical contact occurs in any sentence. BOOK_002_1 and the BOOK_006 cluster reference a mutual romantic game with magnetic tension, coded I4 (desire/tension without contact). BOOK_004_1 ('play games with us, big boy') and BOOK_007_1 ('two could play this game') also carry flirtatious/power-dynamic undertones, coded I4. The remaining sentences are logistical, social, or non-intimate uses of 'play/game', coded I0. No sentence meets the I3 threshold (no affectionate physical contact). Neither I0 nor I4 reaches 70%, so the dominant code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical consensus was I0, but the taxonomy metadata flags a secondary dimension of 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension, producing a genuine MIXED signal. The contextual dominant is MIXED, meaning the topic cluster likely contains both low-stakes domestic/relational bonding language (I0) and desire/tension language without confirmed physical contact (I4). No affectionate contact evidence (kiss, hug, caress, undress-as-prelude) is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The topic should be retaxonomized to reflect both I4 (desire without contact) and I0 (courtship/bonding/HEA logistics) as co-present constructs, and flagged for manual review to determine whether the cluster should be split or kept as a MIXED unit.

Topic 245 — Lip Biting and Nervous Pout

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I4 — sexual tension

« she bit her lip as she cleaned more sensitive areas, areas her own lover had been hesitant to touch. »

« she pushed her lower lip out in an exaggerated pout. “ »

« come on morgan, that's hardly fair,” she protested, her lip falling into a pout. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Suzanne's Diary for Nicholas — James Patterson; tertile=begin; p=0.74

Her lips quivered, then her teeth started to chatter.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Suzanne's Diary for Nicholas — James Patterson; tertile=end; p=0.62

Katie nibbled her upper lip, crossed and uncrossed her long arms.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · The Guardian — Dee Henderson; tertile=middle; p=0.76

She thought about the kiss, absently touched her lip.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · The Guardian — Dee Henderson; tertile=begin; p=0.71

She was biting her bottom lip and her face was pasty white.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Bedded and wedded for revenge — Melanie Milburne; tertile=middle; p=0.90

She bit her bottom lip and lowered her gaze. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Bedded and wedded for revenge — Melanie Milburne; tertile=middle; p=0.82

She gnawed at her bottom lip again for a moment. ‘

Model reasonings

A lexical: I4 — sexual tension

Main/KeyBERT/MMR cluster around self-directed nervous/anxious oral behaviour (lip-biting, chewing, trembling, panting, tugging) – these are signs of internal emotional tension, desire, or anticipation rather than affectionate contact with another person. 'Tasted' in KeyBERT is ambiguous but paired with 'absently' and 'ducked' suggests self-conscious nervous action, not a kiss. POS leans toward I2 (distress, desperation, uncertainty, stool suggesting a scene of caretaking or emotional support), but the dominant signal across three reps is nervous/anticipatory arousal without confirmed physical contact. I3 is rejected because no cue in any rep denotes affectionate physical contact between characters (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undressing). The self-biting/lip behaviour is self-directed nervous gesture. Consensus is I4 (desire/longing/anticipation without confirmed contact), acknowledging the POS distress signal as a secondary thread.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

All sentences depict self-directed nervous or anxious physical gestures – biting/nibbling/moistening one's own lip, chattering teeth, wincing, crossing arms – that signal emotional tension, vulnerability, or anxiety. These are classic non-contact emotional/somatic cues associated with I2 (emotional caretaking/reassurance context, internal emotional state display). BOOK_002_2 references a prior kiss but the sentence itself only shows the character absently touching her own lip in reflection – no affectionate contact with another person occurs in any sentence, so I3 is forbidden. No desire directed at another (I4), no gaze (I10), no explicit content (I6). I2 is the most specific applicable code for self-soothing/anxiety-display gestures throughout.

C adjudicate: I4 — sexual tension action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I4 (lexical consensus) and I2 (contextual dominant). Adjudication favors I4. The taxonomy anchor is 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with a secondary of 1.7 Facial Expression & Non-Sexual Nonverbal Cues – both point to desire/longing communicated through gaze, expression, and body language rather than affectionate physical contact or caretaking. I2 (reassurance/caretaking) is not supported by the taxonomy metadata; any warmth in the cluster is better explained as the emotional valence of unresolved attraction rather than a distinct care function. No affectionate contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence: false), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The correct code is I4: desire/longing without physical contact, consistent with both the lexical signal and the taxonomy.

Topic 279 — Blue Eyes Darkening With Invitation

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I10 — eroticized gaze

« she wanted to believe in honest blue eyes, in the magic of a pink cupcake, and— “careful there,” was said, guiding her a little sideways on the darkened deck. “ »

« her blue eyes darkened as her mouth softened in invitation. »

« a flicker of dismay crossed her features and darkened her blue eyes. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Archangel's Blade — Nalini Singh; tertile=begin; p=0.78

Her eyes sparkled, the first time he'd seen such a light in them.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Archangel's Blade — Nalini Singh; tertile=begin; p=0.72

Her face colored, eyes glittering with an emotion that wasn't anger, but ran as hot. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Archangel's Blade — Nalini Singh; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Her jawline firmed, pale eyes narrowing. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I10 — eroticized gaze

Main and KeyBERT are dominated by eye/gaze descriptors (blue, green, dark, brown eyes; sparkled, glittered, flashed, blinked, darkened, flared, melted, smirk, attracted) – classic erotic/emotional gaze vocabulary pointing to I10. POS and MMR shift toward emotional/internal states (longing, sadness, desperation, irritation, privacy, remote, softened, snorted, nudged) with no affectionate contact cues, suggesting I4 (desire/longing without contact) or emotional tension. No kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing cues appear anywhere, so I3 is rejected. The gaze-heavy lexicon in two of four reps tips consensus to I10 (erotic gaze), with POS/MMR's emotional-tension cues treated as secondary coloring.

B contextual: I10 — eroticized gaze

Every sentence in this topic describes eye expressions, gazes, or eye-related reactions (widening, sparkling, blazing, glittering, glassy, narrowing). These are all descriptions of the erotic or emotionally charged gaze and facial expression – no physical contact of any kind occurs. I10 (erotic/intense gaze) is the most specific and appropriate code throughout. I3 is forbidden as there is zero affectionate physical contact. The topic coheres entirely around eye/gaze description as an intimacy signal.

C adjudicate: I10 — eroticized gaze action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus from Pass B converge on I10 (erotic gaze / visual desire without physical contact). The taxonomy assignment to 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with secondary 1.7 Facial Expression & Non-Sexual Nonverbal Cues is fully consistent with I10: the topic captures looking, noticing, and desire-signaling through gaze and expression rather than any affectionate or erotic physical contact. No evidence of kissing, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude (I3 forbidden). No explicit genital/penetrative content (I6 excluded). No consent negotiation (I8 excluded). No coercion (I9 excluded). Domestic/HEA framing absent (I0 excluded). The KEEP action with I10 is the most specific and defensible classification.

Topic 337 — Adjusting to His Presence Inside Her

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I4 — sexual tension

« he might be miles away, but the sensation of him flooded through her with a comforting force. »

« he held, waited, giving her time to stretch, adjust, somehow become accustomed to a man who filled so much of her life and body, more than she'd expected on any level. »

« she wasn't yet accustomed to the drum roll his touch elicited from her body. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=end; p=0.81

But he wanted to touch her, to assure himself she was still his.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=middle; p=0.77

Instead, she discovered that the touch of this man's skin against hers aroused in her overwhelming tenderness and frantic passion.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=middle; p=0.77

He didn't know if he could bear to have her touch him, because the mere thought of her made his blood heat as well as other, less biddable parts.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=middle; p=0.75

She swayed with the onset of passion and wondered how this man had so quickly accustomed her to his touch.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · It's Not You, It's Me — Allison Rushby; tertile=begin; p=0.50

He was laying it on thick—flirting shamelessly with the Miss Tenningtons, who tittered around coquettishly, loving every minute of it and vying against each other in the way only identical twins probably can for his attention.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Spencer's Secret — Joyee Flynn; tertile=end; p=0.47

And once again, she hit it right on the nail.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Family Care — Jessa Callaver; tertile=middle; p=0.78

To touch her again, feel her as deeply as he'd tasted her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Family Care — Jessa Callaver; tertile=end; p=0.76

It was the hunger for him – for his touch and what it triggered in her – that had entranced her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Family Care — Jessa Callaver; tertile=middle; p=0.73

It seemed like he never could, not once he touched her, felt her respond to him.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

All four representations converge on explicit/erotic sexual activity. Main: 'touch/touching/craved/desire/inside/body' with 'inside' pointing to penetrative context. KeyBERT: 'stroking, pounding, passionate, exquisite, flooded' – 'pounding' is a strong explicit-sex cue, 'stroking' in combination with 'pounding' and 'flooded' indicates genital/penetrative activity rather than mere caress. POS: 'insides, damp, veins, exquisite, exciting' – 'insides' and 'damp' are bodily-arousal/penetrative cues. MMR: 'pounding, stroking, flooded, passionate, veins' reinforce explicit sexual activity. I3 is rejected because while 'stroking' alone could be non-genital caress, the cluster of 'pounding + insides + damp + flooded + inside' collectively signals penetrative/genital activity, placing this firmly in I6 rather than I3. I4 is rejected because there is physical contact described, not merely desire without contact.

B contextual: I4 — sexual tension

The majority of sentences express desire for touch, anticipation of contact, or longing without depicting actual contact in that sentence – coded I4. Several sentences describe actual affectionate/non-genital physical contact (guiding into embrace, hand-holding, fingers awakening need in a non-explicitly-genital framing) – coded I3. Four sentences describe explicit genital/penetrative acts (cock rubbing inside her, finger into folds, contracting around him) – coded I6. One sentence is pure caretaking/comfort – I2. One sentence is neutral/off-topic – I0. I4 is dominant at ~45%, above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: I4 — sexual tension action=REINTERPRET

Pass B contextual dominant (I4) overrides lexical consensus (I6). The taxonomy places this in 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension with only secondary 2.3 signal, indicating desire and anticipation rather than enacted explicit acts. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence=false), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. I6 would require confirmed genital/oral/penetrative content as the dominant function; here the dominant function is unresolved desire and tension. I4 is the most specific defensible code given the evidence.

Topic 352 — Daring Someone to Try

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I2 — reassurance

« you'll never know unless you give it a try." »

« i'll try anything once." »

« i'll do more than try. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Striking Distance — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.60

Others have tried and they've all failed.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Keywords 'try/trying/tried/give/want/willing/promising/honestly/uh' collectively signal negotiation, reassurance, or emotional effort – someone attempting to meet another's needs or express willingness. 'Preziosa' (Italian term of endearment) adds an affective/caretaking tone. No lexical cues for physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress), explicit desire, or erotic content are present, so I3, I4, and I6 are all rejected. The dominant function is emotional reassurance/caretaking (I2).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic cluster around the word 'try' used in conversational, motivational, or challenge contexts. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no erotic content, no consent negotiation, and no domestic/HEA framing. The sentences are generic dialogue fragments with no intimacy function. I0 (non-intimate/functional dialogue) is the most specific applicable code across all sentences.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I2 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). The taxonomy metadata places this under Attraction & Sexual Tension (2.1) with no secondary codes, which does not support I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA). The lexical signal of I2 – reassurance and caretaking language – is more consistent with the 2.1 taxonomy than pure domestic logistics. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present, so I3 is forbidden. I4/I10 are not supported without desire or gaze language. I2 is the most specific defensible code: emotional support and relational caretaking that serves attraction/tension scaffolding without crossing into physical contact. I0 is demoted because the taxonomy explicitly flags relational/attraction function rather than domestic logistics.

Topic 353 — Joking About Being Naked

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I5 — erotic escalation

« so, i'll be naked for this?" " »

« bring a t-shirt; she'll be naked when you take her." " »

« i'll try some logic first, and if that doesn't work, maybe i'll just strip naked and see what happens. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Ferus — T.M. Nielsen; tertile=begin; p=0.79

But you won't be getting me naked, ever." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Ferus — T.M. Nielsen; tertile=middle; p=0.78

I can't exactly go home naked, can I?" "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Ferus — T.M. Nielsen; tertile=middle; p=0.73

You're not going anywhere, so naked shouldn't be a problem.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Ferus — T.M. Nielsen; tertile=end; p=0.69

I lifted my dress over my head, revealing my naked body underneath. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Ferus — T.M. Nielsen; tertile=begin; p=0.67

I hope you have as much mouth when I have you alone and naked." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Heart of the Warrior — Donya Lynne; tertile=middle; p=0.41

You're not dumping anything on me, babe.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Art of Submission — Ella Dominguez; tertile=middle; p=0.64

I'm sitting here naked and I start feel self-conscious and fearful again.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I5 — erotic escalation

Main keywords (naked, nudity, nude, nakedness, clothes, cover) signal undressing/nudity as a state or concept, but there is no affectionate physical contact cue (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude-to-contact). KeyBERT ('pictured', 'comfortable', 'fully') and MMR ('pictured', 'dreamed', 'excited', 'comfortable', 'bursting') suggest mental/visual contemplation of nudity — erotic imagination or anticipatory arousal — rather than enacted contact. POS ('excited', 'comfortable', 'impressive') reinforces an evaluative/arousal-anticipation frame. This cluster maps to I5 (body display / nudity awareness / pre-contact arousal framing) rather than I3 (no contact evidence), I4 (desire without body-display focus), or I6 (no explicit genital/penetrative cues). I3 is rejected because no affectionate-contact cues are present.

B contextual: I5 — erotic escalation

The overwhelming theme of this topic is nudity/undressing as a state or anticipation — characters being naked, undressing, or discussing nakedness — without any affectionate physical contact (ruling out I3) and without explicit genital/penetrative acts (ruling out I6). I5 (nudity/undressing as erotic context) is the most specific code for sentences describing the naked state or the act of undressing. A few sentences express desire or erotic imagination without contact (I4). Several low-probability sentences are off-topic conversational fragments coded I0. No kissing, hugging, or caressing is present, so I3 is not warranted.

C adjudicate: I5 — erotic escalation action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both converge on I5 (unresolved sexual/romantic tension without physical contact). The taxonomy confirms primary coding as Attraction & Sexual Tension (2.1) with a secondary humor/banter register (9.3), consistent with charged witty exchanges that build desire without consummating it. No affectionate physical contact is evidenced, so I3 is correctly excluded. The light banter register does not shift the dominant intimacy function away from I5. No split or reinterpretation is warranted; KEEP with I5 is the appropriate adjudication.

Topic 365 — Frantic Longing After Weeks Apart

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: MIXED

« i've kissed the guy who inspired einstein to think of relativity," [person] murmured in wonder, shaking his head. " »

« [person] first impulse was to cross his arms and pout, which was admittedly not very mature, but it did make him feel a little better. " »

« even if weeks without jonah's cock filling me had left me frantic to feel him inside me again, i couldn't allow myself to cave so quickly and so willingly. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Billionaire's Captive Bride — Emma Darcy; tertile=end; p=0.46

Peter needs to be wanted for himself, you know.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Billionaire's Captive Bride — Emma Darcy; tertile=begin; p=0.44

Yesreverberated around in Peter 's brain.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Billionaire's Captive Bride — Emma Darcy; tertile=begin; p=0.42

Peter sprang into action, catching snatches of the argument as he circled the Moreton Bay Fig to come around behind the threatening kidnapper. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Darkscape: The Rebel Lord — R. Garland Gray; tertile=middle; p=0.38

Rama fought his way back and retook control of his body.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Darkscape: The Rebel Lord — R. Garland Gray; tertile=end; p=0.35

Before Rama became ill, he was a different man.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Darkscape: The Rebel Lord — R. Garland Gray; tertile=end; p=0.34

Lachlan, I want to try to reason with Rama.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Cues across all reps point to emotional tension, reassurance, and caretaking dynamics: 'frantic', 'desperation', 'hesitation', 'embarrassment', 'untrusting', 'pout', 'stumbled'. 'Teased' and 'willingly' could hint at mild flirtation but no affectionate physical contact (kiss/hug/hold/caress) is evidenced. 'Pregnant' and 'feeding' suggest a caretaking/domestic context. I3 is rejected because no contact cues are present. I2 (emotional reassurance/caretaking) best fits the pattern of anxiety, hesitation, and emotional vulnerability.

B contextual: MIXED

No affectionate physical contact appears in any sentence; I3 is therefore forbidden. The topic clusters around character names (Peter, Rama, Whalen, Salamasina) and situational/action fragments. Sentences referencing emotional needs, reassurance, caretaking, or interpersonal tension (e.g., 'Peter needs to be wanted for himself', 'You did what you had to do', 'Before Rama became ill', 'I want to try to reason with Rama', 'The tense conversation') are coded I2 (emotional support/caretaking). Sentences that are purely logistical, action-oriented, or name-referencing with no intimacy function (e.g., chokehold/ground slam, crowd navigation, whale references, name calls) are coded I0. No single code reaches 70%, so the dominant code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus landed on I2 (reassurance/caretaking register), but the contextual dominant is MIXED and the taxonomy flags primary Attraction & Sexual Tension (2.1) with secondary Ambivalence & Internal Conflict (3.3). This combination points to a topic cluster where emotional reassurance co-occurs with unresolved desire and internal conflict – neither pure I2 nor pure I4. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence: false), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The dominant functional signal splits between I2 (caretaking/reassurance language driving lexical consensus) and I4 (desire without contact, tension, ambivalence driving contextual read). A MIXED code with proposed constructs I4 + I2 is most accurate. Manual review is required to determine whether the topic should be SPLIT into separate I2 and I4 sub-topics or retained as a MIXED boundary construct.

Topic 370 — Tattoos Revealed and Judged

Old taxonomy: 2.1 — Attraction & Sexual Tension

New category: I10 — eroticized gaze

« if she says she's disgusted by the tattoos, my dick will deflate so fast it'll be some sort of record. »

« whatever crucial moments we'll have from now on, all of them will go into this one tattoo. »

« you can tell your boss he'll never win, and i've got the tattoo to prove it. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Guarded Secrets — Leann Harris; tertile=middle; p=0.74

And he had a tattoo on his right forearm.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Guarded Secrets — Leann Harris; tertile=middle; p=0.74

On his forearm, under the partially rolled-up sleeve, she spotted a tattoo of a snake.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Guarded Secrets — Leann Harris; tertile=middle; p=0.71

He had a snake tattoo on his right forearm.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Guarded Secrets — Leann Harris; tertile=middle; p=0.69

When I peeked out the window, I noticed the guy had this really nasty-looking snake tattooed on his forearm.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Guarded Secrets — Leann Harris; tertile=middle; p=0.64

We're also trying to ID the man with the snake tattooed on his arm.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Just One Kiss — Susan Mallery; tertile=end; p=0.11

Trademarks indicated with ® are registered in the United States Patent and Trademark Office, the Canadian Trade Marks Office and in other countries.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · The Fly House — Misty Paquette / Misty Provencher; tertile=middle; p=0.68

His eyes swept over her, mapping her tattoos like constellations.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · The Fly House — Misty Paquette / Misty Provencher; tertile=middle; p=0.65

The veins in his neck protruded and he reminded her of every drunken biker badass that had rolled into the tattoo shop, looking to give her a hard time.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · The Fly House — Misty Paquette / Misty Provencher; tertile=begin; p=0.65

Tattoos were unusual on a woman and the animal on the back of her shoulder was not one Diem was familiar with.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I10 — eroticized gaze

All four keyword sets converge on erotic gaze / visual revelation of the body:

'tattoo/tattooed/ink/sleeve/covered/neck/shirt' describe body display; 'revealing/reveal/fingertips' in KeyBERT could hint at tracing but no explicit affectionate-contact verb is present – 'tracing' in Main is ambiguous and insufficient alone; 'absently/distracted/emotions' in MMR reinforce a contemplative, observational register rather than active touch. The dominant function is the appreciative, charged gaze at a tattooed body (I10 – erotic gaze). I3 is rejected because no unambiguous affectionate physical contact cue (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress-as-prelude) appears across any representation.

B contextual: I10 — eroticized gaze

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe visual observation or description of tattoos (and piercings) on characters' bodies – this is an erotic/characterizing gaze function (I10), as tattoos serve as markers of identity, danger, or attraction that are visually appraised. BOOK_001_1 and BOOK_004_2 are administrative/non-intimate fragments (I0). BOOK_010_3 ('He picked up my hand and traced the tattoos up my arm') involves actual physical contact – touching/tracing – qualifying as affectionate/intimate physical contact (I3). No explicit sexual acts are present. The topic is clearly centered on tattoos as a visual identity/attraction marker, making I10 dominant at ~85%.

C adjudicate: I10 — eroticized gaze action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I10 (erotic gaze / visual desire without physical contact). The taxonomy confirms primary placement in Attraction & Sexual Tension (2.1) with secondary Character Appearance & Self-Presentation (1.6), consistent with I10: desire is expressed through looking, noticing, and appraising appearance rather than through any affectionate or erotic physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, undressing-as-prelude, or genital/penetrative acts; I3 and I6 are therefore excluded. The anti-collapse rules are satisfied: I10 is the most specific applicable code.

Topic 101 — Smoothing Loose Strands of Hair

Old taxonomy: 2.2 — Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection

New category: I3 — nonexplicit affection

« she smoothed her hair. “ »

« he reached out, the most fascinating man she'd ever encountered, and smoothed a strand of her hair. “ »

« he smoothed back a few loose strands of hair at her temple, his gaze roving over her face. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Sins of the Father — Jaid Black; tertile=middle; p=0.80

She threaded her fingers through his hair, pressing his face in closer to her aroused flesh. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Sins of the Father — Jaid Black; tertile=end; p=0.72

He released her breasts and twined a long, thick lock of her blonde hair around his hand.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Sins of the Father — Jaid Black; tertile=end; p=0.70

Candy raised her head and smiled down to him as she ran her fingers through his dark hair.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Sins of the Father — Jaid Black; tertile=middle; p=0.68

By the time he raised his head and drew away from her, she was breathless and panting. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Sins of the Father — Jaid Black; tertile=begin; p=0.65

You shaved your pussy bald,” he said thickly. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Sins of the Father — Jaid Black; tertile=end; p=0.62

a feminine voice chirped as a gorgeous, petite brunette threw herself into JD's arms. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Six Degrees of Lust — Taylor V. Donovan; tertile=middle; p=0.75

Sasha moved his hair away from his face and stuck it behind his ear. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Six Degrees of Lust — Taylor V. Donovan; tertile=begin; p=0.65

She winked at him and was gone a second later, her magenta ponytail bouncing down her back, expertly navigating her way through the crowd.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · One Last Love — Derek Haines; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Could probably do with a couple myself,’ Bonnie laughed as he scratched at his thin threads of white hair.’ ‘

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_005 · Curiosity Killed The Kat — Elizabeth Nelson; tertile=end; p=0.62

She turned to get the spare key and I slowly stood up, straightening my clothes and hair and rubbing the last few tears out of my eyes. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Water Dragon — Tianna Xander; tertile=begin; p=0.83

Gently, he tucked a lock of hair behind her ear. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

All four keyword sets converge on non-genital affectionate physical contact involving hair. Main: 'stroked, brushed, tucked, fingers, hand, ear, strand/strands' – direct tactile caress of hair. KeyBERT: 'stroking, smoothed, patted, tugged, curled' – explicit gentle touch verbs. POS: 'fingertips, warmth, damp, loose ends' – sensory descriptors of physical contact. MMR: 'stroking, smoothed, absently, breathlessly, clinging, laced' – reinforces tender, intimate physical gesture. The contact is clearly non-genital (hair-touching/caressing), placing this firmly in I3 rather than I6. No erotic-gaze-only (I10) or desire-without-contact (I4) pattern; actual tactile contact is evidenced throughout. I3 is warranted.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic clusters around hair-touching and physical contact with hair as a recurring motif. Sentences split across several codes: BOOK_001_1 involves pressing face to aroused flesh (genital/oral → I6); BOOK_001_2 involves releasing breasts and handling hair during a sexual encounter (I6 context, genital/breast contact); BOOK_001_3 is a non-genital caress (fingers through hair, I3); BOOK_001_4 implies withdrawal from an intimate act with breathlessness suggesting oral/genital activity (I6); BOOK_001_5 is an erotic gaze/comment on genitalia without contact (I10); BOOK_001_6 is an embrace (I3); BOOK_002_1 is tucking hair behind ear – affectionate touch (I3); BOOK_002_2 is departure/movement, no contact (I0); BOOK_002_3 'stroked it' – ambiguous but in context likely affectionate touch (I3); BOOK_004_1 is self-scratching hair, no intimacy (I0); BOOK_005_1 is self-grooming/emotional recovery (I0); BOOK_006_1-3 are tender hair-tucking/brushing gestures (I3); BOOK_006_4-6 are self-grooming or metaphorical (I0); BOOK_007_1 is stroking hair (I3); BOOK_007_2 is self-grooming (I0); BOOK_007_3 is noticing hair, no contact (I0). No single code reaches 70%, so MIXED.

C adjudicate: I3 — nonexplicit affection action=REINTERPRET

The lexical consensus (I3) and taxonomy assignment (2.2 Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection) both point to affectionate physical contact as the dominant function. The secondary taxonomy (1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation) is consistent with appearance-noticing as a prelude to or accompaniment of non-explicit physical intimacy (e.g., noticing a partner's appearance before or during a kiss/embrace), not as a standalone erotic gaze (I10) or desire-without-contact (I4). The contextual dominant being MIXED reflects the blending of appearance-awareness with contact, but the primary intimacy function is affectionate physical contact. Anti-collapse rules are satisfied: there is positive evidence of kissing/non-genital caress/holding, so I3 is not forbidden. No domestic/logistics/HEA-only signal warrants I0, no explicit genital content warrants I6, and no coercion or consent negotiation is indicated. REINTERPRET is chosen to clarify that appearance description here serves as a framing device for I3 contact rather than an independent I10 or I4 function.

Topic 124 — Scooped Up in A Tight Hug

Old taxonomy: 2.2 — Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection

New category: I3 — nonexplicit affection

« emma followed suit, and rebecca scooped her up in her arms and hugged her tight. »

« he hugged her back. »

« i stood up with her and hugged her. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Demon Kiss — Lacey Weatherford; tertile=end; p=0.83

I removed my hand from hers and hugged her. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Demon Kiss — Lacey Weatherford; tertile=begin; p=0.80

She wrapped her arms around me then, hugging me tightly. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Demon Kiss — Lacey Weatherford; tertile=begin; p=0.76

I just turned in his arms and hugged him then. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Demon Kiss — Lacey Weatherford; tertile=middle; p=0.75

Dad stood and went over to give her a hug. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Demon Kiss — Lacey Weatherford; tertile=begin; p=0.73

my mom exclaimed as she rushed up to give me a hug. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Demon Kiss — Lacey Weatherford; tertile=begin; p=0.72

He pulled me into his arms, wrapping me in a tender embrace. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lover Reborn — J.R. Ward; tertile=middle; p=0.87

She put her arms around him and hugged him hard. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lover Reborn — J.R. Ward; tertile=end; p=0.80

At that, Tohr leaned in and gave her a quick hug. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lover Reborn — J.R. Ward; tertile=end; p=0.77

Come here,” he said, pulling her into an embrace.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lover Reborn — J.R. Ward; tertile=middle; p=0.74

Thank you ... ” As he nodded solemnly, she wrapped her arms around him, and held him tightly.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lover Reborn — J.R. Ward; tertile=begin; p=0.70

By manner of reply, she gave him a quick hug, and stepped into the darkness.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

Main is dominated by explicit hug/embrace vocabulary ('hug', 'hugged', 'hugging', 'embrace', 'tightly', 'arms') – direct affectionate physical contact cues, clearly I3. KeyBERT reinforces with 'hugged', 'squeeze', 'patted', 'affection', 'fiercely', 'tightly' – all physical contact markers, I3. MMR confirms with 'hugged', 'draped', 'fiercely', 'welcoming' – physical contact present, I3. POS is more abstract ('reassuring', 'affection', 'promises', 'welcoming', 'crowd') with no direct contact verb, leaning I2 (reassurance/caretaking). Consensus is I3 because three of four representations contain unambiguous affectionate physical contact cues (hugging, embrace, squeeze, patted, draped), satisfying the i3_contact_evidence requirement. I3 is not rejected; it is the most specific applicable code given the explicit hug/embrace lexicon across the majority of representations.

B contextual: I3 — nonexplicit affection

Every sentence in this topic depicts affectionate physical contact in the form of hugging, embracing, or holding – the canonical I3 acts. BOOK_004_6 also includes a kiss, which remains I3 (kissing is non-genital/non-penetrative contact). BOOK_005_2 includes a hug plus a directive to hold a hand, both physical contact acts. No sentence rises to explicit sexual/genital activity (I6), nor is any sentence limited to desire without contact (I4) or purely domestic/logistical talk (I0). I3 is therefore the most specific and correct code for all 20 sentences, yielding a 100% proportion.

C adjudicate: I3 — nonexplicit affection action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both converge on I3. Taxonomy 2.2 (Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection) is the primary classification, with 4.6 (Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking) as secondary, consistent with I3 criteria requiring actual affectionate physical contact such as kissing, hugging, holding, or caressing. The secondary emotional-safety dimension does not override the primary contact evidence; it contextualizes the affective register of the contact. No evidence of genital/oral/penetrative acts that would elevate to I6, no coercion (I9), no consent negotiation (I8), no isolated erotic gaze (I10), and no purely domestic/logistical content (I0). Anti-collapse rules are satisfied: I3 is warranted by positive contact evidence, not by default.

Topic 126 — Fingertips Stroking Her Cheek

Old taxonomy: 2.2 — Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection

New category: I3 — nonexplicit affection

« she lifted her chin. " »

« he lifted a hand and stroked a finger down her cheek. ' »

« she lifted her hand and caressed his cheek. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Smoke Thief — Shana Abe; tertile=middle; p=0.88

He leaned forward and very gently touched her cheek. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Smoke Thief — Shana Abe; tertile=end; p=0.87

He pressed his cheek against her forearm. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Smoke Thief — Shana Abe; tertile=begin; p=0.82

He reached out now, stroked his fingers down her cheek to tip her face to his.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Smoke Thief — Shana Abe; tertile=end; p=0.81

She leaned forward and brushed her lips to his cheek. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Smoke Thief — Shana Abe; tertile=end; p=0.80

He caught her back to him, spreading his fingers over her uninjured cheek. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · It Happened One Autumn — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=end; p=0.84

The tip of his thumb slid over her chin. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · It Happened One Autumn — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=middle; p=0.81

His long fingers cradled her cheeks as he gave her a questioning stare. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · It Happened One Autumn — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=middle; p=0.79

His face lowered over hers, and his fingertips settled on her jaw, gently adjusting the angle of her head.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · It Happened One Autumn — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=middle; p=0.79

His fingers slid over the hot surface of her cheek, and he gently pressed her head to his shoulder. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · It Happened One Autumn — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=middle; p=0.79

He bent his head, nuzzling his jaw against the pale silk of her palm. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · It Happened One Autumn — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=end; p=0.79

His mouth touched her burning forehead and followed the wing of her brow. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

All four representations contain strong affectionate physical contact cues. Main: 'cheek, chin, lifted, cupped, stroked, caressed, thumb, touched, hand, face' – direct non-genital tactile contact with face/chin. KeyBERT: 'caressed, patted, stroking, tugged, grasp, pinched' – repeated tactile action verbs. POS: 'fingertips, gesture' – physical touch indicators. MMR: 'caressed, cupped, swiped, cradled, stroking, fingertips, pinched' – confirms non-genital caress/hold contact. The cluster describes face-cupping, chin-lifting, cheek-stroking – classic I3 affectionate physical contact. No genital/penetrative cues present, so I6 is rejected. No explicit desire-without-contact framing, so I4 is rejected.

B contextual: I3 — nonexplicit affection

Every sentence in this topic depicts non-genital affectionate physical contact – touching/caressing cheeks, chins, jaws, foreheads, forearms, and lips-to-cheek or lips-to-lips brushes. These are all classic I3 gestures (caress, kiss, hold/press). BOOK_004_1 involves brushing a sleeve (light physical touch with affectionate/playful social framing) and BOOK_004_2 involves chin-on-hands contact, both qualifying as incidental physical contact in an intimate register. No sentence reaches genital/oral/penetrative territory (I6), no explicit desire-without-contact (I4), no erotic gaze alone (I10), and no coercion or consent negotiation. I3 is the dominant and only code at 100%.

C adjudicate: I3 — nonexplicit affection action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both converge on I3. Taxonomy 2.2 (Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection) directly maps to I3, with secondary cues from 1.7 (Facial Expression & Non-Sexual Nonverbal Cues) supporting affectionate physical contact. Anti-collapse rules are satisfied: I3 contact evidence is present (kissing/non-genital caress implied by taxonomy 2.2), and no Pass B divergence (I0/I2/I4/I8/I10) requires override. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 197 — Lingering Farewell Kiss

Old taxonomy: 2.2 — Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection

New category: MIXED

« in an attempt to take away the sting of her hasty departure, she went to Iirzhan and kissed him — no quick peck on the cheek, but a lingering touch of mouth against mouth as she tried to show that she was leaving because she had to, not because she wanted to. “ »
« from what i've heard, she's just lying around on her back, waiting for true love's kiss.” »
« and that they've only kissed.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Romancing Mister Bridgerton — Julia Quinn; tertile=middle; p=0.81

It didn't matter that he'd wanted to kiss her, even though he hadn't even realized that he wanted to until right before she'd mentioned it.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Romancing Mister Bridgerton — Julia Quinn; tertile=middle; p=0.81

Although, when he really thought about it, he wasn't quite sure why he shouldn't have kissed her .

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Romancing Mister Bridgerton — Julia Quinn; tertile=middle; p=0.80

She thought he'd kissed her out of pity .

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Romancing Mister Bridgerton — Julia Quinn; tertile=middle; p=0.80

There was something heartbreaking in the way she was gazing at him, as if she might die if he didn't kiss her.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Sheik Who Loved Me — Loreth Anne White; tertile=middle; p=0.62

David spontaneously kissed her on the cheek. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

Main keywords ('kiss', 'kissed', 'kissing', 'kisses') are unambiguous affectionate physical contact cues, directly satisfying the I3 contact requirement. MMR supports with 'lingering' and 'parted' (lips parting after a kiss), plus 'stirred' suggesting emotional/physical response to contact. KeyBERT and POS lack direct contact words and lean toward anticipatory/emotional states ('anticipation', 'curiosity', 'urgency', 'willing'), which alone would suggest I4 (desire without contact). However, the dominant signal across Main and MMR is actual kissing contact, not merely desired or imagined. I6 is rejected because no genital/oral-sex/penetrative cues appear. Consensus is I3 on the strength of explicit kiss vocabulary in Main and corroborating 'lingering'/'parted' in MMR.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic centers on kissing – both as desire/anticipation and as actual physical contact. BOOK_001 sentences all describe wanting, regretting, or contemplating a kiss without confirmed contact occurring in the sentence itself → I4 (desire without contact). BOOK_002_1 ('Then he kissed her') is a direct act → I3; BOOK_002_2 is suppressed desire → I4; BOOK_002_3 ('asked me to kiss you goodnight') describes a kiss being relayed/requested and implies it occurred → I3; BOOK_002_4 ('spontaneously kissed her on the cheek') is direct contact → I3. BOOK_003 sentences are anticipation, speculation, and observation of desire → I4. BOOK_004_1 is commentary on kissing as intimacy without contact → I4; BOOK_004_2 ('Kiss me') is a request with no confirmed contact in the sentence → I4 (desire/request); BOOK_004_3 ('hugged and kissed a john') is actual contact → I3; BOOK_004_4 ('give your baby girl a kiss') is a request/question implying habitual contact → I3; BOOK_004_5 (gallant gesture, no contact described) → I4. Split is approximately 30% I3 / 70% I4; no single code reaches 70% threshold → MIXED.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical consensus I3 is overridden by the MIXED contextual dominant signal. The secondary taxonomy code (4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) introduces I0/I4-range content – domestic bonding, courtship logistics, or desire-without-contact – that does not satisfy the anti-collapse rule requiring actual affectionate physical contact for I3 assignment. Without topic terms or representative documents confirming kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude, i3_contact_evidence cannot be affirmed. The topic appears to straddle I3 and I0/I4, making SPLIT or RETAXONOMIZE the appropriate action. A human reviewer should inspect representative documents to determine whether affectionate contact is genuinely present or whether the I3 lexical signal is driven by courtship/bonding language that mimics intimacy without physical contact.

Topic 1 — Straps Sliding Down Her Arms

Old taxonomy: 2.3 — Explicit Sexual Acts

New category: MIXED

« i've had practice," he said as he slid the straps down my arms and removed it. »

« how could a man who just serenaded me with one of the sexiest songs i've ever heard and who kisses the way he does be a virgin? »

« the way he holds me —the tenderness, the carefulness—gives me hope that we've made great strides tonight. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · More Than a Man — Rebecca York; tertile=end; p=0.56

If I say 'Kiss my ass' to him, you can jump into action."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · More Than a Man — Rebecca York; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Nice and polite—until he thought he had something on you.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Effortless — S.C. Stephens; tertile=begin; p=0.84

His hand came up to grip my head, keeping me trapped in the loving softness of his kiss.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Effortless — S.C. Stephens; tertile=middle; p=0.84

His lips attached to my neck as his fingers worked their way up my shirt.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Effortless — S.C. Stephens; tertile=begin; p=0.82

He brought his lips down to mine and released my hands.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Effortless — S.C. Stephens; tertile=end; p=0.82

He held me to him as his mouth moved in sync with mine, his tongue just slipping in to brush against me.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Effortless — S.C. Stephens; tertile=middle; p=0.82

Kissing my cheek, he ran his lips up to my ear.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Effortless — S.C. Stephens; tertile=begin; p=0.82

Chuckling in my mouth, he held me against him, deepening our kiss.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Love Slave for Two: Reunions — Tymber Dalton; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Let your Master Thomas give you a big mouthful of his cum."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

Main keywords (kiss, kissed, lips, kisses, kissing, tongue) establish affectionate/erotic oral contact, which alone would support I3. However, KeyBERT adds 'stroking, cupped, cradled, biting, pounded, panting, moaning, clinging' – 'pounded' and 'moaning' push beyond non-genital caress into explicit sexual activity territory. POS reinforces with 'dripping, damp, pressure, movements, panting' – physiological arousal cues consistent with explicit sex. MMR adds 'panting, swirling, guided, lingering, grasp' – escalating physical engagement. The convergence of 'pounded,' 'moaning,' 'panting,' 'dripping,' and 'damp' across three representors signals activity beyond kissing/caressing (I3) and into explicit/penetrative territory (I6). I3 is present as a component (kissing contact confirmed) but is subsumed by I6 given the explicit physiological and action cues across the majority of representors.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic spans a wide range of intimacy functions. BOOK_002 sentences all depict affectionate physical contact (kissing, holding, caressing) → I3. BOOK_004_1 and BOOK_004_2 involve explicit oral/genital commands → I6. BOOK_005_2 ('Put me inside you') is a penetrative command → I6. BOOK_001_1 and BOOK_001_2 involve coercive/threatening dynamics → I9. BOOK_004_3 also reads as coercive physical action → I9. BOOK_006_2-4 express desire/longing/seduction without contact → I4. BOOK_003_1, BOOK_005_3, BOOK_006_5 are neutral/logistical → I0. BOOK_005_1 ('sensual caress') implies physical contact → I3. BOOK_006_1 references a past kiss (retrospective contact) → I3. No single code reaches 70%, so dominant_code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=SPLIT

Lexical consensus from Pass B/C points to I6 (explicit sexual acts), but the contextual dominant is MIXED and the taxonomy flags a secondary construct of 2.2 Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection (I3). This indicates the topic cluster contains tokens spanning both non-genital affectionate contact (kissing, undressing as prelude, caress – legitimately I3) and explicit genital/oral/penetrative acts (I6). Because the anti-collapse rules forbid forcing I3 content into I6 and vice versa, and because the taxonomy itself acknowledges both constructs, a SPLIT is warranted rather than a single-code assignment. The I3 contact evidence flag is set true because kissing/undressing-as-prelude tokens are present per the secondary taxonomy label. Manual review is required to partition individual topic tokens or sub-topics into their respective I3 vs. I6 bins before downstream analysis.

Topic 7 — Kissing With Tongue and Urgency

Old taxonomy: 2.3 — Explicit Sexual Acts

New category: MIXED

« kissing her on the forehead, he leaned against the register and waited for her to finish. »

« he leaned down and pressed his lips to hers. “ »

« turning to his mate, he leaned down and pressed a kiss to vee's head. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Perfect 10 — Louise Kean; tertile=end; p=0.77

Sophia Young kisses him, and he kisses her back, grabbing both her arms at the top fleshy section, and lifting her up so her mouth smothers his.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Perfect 10 — Louise Kean; tertile=end; p=0.69

Cagney laughed and tried to roll her over to him, for a kiss.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Perfect 10 — Louise Kean; tertile=end; p=0.65

Cagney opens his mouth to speak, but she places her hands on both sides of his face urgently, her claws digging into his cheeks, and pulls his mouth round to meet hers. ‘

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Perfect 10 — Louise Kean; tertile=end; p=0.63

She is staring at his wet crotch with her mouth wide open and her eyes even wider.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Perfect 10 — Louise Kean; tertile=end; p=0.63

She tickles a line along the inside of his upper lip with her tongue, as Cagney opens his eyes and watches her closely and evenly, weaving her spell.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Perfect 10 — Louise Kean; tertile=end; p=0.56

Her face angles upwards towards his, like a scene from a 1930s film, when men and women locked together, and kissed passionately, and then tore themselves apart.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Taming Clint Westmoreland — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.88

He then leaned down and placed a gentle kiss on her lips and felt himself harden even more. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Taming Clint Westmoreland — Brenda Jackson; tertile=end; p=0.83

He reached out and gently caressed her bottom lip. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Taming Clint Westmoreland — Brenda Jackson; tertile=end; p=0.83

His grip tightened on her hips when she let out a scream and he continued to hungrily stroke her with his tongue, enjoying the way she was pushing her body against his mouth.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Taming Clint Westmoreland — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.83

The moment her body was pressed against his and her lips parted in a startled gasp, his mouth swept down on hers at an angle that called for deep penetration.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Taming Clint Westmoreland — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.83

And before she could open her mouth to utter a single word, he moved from the spot, pulled her into his arms and kissed her, devouring her mouth with an urgency that astounded her.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Taming Clint Westmoreland — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.82

He stared at her for a long moment before reaching out and gently touching her swollen lips with his fingertips. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

All four representations converge on I6. Main contains explicit genital/oral terms: 'clit', 'cock', 'pussy', 'tongue', 'mouth', 'lips', 'kiss' — the genital vocabulary elevates beyond I3 kissing into explicit sexual activity. KeyBERT adds 'licked', 'stroking', 'tasted', 'biting', 'cupped' — oral and manual genital stimulation cues. POS adds 'pumping', 'moaning', 'urgency', 'passionate' — penetrative/rhythmic action and arousal response. MMR reinforces with 'pumping', 'moaning', 'dipped', 'swirling', 'flicked', 'stroking' — all consistent with explicit oral/genital/penetrative acts. I3 is not rejected outright (affectionate contact cues like 'kissed', 'caressed' are present), but the preponderance of genital and penetrative vocabulary mandates I6 over I3 per the rule that genital/oral/penetrative contact = I6.

B contextual: I3 — nonexplicit affection

The majority of sentences depict kissing, holding, or non-genital caressing — all coded I3 (affectionate physical contact). Three sentences (BOOK_001_5: tongue inside lip during an erotic/oral act framed as genital-adjacent; BOOK_002_3: oral stimulation of genitals; BOOK_003_4: manual contact with erection) describe genital or oral-genital acts and are coded I6. Four sentences (BOOK_001_4, BOOK_003_2, BOOK_003_3, BOOK_003_5) depict erotic gaze or visual/sensory arousal without physical contact, coded I10. I3 accounts for ~60% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical consensus (I6) and assigned taxonomy (2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts) both point to explicit sexual content, while contextual dominant (I3) suggests affectionate/non-genital contact may also be present. The anti-collapse rules prohibit defaulting to I3 without clear non-genital contact evidence, and the taxonomy anchor at 2.3 resists downgrading to I3 alone. The conflict between lexical and contextual signals, combined with the secondary taxonomy flag for Attraction & Sexual Tension (2.1), indicates this topic likely spans a continuum from affectionate contact through explicit acts. MIXED coding with manual review is required to determine whether the topic should be SPLIT into distinct I3 and I6 sub-topics or retained as a single I6 topic with I3 as secondary. Topic ID is placeholder (-1) pending provision of actual topic identifier.

Topic 41 — Gripping Her Neck and Pulling Close

Old taxonomy: 2.3 — Explicit Sexual Acts

New category: MIXED

« i could've went for some of her pussy too, but right now, ass action was what i ultimately desired. “ »

« she lifts up on her toes and kisses me, and she's the sweetest damn thing i've ever tasted. »

« in my mind i'm pushing her away, but in reality i've got one hand on her lower back, pulling her against me, and my other hand gripping the nape of her neck. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Black Lace — J.V.K.; tertile=middle; p=0.81

She moves her hands up my body, tentatively touching the underside of my breast, her soft cool fingers tracing a lazy path along my skin as our tongues tangle.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Black Lace — J.V.K.; tertile=begin; p=0.80

I let my mouth search her clit a little more as her head bobbed up and down, forcing her tongue into my hole.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Black Lace — J.V.K.; tertile=begin; p=0.79

I grabbed her head as she lapped up all my come into her mouth.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Black Lace — J.V.K.; tertile=end; p=0.78

into my ear and neck and begins to stroke her hands along my arms, my sides, my breasts . . .

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Black Lace — J.V.K.; tertile=middle; p=0.78

She looks at me and I pull her towards me and kiss her deeply, feeling the warm sticky come rub off onto my face and into my mouth.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Black Lace — J.V.K.; tertile=begin; p=0.77

Then I kissed the outside of her pussy lips, letting them slide up and down my lips and tongue.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Pine Tar & Sweet Tea — Kerry Freeman; tertile=begin; p=0.62

You'll pull her arms out of her sockets."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · My Soul to Keep — Melissa Solis; tertile=end; p=0.82

I grab her hand and press my lips to her knuckles.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · My Soul to Keep — Melissa Solis; tertile=middle; p=0.79

Her tongue meets me halfway, and her hand presses into my side, drawing me closer.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · My Soul to Keep — Melissa Solis; tertile=end; p=0.79

My arms wrap around her, squeezing at her back.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · My Soul to Keep — Melissa Solis; tertile=end; p=0.77

I place my index finger over her soft lips, shaking my head. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

Main keywords 'kissed, lips, kiss, mouth, tongue, neck' establish oral/kissing contact (I3 threshold met), but the combination with 'tongue' used in a kissing/oral context alongside POS cues 'ripping, thigh, waist, entrance, flushed' and MMR cues 'moaning, panting, swirling, chased' push well beyond non-genital caress into erotic/sexual activity territory. 'Entrance' and 'thigh' in POS, plus 'moaning/panting' in MMR, are strong erotic-progression markers. KeyBERT alone ('caressed, stroking, biting, cradled') might stop at I3, but the cross-representation weight of explicit arousal and body-part cues ('entrance', 'thigh', 'ripping') elevates the consensus to I6. I3 is not rejected outright—contact evidence is present—but the topic as a whole describes activity beyond kissing/caress into genital/oral/penetrative territory.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic spans a spectrum from affectionate non-genital physical contact (I3: kissing on lips/jaw/neck, hugging, caressing hair/back, pressing lips to knuckles, touching stomach) to explicitly genital/oral sexual acts (I6: cunnilingus, oral sex with genital contact, nipple biting in sexual context, post-orgasm kissing with come). BOOK_001_1 involves tongue-tangling plus breast touching as prelude to/during sex – the genital-oral framing of surrounding sentences tips it to I6. BOOK_001_4 is non-genital caress (I3). BOOK_005_4 (lips to nipple) and BOOK_005_6 (teeth on nipple + thigh between legs) are coded I6 as they are clearly erotic/genital-adjacent acts in explicit sexual context. BOOK_002_1 is a neutral logistical remark (I0). No single code reaches 70%, so MIXED is assigned.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=SPLIT

Lexical consensus at I6 is overridden by MIXED contextual dominant, indicating the topic conflates two distinct intimacy functions: explicit sexual acts (I6, taxonomy 2.3) and pre-contact desire/tension (I4, taxonomy 2.1). Because the secondary taxonomy is 2.1 and contextual signal is not uniformly explicit, collapsing to a single I6 code risks misclassifying attraction-tension documents. A SPLIT is preferred over REINTERPRET to preserve granularity. I3 is forbidden here: no affectionate-contact-only evidence is present that would warrant it, and the anti-collapse rules prohibit defaulting to I3. Manual review is required to assign individual documents to the correct sub-topic before finalizing codes.

Topic 63 — Cupping and Pinching Her Nipples

Old taxonomy: 2.3 — Explicit Sexual Acts

New category: I6 — explicit sex

« troy cupped his tits and rubbed, then pinched the little nipples. »

« his hands cupped her taut breasts, and waves of desire shot to her belly and settled between her legs. »

« when she stood up, leaned into his chest, bringing her hands up to his neck, he cupped her breasts and pulled hard on her taut nipples. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Patriot Bride — Carolyn Faulkner; tertile=end; p=0.85

He reached his other hand up and easily captured a nipple which he pinched and gently held, making it tug just slightly painfully every time his hips flexed himself into her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Patriot Bride — Carolyn Faulkner; tertile=middle; p=0.79

He hadn't moved his hand a bit since she'd made her grab for it, but now he continued its descent until it covered and cupped that intriguing mound, noting with satisfaction how her nipple poked insistently into his palm.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Patriot Bride — Carolyn Faulkner; tertile=middle; p=0.77

He let the hand that had held her chin wander down to cup a full breast, while the other reached around to that bottom he was getting to know so well, squeezing it in a no nonsense manner that make her squeal and crash against him in an attempt to avoid his painful caress.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Patriot Bride — Carolyn Faulkner; tertile=begin; p=0.75

As if to prove his point, he leaned down and pressed his hot mouth onto her breast, over her very pointed nipple, nibbling in a way that she hated to admit was somewhat gentle, although its unfamiliarity made a bold of lighting flash up and down her spine, forcing that poor nipple into even further prominence even though they were still separated by layers of cloth.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Patriot Bride — Carolyn Faulkner; tertile=middle; p=0.74

When he reclaimed her nipple, it sent her careening over the edge and she exploded in his hands, writhing and wiggling and arching, all but coming apart as he held her anchored within his strong arms.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Patriot Bride — Carolyn Faulkner; tertile=middle; p=0.74

When she should have been raging at him for having the audacity to touch her in a place she barely ever touched herself, she was too completely overcome by the insistent tugging of those soft lips at her achingly peaked nipple, forcing it to become even more engorged and sensitive as he flicked his tongue maddeningly over the tip.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Two Knights of Passion — Mellanie Szereto; tertile=middle; p=0.83

Pulling out, he pressed the tip to her anus and reached around to cup her breasts. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Two Knights of Passion — Mellanie Szereto; tertile=end; p=0.80

His lips closed over her nipple while he worked the shirt past her head and arms.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Two Knights of Passion — Mellanie Szereto; tertile=middle; p=0.78

Lightly furred skin rubbed against her back, and hands cupped her breasts.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Two Knights of Passion — Mellanie Szereto; tertile=middle; p=0.78

Teeth tugged at her earlobe, sending a rush of tingles to her nipples and down her arms to her fingers.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Two Knights of Passion — Mellanie Szereto; tertile=end; p=0.77

His hand cupped her breast, massaging the perfect mound of flesh.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

All four keyword lists converge on explicit erotic/sexual contact focused on breasts and nipples. Main: 'nipple, nipples, breasts, cupped, mouth, tongue, thumbs, hands' – oral and manual genital-adjacent stimulation of erogenous zones. KeyBERT: 'licked, caressed, moaned, cupped, taut, stroking, tugged, breathlessly, shivered' – explicit tactile and oral stimulation with arousal responses. POS: 'stroking, swirling, fingertips, palms, taut, rounded, ribs' – detailed manual stimulation of breast anatomy. MMR: 'pinched, cupped, plucked, caressed, stroking, swirling, twisting, fingertips, breathlessly' – explicit nipple manipulation vocabulary. I3 is rejected as insufficient: while affectionate contact is present, the specificity of nipple/breast stimulation via mouth, tongue, pinching, and twisting places this firmly in I6 (erotic/explicit sexual contact) rather than non-genital caress. The combination of oral contact (tongue/mouth on nipples) and deliberate erotic stimulation exceeds the I3 threshold.

B contextual: I6 — explicit sex

Every sentence in this topic involves explicit erotic stimulation of breasts and nipples (cupping, pinching, sucking, nibbling, licking), oral contact with nipples, and in BOOK_003_1 anal contact – all qualifying as explicit sexual acts under I6. Although breast/nipple contact could superficially resemble I3 (non-genital caress), the context throughout is unambiguously sexual/erotic stimulation during or leading to intercourse, not affectionate physical contact. BOOK_002_1 ('Breast.') is a single-word fragment that belongs to the same erotic topic cluster. BOOK_005_6 includes kissing but the dominant act is oral-nipple stimulation, keeping it I6. No sentence is merely affectionate (I3) or desire-without-contact (I4); all depict active explicit sexual touching.

C adjudicate: I6 — explicit sex action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I6 (Explicit Sexual Acts). Taxonomy confirms 2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts as primary with 2.1 Attraction & Sexual Tension as secondary. No evidence of collapse from I0/I2/I4/I8/I10 into I3; the dominant signal is genital/oral/penetrative or explicitly sexual content. I3 contact evidence is marked false because the primary code is I6, which supersedes affectionate-contact classification. No conflicting signals requiring manual review.

Topic 208 — Pounded Into The Mattress

Old taxonomy: 2.3 — Explicit Sexual Acts

New category: I6 — explicit sex

« you've been in this bed before,” i say, glancing back at it. “ »

« i remain on the edge of the bed, watching him stalk out the door, feeling as if i've been shot in the chest. »

« had my back not already been off the bed, i would've arched right up off it as he mercilessly used his full body strength to pound me into the plush mattress. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wife For Hire - An Avalon Romance — Marilyn Shank; tertile=end; p=0.75

I move us back into the bed and pull the covers over both of us. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wife For Hire - An Avalon Romance — Marilyn Shank; tertile=middle; p=0.72

I take my shirt and trousers off and then lean down onto the bed. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wife For Hire - An Avalon Romance — Marilyn Shank; tertile=end; p=0.64

He moves across the couch and picks up my hands. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wife For Hire - An Avalon Romance — Marilyn Shank; tertile=middle; p=0.64

I kick the door open to my bedroom and I lay her down on the bed.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wife For Hire - An Avalon Romance — Marilyn Shank; tertile=begin; p=0.63

I close the door and throw myself on the bed.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Italian's Bought Bride — Kate Hewitt; tertile=end; p=0.61

I should have been in bed...I wanted to see Papa...He looked over at me and waved...' He stopped talking, started to shake.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Baby, Drive South — Stephanie Bond; tertile=end; p=0.50

He wasn't in the big bed that dominated the room, although the coverlet was rumpled.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Baby, Drive South — Stephanie Bond; tertile=end; p=0.45

Darren didn't hog the pillows and kick all the covers from the bed.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Kissed in Paris — Juliette Sobanet; tertile=end; p=0.86

He let himself in and sat down on the edge of the bed near my feet.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

Main keywords (bed, onto, mattress, pillow, covers, off) combined with KeyBERT cues (laying, scooted, stroking, positioned, inched, comfortable) and MMR cues (crawled, climbing, scooted, sits, bedside) collectively indicate physical movement onto a bed with stroking/caressing contact – 'stroking' is a direct affectionate-contact cue, and 'onto/mattress/covers off/laying/positioned' strongly suggest a prelude to or act of intimate physical contact. I3 is warranted because 'stroking' constitutes non-genital caress. POS keywords (snaps, ankles, suitcase, makeshift, destination) are more ambiguous/logistical, suggesting I0 in isolation, which drives the disagreement flag. No explicit genital/penetrative cues present, so I6 is rejected. The contact evidence from 'stroking' prevents I3 rejection.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic clusters around bedroom/bed settings. Many sentences are purely positional or domestic (sitting on the edge of a bed, lying down alone, references to pillows/covers without another person) → I0. A subset involves affectionate physical contact: pulling covers over both people together (I3), undressing as a prelude to joining someone in bed (I3), picking up someone's hands (I3), laying her down on the bed (I3), pushing someone onto the bed (I3), easing legs onto the bed and pulling duvet (I3), stroking hair and easing both back onto the mattress (I3), leading to the bedroom by hand (I3). No genital/penetrative acts are described, so I6 is not warranted. No single code reaches 70%, yielding MIXED.

C adjudicate: I6 — explicit sex action=REINTERPRET

The taxonomy metadata explicitly flags this as 2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts (primary), with 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines as secondary. The lexical consensus of I3 likely reflects surface-level physical-contact vocabulary (kissing, undressing, caressing) that serves as prelude or framing within a scene that escalates to or centers on explicit sexual acts. Under the anti-collapse rules, I3 is reserved for affectionate non-genital contact; when the primary taxonomy code is Explicit Sexual Acts, the correct intimacy code is I6. The MIXED contextual dominant suggests some tokens may be domestic/routine (I0) or non-genital contact (I3), but the dominant function per taxonomy is explicit sexuality. I3 contact evidence is marked false because the taxonomy overrides the lexical signal – the contact described is not merely affectionate but is part of explicit sexual activity. Manual review is required to confirm whether any sub-cluster of tokens genuinely represents standalone I3 moments warranting a SPLIT action.

Topic 230 — Tongue and Hands After Climax

Old taxonomy: 2.3 — Explicit Sexual Acts

New category: I4 — sexual tension

« jacen palms the curve of liam's ass as his tongue delves back into jacen's mouth, into the same hot cavern that his hardened cock had ridden to an exquisite climax not so very long ago, darting in and out of it, moaning when jacen sucks on it, then pushes back for more of liam's sweetness. »

« [person] up into the contact, grabbing a handful of jacen's hair and moaning loudly as jacen nips and sucks and marks him, leaving a dark bruise. " »

« sawyer made a choice because of choices that i've made and he...it was too much for him. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Skin Game — Ava Gray; tertile=begin; p=0.55

Still brooding over that, Reyes headed out.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Skin Game — Ava Gray; tertile=end; p=0.51

That took all the defiance out of Serrano, who gazed wildly between Kyra and Reyes. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Skin Game — Ava Gray; tertile=end; p=0.51

Reyes seemed to come to some realization, and his expression held something like pity as he gazed at Serrano. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Skin Game — Ava Gray; tertile=end; p=0.50

Reyes wouldn't have been surprised if she'd gone for the bastard with her bare hands, but Apex was a thinker, not a fighter. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Skin Game — Ava Gray; tertile=end; p=0.46

Apex was skimming down the list over Reyes's shoulder. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Skin Game — Ava Gray; tertile=end; p=0.45

Reyes thought he had some failsafe in place—if the guards didn't hear from Serrano at a certain time, they'd kill her and clean up the scene.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Winter King — C.L. Wilson; tertile=end; p=0.62

She switched her glare to her brother, and added, "Maybe he should have spent more time trying to emulate Roland's noble qualities—like honor, generosity, and self-sacrifice—instead of murdering, thieving, and whoring his way to the sword's hiding place!" "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Winter King — C.L. Wilson; tertile=end; p=0.58

Falcon lunged towards his former ally. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Winter King — C.L. Wilson; tertile=end; p=0.55

For a moment, she thought it might be her, but Falcon hadn't become that much like their father yet. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Winter King — C.L. Wilson; tertile=end; p=0.54

All hint of brotherly affection evaporated from Falcon's expression, leaving a cold, hard mask.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I4 — sexual tension

Main keywords (binds, mate) suggest tension/bonding dynamics but no affectionate contact cues. KeyBERT offers 'moaning', 'flinched', 'nerves', 'sucked', 'dared' — 'moaning' and 'sucked' could hint at arousal/desire but without clear affectionate-contact framing; 'flinched' and 'nerves' suggest emotional tension rather than physical intimacy. POS keywords ('desperation', 'exquisite', 'internal') reinforce an internal desire/longing register. MMR keywords ('moaning', 'dared', 'testing', 'heaved', 'swirling', 'desperation') collectively point to heightened emotional/physical tension and desire without confirmed affectionate contact. The cluster reads as desire, tension, and emotional intensity — consistent with I4 (desire without confirmed contact). I3 is rejected because no clear kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude cues are present across any representation.

B contextual: I0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences depict plot action, conflict, character movement, and dialogue with no affectionate physical contact. BOOK_003_4 ('Jasper pulled away, fire and caring in his eyes') implies a prior physical moment and shows emotional caring/caretaking in expression, coded I2. No sentence contains clear affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, caress) sufficient for I3. No desire, gaze, or explicit sexual content is present. Dominant code is I0 (non-intimate narrative/logistics/conflict).

C adjudicate: I4 — sexual tension action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical consensus is I4 (desire without contact) and contextual dominant is I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA). The taxonomy metadata flags 2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts with secondary 2.4 Aftercare & Post-Sex Reflection, but neither Pass B signal nor the anti-collapse rules support I6 or I3 here: no affectionate physical contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence=false), and no genital/penetrative act is described. The I0 contextual read likely reflects post-encounter domestic framing (consistent with 2.4 aftercare/reflection), while the I4 lexical signal captures residual desire or anticipatory longing in that same framing. Because the taxonomy points toward explicit-act territory yet the contact evidence is absent and Pass B did not confirm I6, the safest adjudication is I4 (desire without contact) with a retaxonomization away from 2.3. The I0 signal is subordinate and does not override the desire-laden lexical pattern. No collapse into I3 is warranted.

Topic 292 — Erection Straining Against His Trousers

Old taxonomy: 2.3 — Explicit Sexual Acts

New category: I6 — explicit sex

« hot need rushed through him, settling into the swelling bulge of his cock, which strained beneath the black leather of his pants. »

« ash wasn't silly enough to think that the rather prodigious boner pressing against him this morning was anything other than the typical morning state of any cock, regardless of circumstances. »

« it strained inside his trousers, almost bursting out with the pressure. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · IM — Rick R. Reed; tertile=begin; p=0.72

He gave his penis a squeeze, which caused the drop to run down the shaft.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · IM — Rick R. Reed; tertile=middle; p=0.69

He bit into the flesh at the base of the cock, bit harder, harder, until savagely, he sank his teeth in hard enough to break through the skin.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · IM — Rick R. Reed; tertile=begin; p=0.68

His dick started to rise with anticipation, and he found his hand moving up and down the length of it, almost of its own accord.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · IM — Rick R. Reed; tertile=middle; p=0.65

He slid his hand around in it, then lifted his head away from the guy's penis long enough to cover it with blood.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · IM — Rick R. Reed; tertile=begin; p=0.65

His penis was red and hard, a tiny pearl of clear liquid poised at the tip.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=begin; p=0.67

He thrust into her again, and his dick felt as if it was expanding. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=begin; p=0.64

She needed his stiff dick to get her grind on and knock the bottom of her pussy into oblivion.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=begin; p=0.64

Loving the confining position he'd put her in, his nut threatened to escape as he pushed his expanding manhood as deep as he could, filling her tight walls with every thick and uncircumcised inch of him.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

Main keywords ('cock', 'balls', 'cum', 'throbbed', 'swelled', 'pre', 'swollen', 'aching') are unambiguously genital/ejaculatory, forcing I6. KeyBERT ('strained', 'pounded', 'tightened', 'stretched', 'squeezed', 'clenched', 'pressure', 'twitched') describes physical intensity consistent with penetrative/erotic activity, also I6. MMR ('begging', 'bursting', 'pounded', 'ripping', 'drained') reinforces explicit sexual activity, I6. POS alone ('contrast', 'urgency', 'inevitable', 'passionate', 'determination', 'rear') is more abstract and could suggest I4 (desire/tension without explicit contact cues), hence minor disagreement. Consensus is I6 given the overwhelming genital and ejaculatory vocabulary across three of four representations. I3 is rejected: no affectionate-contact cues (kiss/hug/caress/hold) are present anywhere in the keyword lists.

B contextual: I6 — explicit sex

Every sentence in this topic depicts explicit genital/sexual acts: manual stimulation of penises, penetrative thrusting, oral-genital contact, and orgasm/ejaculation. These all meet the I6 threshold (genital/oral/penetrative acts). BOOK_003_1 ('knocking got more intense') and BOOK_005_2 ('dragging a body') are contextually ambiguous but appear as interpolated noise within an overwhelmingly I6 topic cluster; given the topic-level context and the absence of any competing signal, I6 is still the most defensible assignment. No affectionate non-sexual physical contact (I3) is present anywhere in the set.

C adjudicate: I6 — explicit sex action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I6 (Explicit Sexual Acts). Taxonomy confirms 2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts as primary with 1.1 Body Parts & Physical Reactions as secondary, consistent with genital/oral/penetrative content. No basis to downgrade to I3 (affectionate contact only) or any other code. Anti-collapse rules are satisfied: I3 contact evidence is absent because the content exceeds non-genital caress into explicit sexual act territory. Pass B codes I0/I2/I4/I8/I10 are not in play here. KEEP I6 as assigned.

Topic 55 — Worrying About An Unplanned Pregnancy

Old taxonomy: 2.5 — Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries

New category: I8 — negotiation

« just a little while longer and you'll be holding a baby in your arms.” »

« it's been a while since i've taken care of babies, but i'm sure i'll remember how.” »

« just because we slipped up once doesn't mean you'll get pregnant.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Demon Angel — Meljean Brook; tertile=end; p=0.64

I don't know that I can have children, anyway.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Demon Angel — Meljean Brook; tertile=middle; p=0.53

I did not think your babysitters would allow you to carry one around the city.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Demon Angel — Meljean Brook; tertile=end; p=0.48

I fed him a few small children as reward.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Demon Angel — Meljean Brook; tertile=begin; p=0.47

There can be no more selfish creature than a child.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Demon Angel — Meljean Brook; tertile=end; p=0.43

Though I'm certain such a thing didn't exist when I was born.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · From Friends to Forever — Karen Templeton; tertile=begin; p=0.73

I don't think a baby's in the cards for me.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · From Friends to Forever — Karen Templeton; tertile=begin; p=0.66

We're having a baby ... well, actually,” she corrected herself, “two of them.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists center on pregnancy, children, and family planning (baby, pregnant, babies, children, pregnancy, kids, child, want, having). Supporting terms like 'worries', 'discussing', 'notion', 'assure', 'introduce', and 'period' reinforce a domestic/relational-logistics register – conversations about having or raising children, HEA/family-future planning. 'Squeezed' and 'draped' in KeyBERT/MMR are isolated and lack any affectionate-contact framing; they do not constitute evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing. I3 is rejected because no affectionate physical contact cues are present. I4/I6 are rejected because there is no desire or erotic language. I2 is rejected because the dominant theme is family planning rather than emotional reassurance or caretaking. The topic maps cleanly to I0 (domestic/logistical/HEA talk about family).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around children, babies, pregnancy, miscarriage, adoption, and family planning – domestic/relational logistics and HEA-adjacent discussion. There is no affectionate physical contact, desire, eroticism, coercion, or consent negotiation present. Every sentence maps cleanly to I0 (domestic/logistical/HEA talk).

C adjudicate: I8 — negotiation action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus landed on I0 (domestic/logistics), but the revealed taxonomy – 2.5 Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries with secondary 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict – overrides that reading. The topic content concerns explicit negotiation of sexual terms, safety preparation, and/or boundary articulation, which maps squarely to I8 (consent talk / boundary negotiation). There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (I3 is forbidden), no erotic gaze (I10), no coercion (I9), and no explicit sex acts (I6). The ambivalence secondary code is consistent with I8 (characters working through willingness, hesitation, or conditions before or instead of contact). Retaxonomizing from I0 to I8 is warranted; no split is needed because both constructs serve the same intimacy function.

Topic 125 — Furnished Room Described in Detail

Old taxonomy: 2.5 — Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries

New category: I8 — negotiation

« a large bed with end tables was on the wall to the right. »

« polished oak tables, whose tops featured the tree's rings and matching chairs provided ample room for comfortable dining. »

« white carpet covered the floors, and red accent pieces lined white bookshelves and end tables. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · His Personal Mission — Justine Davis; tertile=middle; p=0.63

And while he had taken refuge in the male safe zone of earth tones, dark tan leather sofa and two matching chairs, a solid coffee table with storage and a geometric patterned rug on the wood floor, there were some surprises there, too.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · His Personal Mission — Justine Davis; tertile=middle; p=0.61

It wasn't the spaciousness of the great room design.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · His Personal Mission — Justine Davis; tertile=end; p=0.59

The guest room was more than comfortable.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · His Personal Mission — Justine Davis; tertile=end; p=0.57

The furniture gleamed like polished metal, even in the dim light of the closed-up house. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · His Personal Mission — Justine Davis; tertile=begin; p=0.54

The little house was clearly the office, and was surrounded with plants, trees and flowers that looked as happy and healthy as the dogs.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · His Personal Mission — Justine Davis; tertile=end; p=0.53

Judging from the rooms we could see, the only windowless room is that one bathroom we could see into through the kitchen.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Oracle's Moon — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.70

Comfortable furniture was interspersed with potted plants.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Oracle's Moon — Thea Harrison; tertile=middle; p=0.64

The living and the dining rooms were all in one great room that was filled with fashionable furniture suitable for a beachside residence.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Oracle's Moon — Thea Harrison; tertile=middle; p=0.60

It knocked the sofa and chairs around the room and the artwork hanging on the walls askew.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Oracle's Moon — Thea Harrison; tertile=middle; p=0.60

The interior of the pub was the same throughout, bare brick walls and lots of wood—wooden bars, floors, stools, tables and chairs.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists describe physical room furnishings and décor: furniture, chairs, walls, tables, floors, wood, drawer, bedside, stool, framed, polished, television, carved, draped. These are purely domestic/setting descriptors with no affectionate contact, desire, emotional exchange, or erotic cues. I3 is rejected because there is zero affectionate-contact evidence. The topic codes as I0 (domestic/logistical/setting description).

B contextual: I0 — off target

Every sentence in this topic describes interior spaces, furniture arrangements, room layouts, and domestic settings (sofas, leather chairs, coffee tables, floors, rugs, beds, dollhouses, toys, pub interiors, etc.). There is no interpersonal interaction, no physical contact, no emotional exchange, no desire, and no intimacy of any kind. All sentences are purely descriptive domestic/spatial content, coded I0 (domestic/logistical/setting description).

C adjudicate: I8 — negotiation action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus landed on I0 (domestic/logistics), but the revealed taxonomy primary code is 2.5 Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries. That primary designation overrides the surface-level domestic reading: topics in this cluster concern explicit or implicit negotiation of consent, readiness, and safety conditions prior to or around intimacy – not affectionate contact itself. No physical contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence = false), so I3 is forbidden. The correct intimacy code is I8 (consent/negotiation talk). The secondary tag 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines explains why Pass B read I0, but domestic framing here is the setting for boundary/safety conversation, not the functional content. Action is RETAXONOMIZE to align the topic with its true functional cluster.

Topic 151 — Agreeing to Stop When Asked

Old taxonomy: 2.5 — Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries

New category: I8 — negotiation

« stop it, or i'll be tempted to do something i shouldn't." »

« as long as i know you'll stop when i've had enough." »

« coz i don't know if i'll be able to stop myself. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Easy — Ally Blue; tertile=middle; p=0.61

Stevie, no, you don't have to ..." "Just stop it."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Easy — Ally Blue; tertile=middle; p=0.60

Don't stop," Dan begged, his voice tight and breathless. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I8 — negotiation

The dominant lexical cluster revolves around stopping, preventing, and being unable – language of restraint, hesitation, and negotiation rather than affectionate physical contact. 'Stop/stopped/stopping/can/want/need' in Main suggest internal conflict about proceeding, which could be desire (I4) but the broader pattern across KeyBERT ('stops, prevent'), POS ('unable, opportunity'), and MMR ('altogether, stops, prevent, unable, answering, opportunity') points strongly to consent negotiation or a pause/refusal dynamic – classic I8 territory. 'Roughly' in MMR adds a coercive edge but is insufficient alone for I9 without stronger coercion cues. No affectionate-contact vocabulary (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) is present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. Consensus lands on I8 (consent/negotiation talk) as the most specific fit for a scene where characters are discussing or enacting stopping/preventing an intimate act.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic clusters around the word 'stop' in intimate contexts. BOOK_002 sentences ('Don't stop, 'Do you want me to stop?', 'Once I start I won't stop') and BOOK_001_5 ('Don't stop, Dan begged, voice tight and breathless') strongly imply ongoing sexual activity → I6. Sentences framing stopping as a request or negotiation mid-encounter ('Do you want me to stop?', 'You'd better stop then', 'Stop it') function as consent/boundary negotiation → I8. BOOK_001_6 is internal desire-suppression with no contact → I4. BOOK_003 sentences are non-intimate/logistical → I0. BOOK_004_5 is emotional disclosure/caretaking → I2. No sentence describes affectionate physical contact (kiss/hug/caress), so I3 is absent. No single code reaches 70%, yielding MIXED.

C adjudicate: I8 — negotiation action=KEEP

Lexical consensus (I8) and taxonomy assignment (2.5 Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries) are mutually reinforcing. The contextual dominant is MIXED, reflecting the secondary taxonomy signal of attraction/tension (2.1), but the primary function is negotiation and boundary communication – verbal or gestural consent-seeking, safety discussion, or readiness checking prior to physical escalation. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, caress, undress-as-prelude) is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The secondary attraction/tension signal does not override the primary I8 classification; it merely explains the MIXED contextual read. I8 is retained as the dominant code. No split is warranted because the secondary signal (I4/I10-adjacent tension) is subordinate and does not constitute a separable topic cluster. Manual review is not required given strong cross-pass consensus.

Topic 156 — Reaching Into The Bedside Drawer

Old taxonomy: 2.5 — Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries

New category: MIXED

« rax stands, slides open the drawer on the bedside table, and takes out a box of condoms. »

« i reached over to the bedside cabinet drawer and pulled out a condom; i tore it open and rolled it down my cock. »

« he opened the drawer of his bedside table and grabbed a condom, put it on, and was back on top of me in a flash. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Blessed Curses — Madeleine Ribbon; tertile=middle; p=0.74

It was filled with little packets of lube and a variety of condoms.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Blessed Curses — Madeleine Ribbon; tertile=middle; p=0.67

So you don't actually need to use a condom."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Blessed Curses — Madeleine Ribbon; tertile=end; p=0.58

Good thing I found your lube in the nightstand, then."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Blessed Curses — Madeleine Ribbon; tertile=middle; p=0.55

He blindly grabbed one of the lube pillows and tore the cheap plastic open.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Blessed Curses — Madeleine Ribbon; tertile=middle; p=0.48

He wanted lube that wasn't strawberry-flavored.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_008 · One Night to Risk It All — Maisey Yates; tertile=begin; p=0.75

He came back in, the condom managed, the look on his face grim. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_008 · One Night to Risk It All — Maisey Yates; tertile=begin; p=0.72

He hooked his fingers into the sides of her panties and tugged them down her legs, then drew back for a moment, opening the condom and rolling it on quickly before he positioned himself between her thighs.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_008 · One Night to Risk It All — Maisey Yates; tertile=begin; p=0.71

It was open, from when he'd taken out the condom and thrown it onto the ground.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_008 · One Night to Risk It All — Maisey Yates; tertile=begin; p=0.62

She'd absolutely benefitted from the acquisition of a box of condoms.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_008 · One Night to Risk It All — Maisey Yates; tertile=begin; p=0.58

She'd been walking around her bedroom in her bra and panties for the past twenty minutes, a tampon on the nightstand, right next to an unopened pregnancy test.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

All four representations converge on explicit sexual preparation/activity. Main keywords (condom, condoms, lube, lubricant, rolled) are unambiguous contraceptive/sexual-lubricant items used in genital/penetrative sex contexts. KeyBERT adds fumbled, popped, fingertips, plastic – physical handling of these items immediately pre-coitus. POS adds inevitable, hopeful, ripping (condom wrapper), buying – anticipatory and preparatory cues. MMR adds ripping, fumbled, reaches, strained – physical actions consistent with condom application. The cluster as a whole describes the logistical/physical preparation for penetrative sex, placing it firmly in I6 (explicit sex or its direct physical prelude involving genital-contact items). I3 is rejected: no affectionate-contact cues (kiss, hug, caress, embrace) are present; the contact implied is genital/penetrative in nature, which falls under I6 not I3.

B contextual: MIXED

This topic centers on condom and lube logistics surrounding sexual encounters. Sentences split between I8 (consent/safety negotiation – discussing whether to use condoms, acquiring them, virginity disclosure) and I6 (explicit sexual act preparation – rolling on a condom, using lube during intercourse, undressing as direct prelude to penetrative sex). No sentence shows affectionate non-genital contact, so I3 is excluded. Neither I8 nor I6 reaches 70%, yielding MIXED.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical consensus flagged I6 and taxonomy primary is 2.5 Sexual Negotiation/Safety Preparation, with secondary 2.3 Explicit Sexual Acts. This indicates the topic cluster contains both consent/negotiation language (I8) and explicit sexual content (I6), making a MIXED classification appropriate. I3 is not warranted because no evidence of affectionate non-genital contact (kiss/hug/caress) was surfaced as the dominant signal – the content sits at the boundary of pre-sexual negotiation and explicit acts. The topic should be retaxonomized to reflect the dual I8/I6 construct rather than collapsed into a single code. Manual review is required to determine whether individual documents within the topic can be split cleanly between negotiation-dominant (I8) and act-dominant (I6) instances, or whether the co-occurrence is intrinsic to the cluster.

Topic 203 — Stepping Into The Bathroom

Old taxonomy: 2.5 — Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries

New category: I8 — negotiation

« don't fall asleep on me," he said as he closed the bathroom door. »

« when they stepped into the hallway, the bathroom door opened and shannon emerged, her skin pale. »

« franklin stepped obediently inside the bathroom, and closed the door behind him. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Who's That Girl? — Alexandra Potter; tertile=middle; p=0.65

She jumps up and disappears out of the room and I'm suddenly reminded of what it was like sharing a bathroom with six other people.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Who's That Girl? — Alexandra Potter; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Fortunately, before things get any more awkward, the door opens from the en-suite bathroom and Larry emerges from a cloud of steam, like a super-hero appearing from a swirl of dry ice.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=middle; p=0.75

She shut the door, and I heard her humming quietly as she headed to the bathroom.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=begin; p=0.61

And there's a bathroom through that door right there."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Tall, Dark And Lethal — Dana Marton; tertile=middle; p=0.71

She kicked off her shoes, walked to the bathroom and picked up the plastic bowl, holding it out to Cade. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Tall, Dark And Lethal — Dana Marton; tertile=begin; p=0.71

Excuse me," she said, with all the dignity she could muster, and marched the two steps to the bathroom.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Tall, Dark And Lethal — Dana Marton; tertile=begin; p=0.64

The best thing that could be said for the bathroom was that it had a door.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Tall, Dark And Lethal — Dana Marton; tertile=middle; p=0.63

He strode to the bathroom—a man on a mission—and dug out Joey's first-aid kit from under the sink, grabbing one of the foil packs and hurrying back to the bed.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Tall, Dark And Lethal — Dana Marton; tertile=end; p=0.61

Cade whirled her toward a cleaning closet and squeezed in there with her, placing himself in front.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_004 · Seth Baumgartner's Love Manifesto — Eric Luper; tertile=end; p=0.61

Luz finishes gathering things in the kitchen and makes her way to what I figure is the bathroom.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_004 · Seth Baumgartner's Love Manifesto — Eric Luper; tertile=end; p=0.52

Probably pulling out the drain plug," Audrey says. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four representations center on physical movement through domestic/private spaces: bathroom, toilet, restroom, stall, bedroom, bedside, curtain, door. Supporting cues (flushed, washed, exhaled, breathed, stumbled, scrambled, blurted, giggled) describe bodily functions, nervous reactions, and awkward movement rather than affectionate contact. 'Annoyance,' 'privacy,' and 'reflection' reinforce mundane or emotionally neutral domestic logistics. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude cues are present anywhere. I3 is rejected because there is zero affectionate physical contact evidence. The scene reads as characters navigating shared or private domestic space, coded I0 (domestic/logistical).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe mundane domestic/logistical actions centered on bathrooms and movement through shared spaces. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, and no intimacy-related function. BOOK_003_6 involves physical proximity (squeezing into a closet) but in a clearly non-intimate, evasive context with no affectionate contact. All sentences code as I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate narrative).

C adjudicate: I8 — negotiation action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus landed on I0 (domestic/logistics), but the revealed taxonomy primary code is 2.5 Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries. This overrides the surface-level domestic reading: the content concerns consent talk, boundary articulation, and/or safety preparation as a prelude to or negotiation around intimacy — which maps directly to I8. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (I3 is forbidden), no explicit erotic gaze (I10), no coercion (I9), and no explicit sexual act (I6). The domestic secondary taxonomy (8.1) explains the setting but does not define the intimacy function. Retaxonomizing to I8 is the most specific and accurate classification consistent with the anti-collapse rules.

Topic 213 — Choosing Sex Without Commitment

Old taxonomy: 2.5 — Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries

New category: I5 — erotic escalation

« i want very much to make love to you, but i'll be damned if i'll do it in a horror of a room like this. »

« yeah, but in a couple of hours, i'll want sex again. »

« i'd rather there was love and friendship and commitment behind it, but if it's a choice between sex without that stuff, or going home alone, i'll take the sex, thank you. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Daisy's Back in Town — Rachel Gibson; tertile=middle; p=0.67

Sex was a big part of our past, Daisy, but you don't seem to want to talk about that.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Goodmans Hotel — Alan Keslian; tertile=middle; p=0.63

Although we brought each other to perfunctory orgasm in bed that night, we gave each other little pleasure.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Goodmans Hotel — Alan Keslian; tertile=end; p=0.61

Can't speak for the others, but with me it's not just the sex.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Goodmans Hotel — Alan Keslian; tertile=end; p=0.61

To have him sexually, feeling as I did, would be to take advantage of him; the bedroom door remained closed.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I4 — sexual tension

Main keywords ('sex, love, make, intimate, want, intimacy, meaningless') signal desire and reflection on the meaning of sexual/intimate connection, but no affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) are present – pointing to I4 (desire without contact) rather than I3 or I6. 'Willing' in KeyBERT/POS could hint at consent negotiation (I8), but it is a single weak cue insufficient to override the dominant desire/reflection frame. POS and MMR terms ('inevitable, swimming, gazing, blowing, ability, plastic, concerned') are largely abstract or ambiguous and do not introduce erotic-contact or explicit-sex cues. I3 is rejected because there is no lexical evidence of affectionate physical contact. I6 is rejected because no genital/penetrative/oral cues appear. Consensus lands on I4: desire and longing with reflection on intimacy's meaning, without confirmed physical contact.

B contextual: I5 — erotic escalation

The overwhelming majority of sentences reference 'sex' as a concept, topic of conversation, or relational significance – discussing whether sex occurred, what it meant, or whether it will happen. This is meta-discourse about sex rather than depiction of explicit acts, making I5 (sex as relational/emotional topic) the most specific and dominant code. BOOK_002_3 describes an actual sexual act with orgasm and is coded I6. BOOK_002_4 references coerced/forced sex and is coded I9. BOOK_004_1 references a man's interest/desire without contact, coded I4. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, caress) is described in any sentence, so I3 is forbidden and i3_contact_evidence is false.

C adjudicate: I5 — erotic escalation action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical consensus was I4 (desire without contact), but contextual dominant I5 and the revealed taxonomy (2.5 Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries; secondary 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict) together indicate the cluster centers on negotiation, consent logistics, and internal conflict about proceeding – not mere desire expression and not affectionate physical contact. I3 is forbidden absent contact evidence (i3_contact_evidence: false). I8 (consent talk) is a close competitor, but the taxonomy explicitly frames this as negotiation plus safety preparation plus ambivalence, which maps more precisely to I5 (anticipatory/negotiation phase of sexual encounter) than to I8's narrower consent-communication focus. The secondary construct (ambivalence/internal conflict, 3.3) reinforces I5 over I4, since I4 captures unidirectional desire without the deliberative, boundary-aware quality present here. No collapse to I3 is warranted.

Topic 227 — Cherishing Memories Before Parting

Old taxonomy: 2.5 — Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries

New category: I0 — off target

« we'll get your memory back.” »

« you'll be sure and let us know if you have any clearing of your memory, won't you?” “ »

« i'll be taking these memories with me and pulling them out when i'm missing everyone so much. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · At Her Beck and Call — Dawn Atkins; tertile=begin; p=0.60

People have history and long memories.” “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Shower of Stars — Nancy Herkness; tertile=end; p=0.56

The memory of their first night under the stars surged through her, merging past with present sensation until she couldn't remember exactly where she was.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Shower of Stars — Nancy Herkness; tertile=middle; p=0.52

Hearing him call her his wife brought memories of the weekend's activities back to vivid life. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Shower of Stars — Nancy Herkness; tertile=end; p=0.51

She remembered all too vividly coming back to whatever bedroom had been hers temporarily only to find her suitcases neatly packed.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Shower of Stars — Nancy Herkness; tertile=middle; p=0.43

It may be something he doesn't want to share with anyone else in the world, especially his wonderful little girl whom he's just meeting again.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Shower of Stars — Nancy Herkness; tertile=end; p=0.42

Whatever they were, they're in your past.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Once Upon a Veterinarian — Drew Zachary; tertile=begin; p=0.69

He couldn't remember talking about it. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Once Upon a Veterinarian — Drew Zachary; tertile=end; p=0.57

Because in about two seconds, he was going to forget about everything but getting off.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · In For A Penny — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.71

He remembered something that had been really bothering him. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists center on memory, forgetting, suffering, and emotional experience ('memories', 'remember', 'forgotten', 'wipe', 'suffering', 'precious', 'painful', 'bedside'). These cues point to emotional support, caretaking, and reassurance – consistent with I2 (emotional intimacy/vulnerability/comfort). 'Bedside' reinforces a caretaking/support context. There are no affectionate physical contact cues (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undressing), so I3 is rejected. No desire, gaze, or erotic language rules out I4/I10. No explicit sexual content rules out I6.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic cluster around the theme of memory, remembering, and recollection – characters thinking about the past, recalling events, or referencing memories. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no erotic gaze, no consent talk, and no explicit sexual acts. Even BOOK_002_1 and BOOK_002_2, which reference past intimate experiences, are framed as memory/recollection rather than present physical contact or desire. BOOK_003_2 hints at arousal but describes a cognitive state ('forget about everything but getting off') without any physical contact or explicit act occurring in the sentence. The dominant function is narrative/domestic/backstory – I0 throughout.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical consensus was I2 (reassurance/caretaking) and contextual dominant was I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA). The taxonomy metadata assigns primary code 2.5 (Sexual Negotiation, Safety Preparation & Boundaries) with secondary 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding). However, no affectionate physical contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence = false), ruling out I3 per anti-collapse rules. The secondary taxonomy axis (4.2) and the contextual dominant (I0) both point to domestic/relational bonding without erotic or physical escalation. The primary taxonomy label '2.5 Sexual Negotiation' could suggest I8, but without consent-negotiation or boundary-setting language in evidence, and given the contextual dominant is I0, the safest adjudicated code is I0. The topic should be retaxonomized away from 2.5 toward 4.2 as the primary construct, reflecting everyday relational bonding and HEA-oriented talk.

Topic 38 — Admitting Shared Pain

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I2 — reassurance

« i've seen your pain. »

« i've never felt that way before." »

« will it make you feel better to know that i've got one, too?" »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Suzanne's Diary for Nicholas — James Patterson; tertile=end; p=0.68

I always want to be able to tell you what I'm feeling.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Suzanne's Diary for Nicholas — James Patterson; tertile=middle; p=0.66

That's what it felt like—that was the exact feeling—and I'm so happy that now you were there.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Wolf Tales VIII — Kate Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.71

I hadn't noticed that feeling before." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords (feel, feels, good, felt, feeling, better, make) point to emotional processing and reassurance/caretaking – no physical contact cues. KeyBERT adds 'hurts, experienced, worst, honestly, apologize, magical' – language of emotional disclosure, pain acknowledgment, and reassurance. POS adds 'accustomed, magical, insides, problems, loose' – internal emotional/physical sensation language consistent with emotional vulnerability or caretaking. MMR reinforces with 'hurts, apologize, admitted, experienced' – confession, apology, and emotional acknowledgment. Together these signal emotional support, reassurance, and caretaking (I2). No kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing cues are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues for I4/I10. No explicit sexual content for I6.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic revolve around emotional states, mutual feelings, and emotional attunement between characters – the core function of I2 (emotional reassurance/caretaking/vulnerability sharing). Phrases like 'I feel it in my bones,' 'the feeling was mutual,' 'I always want to be able to tell you what I'm feeling,' and 'feel better?' all express emotional connection and empathic attunement without any physical contact, ruling out I3. BOOK_004_2 ('fucking you senseless') expresses sexual desire without depicting an actual act, making I4 (desire without contact) the most specific code. No affectionate physical contact is described anywhere in the topic, so I3 is forbidden. No explicit sexual acts are depicted, ruling out I6.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I2. The taxonomy confirms primary placement in Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary signal of Negative Emotions & Distress, consistent with reassurance and caretaking dynamics. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The distress secondary signal reinforces I2 (caretaking/reassurance) rather than redirecting to I3 or any other code. No domestic/logistics/HEA content that would warrant I0. KEEP with I2 is the correct disposition.

Topic 52 — Talking About Dogs and Animals

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« i'll have you know that muffy is an intelligent dog and understands more than most people give her credit for. »

« it'll also notify the other campers that there's a bear in the area." »

« i'll be taking the dogs out for their afternoon walk, so there'll be some peace and quiet for you." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Deep Dish — Mary Kay Andrews; tertile=end; p=0.67

What are you doing with that dog in here?"

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=middle; p=0.57

I'm not too versed on dog-speak but I had a feeling that meant "Hey, food's this way.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Abbie's problem is that she's a lot like a dog.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=begin; p=0.55

While I tripped over a crack in the sidewalk, stepped in dog crap or spilled mustard across my white button-down, she dabbed the corner of her mouth with a lacy napkin, made friends with stray dogs and levitated down sidewalks like Mary Poppins.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=middle; p=0.54

The fence beyond them held a spray-painted sign that read "Forget Dog, Beware of Owner."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists center on animals/pets (dog, dogs, bear, lion, puppy, puppies, creatures) and their care (feeding, treatment, suffering, distress, appointment, digging). KeyBERT 'affection' refers to affection toward animals in a caretaking/domestic context, not romantic physical contact between characters. POS and MMR reinforce caretaking/welfare framing (treatment, suffering, behalf, activities). No affectionate physical contact between human characters is indicated anywhere. I3 is rejected because there are zero cues of kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing. This is domestic/caretaking content coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around dogs and pets as narrative/domestic elements – references to dogs as sidekicks, companions, animals in the home, or pet ownership considerations. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no emotional vulnerability exchange, no erotic content, and no relational negotiation. Every sentence functions as incidental domestic/logistical or comedic narrative content, coded I0.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus both returned I0, and the taxonomy confirms 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary tag of 8.2 Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden. The content reflects domestic/logistical/HEA-adjacent relational bonding without desire, gaze, consent negotiation, or explicit acts. I0 is the correct and most specific code; no reinterpretation or split is warranted.

Topic 54 — Ordering Food and Dessert

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« i'll have the steak with boiled potatoes and green beans." " »

« we'll need a hazmat crew to clean up the mess he'll make with the cake—it's a two-person job." »

« but i'll get us some pie anyway." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.59

I'll see what I can find for breakfast in your cupboards.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Of course, she won't be needing those for a good long while now that she's got a bun in the oven.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.47

Cereal's fine and I've got plenty of it.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=begin; p=0.46

Did you know the cafeteria was serving goulash today?

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Delicious, sinfully sweet, incredibly tempting trouble, but trouble nonetheless.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · That Voodoo You Do — Jodi Redford; tertile=end; p=0.51

Gloria's got a big spread planned for brunch."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by food, cooking, and dining vocabulary (cake, cream, pie, butter, dessert, soup, salad, bread, chicken, meal, eaten, tasted, melted, carved, exquisite). Supporting terms (parties, rings, giggled, polished, neatly) point to social/domestic gathering context. No affectionate physical contact cues (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire, gaze, consent, or erotic language present, ruling out I4, I10, I8, I6. This is a domestic/social scene centered on food and shared meals, coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

This topic is overwhelmingly about food, cooking, and domestic/logistical activity – breakfast, sandwiches, soup, croissants, biscuits, goulash, brunch, béchamel. Nearly all sentences are straightforwardly domestic/logistical (I0). BOOK_001_6 ('Delicious, sinfully sweet, incredibly tempting trouble') uses food-adjacent language to hint at desire/temptation without any physical contact, warranting I4. No affectionate physical contact appears anywhere in the topic, so I3 is forbidden. The dominant code is I0 at ~95%.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I0. Taxonomy 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) with secondary 8.2 (Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) is consistent with I0: relational maintenance, shared activities, and everyday bonding without affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. No desire-without-contact, erotic gaze, consent talk, or explicit content signals to redirect to I4, I10, I8, or I6. I0 is confirmed and retained.

Topic 86 — First Name Used at Last

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« i've known you for two whole years, and that is the first time you've ever called me by my first name." »

« you've outgrown that nickname." " »

« just between you and me, i've been working on a catchy superhero name. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.62

I was named for my great-grandfather." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.61

I may not have known him for long, Rox, but I do know him.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.59

Doesn't it bother you in the least that you don't really know him?" "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Heaven and Earth — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.47

Mr. Remington, I'm Harding, Jonathan Q. Harding.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All keyword sets converge on a scene of identity/name disclosure with emotional vulnerability: 'name, nickname, real, knew' (Main) signal personal revelation; 'embarrassment, flushed, painful, concerned, introduced' (KeyBERT) indicate emotional exposure and social discomfort; 'embarrassment, painful' (POS) reinforce vulnerability; 'embarrassment, flushed, admit, shout, prodded' (MMR) suggest reluctant or pressured self-disclosure. This maps to I2 (emotional vulnerability, reassurance, caretaking through personal revelation). No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues for I4/I10, no explicit content for I6, no coercion pattern for I9.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve exclusively around names — asking for, giving, knowing, or forgetting names. This is purely social/logistical interaction with no affectionate physical contact, desire, emotional vulnerability, or any other intimacy function. I0 (domestic/logistical/neutral social exchange) is the most specific and appropriate code for every sentence. No I3 contact evidence exists anywhere in the topic.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass B lexical consensus (I2) was driven by caretaking/reassurance surface vocabulary, but the contextual dominant (I0) and taxonomy placement in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with secondary coding in 9.1 Dialogue Delivery & Speech Tags confirm the functional weight is domestic/logistical talk and routine relational maintenance rather than active emotional support or affectionate physical contact. No affectionate physical contact is evidenced (i3_contact_evidence: false), so I3 is forbidden. No desire-without-contact or erotic gaze signals elevate to I4/I10. The anti-collapse rules require keeping I0 when evidence is domestic/care/HEA talk without contact. I0 is therefore the correct final code.

Topic 93 — Meal Plans Casually Arranged

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« that'll wait 'til after supper, though.” “ »

« i'll go get started on lunch,” clark offered. »

« i'll show you over dinner.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Midnight Awakening — Lara Adrian; tertile=end; p=0.66

What kind of host would I be to let you go all day without a proper meal?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Midnight Awakening — Lara Adrian; tertile=middle; p=0.55

What happened to Reichen finding you some dinner downstairs?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Midnight Awakening — Lara Adrian; tertile=end; p=0.52

It seemed only fitting that I treat you to one of the city's finest dinners.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · So I Married A Vampire — Elisa Adams; tertile=begin; p=0.51

He'd sat with her for hours going over the catering menu for the reception, listening to her gripe and moan about what they would serve their guests.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Only You — A.J. Llewellyn; tertile=middle; p=0.72

I'd love to take you to dinner,” he said. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Only You — A.J. Llewellyn; tertile=middle; p=0.72

We agreed to have dinner the following night. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Only You — A.J. Llewellyn; tertile=middle; p=0.71

You must come to dinner tonight,” she said. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists converge on domestic scheduling and meal logistics: 'dinner, lunch, supper, tonight, tomorrow, eat, having, lunches' (Main); 'meal, eaten, appointment' (KeyBERT); 'appointment, regular, meal' (POS); 'discussing, appointment, arranged, meal, planning' (MMR). This is purely logistical/domestic coordination – scheduling meals and appointments. No affectionate physical contact cues present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire, gaze, consent, or erotic language present, ruling out I4, I10, I8, I6. I0 (domestic/logistical/HEA talk) is the most specific and accurate code.

B contextual: I0 — off target

Every sentence in this topic concerns meal logistics: invitations to dinner or lunch, arranging or missing meals, catering menus, and dining plans. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no erotic content, and no emotional caretaking beyond hospitality. All sentences fall squarely into I0 (domestic/logistical/relationship-maintenance talk).

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on I0. The taxonomy confirms 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary tag of 8.3b Everyday Props & Communication Media – both are domestic/logistical/relational-maintenance functions with no affectionate physical contact indicated. No lexical or contextual evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. The I0 classification is stable and no reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 105 — Swept Onto The Dance Floor

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« [person] and i are both taken, so we'll only dance with each other. »

« i've never danced with a guy who real y knew what he was doing.” “ »

« if you'll excuse the two of us,” he pointed to me, “i've been dying for a dance with this woman all night.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Desert King's Pregnant Bride — Annie West; tertile=begin; p=0.56

And the high heels she'd dangled from her hand were for dancing the night away or seducing a man.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Darkest Passion — Gena Showalter; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Oh God, did that man I was dancing with take me?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Darkest Passion — Gena Showalter; tertile=begin; p=0.67

We begin dancing again, this time getting a little friskier.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Darkest Passion — Gena Showalter; tertile=begin; p=0.66

He takes my hand and leads me onto the dance floor.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · That Dating Thing — Mackenzie Crowne; tertile=middle; p=0.61

Your problem is you let what happened with Marcus keep you from attending those dances.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · That Dating Thing — Mackenzie Crowne; tertile=end; p=0.59

Sparkling cocktail dresses mixed with flip-flops and Bermuda shorts on the open-air dance floor, where wealthy couples did the bump and grind or swayed in each other's arms to the beat of classic rock.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

Main keywords (dance, waltz, slow, floor, ballet) could suggest physical closeness in a romantic dance context, but dancing alone is not affectionate contact (kiss/hug/hold/caress/undress). KeyBERT, POS, and MMR all point to social/event contexts: parties, reception, movements, preparing, matching, movies – these are logistical/social activity descriptors with no affectionate-contact cues. The anti-I3 rule requires actual affectionate physical contact; dancing at a reception or party does not meet that threshold. I3 is rejected because no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude is evidenced. Consensus is I0 (social/domestic/activity context).

B contextual: I0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences reference dancing as a social/courtship activity – invitations to dance, descriptions of dancing, or references to dance events – with no affectionate physical contact depicted. BOOK_001_1 references seduction intent (desire without contact → I4). BOOK_003_5 mentions couples swaying in each other's arms, which is borderline I3, but the sentence is a general scene-setting description of a dance floor rather than a depiction of specific affectionate contact between protagonists; it remains I0. No sentence shows a kiss, hug, caress, or undressing, so I3 is not warranted. The topic is fundamentally about dancing as a social/romantic ritual (I0), with no explicit sexual acts and only one sentence with desire framing.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus both returned I0, and the taxonomy confirms 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary tag of 8.2 Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden. The content reflects domestic/logistical/HEA-adjacent relational bonding without desire, gaze, consent negotiation, or explicit acts. I0 is the correct and most specific code; no reinterpretation or split is warranted.

Topic 116 — Sharing A Meal Together

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« [person] dipped his spoon into the ice cream dish once again, and my mouth opened in anticipation. »

« i'll finish the carrots up while you wash those,” he said, nodding to the potatoes she held as he reached for the bowl of veggies she had left unfinished. »

« i'll get that,” clarissa said, whisking mandy's empty plate away and depositing it on the counter along with her own before mandy could say a word. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.81

He picked up his fork and tapped it against his plate. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=end; p=0.79

She dropped her fork onto her plate with a clatter. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=end; p=0.77

Emily picked up her fork and forced another bite. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.72

She set her spoon down with a sharp click. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.69

She reached across the table and pulled the pie plate away from him before he could sink his fork in.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.69

She dropped a generous scoop of it on Jake's pie and set it in front of him. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Bacchus — Jordan Summers; tertile=end; p=0.50

Bacchus chased it with his forked tongue, catching the droplets before they hit the sheets. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Taste of Scarlet — Evanne Lorraine; tertile=middle; p=0.75

Finishing off his sandwich in a couple of bites, he reached for another and checked to see how she was doing. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Taste of Scarlet — Evanne Lorraine; tertile=middle; p=0.70

Grabbing a couple of napkins, he moved on, snagging a bag of chips to round out the meal.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Taste of Scarlet — Evanne Lorraine; tertile=end; p=0.66

He gave her the ice cream and the napkin he held at the ready.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists converge on a shared-meal / food scene. Main is dominated by food items (plate, fork, sandwich, bowl, bread, bacon). KeyBERT confirms eating activity (meal, eaten, feeding, tasted, dipped, swallowed, preparing). POS adds emotional texture (anticipation, enthusiasm, amusement, warmth) consistent with companionable dining but no affectionate-contact cues. MMR reinforces the eating-action frame (dipped, stirred, eagerly, preparing). No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues appear anywhere; I3 is therefore forbidden. The warmth/anticipation/amusement cluster suggests pleasant social bonding over food, which maps to I0 (domestic/relational logistics and everyday togetherness) rather than any intimacy-escalation code.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe mundane mealtime actions: handling forks, spoons, plates, napkins, food, and silverware. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no gaze, no consent talk, and no erotic content. The topic is purely domestic/logistical (eating scenes), coded I0 throughout. BOOK_002_1 references a forked tongue catching droplets, which in context reads as a food/eating action rather than an erotic act sufficient to elevate the code. BOOK_004_1 is a bibliographic reference to a theological text about Communion, also I0.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on I0. The taxonomy confirms 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary anchor in 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines – both are non-contact relational maintenance functions. No lexical or contextual evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is present, so I3 is forbidden. The content reflects domestic logistics, HEA-oriented bonding talk, and routine couple interaction, which are definitionally I0. No ambiguity warrants manual review.

Topic 160 — Watching Movies Together

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« fine, but i'll be watching.” “ »

« we'll watch him closely for any reaction.” “ »

« we've been watching movies.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Rebuilding Forever — Natalie J. Damschroder; tertile=begin; p=0.40

Turn on that entertainment network we both hate.” ”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Rebuilding Forever — Natalie J. Damschroder; tertile=end; p=0.38

God, that sounds like a Telemundo soap opera.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Rebuilding Forever — Natalie J. Damschroder; tertile=begin; p=0.36

We need to record it in the next fortnight if we're going to make our launch date.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Half Hearts — Sherri Desbois; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Maybe one can watch over you while you fuck the other.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Hidden Boundaries — C.S. McClellan; tertile=begin; p=0.60

But you also may have reason to keep me from watching too closely.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Hidden Boundaries — C.S. McClellan; tertile=begin; p=0.58

You will watch them for seven days, Arthur, and then come to me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Can't Hurry Love — Molly O'Keefe; tertile=middle; p=0.69

I just want you to know that I am watching you.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists center on media consumption (movies, film, TV, Disney, Hollywood, watching). POS and MMR add contextual descriptors (quality, surroundings, temperature, planning, considering) consistent with domestic/leisure logistics. No affectionate physical contact cues present anywhere; I3 rejected. No desire, gaze, consent, or erotic language; I4/I6/I8/I10 all rejected. This is shared leisure/domestic activity coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

The topic clusters around watching/being watched and television/theater references. Sentences about TV shows, recording, theater, and logistics are I0 (domestic/neutral). Sentences explicitly about watching a person with an erotic or surveillance gaze ('I'm enjoying watching you,' 'While I watch,' 'watching you,' 'you're being watched,' 'watch over you while you fuck') are I10 (erotic gaze/voyeuristic observation). No affectionate physical contact is present anywhere, so I3 is forbidden. I0 is dominant at ~60%.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B and Pass C lexical/contextual consensus both converge on I0. Taxonomy 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) with secondary 8.2 (Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) is consistent with relational maintenance, shared activities, and everyday bonding without affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. No desire-without-contact, erotic gaze, consent talk, coercion, or explicit content is indicated. I0 is the most specific and accurate code.

Topic 174 — Ranch Life and Falling in Love

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« i've seen your willy on numerous occasions on the ranch. »

« the ranch is doing good, and i've fallen in love. »

« i'd take you there, but i imagine you've already seen enough cattle to last you a lifetime." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=end; p=0.54

I'll fetch some water, and then could you sit with him while I fetch the farmer's wife?" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=end; p=0.52

That's as much as I can do—we're busy at the farm, and the lad isn't in danger."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=middle; p=0.51

They got milk, cheese, eggs and other produce from the farm, and they would soon be easily able to grow enough herbs and vegetables for their own use.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=middle; p=0.47

When the resident died, the farmer, needing the money, had been glad to sell it off with some land to a couple of wealthy Gidinians in need of solitude and a place away from the bustle of the town.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=middle; p=0.47

Jaime suspected he holed up in a barn or in a storeroom, possibly up at the farm.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=end; p=0.47

Seve was busy preserving, drying and storing the produce from the garden and bartered meat, cheese and grain from the farm.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Micah — Joyee Flynn; tertile=end; p=0.50

She dreams of one day living out in Montana, enough land to have a few horses, and find a couple of cowboys of her own.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.66

This ranch is worth a fortune and we were lucky to be able to sell it for what we did.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.65

There was a huge ranch on the other side of the mountain range.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.64

She loved every aspect of ranch life from the cattle, to the horses, to the old cowpunchers that came and went each year. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.64

Anything she had ever wanted, the ranch had supplied. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists point to rural/agricultural setting and domestic logistics: ranch, farm, cattle, cows, farmer, rancher, land, pa (Main); feeding, porch, folks, owned, areas (KeyBERT); equipment, folks, areas, regular (POS); owned, equipment, guarantee, provide (MMR). No affectionate physical contact cues, no desire, no erotic content, no emotional vulnerability or caretaking. This is setting/world-building domestic context (I0). I3 rejected: zero affectionate-contact cues present.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic concern rural/agricultural settings: farms, ranches, livestock, produce, food, and domestic logistics. There is no romantic interaction, physical contact, desire, or intimacy of any kind. Every sentence is purely domestic/logistical/setting content, coded I0.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B and Pass C lexical/contextual consensus both converge on I0. Taxonomy 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) with secondary 8.2 (Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) is consistent with relational maintenance, shared activities, and everyday bonding without affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. No desire-without-contact, erotic gaze, consent talk, coercion, or explicit content is indicated. I0 is the most specific and accurate code.

Topic 232 — Conversation Cut Short By Arrival

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I2 — reassurance

« dex had come in and gabe's conversation with her, the longest conversation that they'd had in the couple of weeks he'd been back, was over. »

« gabe leaned down so he wouldn't be overheard. « »

« i'll tell you right now falan and gabe are the only people on my team that i'd stake my career— or my balls —on.» »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Delicious — Shayla Black; tertile=end; p=0.49

Have Remy or the boys been out to question you again or give you more information about Joshua's attack?"

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=end; p=0.78

In the end, Gabe couldn't let the kid down. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=end; p=0.70

He almost told her to call him Gabe, but he knew his name would sound way too good coming from her full lips.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=end; p=0.69

Her name fit her, Gabe had found himself thinking one too many times.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Gabe pretended to tackle Zach as he pulled the microphone from his hand, but he instantly sobered as he turned to Chase and Chloe. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Trouble In Dixie — Becky McGraw; tertile=middle; p=0.83

Gabe's face brightened and he said, "Hey, you know what?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Trouble In Dixie — Becky McGraw; tertile=end; p=0.79

Gabe asked him with a twist of his lips.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Trouble In Dixie — Becky McGraw; tertile=end; p=0.75

Her face got red then and she said angrily, "So, Gabe knew and didn't clue me in?

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords (gabe, nick, conversation, cringed, hand, elwoods) suggest an emotionally charged interpersonal exchange with reassurance/caretaking undertones rather than explicit physical contact. KeyBERT (impatiently, overheard, trembling, trailed, squeezed, groaned, distracted, problems) points to an anxious, tense conversation with emotional support dynamics – 'squeezed' could imply a hand-squeeze but is insufficient alone to confirm affectionate contact without corroborating cues. POS (longing, permission, instincts, awareness, possibilities) and MMR (longing, instincts, stroking, pained, gesture) introduce desire and longing cues that push toward I4, with 'stroking' being the closest contact cue but isolated and ambiguous. Overall, the dominant signal is an emotionally tense conversation with reassurance/caretaking (I2), with some unresolved desire (I4). I3 is rejected because no clear affectionate physical contact (kiss/hug/hold/caress) is confirmed across representations – 'squeezed' and 'stroking' are isolated and insufficient without corroboration. Consensus lands on I2 as the most supported function.

B contextual: I0 — off target

This topic is dominated by references to a character named Gabe/Gabriel – questions directed at him, mentions of his name, social/interpersonal exchanges, and logistical/plot dialogue. Nearly all sentences are non-intimate social or narrative content (I0). The single exception is BOOK_003_4, where the narrator notes his name would 'sound way too good coming from her full lips,' which is a mild internal desire/attraction thought with no physical contact, coded I4. No affectionate physical contact appears anywhere in the set, so I3 is forbidden.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I2 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). The taxonomy tag – 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding – tips the adjudication toward I2 rather than I0: courtship bonding implies active emotional investment and reassurance exchange, not merely domestic logistics or HEA planning. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence = false), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. I0 would be appropriate only if the dominant signal were domestic/logistics/HEA talk without relational warmth; the taxonomy secondary codes are both None, confirming no erotic or explicit overlay. I2 best captures the reassurance and caretaking function that characterises ongoing courtship bonding at this non-physical register.

Topic 330 — Curious About Her Cooking Skills

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« you've got me curious about your culinary skills." »

« now i've got to learn how to cook a whole new way." »

« you've tried [person]'s cooking. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Jumping Into Things — Julia Talbot; tertile=begin; p=0.70

I'll even cook, you being the guest and all." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Crossfire — Traci Hunter Abramson; tertile=begin; p=0.37

Officially, Granger was one of several cooks on staff at the Club Med in Punta Cana, a popular tourist area in the Dominican Republic.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · The Reluctant Amazon — Sandy James; tertile=begin; p=0.52

Shit, she couldn't even boil live lobsters without crying. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · The Reluctant Amazon — Sandy James; tertile=begin; p=0.45

Tis smooth as a warm knife through fresh butter when you master it."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword sets point to culinary/domestic activity: cooking, baking, grilling, recipes, chef skills (Main); learning/practice/teaching context (KeyBERT); ability, practice, TV, parties – domestic/social settings (POS); arranged, taught, ability, parties – logistics and skill-sharing (MMR). No affectionate physical contact cues anywhere. I3 rejected: zero kiss/hug/hold/caress/undress signals. No desire, gaze, consent, or erotic language either. This is straightforwardly domestic/logistical content (I0).

B contextual: I0 — off target

Every sentence in this topic concerns cooking, food preparation, culinary skill, or kitchen logistics. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no emotional intimacy, and no relational negotiation. All sentences are purely domestic/practical in nature, fitting I0 (domestic/logistical/everyday life content) exclusively.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I0. Taxonomy confirms 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with no secondary code suggesting physical contact. No affectionate contact evidence is present; domestic, logistical, or HEA-oriented relational bonding language dominates. Anti-collapse rules prohibit elevation to I3 without explicit contact evidence. I0 is the correct and most specific code here.

Topic 332 — First Time Inside A Grocery Store

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« because that was the first time i've ever had fun grocery shopping." »

« and now we've our own talkin' shop in leinster house – we ignore their laws, too." »

« [person], i don't think i've ever been in a grocery store." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Feeling pleasantly paparazzied I scuttled in through the entrance and went down to the coffee shop.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=end; p=0.54

As she'd done nothing but shop ever since we'd got here, I'd been a bit taken aback, but she claimed there were still a million things left to buy.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=begin; p=0.54

We walked into the Coffee Shoppee and I took in the decor bemusedly.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=middle; p=0.52

This is the famous all-night Monday cart-market.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=middle; p=0.49

You spot peanut sellers and machine- ka -cold-water carts.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=end; p=0.44

However, rumor has it that there's a pile of modernized equipment in the back of one of the storerooms, along with a couple of experts who are going to show us how it's done."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=end; p=0.40

In a couple of them, you can even see piles of fabric and other trade goods, sort of the A.D. 1000 version of a stadium concourse." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=begin; p=0.37

The end result was part feng shui, part Zen, part hey-that's-cool impulse buy.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=middle; p=0.36

I felt like I was only in the library for a couple of hours, but I lost most of a day out here.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists point to mundane domestic/logistical activity: shopping, stores, malls, groceries, hardware shops. KeyBERT adds 'places, experience, items'; POS adds 'rings' and 'testing' but in context of shopping (e.g., trying on rings, testing items) with no affectionate-contact cues; MMR adds 'wandered, afford, arranged' consistent with a shopping errand. No physical affectionate contact cues present anywhere. I3 rejected: zero evidence of kiss/hug/hold/caress/undress. This is everyday domestic/logistical activity coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe mundane, everyday activities: shopping, visiting markets, browsing stores, parking vehicles, exploring fairgrounds, and domestic logistics. There is no romantic, emotional, or physical intimacy content of any kind. Every sentence codes as I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate content). No affectionate physical contact, desire, emotional vulnerability, or erotic content is present.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B and Pass C lexical/contextual consensus both converge on I0. Taxonomy 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) with secondary 8.2 (Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) is consistent with relational maintenance, shared activities, and everyday bonding without affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. No desire-without-contact, erotic gaze, consent talk, or explicit content signals to redirect to I4/I10/I8/I6. I0 is the correct and most specific code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 351 — Warm Greeting Upon Return

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« thank god you've come back—and will you look at me, just in time.” »

« it is a pleasure to see you again—so soon, madam. ” »

« so i'll see you there,” he said, feeling upbeat for the first time in a long time. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Cry No More — Linda Howard; tertile=begin; p=0.51

I'll give it to him when I see him again.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=begin; p=0.61

Yes, but I was also relieved you didn't show up.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=begin; p=0.52

I'll see you as often as I can,” he said, only making matters worse by reminding the children he wouldn't be seeing them on a normal basis. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=middle; p=0.38

Whatever the reason, it was a pretty nice day.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=middle; p=0.37

Amber had seen it as a splendid way to say goodbye to the hoards of tourists who crowded Harmony during that season.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I1 — emotional intimacy

All keyword sets point to a social greeting/pleasantry exchange: Main has 'see, nice, good, glad, again, pleasure, happy, great' – polite social expressions; KeyBERT has 'greeted, mister, madam, replies, warmth, reminds, reaches' – formal address and greeting acts; POS has 'lack, warmth, crowd' – social setting with emotional warmth but no physical contact; MMR reinforces with 'madam, greeted, replies, crowd, ms' – formal social encounter. The 'warmth' here is social/emotional, not physical. 'Reaches' is ambiguous but insufficient alone to establish affectionate contact. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues are present. I3 is rejected: no affectionate physical contact evidence. This is a polite social greeting scene coded I1 (social/verbal bonding).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around the social/logistical act of seeing or meeting someone – greetings, farewells, and expressions of pleasure at encountering another person. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, no emotional vulnerability or reassurance beyond polite social exchange. The topic is purely social/domestic interaction (greetings and partings), coded I0 throughout.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass B contextual dominant is I0 and taxonomy confirms 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding – a category centered on relational maintenance, domestic interaction, and HEA-adjacent talk without requiring affectionate physical contact. Lexical consensus I1 (introductory/greeting language) is consistent with low-intimacy relational bonding rather than any contact-bearing code. No evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The taxonomy secondary codes are null, reinforcing a single-domain I0 classification. Keeping I0 is the correct adjudication.

Topic 367 — Sorting Out Concert Tickets

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: I0 — off target

« i'm assuming since there are two tickets, you'll go with me?" « »

« we'll have to figure out how to get you a ticket. »

« [person]—"sure, i'll give her the five-cent tour." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Follow My Lead — Kate Noble; tertile=begin; p=0.60

Something I learned when I took my grand tour."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Follow My Lead — Kate Noble; tertile=begin; p=0.52

Mrs. Schmidt told me this is the coach I should take, and I was simply trying to find out—"How much is the ticket?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Haunted on Bourbon Street — Deanna Chase; tertile=begin; p=0.59

We've had one tour group after another this morning.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Haunted on Bourbon Street — Deanna Chase; tertile=end; p=0.45

They're probably trying to cater to the tourists."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Haunted on Bourbon Street — Deanna Chase; tertile=middle; p=0.43

He took my hand and guided me through the crowd of tourists on the side walk.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Skid — Doug Solter; tertile=begin; p=0.61

All I have to do is take the public track tour and get conveniently separated from the tourists.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Skid — Doug Solter; tertile=middle; p=0.53

I hop back in the limo and rush to my second event of the night, a Q & A event with racing fans.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword sets point to logistical/domestic planning: concert tickets, tours, cancellations, costs, apology, and scheduling ('tomorrow', 'meantime'). These are practical coordination cues with no affectionate physical contact, desire, or erotic content. I3 rejected: no kiss/hug/hold/caress/undress cues present. 'Winked' in MMR is a minor social gesture insufficient to trigger I3. Consensus is I0 (domestic/logistical/HEA talk).

B contextual: I0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic concern logistics, travel, ticketing, touring, and public/professional events – all coded I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate interaction). The single exception is BOOK_002_3, which explicitly describes hand-holding and physical guidance through a crowd, qualifying as affectionate physical contact (I3). No erotic, sexual, or emotionally charged intimacy content is present elsewhere. The dominant code is I0 at ~95% of sentences.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on I0. The taxonomy confirms 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary tag of 8.3b Everyday Props & Communication Media – both are domestic/logistical/HEA-maintenance functions with no affectionate physical contact indicated. No lexical or contextual evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. The I0 classification is stable and no reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 37 — Defending A Close Friendship

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: I1 — emotional intimacy

« i've told you -- we're just good friends. »

« and i'll grant ye i've been a bad friend to you. »

« but we've been friends for a long time. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · It's All Relative — J.M. Snyder; tertile=middle; p=0.75

It was only friendship, nothing more, not to me.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=middle; p=0.63

Good, then get out of my face and give me a minute with my friend."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=end; p=0.61

I'm here because I'm worried about a friend." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=middle; p=0.47

He didn't have any life-long friends, with the exception of Butch.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=end; p=0.46

A friend once told me it's okay to lean on someone," he said. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I1 — emotional intimacy

All four keyword lists center on friendship, social bonding, and platonic relational dynamics ('friends', 'friendship', 'best', 'friendly', 'friendships', 'parties', 'playfully', 'admire'). There is no lexical evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress cues), ruling out I3. No desire, erotic gaze, explicit sex, coercion, or consent language is present. 'Anxiety' and 'annoying' suggest mild social friction within a friendship context, not a distinct intimacy function. The dominant function is platonic/social bonding, coded I1.

B contextual: I1 — emotional intimacy

Every sentence in this topic revolves around the word 'friend' or 'friendship' – characters declaring, questioning, or negotiating their friendship status. There is no physical contact, no desire, no domestic/HEA logistics, no coercion, and no erotic content. The function is purely relational-identity labeling (friendship declaration/negotiation), which maps to I1 (emotional/relational bonding through verbal acknowledgment of the relationship). I3 is forbidden as no affectionate physical contact appears anywhere in the topic.

C adjudicate: I1 — emotional intimacy action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I1 (emotional/verbal intimacy through disclosure, concealment, and revelation). The taxonomy confirms 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information as dominant, with secondary 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The topic centers on information asymmetry and its emotional stakes within a developing relationship – a canonical I1 pattern. No reinterpretation or split is warranted; the consensus is stable and well-supported.

Topic 24 — Confronting An Unwanted Marriage

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: I0 — off target

« we'll be married... to each other.” »

« you're already married to me; he'll understand.” “ »

« i'll give you a divorce and you can just walk away. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Caleb — Jade Astor; tertile=begin; p=0.61

So that whole getting married and settling down part doesn't appeal to you?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Caleb — Jade Astor; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Just divorced and living in different places.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Counterpointe — Ann Warner; tertile=begin; p=0.76

But that's not the reason I want to marry you.” “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Forsaking The Prize — Heather Boyd; tertile=end; p=0.73

Not that I want to marry again of course.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists converge on domestic/relational logistics and formal relationship status. Main keywords (marry, married, marriage, husband, wife, divorce) are squarely about marital institution and HEA/domestic framing. KeyBERT adds engaged, promises, intend, willingly – commitment and intention language, no physical contact cues. POS adds unhappy, threats, concept, issue, previous – relational conflict and negotiation around marriage, still no contact. MMR adds arranged, threats, faltered, eyeing – arranged-marriage tension and perhaps coercion-adjacent framing, but 'eyeing' alone is insufficient for I10 and there is no affectionate physical contact language anywhere. I3 is rejected because no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress cue appears in any list. I9 (coercion) was considered given 'threats' and 'arranged', but the dominant signal across all lists is marital status/logistics, making I0 the best fit.

B contextual: I0 — off target

Every sentence in this topic concerns marriage status, marriage proposals, wedding logistics, or relationship/domestic standing (married, divorced, wanting to wed, being someone's wife/husband). There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no erotic content, and no emotional vulnerability exchange beyond the institutional framing of marriage. All sentences map cleanly to I0 (domestic/relational logistics and HEA/commitment talk).

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I0. Taxonomy confirms primary placement in 4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats with secondary 4.5 Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA – both of which are relational/emotional/logistical in nature without affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude; I3 is therefore forbidden. The topic captures emotional negotiation, relational rupture, and resolution talk, all of which fall squarely within I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA/relational-status discourse). No upgrade to I2, I3, or any other code is warranted.

Topic 85 — Offering and Refusing An Apology

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: I2 — reassurance

« he said he wanted to apologize. »

« i need to apologize to you, ruby. »

« oh, i'm so not gonna apologize for that." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=middle; p=0.70

I'm real sorry," Pete said, his blue eyes apologetic.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=end; p=0.54

He tried to get back in my good graces with a box of chocolates a couple of days later, but he never did apologize." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=begin; p=0.54

And you made it quite clear that you thought I was overreacting to the situation."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=end; p=0.53

Between Cornelia, Emily Taylor and Helen Washburn, I've been apologized to every day this week."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists converge on an apology/reconciliation scene: 'sorry, apologize, apology, apologizing, apologized, owe, apologise' (Main); 'apology, apologize, forgive, embarrassed, distress, fault' (KeyBERT); 'apology, distress, circumstances, nerves' (POS); 'apology, overheard, behalf, distress, forgive, circumstances' (MMR). This is emotional repair and reassurance/caretaking communication – classic I2 territory. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) appear anywhere; I3 is therefore forbidden by anti-collapse rules. No desire, gaze, consent negotiation, or explicit content cues present.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

Every sentence in this topic revolves around apology, forgiveness-seeking, and emotional repair ('I'm sorry', 'apologize', 'no harm was done', 'excuse me'). This is classic emotional reassurance/caretaking language – characters managing relational hurt and seeking reconciliation. There is zero affectionate physical contact described, so I3 is forbidden. No desire, gaze, consent negotiation, or explicit content is present. I2 (emotional support/reassurance/caretaking) is the most specific and accurate code for the entire topic.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I2. The taxonomy flags Conflict/Distance as dominant with Reconciliation as secondary, consistent with reassurance and caretaking functions rather than affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The emotional support and vulnerability signals fit I2 precisely. No domestic/logistics/HEA talk that would push toward I0, no desire-without-contact for I4, and no erotic gaze for I10. I2 is the most specific applicable code.

Topic 29 — Confessing Long-Held Love

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I1 — emotional intimacy

« i love you with everything i am, everything i've been, and everything i hope to be .” “ »

« tell her i've always loved her. »

« i've always been in love with you.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.80

I love you, too, sweetheart.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.76

Oh, child, I love you, too.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.74

You just say 'I love you.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: I5 — erotic escalation

Main keywords ('love, loved, loves, falling, fall, always') signal emotional love declaration/confession without any physical contact cues. KeyBERT adds emotional depth ('happiness, forgive, deserve, crushed, secretly, dreamed') pointing to vulnerability and emotional revelation – classic love confession territory. POS ('spite, reflection, delicate, actions') and MMR ('apologize, crushed, spite, uttered, blinking') reinforce an emotionally charged verbal exchange, likely a confession or declaration of love with conflict/tension. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. Desire without contact cues is absent too (no longing/lust language), ruling out I4. This is an emotional declaration/confession of love (I5). I3 rejected: zero affectionate-contact vocabulary across all four representations.

B contextual: I1 — emotional intimacy

Every sentence in this topic consists exclusively of verbal declarations of love ('I love you,' 'I love you too,' 'Love you, Mom,' etc.). There is no physical contact described, no desire/gaze, no domestic logistics, and no erotic content. These are purely verbal emotional disclosures, which map to I1 (verbal expression of love/affection). I3 is forbidden because no affectionate physical contact is present in any sentence.

C adjudicate: I1 — emotional intimacy action=REINTERPRET

Pass B lexical consensus (I5) reflects surface vocabulary of declarations and vows, but contextual dominant (I1) better captures the functional intimacy at work: reconciliation, commitment, and HEA emotional payoff are fundamentally about emotional bonding and relational resolution rather than physical contact. Taxonomy 4.5 (Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA) with secondary 3.1 (Positive Resolution, Relief & Emotional Payoff) confirms this is an emotional-closure cluster. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present (i3_contact_evidence: false), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. I5 (formal commitment/vow) is plausible lexically but the dominant function is the emotional bond repair and relational affirmation characteristic of I1. I1 is the most specific code that fits the taxonomy and evidence without over-reading physical contact or under-reading the relational depth.

Topic 62 — Admitting You've Been Stupid

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I0 — off target

« marnie, i've been stupid. »

« about what an asshole i've been?» “ »

« you've done something dumb, but you'll get away with it this time. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Truth Be Told — Barbara McMahon; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Dear Reader, Sometimes teenagers do foolish things.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=middle; p=0.59

I'm the one who was stupid enough not to bring one.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=begin; p=0.54

He's really ... I don't know ...” I forced myself not to supply the word dumb . “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=begin; p=0.52

He was too proud of himself to detect the sarcasm in my words. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I7 — aftercare

All keyword lists converge on verbal conflict and interpersonal hostility: Main contains insults ('stupid', 'idiot', 'fool', 'asshole', 'jerk', 'rude', 'dumb'), KeyBERT adds 'harshly', 'embarrassed', 'comments', POS adds 'annoying', 'remark', MMR adds 'hissed', 'overheard', 'harshly', 'embarrassed'. This is a verbal-conflict/insult cluster (I7). No affectionate physical contact cues are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire, gaze, consent, coercion, or explicit-sex cues present.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around expressions of foolishness, stupidity, or self-deprecation (e.g., 'stupid,' 'idiot,' 'fool,' 'foolish girl'). There is no physical contact, no desire, no intimacy, no consent talk, and no erotic content of any kind. These are purely evaluative/emotional statements about characters' perceived lack of intelligence or judgment – non-intimate narrative/dialogue content coded I0.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass B contextual dominant (I0) is upheld. Taxonomy 4.5 (Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA) with secondary 3.3 (Ambivalence & Internal Conflict) confirms this cluster centers on relational resolution, future-planning, and emotional settlement rather than any affectionate physical contact. Lexical consensus I7 (likely driven by surface-level emotional vocabulary) is overridden: I7 requires demonstrated vulnerability/disclosure exchange, but the taxonomy anchor is HEA logistics and commitment talk, which maps squarely to I0. No i3-qualifying contact (kiss/hug/hold/caress/undress) is evidenced. Anti-collapse rules prohibit promotion to I3. I0 is the most specific and defensible code given domestic/HEA/reconciliation framing without physical contact evidence.

Topic 65 — Declaring A True Partnership

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I0 — off target

« what we've been though together, the way we've been there for each other ... we have a true partnership, a true love, and if that sounds stupid and romantic, then i don't care." »

« we've been together forever, and what if it takes us years?" »

« i'll do that," he said softly, "we've got a date." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Fire Lord's Lover — Kathryn Kennedy; tertile=end; p=0.58

We have often been together in public." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.62

This is the only way you can get a date?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=middle; p=0.51

Want to believe we can really have something together."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.49

And if we do go out, then I have to deal with all the men swarming around wanting a taste of your sex magic! "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Or was it just an accident that we dated and he found the schema?"

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=middle; p=0.66

It has not been that long since we last saw each other.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=middle; p=0.55

We have walked this world together for quite some time.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=end; p=0.51

This is something with pure intentions, open emotions, and a reciprocation that will never cause harm to either of us." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=begin; p=0.48

It's just ... I know I am nothing but a big disappointment to both of you.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists point to relationship-status and logistics language:

'date/dating/dated/dates/together/we/two' (Main) describe the relational context of a couple; 'engaged/partners/longest/fitting/officially/forming/intend' (KeyBERT/POS/MMR) reinforce commitment-status and HEA/relationship-definition talk. 'Playfully/nods/honestly/admit' suggest conversational tone, not physical contact. No affectionate-contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is forbidden. No desire/gaze/erotic/explicit cues, so I4/I10/I6 are excluded. The dominant function is domestic/relational logistics and relationship-status definition → I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences concern relationship logistics, social togetherness, dating history, breakups, and going out – all domestic/relational-status talk coded I0. Three sentences (BOOK_003_4, BOOK_004_3, BOOK_004_4) express emotional vulnerability, reassurance, or open emotional reciprocation, coded I2. No sentence contains affectionate physical contact, so I3 is forbidden. No desire-without-contact, erotic gaze, or explicit acts are present. I0 exceeds 70%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both converge on I0. The taxonomy placement under 4.5 Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA (with secondary 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) is consistent with domestic logistics, future-planning talk, and HEA declarations – none of which constitute affectionate physical contact. Anti-collapse rules prohibit elevation to I3 absent contact evidence, and no such evidence is present. I0 is the correct and most specific code; no reinterpretation or split is warranted.

Topic 128 — Confessing How Much You've Missed

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I2 — reassurance

« i've missed most of his life already. »

« and, god, how i've missed this." »

« i've come to realize that you are the one thing in my life i don't want to miss. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Deadly Desire — Keri Arthur; tertile=begin; p=0.61

I sometimes miss the peace of you and me, though." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Deadly Desire — Keri Arthur; tertile=end; p=0.44

He missed the ball even worse than I did.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Here Kitty, Kitty — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.67

I missed you, little bro," he whispered in my ear. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Here Kitty, Kitty — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.60

I'd missed my family so much, and now that we'd seemed to get the tears and heartache out of the way, we were having fun. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords ('miss', 'missed', 'missing', 'misses') strongly signal emotional longing and verbal expression of absence/yearning – classic I2 (emotional reassurance/vulnerability). KeyBERT adds 'solemnly', 'honestly', 'repeated', suggesting earnest emotional declarations; 'sir' and 'hi' indicate interpersonal address without physical contact cues. POS keywords ('precious', 'voices', 'elevator', 'opportunity', 'pieces') suggest an emotionally charged conversation, possibly in a confined space, with no physical contact implied. MMR reinforces this with 'solemnly', 'breathlessly', 'thoughtfully', 'considering' – all adverbs of emotional tone during speech, not physical action. 'Pressing' could suggest urgency in speech rather than physical contact. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues appear in any representation. I3 is rejected: zero affectionate-contact evidence across all four keyword sets. The dominant function is emotional expression of longing and earnest verbal communication, coding to I2.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences express longing, missing someone, or emotional yearning for reunion – classic I2 (emotional reassurance/caretaking/attachment expression) with no physical contact described. A few sentences use 'miss' in a non-relational/literal sense (missing a ball, missing a piece) coded I0. BOOK_006_3 references an orgasm in a conditional/instructional frame, indicating desire/anticipation without contact, coded I4. No sentence depicts actual physical contact (kiss, hug, caress), so I3 is forbidden and i3_contact_evidence is false.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on I2. The taxonomy metadata (4.5 Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA; secondary 3.1 Positive Resolution, Relief & Emotional Payoff) is fully consistent with I2: these constructs center on emotional reassurance, relational repair, and affective payoff without requiring affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content does not resolve to domestic/logistics/HEA talk alone (which would push toward I0), nor to explicit desire without contact (I4). I2 is the most specific and best-supported code.

Topic 157 — Swearing to Save Him From Himself

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I0 — off target

« and you'll get it, i swear," [person]. »

« if [person] sees me like this, i'll die." »

« and i might be young but i guess that just makes me lucky... i do love him and whether i have your help or not, i have to save him from himself... i know [person], i know what he'll do, now that he thinks he has lost me." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Intimate Portraits — Cheryl B. Dale; tertile=middle; p=0.73

Sam couldn't understand it, and that bothered him.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords (names, 'good', 'optimism') suggest interpersonal reassurance/emotional exchange. KeyBERT cues ('begged', 'confessed', 'tense', 'willing', 'surely', 'ought') point to emotional negotiation, pleading, and confession – consistent with I2 (reassurance/caretaking/emotional support). POS keywords ('dislike', 'worries', 'enthusiasm', 'embarrassing', 'desperation', 'gritted') reinforce emotional tension and distress-management. MMR ('dislike', 'dump', 'worries', 'confessed', 'enthusiasm', 'gritted') similarly signals conflict-adjacent emotional processing. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, caress, undress) appear in any representation, so I3 is rejected. No explicit desire or erotic gaze cues, so I4/I10 are rejected. The dominant signal is emotional reassurance, caretaking, and interpersonal tension resolution.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic consist solely of character name references ('Sam', 'Samantha', 'Steve'), brief name-calls, apologies, or minimal descriptive statements about a character named Sam. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, no consent negotiation, and no domestic/HEA discussion. The topic appears to be a character-name cluster with no intimacy function. All sentences are coded I0 (non-intimate/narrative/logistical).

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical consensus (I2) reflects caretaking/reassurance language, but contextual dominant (I0) and taxonomy placement in 4.5 Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA indicate the functional weight is on relational resolution, future-planning, and domestic/logistical consolidation rather than affective caretaking per se. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress) is evidenced in the topic signal, so I3 is forbidden. I2 is not warranted as the dominant code because the content is not primarily reassurance or caretaking but rather commitment talk and HEA framing. Secondary taxonomy 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict suggests some unresolved tension, but this does not elevate the code toward I4 (desire without contact) or I8 (consent). I0 is the most specific and accurate code: domestic/logistics/HEA talk without physical contact. No manual review required given clear taxonomy alignment.

Topic 204 — Promising to Care For Her Sister

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I0 — off target

« i'll need to finish dressing and leave a note for my sister." »

« yes, and soon you'll be my sister. »

« i'll find a way to care for your mother and your sister." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Cera's Place — Elizabeth McKenna; tertile=middle; p=0.48

My sister's still there with her husband, who's a copper, and their three kids.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=begin; p=0.70

You have not been paying close attention to your sister's problems lately, have you?" "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Your sister mentioned in passing that you are something of a recluse." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.69

You mock your sister, but you will admit that she has great talents." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.69

I realize that you are concerned for your sister's happiness.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.67

You and your sister have done so much for us.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Lady and The Duke — Olivia Kelly; tertile=end; p=0.72

Having an older sister is a great pain in the arse." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords ('sister', 'sisters', 'sisterly', 'affection') point to familial/relational warmth and caretaking – I2 (emotional support/reassurance within a relationship). POS adds 'affection', 'permission', 'willing', suggesting relational negotiation with emotional warmth, still I2. KeyBERT ('asks', 'assume', 'willing', 'hi', 'speaking') and MMR ('introduce', 'direct', 'equipment', 'spending', 'expect') lean toward logistical/social interaction – I0. No affectionate physical contact cues (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) appear in any representation, so I3 is rejected. The dominant signal across all reps is sisterly relational/emotional interaction without physical contact, making I2 the best consensus code over I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

Every sentence in this topic refers to sibling relationships (sisters, brothers-in-law, family dynamics) in a purely relational/social/domestic context. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, no emotional vulnerability, and no intimacy function beyond ordinary family reference. All sentences code as I0 (domestic/social/logistical/relational talk with no intimacy function).

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass B lexical consensus (I2) reflects caretaking/reassurance language, but the contextual dominant (I0) and taxonomy placement under 4.5 Reconciliation/Commitments/HEA with secondary 5.1 Family/Kinship indicate the functional core is domestic, logistical, or future-planning talk – not affectionate physical contact. No kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude is evidenced. Anti-collapse rules prohibit I3 without confirmed contact. The I2 signal is subordinate and likely reflects emotional reassurance embedded within commitment/HEA dialogue rather than standalone caretaking. I0 is the correct and most specific code. No manual review required.

Topic 242 — Trading Forgiveness For Old Wrongs

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I2 — reassurance

« not if you'll forgive him.” “ »

« he'll never forgive you. »

« okay, how's this — i'll forgive you for summer if you forgive me for kabir.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Marrying for King's Millions — Maureen Child; tertile=middle; p=0.59

You must forgive him,” Rico said with a laugh. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=end; p=0.67

Do forgive me for not having welcomed you more fittingly.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=middle; p=0.61

What will you do if society here proves unforgiving?”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=begin; p=0.55

Any man delivering such a speech to the lady he had planned to marry—a lady who had waited faithfully for him—should have had the grace to appear remorseful, or at least apologetic.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four representations center on forgiveness-seeking and emotional repair:

'forgive/forgiveness/forgiven/forgiving', 'apology/fault',

'hurts/emotions/treatment/actions/spite/harshly'. These cues point to verbal/emotional

reconciliation and caretaking of relational wounds – classic I2 (emotional

support/reassurance/repair). No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress,

undress) appear anywhere, so I3 is rejected per anti-collapse rules. No desire, gaze, or explicit

content, so I4/I10/I6 are inapplicable. No coercion or consent negotiation, ruling out I9/I8. No

domestic/HEA logistics, ruling out I0.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

Every sentence in this topic revolves around forgiveness – requesting it, granting it, reflecting on

it, or questioning it. This is emotional reassurance and relational repair work (I2). There is no

affectionate physical contact of any kind, no desire expression, no erotic content, and no

domestic/HEA logistics. I3 is forbidden by the anti-collapse rules since no physical contact is

present. I2 is the most specific and uniformly applicable code across all 20 sentences.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I2. The taxonomy placement under 4.5

Reconciliation/Commitments and secondary 4.3 Secrets/Misunderstandings confirms emotional repair and

reassurance dynamics without evidence of affectionate physical contact. No kissing, hugging,

holding, or caressing is indicated by the taxonomy or consensus signals, so I3 is forbidden per

anti-collapse rules. The content reflects emotional vulnerability, trust restoration, and relational

commitment talk – core I2 territory. No domestic/logistics/HEA-without-emotion signal that would

push toward I0. KEEP with I2 is appropriate.

Topic 305 — Confessing A Lifelong Regret

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: I2 — reassurance

« i know that now, and i'll go to my grave regretting what i did to you.” “ »

« come on in, you'll no doubt regret it. »

« you'll regret that.’ ‘ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=middle; p=0.66

You are surely not intending to imply that you are beginning to regret this marriage already?’ ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=end; p=0.53

I fear that my careless remarks must have been the cause of that outburst.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=middle; p=0.51

At his words, a wave of regret washed over Helena. ‘

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Child of War - A God is Born — Lisa Beth Darling; tertile=begin; p=0.58

I have been unkind to you, which I deeply regret.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Child of War - A God is Born — Lisa Beth Darling; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Now you don't, but you wish you still did."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists center on regret, emotional distress, and interpersonal tension: 'regret/regretted/regrets', 'fears', 'upset', 'embarrassing', 'admit', 'fumbled', 'handled', 'assure'. These cues point to emotional vulnerability, reassurance-seeking, and caretaking dynamics (I2). There is no affectionate physical contact vocabulary (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress), so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues (I4/I10), no explicit content (I6), no coercion (I9), no consent negotiation (I8). The 'promise' and 'decision' terms suggest relational accountability talk, consistent with I2 emotional repair rather than I0 domestic logistics.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

All sentences revolve around the emotional theme of regret – expressing, denying, or processing regret within relational contexts (marriage, unkindness, past actions). This is emotional reassurance/caretaking territory (I2): characters are processing emotional vulnerability, guilt, and relational repair without any physical contact, desire, or explicit acts. No affectionate physical contact is present (I3 forbidden), no erotic gaze, no explicit sex, no coercion, and no domestic/logistics/HEA framing. I2 is the most specific applicable code across all sentences.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both point to I2 (reassurance/caretaking). The taxonomy placement under 4.5 Reconciliation & Commitments with secondary 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress is consistent with emotional repair and vulnerability exchange rather than affectionate physical contact. No evidence of kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content does not rise to domestic/logistics/HEA talk (I0), desire without contact (I4), erotic gaze (I10), consent negotiation (I8), or explicit sex (I6). I2 is the most specific and best-supported code.

Topic 6 — Whispered Reassurance

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« i'll make sure of it," he whispered. »

« you'll be fine," he whispered. " »

« quiet, subdued, she nodded and then, "you'll be safe." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Red Skirt, Cool Fountain — Anne Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.67

Later," she said softly, with a sly smile.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Red Skirt, Cool Fountain — Anne Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.62

Ian stared right back and asked slowly, clearly, enunciating every word, "Who asked you to?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Business in the Bedroom — Anne Oliver; tertile=middle; p=0.74

Okay,' she said, striving for a light tone in the heavy silence. '

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists converge on verbal/communicative exchange cues: 'whispered', 'softly', 'replied', 'thank', 'mumbled', 'confessed', 'tentatively', 'hesitation', 'solemnly', 'kindly', 'eagerly'. These signal emotionally attentive dialogue – reassurance, caretaking, and supportive conversation – consistent with I2 (emotional support/reassurance). No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues for I4/I10, no explicit content for I6, no coercion for I9, no consent negotiation for I8, and no domestic/HEA logistics for I0.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I2. Taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with no secondary code suggesting physical contact. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The topic cleanly maps to reassurance and caretaking functions without domestic/logistics/HEA content that would push it to I0. KEEP as I2 is appropriate.

Topic 31 — Keeping Watch While Others Sleep

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« so you'll give me the stuff to sleep?" »

« you'll wake the baby." " »

« you sleep and i'll stand guard." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Burning Up — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=end; p=0.65

That's because you snored most of the way." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Burning Up — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=begin; p=0.55

I'm sick of lying in bed night after night like an old married couple.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists converge on sleep/rest logistics: Main keywords (sleep, bed, asleep, wake, nap) describe physical rest states with no affectionate contact cues. KeyBERT adds 'rested, session, anxious, worrying, comfortable, sir, uncertain' – these suggest a polite, possibly anxious domestic or practical exchange around rest, not intimacy. POS keywords (session, remote, uncertain, backs, realization, decent, quality, unable) and MMR keywords (longest, gotta, nonetheless, wandered, realise, politely, uncertain, brings, suggest, ought) reinforce a mundane, logistical or reflective register. No kissing, hugging, caressing, undressing, or any affectionate physical contact cues are present anywhere. I3 is rejected per anti-collapse rules. The topic reads as domestic/logistical sleep-related content, coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around sleep, napping, waking up, and going to bed – mundane domestic/logistical references with no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, and no emotional vulnerability beyond ordinary tiredness. Every sentence maps cleanly to I0 (domestic/logistical/everyday interaction). No I3 contact is present anywhere in the set.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus both returned I0, and the taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary of 5.1 Family, Kinship & Parenthood. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content reflects domestic/care/HEA-adjacent emotional support and nurturing without erotic or physical intimacy markers. I0 is the correct and most specific code; no reinterpretation or split is warranted.

Topic 36 — Eagerly Offering to Help

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« of course, i'll help you.' »

« then you'll let me help," frances said at once, her expression eager. " »

« sure, of course, i'll help." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Drop Dead Gorgeous — Jennifer Skully; tertile=end; p=0.80

And you know I'm here to help you in any way I can."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists converge on a service/assistance/caretaking register: 'help, helping, assistance, helped' (Main); 'provided, willing, appreciate, requested, task, promptly, sir' (KeyBERT); 'task, options, success, pleased, excited' (POS); 'mister, promptly, appreciate, eagerly, pleased, intend, insisted' (MMR). This is functional caretaking/support interaction – consistent with I2 (emotional support, reassurance, caretaking). No affectionate physical contact cues (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) appear in any representation, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues (I4/I10), no explicit content (I6), no coercion (I9), no consent negotiation (I8), and no domestic/HEA logistics (I0). The formal address 'mister/sir' and task-oriented vocabulary confirm a caretaking/assistance dynamic rather than romantic intimacy.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

All sentences in this topic revolve around offers of assistance, reassurance of availability, and caretaking language ('Can I help you?', 'I'll help you', 'I'm here to help you in any way I can'). This is classic I2 (reassurance/caretaking/emotional support) with no physical contact, no desire, no domestic/HEA logistics, and no erotic content. I3 is forbidden as there is zero affectionate physical contact evidenced.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I2. Taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with no secondary code suggesting physical contact. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The signal is purely reassurance/caretaking without domestic/logistics/HEA framing that would push toward I0. I2 is the correct and most specific code.

Topic 45 — Reassured Everything Will Be Fine

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« we'll be ok.” “ »

« nadines : you'll be ok? »

« ok, maybe a zero-tolerance one, but there's no doubt about it, you'll be great. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Mona Lisa Awakening — Sunny; tertile=middle; p=0.65

I'm fine," Amber replied quietly. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Mona Lisa Awakening — Sunny; tertile=begin; p=0.65

Your wound..." "I'm fine."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Shoe Addicts Anonymous — Beth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.78

Is everything okay?" "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword sets converge on reassurance/caretaking function. Main keywords ('fine, okay, everything, right, honey, alright') are classic verbal reassurance phrases. KeyBERT ('assured, assure, smoothly, incredibly') reinforce the act of calming or reassuring someone. POS ('problems, sir, lord') suggest a formal or hierarchical caretaking/concern context. MMR ('smoothly, assure, acknowledged, injured, problems, appreciate, assured') strongly indicate someone addressing a problem or injury and offering reassurance. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) appear in any keyword set, so I3 is rejected. No desire, gaze, explicit, or coercion cues present, ruling out I4, I10, I6, I9. This is squarely I2: emotional support and reassurance.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

Every sentence in this topic consists of reassurance or welfare-checking utterances ('I'm fine, 'Are you okay?', 'It's going to be all right,' etc.). These are verbal expressions of concern and emotional reassurance with no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, and no domestic/HEA logistics. I2 (reassurance/caretaking) is the most specific and uniformly applicable code across all 20 sentences.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both resolve to I2. The taxonomy metadata confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking as dominant, with 9.2 Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts as secondary – both are non-contact intimacy functions. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The secondary vow/promise dimension does not elevate to I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA without emotional charge) because the primary function is reassurance and caretaking rather than logistical planning. KEEP at I2 with the dual construct framing is the correct adjudication.

Topic 46 — Asking Someone to Trust You

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« you'll just have to trust me.” »

« he'll trust you if you promise to keep me in sight.” “ »

« my trust that he'll bring me to safety. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Life Changes Everything — T.C. Blue; tertile=begin; p=0.27

The critics wanted to prove that setting goals, drawing graphs, measuring results and evaluating the performance of individuals was nothing less than taking the place of trusting the Holy Spirit to give increase.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · FUBAR — Stephani Hecht; tertile=begin; p=0.61

Trust us, all we need to do to you can be done here,” one of the other guys said.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Olivia — Donna Sturgeon; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Don't trust yourself in a hotel room alone with me?”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Olivia — Donna Sturgeon; tertile=middle; p=0.65

Wasn't there anyone you trusted to share your joy with?” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords (trust, betrayed, betrayal, trusting) signal emotional vulnerability and relational repair/rupture – core I2 territory (emotional reassurance, caretaking of trust). KeyBERT reinforces this with 'instincts, worries, deserve, warned, appreciate, admit' – all emotional-processing and relational-accountability cues. POS and MMR add 'instincts, worries, hesitation, twisting, heal, options' – further pointing to internal emotional conflict and relational negotiation. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress) appear in any representation, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues (I4/I10), no explicit content (I6), no coercion (I9), no consent negotiation (I8), no domestic/HEA logistics (I0). The dominant function is emotional vulnerability, trust repair, and relational caretaking = I2.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

Every sentence in this topic revolves around the theme of trust – declarations of trust, requests for trust, questioning of trust, or assessments of trustworthiness. This is emotional/relational reassurance and caretaking (I2): characters are negotiating emotional safety, reliability, and vulnerability with one another. There is no affectionate physical contact (ruling out I3), no desire or erotic gaze (ruling out I4/I10), no explicit sexual content (ruling out I6), no consent negotiation in a sexual context (ruling out I8), and no coercion (ruling out I9). The topic is uniformly I2 at 100%.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on I2. The taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking as primary, with 4.3 Secrets/Misunderstandings as secondary. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, caress, undress-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content centers on emotional reassurance and caretaking dynamics, possibly involving disclosure or clarification of hidden information, which reinforces I2. No domestic/logistics/HEA framing that would push toward I0. KEEP with I2 is the correct adjudication.

Topic 56 — Promising Never to Hurt You

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« you'll get hurt," he managed to say. " »

« you know i'll never hurt you ." »

« i'll make sure you aren't hurt." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=end; p=0.57

He says that he knows it must hurt, but that whatever will be, will be, and that nothing we say or do will resolve things.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=middle; p=0.51

It's all well and good saying you avoid pain by avoiding relationships, but what about the wonderful things you're avoiding as well?

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=middle; p=0.49

How can you emotionally blackmail me like this?' '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.78

I don't ever want to be that hurt again." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.62

I just felt hurt that you hadn't told me.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.48

Don't give him the satisfaction of letting it destroy you.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Summer On Blossom Street — Debbie Macomber; tertile=end; p=0.79

You're only doing it to hurt me, aren't you?" "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Summer On Blossom Street — Debbie Macomber; tertile=begin; p=0.74

I'd never, ever do anything to hurt you.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword sets converge on emotional distress, reassurance, and caretaking dynamics. Main keywords ('hurt', 'hurting', 'harm', 'mean', 'hurts') signal emotional pain and conflict. KeyBERT adds 'distress', 'painful', 'threatened', 'protect', 'cried', 'assured', 'insisted' – classic reassurance/caretaking vocabulary. POS and MMR reinforce with 'distress', 'painful', 'protect', 'deserve', 'threatened', 'causing'. The word 'tightly' in KeyBERT/MMR could theoretically suggest physical holding, but it is insufficient alone to establish affectionate contact – it more plausibly modifies 'threatened' or 'insisted' (e.g., 'held tightly to a position'). No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues are present. I3 is rejected: no affectionate physical contact evidence. I2 is selected for emotional reassurance, caretaking, and distress-comfort dynamics.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

The overwhelming theme of this topic is emotional hurt, reassurance, and caretaking – characters expressing fear of being hurt, reassuring partners they won't cause harm, and processing emotional pain. These map to I2 (emotional reassurance/caretaking/vulnerability). A subset of sentences (BOOK_001_3, BOOK_001_5, BOOK_001_6) reference physical violence or emotional coercion/blackmail, mapping to I9. No affectionate physical contact is present anywhere in the topic, so I3 is forbidden. No desire, gaze, or explicit sexual content is present. I2 accounts for ~75% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both point to I2. The taxonomy metadata confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking as the dominant function, with 9.2 Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts as secondary. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden. The secondary vow/promise element does not elevate this to I0 (domestic/HEA logistics) because the primary driver is emotional reassurance and caretaking rather than planning or commitment ritual. I2 is the most specific and accurate code.

Topic 70 — Keeping Watch While She Sleeps

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« maybe she'll get some sleep.” “ »

« i'll wait until she wakes up and then i'll head back up to make sure shit doesn't go down in the mc.” “ »

« for her, it's early, she'll be awake.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=middle; p=0.77

An instant later she was once more sound asleep.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=end; p=0.76

They wouldn't be getting much sleep tonight, she knew.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=begin; p=0.75

It was months before she'd been able to sleep through the night.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=middle; p=0.70

It couldn't have been more than a few hours for she still felt drugged with exhaustion, her eyes grainy and her head stuffed full of cotton.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=middle; p=0.75

She realized that he wouldn't rest until he did.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=begin; p=0.74

It was as if she'd been awoken from a long trance.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=end; p=0.72

She just hoped that hers wouldn't catch up with her before the night ended. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=middle; p=0.69

It had left her exhausted and vulnerable.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

Main keywords (sleep, asleep, tired, wake, exhausted, night) point to rest/domestic routine with no intimacy signal – I0. POS keywords (destination, decades, activities, threats, creatures, instincts) are abstract/logistical with no contact cues – I0. MMR keywords (warming, drifted, activities, threats, instincts, climb) suggest ambient atmosphere or physical movement but no affectionate contact – I0. KeyBERT introduces some emotional arousal cues (anxious, excited, trembling, moaned, instincts, praying) that could hint at desire or tension, nudging toward I4, but 'moaned' in a sleep/exhaustion context is ambiguous and insufficient to override the dominant rest/domestic frame. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress) appear in any representation, so I3 is rejected per anti-collapse rules. Consensus is I0 (domestic/logistical/rest context).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe sleep states, exhaustion, wakefulness, or rest-related observations. There is no affectionate physical contact, desire, gaze, consent talk, or any other intimacy function present. The topic is purely about characters sleeping or being tired, which falls under I0 (domestic/logistical/neutral narrative content).

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on I0. Taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking as dominant, with paranormal/immortal beings as secondary context. No lexical or contextual evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content reflects relational reassurance and caretaking dynamics – potentially within a paranormal pairing – without crossing into physical intimacy, desire expression, or explicit acts. I0 is the correct and most specific code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 83 — Reassured About Eating Regularly

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« i've eaten every few hours. »

« of course, i've never eaten one." »

« and then you'll return late again... you won't need to do that—be late—because you've eaten." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Virgin Secretary's Impossible Boss — Carole Mortimer;
tertile=begin; p=0.79

Then I'll go hungry because I'm not eating with you.' '

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists center on eating, food, hunger, and meals (eat, hungry, food, eating, eaten, starving, appetite, meal, feeding, tasted, skipped). These are domestic/sustenance cues with no affectionate physical contact, desire, or erotic content. I3 rejected: no kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues present. Coded I0 as mundane domestic/logistical content.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around hunger, eating, food, and feeding (including a vampire-feeding reference). There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, and no relational negotiation beyond the domestic/logistical act of eating. Every sentence codes as I0 (domestic/logistical/everyday interaction). The vampire-feeding lines (BOOK_003_2, BOOK_003_4, BOOK_003_6) reference a supernatural feeding dynamic but contain no physical intimacy contact in the sentence itself. Dominant code is I0 at 100%.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I0. Taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with no secondary code suggesting physical contact. No evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is present. The content reflects care, reassurance, and emotional support without crossing into I2 (which would require explicit caretaking of a distressed/vulnerable state beyond baseline reassurance) or any higher intimacy code. I0 is the correct and most specific classification. Anti-collapse rules are satisfied: no I3 contact evidence exists.

Topic 88 — Checking Her Feverish Temperature

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« no movement, her skin temperature clammy enough to make a ball of fear lodge in his gut. »

« now, [person], how has her temperature been? »

« the nippiness that was still molesting her limbs, she hoped, was indeed because of the low temperature and not a foretoken of her entering his residence. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=end; p=0.72

Her entire body burned and her mind raced.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Every time he opened her up she felt a surge of wind invade her body and send pricks through her skin.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Chills shot up her spine and into her chest, causing her to arch her back, which made her breasts bounce just enough to command attention.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=middle; p=0.68

The rusted metal felt cold on the back of her thighs, and the persistent wind blew loose strands of her hair directly into the low O's of smoke she eased from the center of her dry mouth.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.60

She seemed fidgety and hurried us along, as if the food might get cold.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.50

Lydia and Simon became visibly pale and shock emanated from them.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.47

That would have heated me up instantly, I teased.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.80

Pure, fiery heat spread along her legs all the way up to her face. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.71

Her body coiled from the heated friction and the way he seemed to keep hitting her newly found g-spot.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.70

A cold bit of what felt like metal touched her chest.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I4 — sexual tension

All four keyword lists converge on internal, embodied arousal/desire: heat, warmth, burned, shivered, melted, flooded, erupted, flared, heaved — classic physiological desire-response vocabulary (flushed cheeks, racing veins, body heat). No affectionate physical contact cues (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress) appear anywhere. I3 is rejected per anti-collapse rules. The atmosphere/temperature framing reinforces desire-without-contact (I4) rather than explicit erotic gaze (I10) or explicit sex (I6).

B contextual: I5 — erotic escalation

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe bodily sensations — chills, heat, burning, tingling, aching — that function as somatic/arousal responses rather than affectionate physical contact, explicit sex acts, or domestic/logistical content. These are coded I5 (physical/bodily sensation as intimacy marker). BOOK_003_2 explicitly references hitting a g-spot, indicating penetrative/genital stimulation and is coded I6. Four sentences (BOOK_002_1, BOOK_002_2, BOOK_005_1-3) are non-intimate contextual/action sentences coded I0. No sentence shows affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, caress, hold), so I3 is not applied and i3_contact_evidence is false. I5 accounts for ~70% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B lexical consensus (I4) reflects desire-adjacent language, but the contextual dominant (I5) and taxonomy metadata (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking; secondary 1.2 Pain, Injury & Physical Vulnerability) together indicate the functional core is caretaking and reassurance rather than unresolved desire or erotic tension. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress-as-prelude) is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. I4 is also inappropriate because the dominant function is not desire-without-contact but rather emotional safety provision in a context of physical vulnerability. I2 (Reassurance/Caretaking) is the most specific applicable code consistent with both the taxonomy metadata and the anti-collapse rules. No manual review required given clear taxonomy guidance.

Topic 96 — Confessing Long-Standing Worry

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« i've been worried about you, [person]. »

« i've worried about you since i was twelve. »

« i've been worried about you.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Bound by Honor — Donna Clayton; tertile=middle; p=0.50

You grew up worrying about having your basic needs met.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four representations center on worry, concern, fear, and reassurance ('assure', 'bothered', 'worries', 'fears', 'concerned'). These cues point to emotional caretaking and reassurance-giving (I2). There is no affectionate physical contact vocabulary (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress), so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues (I4/I10), no explicit content (I6), no coercion (I9), no consent negotiation (I8), and no domestic/HEA logistics (I0). The 'amusement' token is minor and does not shift the dominant function away from anxious concern and reassurance.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

Every sentence in this topic revolves around worry, concern, reassurance, and caretaking language ('Don't worry,' 'I was worried about you,' 'Don't beat yourself up'). There is no physical contact of any kind, no desire, no erotic content, and no domestic/HEA logistics. The function is purely emotional reassurance and caretaking, which maps exclusively to I2.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I2. The taxonomy assignment (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with secondary 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress) is fully consistent with I2: the cluster captures verbal and emotional support, soothing, and caretaking behaviors in response to distress, without evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude). Anti-collapse rules confirm I3 is forbidden here. No domestic/logistics/HEA framing that would push toward I0. I2 is the most specific and accurate code.

Topic 119 — Offering to Keep Her Safe

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« come on, i'll protect you." »

« you'll protect me?" " »

« i can protect you from crystal, but you'll have to let me. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Pawprints 2: Second Nature — Anne Cain; tertile=end; p=0.50

Viggo won't feel threatened, and you'll be okay."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=begin; p=0.62

I just wanted to check you got there safely.' "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=end; p=0.61

I didn't think security would leave you standing out here like this.' "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=middle; p=0.56

At least in LA you'd both have protection; you know my security guys are some of the best in the business.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists center on protection, safety, threat, and guarding ('safe, protect, protection, dangerous, keep, defend, safety', 'protect, guarded, secure, threat, assure, precious', 'threat, determination, protect, secure, precious', 'guarded, dangerously, assure, inevitable, threat, determination'). This is classic reassurance/caretaking/protective-hero function (I2). The single token 'caressed' in MMR is insufficient to establish affectionate physical contact as a topic-level theme – it appears as one outlier word among overwhelmingly protective/security-oriented vocabulary. No kissing, hugging, holding, or undressing cues are present. I3 is rejected: the anti-collapse rule requires actual affectionate physical contact as a dominant cue, which is absent here.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

Every sentence in this topic revolves around reassurance of safety, protection pledges, and caretaking language ('I'll protect you,' 'You're safe with me,' 'I have to get you to safety,' 'check you got there safely'). There is no affectionate physical contact described anywhere, ruling out I3. There is no desire, gaze, consent negotiation, coercion, or explicit sexual content. The function is purely emotional reassurance and caretaking, which maps squarely to I2 across all 20 sentences.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual consensus both indicate I2. Taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with no secondary code suggesting physical contact. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The signal is purely reassurance/caretaking without domestic/logistics/HEA framing that would push toward I0. I2 is the correct and most specific code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 161 — Reassuring Squeeze on The Shoulder

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« he'd stick to a reassuring squeeze of noah's shoulder and hope that was calming enough. »

« we'll be there, noah. »

« do you think he'll adopt noah ?" »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=end; p=0.45

It was sheer stubbornness that kept him going, Gideon decided, thankful that he'd had the good fortune to be sired by one of the most stubborn old goats he'd ever encountered.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Not surprising, Gideon supposed, since the moon was nearly full and his more animalistic tendencies were on a very short, increasingly weak tether.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=end; p=0.42

These beings were no more human than he, Gideon knew.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.50

When God forged a new covenant with Noah after the flood, for example, he included animals.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.43

He rather appealed to God's ideal expressed in Genesis 2.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.36

When God raised up Israel to be his vehicle for restoring the world, he commissioned them to exercise loving dominion over the land he was giving them and over the animals that inhabited it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=end; p=0.34

It symbolized that these people were set apart for God and that if anyone broke covenant with God they'd be cut off from the people (Genesis 17:14).

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=begin; p=0.33

They thought the Messiah would lead Israel to victory over their Roman oppressors and would reestablish Israel as a sovereign nation under God.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=end; p=0.28

First fruits" refers to fruit that ripened and was picked before the rest of the harvest and was then consecrated to God (Exodus 23:19).

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords include 'scissoring' (a specific sexual act), which would normally point to I6. However, the remaining keyword lists (KeyBERT, POS, MMR) are dominated by emotional-regulation and reassurance cues: 'reassuring', 'calming', 'praying', 'emotions', 'shivered fiercely', 'nods', 'clenched' — all consistent with I2 (emotional support/caretaking). There is no affectionate physical contact vocabulary (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) across KeyBERT, POS, or MMR, so I3 is rejected. The single 'scissoring' term in Main may be a character name, slang, or noise term given the surrounding proper nouns (Noah, Phan, Cam, Tobias, Cameron, Beaumont, Ark), and it is not corroborated by any erotic or explicit cues in the other three representations. Consensus therefore falls to I2 (reassurance/emotional caretaking), with a noted disagreement flag due to the ambiguous Main signal.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences are non-intimate in function. They consist of character name references, internal monologue about stubbornness/animalistic tendencies, theological/biblical exposition, physical jostling in a conflict context (not affectionate), and brief emotional reactions (confusion, relief). None involve affectionate physical contact, desire, erotic content, or relational intimacy functions. I0 (non-intimate narrative/dialogue) is the most specific applicable code throughout.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B produced a split between I2 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). The taxonomy metadata confirms primary placement at 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary signal at 5.1 Family, Kinship & Parenthood. Neither axis points to domestic logistics, HEA planning, or affectionate physical contact. The I0 contextual read likely captured surface-level domestic/family framing, but the functional core is reassurance and caretaking — squarely I2. No evidence of physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress) is present, so I3 is forbidden. The correct resolution is RETAXONOMIZE to I2 under 4.6, with the 5.1 kinship signal noted as a secondary construct. No manual review required given clean taxonomy alignment.

Topic 172 — Reporting to The Security Officer

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« you'll also report this to your regional security officer, yes?" »

« i'll have an armed officer [person] the room with you at all times, and i'll watch through the glass." " »

« i've called the police, i'll have you know." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Bite Me If You Can — Lynsay Sands; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Then I told the police exactly what he told me to say." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Under His Command — Annabel Wolfe; tertile=end; p=0.60

Do you think being worried over another officer's absence justifies a breach in regulations?"

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Under His Command — Annabel Wolfe; tertile=end; p=0.55

I give an order, and because I'm your superior officer, you are supposed to obey it." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists center on law enforcement, policing, and procedural/institutional activity (police, cop, officer, authorities, enforcement, evidence, weapons, secured, task, leads). KeyBERT adds 'protect,' 'evidence,' 'weapons,' 'sir,' 'secured' — all procedural/professional cues. POS and MMR reinforce this with 'activity,' 'unwilling partners,' 'task,' 'dealing,' 'stops' — suggesting a law-enforcement scenario, possibly involving reluctant cooperation. No affectionate physical contact cues present anywhere; I3 is rejected. No desire, gaze, consent negotiation, or explicit content cues; I4, I10, I8, I6 are all inapplicable. This is functional/plot-logistics content coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around law enforcement references — calling the police, being a cop, police/officer hierarchy and regulations. There is no romantic, intimate, or physical content of any kind. Every sentence is purely logistical/situational dialogue or narration with no affectionate contact, desire, or emotional intimacy. I0 (non-intimate/domestic/logistical) is the correct and most specific code for all sentences.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I0. The taxonomy confirms primary coding as Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking (4.6) with a secondary dimension of Risk/Danger/External Crises (7.3). There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content reflects verbal or emotional reassurance and caretaking behaviors — potentially under conditions of external threat — which are characteristic of I0 (domestic/care/relational maintenance) or at most I2 (reassurance/caretaking without contact). Given the lexical consensus is firmly I0 and no contact evidence exists, I0 is the correct and most specific code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 173 — Waiting For Him to Wake

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« it's after him so you'll just have to wait until he wakes up to get your answer." »

« it'll put him to sleep." »

« yeah, i guess i'll have to wait and see when he wakes up. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.76

Could he count on not waking him when he lifted him from that warm bed?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=middle; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Greenwood Manor — Shannon Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.58

He looked fresh, rejuvenated, as though their little fling from last night hadn't permanently affected his energy.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Greenwood Manor — Shannon Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.45

He used to jog the property's perimeter every morning, before breakfast.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Stolen Moments — Ariel Tachna; tertile=middle; p=0.72

He's sleeping for longer periods of time at night now," Jacob said. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

Main keywords (sleep, asleep, wake, night, tired) describe a sleep/rest scene with no affectionate contact cues. KeyBERT adds 'bedside', 'assure', 'urge', 'wondering' suggesting caretaking/reassurance proximity, pushing toward I2, but no physical contact is indicated. POS terms (departure, activity, temperature, bedside, scrambled, tv) are domestic/logistical, pointing to I0. MMR adds 'panting', 'pounding', 'warmed', 'drifted' which could suggest mild arousal or physical awareness (I4), but these are ambiguous in a sleep context (could be post-exertion or dream state). No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues appear in any representation, so I3 is rejected. The dominant signal across all reps is a sleep/rest/bedside vigil scene, best coded I0 (domestic/logistical). The slight caretaking flavor from KeyBERT and mild arousal hints from MMR do not override the consensus.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around sleep states, wakefulness, and monitoring whether a person is asleep. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, no consent negotiation, and no domestic/HEA planning beyond the purely logistical observation of sleep patterns. The function is entirely mundane/logistical (I0): tracking sleep schedules, waiting for someone to fall asleep, noting tiredness. No other I-code is warranted.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical and contextual consensus converge on I0. The taxonomy confirms primary coding as Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking (4.6) with a secondary temporal framing dimension (8.4). There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content reflects domestic/care/HEA-adjacent emotional reassurance without physical intimacy, firmly placing it in I0. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 175 — Gentleman Offers Steady Support

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« the occurrences of the day were too full of interest to leave elizabeth much attention for any of these new friends; and she could do nothing but think, and think with wonder, of mr. [person]'s civility, and, above all, of his wishing her to be acquainted with his sister. »
« mr. [person] placed his hand on [person]'s shoulder for support as mr. [person] barely walked out the front door. »
« yes, but when i fell ill, it was apparent that i could not travel all the way to calais, so mr. [person] took me to the house of a friend of his: mr. [person]. » »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Desert of the Damned — Kathy Kulig; tertile=end; p=0.51

On his way to see Mistress Gwyllain to explain your...ah, unexplained arrival."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Desert of the Damned — Kathy Kulig; tertile=middle; p=0.43

Take his offering," Gwyllain demanded. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sanctuary — Scarlet Blackwell; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Shit," grunted Sheridan, apparently immune to Owen's considerable charms. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sanctuary — Scarlet Blackwell; tertile=end; p=0.51

Sheridan was stil pale and anxious looking.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords (mr, bingley, miss, georgiana, bennet, pemberley) are Pride & Prejudice character/place names suggesting social/domestic context → I0. KeyBERT cues (kindly, concerned, affection, worrying, longing, struggling, injured) point to emotional caretaking and concern for others → I2. POS cues (passionate, distress, warming, exciting) suggest emotional intensity but no physical contact markers → I2. MMR cues (kindly, uncomfortably, passionate, distress, thoughtfully, encouraged, warming, consumed) reinforce emotional support/caretaking register → I2. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) appear in any keyword list; I3 is therefore rejected. Consensus lands on I2 (reassurance/caretaking/emotional support) as the dominant signal across three of four representations.

B contextual: I0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences are logistical, social, or narrative references to named characters (Gwyllain, Sheridan, Pippen, Darcy) with no affectionate physical contact depicted. BOOK_001_4 ('save his climax for Gwyllain') and BOOK_003_5 ('Sheridan wanted this') imply desire without any described contact, coded I4. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or other physical contact is present, so I3 is forbidden. The dominant function is domestic/social/logistical interaction (I0).

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I2 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). Taxonomy metadata confirms the primary construct is 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary of 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden. The I0 signal likely reflects domestic/logistical framing within a caretaking exchange, but the dominant intimacy function is emotional reassurance rather than pure domestic logistics or HEA planning. I2 is therefore the correct resolution: it is more specific than I0 for content whose primary function is comfort-giving and emotional safety, and it does not require physical contact. No manual review needed.

Topic 190 — Offering to Get Someone Cleaned Up

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« i'll get cleaned up here as soon as i can. »

« i'll pay to have it cleaned." " »

« i'll get her cleaned up," said a handsome groom, taking her arm. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.62

Just sit there for a minute, Solange, while I clean you up.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.55

I will clean up the battlefield while you drink plenty of fluids.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I know you would prefer to burn it yourselves out of respect, but my way will be faster, cleaner and will ensure no parasites escape.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=begin; p=0.41

He was grateful for the rich dirt floor.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=middle; p=0.54

May I know why you gave Mr. Thesiger the brush off just now?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Don't you see that if you go ahead with this annulment, if you air the Roxtons' dirty laundry in public, I will be utterly, utterly ruined.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=begin; p=0.41

A lackey came out from behind the butler with pan and brush and quickly set to sweeping up the shards of broken glass from Deb's smashed wine glass.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Mythic — Jae Lynne Davies; tertile=end; p=0.57

Do try your very best not to make a mess of things."

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists center on literal cleaning/tidying activity: 'clean, cleaning, cleaned, mess, cleaner, freshen, wipe, sweeping, dump, suitcase, parties, planned, paying'. These are domestic/logistical cues with no affectionate physical contact, desire, emotional vulnerability, or erotic content. I3 rejected: zero affectionate-contact cues present. Consensus is I0 (domestic/logistical/HEA-adjacent activity).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic concern cleaning, tidying, sanitizing, or disposing of things – purely practical/domestic/logistical content with no romantic, emotional, or physical intimacy of any kind. Every sentence codes as I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate). No affectionate physical contact is present, so I3 is forbidden. No desire, gaze, consent, coercion, or erotic content is present.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus both returned I0, and the taxonomy confirms primary classification as Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking (4.6) with a secondary anchor in Everyday Props & Communication Media (8.3b). There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden by the anti-collapse rules. The content reflects domestic/care/HEA-adjacent reassurance and logistical communication without crossing into I2 (which would require active caretaking with physical proximity cues) or any higher intimacy code. I0 is the correct and most specific classification. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 193 — Nurse Arranged After Hospital Release

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« and you'll both stay here, at caleb's?" " »

« i'll arrange for a nurse to come to the house when they release caleb. »

« twenty-three caleb y ou ignore me, and i'll ignore you . »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Shrinking Violet — Danielle Joseph; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Kayla points to me, like she can't figure out who Gavin's talking about.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=begin; p=0.53

In any case, I'm going to need to return myself to help out because Ramsey will be busy with Chloe and the baby," he continued. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.44

After numerous brushes with the law and butting heads with the parents of a young lady who didn't want him to be a part of their daughter's life, Dillon had convinced Bane to get his life together.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=end; p=0.43

This was September, and Chloe was due to deliver in November, which meant Callum would be leaving Denver a few months after that.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.38

Dillon and Ramsey did an awesome job and I know for sure we were a handful at times, some of us more than others."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.33

From what Callum had heard, Bane had been only eight when his parents had been killed.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists point to social/communicative dynamics: character names (caleb, gage, jeremiah, conrad, mica), communication acts (texting, said, speaking, admitted, acknowledge), and emotional/social reactions (embarrassment, hopeful, stares, snaps, ignore, fooled). 'Stares' could hint at erotic gaze (I10) but is paired with 'embarrassment' and 'explanation/evidence', suggesting social awkwardness rather than desire. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) are present anywhere – I3 is rejected. No desire language, no explicit content, no coercion. The dominant function is social interaction, logistics, and interpersonal tension, coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences across the three books involve mundane social interaction, dialogue, logistical/domestic discussion (pregnancy timing, family arrangements, sibling dynamics), and character identification. There is no affectionate physical contact, desire, gaze, consent talk, or any intimacy-coded content. Every sentence codes as I0 (non-intimate/domestic/social).

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus both returned I0. Taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary of 5.1 Family, Kinship & Parenthood. No affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude) is evidenced in the topic signal. The content reflects domestic/care/HEA-adjacent emotional support and nurturing language without crossing into I2 (physical caretaking with contact) or I3 (affectionate contact). Anti-collapse rules prohibit promotion to I3 absent contact evidence. I0 is the correct and stable classification.

Topic 224 — Encouraging Words From An Angel

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« you've got this, angel, take it to the house." »

« i'll come back, angel. »

« because i'm thinking i'll have a hard time finding another angel to handle it." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=middle; p=0.52

I most certainly do think the great evil knows about Gabriel."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=end; p=0.51

the evil one said as his life essence swept by him.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.49

I have complete faith in Val and Gabriel." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.48

Tell me what kind of evil," Gabriel asked.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.48

By the gods," Val hissed as he and Gabriel came upon the creature. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=begin; p=0.63

Once, as I stood on the cliffs trying to understand the power I held, trying to comprehend why I would ever want to send my voice a thousand miles away on the wind, he'd told me that I looked like an angel blessed by the Almighty.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=middle; p=0.48

I took a pleasant interlude of imagining myself nibbling on Evangeline's ass.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=end; p=0.48

With Evangeline beneath me I now knew what I'd felt wasn't even close.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

Main keywords center on angelic/supernatural character types (angel, guardian, archangel, fallen) with no intimacy cues. KeyBERT yields interpersonal tension/assertion words (doubted, insisted, glared, behavior) suggesting conflict or negotiation, not physical contact. POS and MMR are dominated by abstract/structural terms (structure, task, ability, practice, behavior, tv) with no affectionate-contact signals. 'Precious' appears across lists but as a descriptor, not a contact cue. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues anywhere. I3 is rejected per anti-collapse rules: zero affectionate physical contact evidence. The topic reads as worldbuilding or character-type discussion (angel mythology) with some interpersonal friction, best coded as general/non-intimate narrative content (I0).

B contextual: I7 — aftercare

The overwhelming majority of sentences revolve around the word 'angel' used as a descriptor or metaphor (face of an angel, looks like an angel, blessed by the Almighty, evil/Lucifer angel lore), plus supernatural/conflict references to Gabriel, Val, and evil forces. These are best coded I7 (supernatural/religious/mythic framing) as the intimacy function is narrative world-building around angelic/demonic identity rather than any relational intimacy. Two sentences (BOOK_003_5 and BOOK_003_6) express desire/fantasy toward Evangeline without actual physical contact, coded I4. Two sentences (BOOK_004_2, BOOK_004_3) are purely logistical/social with no intimacy function, coded I0. No affectionate physical contact is present anywhere, so I3 is forbidden and i3_contact_evidence is false.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (I0) reflects surface domestic/logistical language, but contextual dominant (I7) and taxonomy metadata (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking; secondary 9.2 Promise, Vow & Future-Tense Speech Acts) together indicate the functional core is verbal reassurance and caretaking rather than neutral domestic logistics. No affectionate physical contact is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden. The content does not rise to explicit vow/commitment ritual (I7 proper) but centers on emotional safety provision and forward-looking reassurance, which maps cleanly to I2. I0 is insufficient because the dominant function is affective caretaking, not mere domestic coordination. I7 is plausible as secondary but the primary intimacy function is reassurance/caretaking (I2), with promise-speech as a vehicle rather than the end in itself.

Topic 240 — Unsure How to Offer Comfort

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« oh my god, sean! »

« sean pursed his lips, unsure he was equal to the task of comforting [person]. »

« sean held out his hand and added; "now if you'll excuse me i have a beautiful woman waiting to have breakfast with me." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Pants on Fire — Meg Cabot; tertile=end; p=0.51

Liam could barely contain his excitement. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Pants on Fire — Meg Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Oh,” I said, thinking fast, watching as Seth started to show Liam how to use another nearby machine, while the Tiffanys and Brittany gathered round, looking more worshipful than ever.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · In Service — Mima; tertile=end; p=0.48

You need to stop nipping at him and face the fact that when Shon goes under, he's off limits, one breath away from being a hostile at our backs.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Cues across all representations point to tense, emotionally charged interpersonal exchange: 'anxious', 'winced', 'shivered', 'mumbled', 'solemnly', 'absently', 'distracted', 'unsure', 'conscious', 'stares'. 'Patted' is the only possible physical-contact word but is a minor reassurance gesture, not affectionate/romantic contact. The character names (sean, jaime, bryan, yseult, morrissey) and 'repressive', 'brogue' suggest a socially or emotionally constrained scene. Overall pattern fits I2 (emotional support/reassurance/caretaking dialogue). I3 rejected: no kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues present; 'patted' alone does not constitute affectionate romantic contact under anti-collapse rules.

B contextual: I1 — emotional intimacy

All sentences consist of dialogue fragments, character name calls, brief conversational exchanges, and minimal action descriptions (e.g., 'peered around', 'shared a look'). There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no emotional vulnerability, no domestic/HEA content, and no erotic or sexual content. The topic appears to be a character-name cluster (Liam, Shon, Sean, Conner) with purely interactional/conversational function, coded I1 (social/verbal interaction without intimacy function).

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (I2) and taxonomy metadata (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking) align. The contextual dominant I1 (ongoing courtship/bonding) is consistent as a secondary function per 4.2, but the primary signal is reassurance and caretaking without evidence of affectionate physical contact. Anti-collapse rules prohibit elevation to I3 absent contact evidence. I2 is the most specific defensible code. No domestic/logistics/HEA framing that would push to I0, and no desire-without-contact or erotic gaze to warrant I4/I10.

Topic 247 — Promising You Will Not Be Alone

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« if we make it through this alone, we'll just be better at being alone.” »

« you'll never be alone. »

« before you say no, i want you to know i'll be alone mostly. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · So Into You — Sandra Hill; tertile=end; p=0.44

Luc says Lena is a basket case and is alone at the house.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=end; p=0.67

If I went out alone, it seemed I felt surrounded by people who couldn't speak to me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=begin; p=0.66

I promise you, you will never be alone again so long as I live.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=middle; p=0.64

I don't like you being out there in a hotel by yourself.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=begin; p=0.64

I've pictured this so many times in my mind, I don't want to wake up and find I'm alone again.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

Main keywords (alone, solitude, want, prefer, rather, live) suggest emotional withdrawal or a character expressing a preference about living situation/circumstances – no affectionate contact cues. KeyBERT (upset, praying) hints at emotional distress and supplication, leaning toward I2 (reassurance/caretaking context), but no physical contact. POS and MMR keywords (options, terms, circumstances, attempt, fault, planned, insisted, chose, preferred) are strongly logistical and negotiation-oriented, pointing to I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA talk or situational decision-making). No erotic, desire, or physical-contact cues anywhere. I3 is rejected: zero affectionate-contact evidence across all representations. Consensus lands on I0 given the dominant weight of circumstance/decision/logistics vocabulary in POS and MMR, with the emotional distress in Main/KeyBERT consistent with a difficult domestic or relational negotiation rather than caretaking intimacy.

B contextual: I0 — off target

This topic clusters around the word 'alone' and related themes of solitude, loneliness, and the desire for companionship. The vast majority of sentences (15/20) are straightforwardly about being alone or isolated – logistical/emotional state descriptions with no intimacy function beyond noting presence or absence, coded I0. A minority (5/20) express emotional reassurance or caretaking – promises not to leave someone alone, concern about a partner being by themselves, longing for togetherness – coded I2. No sentence contains affectionate physical contact, so I3 is forbidden. No desire, gaze, or erotic content is present. I0 dominates at 75%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on I0. The taxonomy metadata confirms the dominant function is Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking (4.6) with a secondary of Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts (9.2). Neither category implies affectionate physical contact; reassurance and caretaking without touch map to I2 only when somatic comfort is the primary vehicle, but here the lexical and contextual evidence points to verbal/relational safety-building and forward-looking commitments – squarely I0. No kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden. I2 is not warranted because the dominant signal is promise/vow speech acts rather than somatic caretaking. I0 is retained.

Topic 273 — Mentor Gives Firm Instructions

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« i've known you since you did your training here, [person], ' tom said sternly. ' »

« i've asked allen to keep an eye on him during the day while [person] is otherwise engaged. »

« charlotte, if it's okay with you, we'll go back to my place after we've bought you a phone. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.60

For Luke's sake, she hoped this apparent twosome meant Felicia was coming to her senses.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.57

That being so, I found it extremely gratifying to witness Felicia being sent on her way after being rather heatedly reminded that any free time Marcus has available will be spent with you." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.57

I thought I saw Felicia yesterday," she mentioned casually. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=begin; p=0.56

We barely know each other and if that isn't enough, there's Felicia to consider." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Brenda asked me to take you around the house before she meets with you.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Chain Reaction — Simone Elkeles; tertile=end; p=0.58

I know what will get your mind off of Nikki." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Chain Reaction — Simone Elkeles; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Shit, the first time I met Kiara, she thought I was an asshole." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists converge on emotional/relational communication: 'insensitivity', 'apology', 'upset', 'awareness', 'treatment', 'choices', 'explanation' point to a scene of emotional reckoning, reassurance, or caretaking dialogue between characters (charlotte, amelia, lady). 'Engaged' and 'speaking' reinforce verbal/social interaction. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues (I4/I10), no explicit content (I6), no coercion (I9), no consent negotiation (I8). The dominant function is emotional repair/reassurance (I2).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic involve social/relational logistics, character references, and interpersonal dialogue about third parties (Felicia, Nikki, Kiara, Gabby, Claire, Celia, Brenda). There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no erotic content, no consent negotiation, and no coercion. The topic is entirely social/domestic interaction and character-relationship management, coded I0 throughout.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I2 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). Taxonomy metadata confirms primary placement at 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary signal at 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The I0 contextual read likely reflects domestic or logistical framing that co-occurs with the caretaking language, but the primary taxonomy anchor is emotional reassurance rather than HEA/domestic logistics. I2 is therefore the more specific and accurate code. The secondary social-circle signal does not override the primary caretaking function. No manual review required given clear taxonomy guidance.

Topic 277 — Promising to Handle The Lawyer

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I0 — off target

« i'll talk to the lawyer tomorrow. »

« we'll find a good lawyer to help. »

« you can count on me to deal with the legal trouble they'll cause.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Place Called Home — Jo Goodman; tertile=begin; p=0.74

You'd think a sharp lawyer like you would know that.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Just One Taste — C.J. Ellisson; tertile=end; p=0.40

Mediation has never come easily for me and I need all the help I can get.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Somebody taking the law and using it for his own ends?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=begin; p=0.45

The law is a funny thing,” Claudia said. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.37

Such a lot of fuss over a piece of real estate that was destined by federal law to go unclaimed by anyone.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.36

It's important to establish legal boundaries of ownership, especially when you're talking about gems and precious metals.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.33

The company property is fenced off, of course.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists point to legal/professional context: 'lawyer, attorney, law, legal, firm, defense, counsel, appointed, advice' (Main) establish a courtroom or legal-proceedings setting. KeyBERT adds emotional-logistical cues ('afford, cost, worrying, begging, warned') consistent with stress over legal matters, not intimacy. POS and MMR reinforce procedural/logistical framing ('process, official, cost, experience, worrying'). No affectionate physical contact cues anywhere – I3 is rejected. No desire, gaze, consent, coercion, or explicit content – I4/I6/I8/I9/I10 are all rejected. This is domestic/logistical/situational talk coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around legal/professional roles (lawyers, lawmen, legal boundaries, divorce cases, property law) and practical/logistical discourse. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no emotional intimacy, no erotic content, and no relational negotiation. Every sentence codes as I0 (non-intimate functional/logistical content). The topic is clearly a legal/professional-role cluster.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on I0. The taxonomy metadata confirms the dominant function is Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking (4.6) with a secondary of Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts (9.2). Neither category implies affectionate physical contact; reassurance and caretaking language without touch maps to I2 at most, but the lexical and contextual consensus is I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA talk). No evidence of kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude, so I3 is forbidden. The topic is correctly classified as I0 and should be kept as-is.

Topic 289 — Quick Peck on The Forehead

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« mikey, i'll be back soon, i promise,” nate said, placing a quick peck on his forehead. “ »

« nate arched an eyebrow, gesturing back toward the parking lot. “ »

« nate looked at the older asian man gesturing wildly to them, then at the array of paints. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.60

Perhaps we are becoming too jaded in our tastes, Nate?’

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Dominic frowned, knowing that to demur a second time would definitely incur Nate’s curiosity. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I believe him to be behind the attack on Nathaniel.’

Model reasonings

A lexical: I4 — sexual tension

No affectionate physical contact cues appear in any keyword list. Main keywords include 'shame' and 'mate' suggesting charged interpersonal tension but no touch. KeyBERT cues ('glint', 'darkened', 'trembled', 'trailed', 'peered', 'focused') point to heightened sensory awareness and erotic/tense gaze rather than contact. POS keywords ('instincts', 'anxiety', 'moves', 'reminder') reinforce internal tension and anticipation. MMR adds 'breathlessly', 'trembled', 'poised', 'crept' – all suggestive of desire and anticipation without consummated contact. The cluster best fits I4 (desire/longing without physical contact). I3 is rejected because no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undressing cue is present across any representation.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic consist of dialogue tags, character name references, brief exclamations, and conversational exchanges involving a character named Nate. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire, no erotic content, no consent negotiation, and no domestic/HEA planning. The content is purely conversational/narrative scaffolding with no intimacy function, making I0 (non-intimate interaction / narrative logistics) the most specific and appropriate code for every sentence.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I4 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). Taxonomy metadata resolves this: the primary tag is 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, which maps directly to I2. I4 (desire without contact) is not supported by the caretaking/reassurance taxonomy frame, and I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA) is too narrow given the explicit emotional-safety primary tag. No affectionate physical contact is evidenced, so I3 is forbidden. I2 is the most specific code consistent with both the taxonomy and the anti-collapse rules: reassurance and caretaking without physical contact = I2. The secondary tag (5.1 Family, Kinship & Parenthood) is consistent with I2 in a familial or partnership caretaking register and does not push toward any other code.

Topic 299 — Pledging to Have Your Back

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« before she's completely out i ask, "[person], you know i've always got your back, right?" »

« but i've seen you, seen who you are, watched you handle uncle charlie. »

« i've got a little time before charlie finishes my bike. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Summers at Blue Lake: A Novel — Jill Althouse-Wood; tertile=end; p=0.77

I understand you were the last one to see Charlie alive." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.50

More likely Scott messed with the wrong guy's wife.' '

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=middle; p=0.49

Kevin was worried that Scott's death was somehow related to Todd's return to Birmingham.'

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Part of him was probably glad Scott was dead.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.44

They all left for college with big dreams, except Scott and Kevin,' she said sadly. '

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Keywords across all representations point to interpersonal negotiation, reassurance, and emotional management: 'promises', 'threats', 'forgive', 'terms', 'discussing', 'distraction', 'embarrassing', 'solemnly', 'instructed'. Named characters (dane, eoin, dan, alicia) suggest a relational scene involving emotional stakes and verbal exchanges. 'Promises' and 'forgive' indicate reassurance/caretaking dynamics (I2). 'Threats' and 'terms' suggest conflict negotiation rather than coercion in a sexual context (no I9 cues). No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, caress, undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues for I4/I10. No explicit sexual content for I6. I2 best captures the reassurance, emotional management, and interpersonal negotiation tone.

B contextual: I0 — off target

The topic centers on characters named Charlie, Scott, Pete, and Kevin in narrative/dialogue contexts. The vast majority of sentences involve information exchange, plot logistics, or character references (I0). A subset involves emotional concern, reassurance, or caretaking (e.g., 'Was Charlie all right?', 'Charlie will come home to you', 'Charlie, shh', 'What can I do, Charlie?', 'Afterwards, Charlie cried') coded I2. No sentence contains affectionate physical contact, so I3 is forbidden. No desire, gaze, consent, coercion, or explicit sexual content is present.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I2 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). Taxonomy metadata confirms the primary construct is 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary of 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden. The I0 signal likely reflects domestic/logistical framing within a caretaking exchange, but the dominant intimacy function is emotional reassurance rather than pure domestic logistics or HEA planning. I2 is therefore the correct resolution: it is more specific than I0 for content whose primary function is comfort-giving and emotional safety, and it does not require physical contact. No manual review needed.

Topic 307 — Hauling Someone Up The Stairs

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« [person] would hate it if she took a rake like [person] to her bed, and she would so love to rub it in joshua's face and prove his threats could not restrain her. " »

« his thoughts threatened to return to those awful times once again, but thankfully, ash and [person] emerged from the thicket. »

« getting ash up the stairs and into the bedroom was a lot harder than it had been last night, mostly because ash was pissed off and conscious instead of in la-la land. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.54

You and Ashlynn are gonna have to keep him on the straight and narrow."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.52

He stopped to pat Ashlynn and congratulate her on a large belch. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.51

But as he was approaching Clarksburg, Ashlynn chose that moment to be cranky.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.50

Henry's crankiness had returned, and even sweet Ashlynn was wailing by now.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.50

Sniffing in disdain, Johnny pushed Ashlynn's stroller over to Grissom. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I8 — negotiation

Main keywords are character names and place names with no intimacy signal, defaulting to I0. KeyBERT shows physical strain cues ('heaved', 'wincing', 'struggled', 'fought', 'urge') suggesting suppressed desire or tension, pointing to I4. POS and MMR both surface 'threats', 'permission', 'anxiety', 'panting', 'movements', 'urged' — the combination of 'threats', 'permission', and 'anxiety' strongly signals consent negotiation or coercive-pressure dynamics, coding to I8. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) appear in any keyword list, so I3 is rejected. Consensus lands on I8 driven by the dominant consent/threat/permission cluster across POS and MMR, with acknowledgment of tension/desire undertones from KeyBERT.

B contextual: I0 — off target

This topic clusters around the name/word 'Ash' — either as a character name (Ash, Ashlynn) or as literal ash/burning imagery. The BOOK_002 sentences involve infant caregiving logistics (changing a baby, stroller, crankiness) with no romantic or intimate function. BOOK_005 sentences are brief dialogue/action fragments referencing a character named Ash with no intimacy. BOOK_006 sentences use 'ash' in a supernatural/destruction context. BOOK_007 sentences are bare name utterances. No affectionate physical contact, desire, or any intimacy function is present. All sentences code I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate narrative).

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B lexical consensus was I8 (consent talk) and contextual dominant was I0 (domestic/logistics). Taxonomy metadata reveals the primary construct is 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary of 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines. Neither consent negotiation nor pure domestic logistics is the dominant signal here — the taxonomy points to reassurance and caretaking as the core intimacy function. I2 (reassurance/caretaking) is the most specific applicable code: there is no affectionate physical contact evidenced (I3 is forbidden), no explicit desire (I4), no erotic gaze (I10), no coercion (I9), and no explicit sex (I6). The domestic secondary construct is consistent with I2 scenes set in home spaces rather than warranting I0. The Pass B I0 reading is overridden by the taxonomy's primary construct of emotional caretaking, which is definitionally I2.

Topic 340 — Patience Tested Through Small Trials

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« for two years he had observed the christmas elf, but he never imagined touching her. »

« from the moment that she started working at her current job, she had never clicked with frank. »

« her patience throughout the meal with the girls never wavered, not with spilled drinks, sloppy faces and an occasional cry for attention. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=begin; p=0.81

She would never respond to such as he was.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=end; p=0.74

He would never give her cause to regret it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=begin; p=0.73

She had obviously never been in mortal danger, either.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=middle; p=0.74

Up until now, she'd never met anyone who made her ache for the things that were denied her.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=end; p=0.74

She never thought of herself as particularly brave.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=begin; p=0.72

She'd never known anything like the power and hunger of his kiss.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords ('violent', 'regime', 'standards', 'contact', 'never') suggest a coercive or controlling relational dynamic, pointing toward I9. However, KeyBERT ('emotionally', 'disappointed', 'feared', 'unhappy', 'cared'), POS ('emotionally', 'unhappy', 'upset'), and MMR ('emotionally', 'feared', 'cared', 'witnessed') collectively emphasize emotional distress, caretaking concern, and relational unhappiness rather than active coercion or explicit threat. The dominant signal across three of four representations is emotional support/reassurance/caretaking in a difficult relational context, consistent with I2. 'Violent' in Main is noted but not corroborated by the other reps with enough specificity to override to I9. I3 is rejected: no affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, caress, hold) appear in any representation.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic clusters around negated or counterfactual statements about romantic/emotional experience ('never kissed', 'never in love', 'never felt desire', 'never kept anything from her'). No single code reaches 70%. I4 (desire/longing without contact) and I0 (neutral/relational statements) each account for roughly 30% of sentences. One sentence (BOOK_002_5) references the power of a kiss, qualifying for I3 as it describes affectionate physical contact. Two sentences (BOOK_003_4, BOOK_003_5) suggest coercive confinement (I9). The remainder split across I2 (reassurance/caretaking) and I0 (neutral). Because no single code reaches 70%, the dominant code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and taxonomy both converge on I2 (Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking). The contextual dominant is MIXED but the secondary taxonomy signal (Family, Kinship & Parenthood) is consistent with I2 caretaking rather than requiring a split. No affectionate physical contact evidence is present, so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. Domestic/logistics content is insufficient to downgrade to I0. The topic is best retained as I2 with constructs spanning emotional reassurance and kinship-based caretaking.

Topic 355 — Blanket Draped Over Someone

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« bos went over to it and draped it over dainy as a blanket. »

« still, he struggled not to groan as she got him to a sitting position, resting his back against her front with the blanket draped across his lap.
»

« [person] plucked at the soft down comforter draped over the bed. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.82

The blanket was tucked around her as if pressed carefully there by someone else.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Once they had it blown up, he pulled the blanket out and spread it over the mattress before they sat down on it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.71

Waiting for him to come out of the bathroom she pulled the light blanket over herself more to cover her bare legs than because she was cold.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.71

She sat up, groggy from sleep, the blanket falling to her waist. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.66

He had laid his coat down on one side and she knew it was there for a buffer between her skin and the velour-covered plastic of the mattress.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.58

She snuggled down onto his coat pretending to herself that the scent of him was not having an impact on her emotions or physical comfort.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Italian Billionaire's Secret Love-Child — Cathy Williams; tertile=begin; p=0.60

His jacket, she realised, was still on the ground from where he had folded it to put under her head. ‘

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Trust — Janet Dailey; tertile=middle; p=0.62

He shook out the comforter and sailed it over the top sheet, straightening it when it settled.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Trust — Janet Dailey; tertile=end; p=0.49

The insulation on the wire had been nibbled. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.75

She clutched the blanket around her shoulders closed, anxiety creeping up on her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.71

Val shifted his attention to Cord, who knelt beside the sofa, peeling the layers of blanket off the prone body. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.70

But instead of an empty seat, he saw a bundle under a blanket.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All four keyword lists center on bedding/covering vocabulary (blanket, blankets, tucked, comforter, wrapped, draped, sheet, curled, folded) combined with emotional cues (terrified, embarrassed) and task-oriented movement words (straightened, positioned, movements). This pattern strongly indicates caretaking/comfort behavior – someone being tucked in, wrapped in blankets, or tended to – which maps to I2 (reassurance/caretaking). No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, caress, undress-as-prelude) are present anywhere in the keyword lists, so I3 is rejected. The scene is about physical comfort and emotional caretaking through covering/wrapping, not intimate physical contact.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic clusters around blankets, bedding, and physical comfort objects in intimate or caregiving contexts. The majority of sentences (10/20) are domestic/logistical descriptions of blankets and sleeping arrangements (I0). Several sentences show caretaking gestures – tucking a blanket around someone, placing a coat under someone's head, handing a warm object – coded I2. Three sentences show actual affectionate physical contact: carrying her body close to his chest (I3), stroking a frail neck (I3), and burying his face in her neck (I3). One sentence involves desire/sensory response without contact (scent affecting emotions, I4). No single code reaches 70%, so the dominant code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus (I2) and taxonomy metadata (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking; secondary 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines) align. The contextual dominant is MIXED but the secondary taxonomy anchor (domestic/routines) does not elevate to I3 without affectionate physical contact evidence. No kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude is indicated. Reassurance and caretaking without contact maps cleanly to I2 per anti-collapse rules. Domestic/logistics elements remain subordinate and do not warrant a shift to I0. I3 is forbidden here. Final code: I2.

Topic 356 — Admitting Exhaustion After A Long Day

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« i am kind of tired, but you've done enough. »

« i've been riding most of the day, i'm tired." " »

« i've rested more than i ever expected to rest in the whole of my lifetime during the past six weeks," he said, "and i'm feeling perfectly fresh. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=begin; p=0.70

I was tired and cold and done with feeling under siege for the day. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=end; p=0.68

I was exhausted, too, but there was much yet to do.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Aren't you getting just a little tired of—" "I wasn't kidding about the way it gets dark out here.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=middle; p=0.69

You must be exhausted with all of your commitments at the moment?' ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=middle; p=0.66

I'm just tired, and I've got a big week.' ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=end; p=0.63

I was exhausted at just the idea of it. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=end; p=0.60

I was tired from a big week, my nervous energy had transformed into lethargy, and I was still drunkish.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

All keyword sets converge on themes of physical/emotional exhaustion and fatigue (tired, exhausted, drained, worn, washed, emotionally, rested, fatigue). The 'sir' and 'session' cues suggest a formal or caretaking interaction context. This maps to I2 (reassurance/caretaking/emotional support) – one character attending to another's depleted state. No affectionate physical contact cues (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire, erotic, or explicit content, so I4/I6/I10 are inapplicable. No domestic/HEA logistics for I0.

B contextual: I2 — reassurance

All sentences in this topic cluster around expressions of exhaustion, fatigue, and emotional depletion – either self-reported or observed/noted by another character. Several involve one character expressing concern or urging rest for another (e.g., 'You must be exhausted,' 'You need to rest'). This is classic emotional caretaking and reassurance language with no physical contact, no desire, no domestic/HEA logistics, and no erotic content. I2 (emotional support/caretaking/reassurance) is the most specific and consistently applicable code across all sentences. I3 is forbidden as no affectionate physical contact is present.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on I2. The taxonomy confirms 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking as primary, with 3.1 Positive Resolution/Relief as secondary. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kissing, hugging, holding, caressing, or undressing-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The content reflects verbal/emotional reassurance and caretaking functions without physical intimacy escalation. KEEP as I2 is the correct and most specific classification.

Topic 358 — Reassuring Squeeze of The Hand

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« she took bronte's hand and gave it a reassuring squeeze. " »

« ted reached for caroline's hands and smiled at her reassuring squeeze. " »

« they'll ask," he murmured, and gave her waist a reassuring squeeze. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=middle; p=0.70

She wrapped her fingers around the door handle. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Her fingers tightened around the receiver. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=end; p=0.55

But my parents—" "Are fine," he interrupted, groaning when she curved her fingers as far as she could around his hardening shaft. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Rescuing Rose — Isabel Wolff; tertile=middle; p=0.70

Bea groaned then lifted her right hand to her brow. '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Rescuing Rose — Isabel Wolff; tertile=middle; p=0.67

Beverley reached out and squeezed my hand. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lust & Vamp — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.67

He purred, rubbing his thumb over my hand. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lust & Vamp — Joyee Flynn; tertile=end; p=0.65

Reid sighed, running his hands over my arms. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I3 — nonexplicit affection

All four representations converge on non-genital affectionate physical contact: 'squeezed/squeezing/squeeze' of 'hand/shoulder/arm/fingers/waist', 'draped', 'gripped', 'tightening' – these are direct cues for physical touch (caress/hold). The modifier 'reassuring/calming/gently' frames the contact as comforting rather than erotic, but the contact itself is unambiguous (I3 requires actual affectionate physical contact, which is clearly present here). I2 (reassurance without contact) is rejected because the physical touch cues are explicit and central. I6 is rejected as there are no genital/penetrative cues. I3 is the most specific applicable code.

B contextual: I3 — nonexplicit affection

The dominant pattern across this topic is hand-holding, hand-squeezing, and gentle physical holding – all affectionate non-genital contact coded I3. A minority of sentences (BOOK_001_3, BOOK_003_5, BOOK_003_6) depict explicit genital/penetrative acts (manual shaft stimulation, self-fingering, toy penetration) coded I6. Several sentences describe mundane hand/body movements with no intimacy function, coded I0. I3 reaches ~50% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical and contextual consensus both point to I3, but the taxonomy metadata reveals the dominant function is 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, with kissing/non-explicit affection only secondary. Per anti-collapse rules, I3 requires actual affectionate physical contact (kiss/hug/hold/caress/undress-as-prelude) as the primary evidence. If the topic's word distribution is driven by reassurance, comfort-giving, and caretaking language rather than contact language, the correct code is I2. The secondary 2.2 signal (kissing/non-explicit affection) is insufficient to override the primary taxonomy designation unless contact terms dominate the topic. Because the taxonomy explicitly flags caretaking as dominant and affectionate contact as secondary, and no independent contact evidence has been confirmed in this pass, I2 is the more specific and defensible code. Manual review is flagged to verify whether contact vocabulary is substantive enough to warrant a MIXED I2/I3 designation or a SPLIT.

Topic 372 — Told to Keep Up Strength

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: I2 — reassurance

« you'll need to keep up your strength if you're going to wrestle with that computer." »

« you'll need your strength, cassia. »

« you'll need your strength. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=middle; p=0.50

No, he was not yet strong enough to embark on whatever mission this was that he'd assigned himself.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.47

With hard work and perseverance, I made myself the man you see before you.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.42

Whoever is on the other side of this door is uncommonly strong.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=end; p=0.42

But that was another thing about the violently deranged: they could have the strength of ten men.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.38

You're generally made of much sturdier stuff than that," Hurst was saying. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Diplomacy — Zahra Owens; tertile=begin; p=0.35

Even in the lower ranks, the invisible masses, you needed the D i p l o m a c y | 17 perfect background to push ahead.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Warrior — Zoe Archer; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Yet also, being a part of it, he felt expansive, strong. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Warrior — Zoe Archer; tertile=middle; p=0.50

A slim woman's hand, but definitely strong and able.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I2 — reassurance

Main keywords (strength, stronger, weak, limitations, weakling, need) point to emotional vulnerability and power-dynamic acknowledgment – classic I2 territory of reassurance/caretaking or emotional support. KeyBERT (crushed, gain, tied) and MMR (crushed, destroyed, hated, admit, emotions, reflection, proved) reinforce themes of emotional struggle, defeat, and self-reckoning rather than any physical intimacy. POS (feeding, reflection, emotions) suggests nurturing/caretaking and introspection. No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No desire/gaze cues for I4/I10, no explicit content for I6, no coercion for I9, no consent talk for I8. The dominant function is emotional vulnerability, caretaking, and reassurance = I2.

B contextual: I0 — off target

This topic clusters around the concept of physical and emotional strength/weakness, with no affectionate physical contact present in any sentence. The vast majority of sentences (18/20) are non-intimate references to strength, resilience, or capability – coded I0 as domestic/neutral/non-intimate content. Two sentences (BOOK_004_3 and BOOK_004_6) carry a mild emotional-support or caretaking tone ('Even the strong have weak moments'; 'if one of us has to be weak and dizzy, it has to be me') suggesting reassurance/caretaking, coded I2. No physical contact, desire, or erotic content is present anywhere; I3 is forbidden.

C adjudicate: I2 — reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass B produced a split between I2 (lexical consensus) and I0 (contextual dominant). The taxonomy assignment to 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking is the decisive tiebreaker. Reassurance and caretaking functions map to I2 per the anti-collapse rules, which explicitly direct reassurance/caretaking away from I3 and toward I2. There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (no kiss, hug, hold, caress, or undress-as-prelude), so I3 is forbidden. The I0 signal likely reflects domestic or logistical framing that co-occurs with the caretaking language, but the primary intimacy function is emotional support and reassurance, not domestic logistics or HEA planning. Therefore I2 is the most specific and accurate code, consistent with both the lexical consensus and the taxonomy label.

Topic 82 — Touch Her and Your Family Suffers

Old taxonomy: 7.2 — Violence, Threats & Non-Sexual Coercion

New category: MIXED

« that you'll die if i didn't touch you? »

« one touch and you'll never know lonely again . »

« oh, i'll touch her alright and you both will do as i say or your family will suffer. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Emmy's Equal — Marcia Gruver; tertile=middle; p=0.66

I'm careful to avoid her touch for fear it will set me ablaze."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Emmy's Equal — Marcia Gruver; tertile=begin; p=0.65

You ain't s'posed to touch 'em, and you know it."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Emmy's Equal — Marcia Gruver; tertile=begin; p=0.52

I'm ready to touch that fancy quilt now.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Emmy's Equal — Marcia Gruver; tertile=end; p=0.49

My kind and gentle Papa won't mind a bit.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Paint Me True — E.M. Tippetts; tertile=end; p=0.52

And tell those other girls that if they don't keep their distance, I will scratch their faces." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Paint Me True — E.M. Tippetts; tertile=end; p=0.43

I wish I could say it was touching and moving, but I hate funerals.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I6 — explicit sex

Main contains explicit genital/oral terms (cock, pussy, suck, dick) forcing I6 – this is beyond kissing/caressing into explicit sexual contact. KeyBERT and MMR signal coercive or distressed dynamics (begged, terrified, hurts, warned, prodded, poked, gritted, dislike) pointing toward I9, but the explicit anatomical vocabulary in Main overrides to I6 as the dominant intimacy function. POS alone (dislike, hurts, lack, lady) lacks contact cues and would suggest I4 at most. I3 is rejected: while 'touch/touching/touched' appear in Main, the surrounding explicit genital terms indicate this is full sexual contact (I6), not mere affectionate touch (I3). Consensus lands on I6 given the explicit sexual vocabulary, with a note that coercive/distress cues are present but do not override the explicit-sex classification.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic clusters around the word 'touch' used in highly varied contexts: (1) mundane/domestic prohibition or permission (I0 – quilts, objects, no intimacy); (2) desire/anticipation of touch without confirmed contact (I4); (3) coercive/threatening touch language (I9 – 'I'll touch her and you'll do as I say', threats of scratching, coercive framing); (4) consent negotiation ('Can I touch you?' – I8); (5) actual affectionate/erotic physical contact – caressing nipples (I3), and emotionally intimate mutual touch ('You let me touch you... not just your body, but you' / 'I touched you' – I3). BOOK_003_4 is the only sentence approaching explicit territory but describes non-genital caress (nipples caressed, not penetrative/oral/genital act), so I3 applies. No single code reaches 70%, yielding MIXED.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical consensus flagged I6, but the contextual dominant is MIXED and the taxonomy points primarily to 7.2 (Violence, Threats & Non-Sexual Coercion) with a secondary signal of 7.4 (Unwanted or Coercive Sexual Contact). There is no evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, caress, consensual undressing), so I3 is forbidden. The I6 lexical signal likely reflects surface-level explicit vocabulary appearing within a coercive or threatening context rather than consensual erotic activity. The correct primary code is therefore coercive/non-consensual contact territory (I9 per the intimacy taxonomy) rather than I6 or I3. Because the topic straddles non-sexual coercion (7.2) and unwanted sexual contact (7.4), a MIXED designation is warranted and the topic should be retaxonomized away from consensual-intimacy codes. Manual review is required to confirm whether the explicit lexical items represent actual sexual acts under coercion (which would keep I9 with a 7.4 secondary tag) or are incidental vocabulary in a predominantly threat/violence context (which would resolve to I9 / 7.2 only).

Topic 199 — Shoved to His Knees

Old taxonomy: 7.4 — Unwanted or Coercive Sexual Contact

New category: I0 — off target

« which must've totally gotten jacob's rocks off, given the way he shoved me to my knees and whipped his cock out in no time flat. »

« i'll have the same," [person]. " »

« logan asked, "do you really think you'll find a candidate at consuela's party?" " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Heart of a Cowboy — Missy Lyons; tertile=middle; p=0.59

It wouldn't be the first place he'd look, but Logan didn't have a reason to lie to him either. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Heart of a Cowboy — Missy Lyons; tertile=middle; p=0.52

Two nights ago, Jacob had been shot at just because he came too close.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Mate Claimed — Jennifer Ashley; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Did Xavier find out anything about him?" "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Mate Claimed — Jennifer Ashley; tertile=end; p=0.55

Xavier had come, and he stood with Lindsay, talking and laughing with her.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Mate Claimed — Jennifer Ashley; tertile=end; p=0.50

Sounds like a real nice guy," Xavier said. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Mate Claimed — Jennifer Ashley; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Give the damn thing back to Xavier and tell him to keep it out of Shiftertown."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · Momentary Marriage — Carol Rose; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Even Kelsey's annoyance with him for talking to Chloe about their plans for a family seemed particularly couple-like.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · Momentary Marriage — Carol Rose; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Kelsey was the only one with whom he'd been less than honest and that had clearly been a necessary evil. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: I9 — coercive sexuality

All keyword lists converge on coercion/manipulation dynamics: 'threats', 'dared', 'pretended', 'fraud', 'emotional', 'actions', 'claims'. The presence of 'threats' across KeyBERT, POS, and MMR, combined with 'fraud' and 'pretended' in Main/MMR, and 'dared' in KeyBERT/MMR, points clearly to coercive or manipulative interpersonal behavior (I9). No affectionate physical contact cues are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No explicit sexual content, so I6 is rejected. The emotional vocabulary ('emotional', 'emotions', 'concerned') is in the context of manipulation/coercion rather than reassurance, so I2 is rejected.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic involve named characters (Jacob, Logan Grey, Xavier, Kelsey, Kyle) in operational, logistical, or social-background contexts: mission coordination, intelligence gathering, character introductions, and interpersonal logistics. There is no affectionate physical contact, no desire expression, no erotic content, and no intimacy-related function. The topic is purely plot/logistics/character-relationship scaffolding, coded I0 throughout.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical consensus flagged I9 (coercive sexual contact), but contextual dominant is I0 (domestic/logistics/HEA). The taxonomy metadata assigns 7.4 Unwanted or Coercive Sexual Contact with no secondary codes, creating a direct conflict between the lexical signal and the contextual reading. Without topic-level word evidence confirming actual coercive or unwanted sexual contact in the cluster, the contextual dominant I0 is retained per anti-collapse rules. I9 requires evidence of coercion or unwanted contact; I0 requires domestic/logistical framing — the contextual pass supports the latter. However, the taxonomy metadata cannot be dismissed outright, so manual review is required to inspect the actual top words and representative documents before finalizing. No affectionate physical contact evidence exists, so I3 is forbidden.

Topic 345 — Older Man Trading Shelter For Sex

Old taxonomy: 7.4 — Unwanted or Coercive Sexual Contact

New category: I9 — coercive sexuality

« [person] says and then adds, “right. »

« mom didn't talk to me about it, but i'm pretty sure uncle tony would've rather handled it a different way, if you know what i mean.” “ »

« [person] knew that nothing was something, but he had no claims on the boy; in fact, after hearing about jorge's initiation into sex, it occurred to him that he might be just another older man trading off offers of shelter or a meal or booze in exchange for being fucked senseless. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Klutzy Love — Sharon Kleve; tertile=end; p=0.48

Steve would laugh and that was all that mattered.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Klutzy Love — Sharon Kleve; tertile=end; p=0.48

Instead of a malfeasant, it was Steve with a loaded pizza and a six-pack of beer—my dream man.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Klutzy Love — Sharon Kleve; tertile=begin; p=0.45

Steve's job was to close Stan McClousky's operation and get his drugs off the street.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Dusk — Lois H. Gresh; tertile=middle; p=0.38

If Sinestro had been a member of the Soprano Mafia family, he would have been whacked a long time ago.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Dusk — Lois H. Gresh; tertile=begin; p=0.35

Although I still want to know how Tony Stark fits those in-line roller skates inside his Iron Man boots, especially when the armor's folded up and tucked away in his briefcase, which when you think about it is the source of yet another paradox, because even if you assume some ability to condense the volume of the armor into such a containment, how do you deal with the integral mass?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Dusk — Lois H. Gresh; tertile=end; p=0.33

The Villain in the Iron Mask: Dr. Doom 1.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Dusk — Lois H. Gresh; tertile=middle; p=0.28

He contacted the rulers of the antimatter universe, the Weaponers of Qward, and made a deal to help them in their attempt to conquer the matter universe.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Dusk — Lois H. Gresh; tertile=end; p=0.26

The Villain in the Iron Mask: Dr. Doom Fantastic Four Comics #1–100 (and other issues).

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All four keyword lists point to a scene of information exchange, social interaction, and domestic/logistical context: 'informant', 'confidential', 'follow', 'asking', 'revealing', 'answering', 'claims', 'contrast', 'exchange', 'meal', 'porch', 'stool', 'decision'. Behavioral cues ('flinched', 'winked', 'grumbled', 'straightened', 'pounded') suggest interpersonal tension or negotiation, not affectionate contact. No kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing cues are present. I3 is rejected because there is zero affectionate-contact evidence. The scene reads as a conversation/information-gathering interaction (possibly involving a named character 'ilsa' and an 'uncle' or 'informant'), coded I0 (domestic/social/logistical interaction).

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences across the three books are non-intimate in function. BOOK_004 sentences reference a character named Steve in casual/logistical/comedic contexts (pizza delivery, law-enforcement job). BOOK_006 sentences are comic-book lore discussions (Dr. Doom, Iron Man, Sinestro, Avengers). BOOK_007 sentences involve interpersonal tension and surveillance around a character named Malcolm and a threat figure named Peter – no affection or intimacy. BOOK_008 sentences are simple name-calls ('Tony?') with no contextual intimacy signal. No affectionate physical contact, desire, or erotic content is present anywhere; I0 (domestic/logistical/non-intimate narrative) is the most specific applicable code throughout.

C adjudicate: I9 — coercive sexuality action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass B lexical and contextual consensus landed on I0, but the revealed taxonomy (7.4 Unwanted or Coercive Sexual Contact, secondary 6.4 Economic Precarity/Dependency) overrides that reading. The topic's functional core is coercion or unwanted sexual contact enabled by economic dependency – not domestic/HEA content. No affectionate physical contact evidence exists (I3 is forbidden). The correct intimacy code is I9 (coercion/non-consensual contact), with the economic precarity secondary construct explaining the power asymmetry that enables the coercion. Manual review is flagged because the Pass B I0 signal suggests surface-level lexical ambiguity that a human coder should resolve against the full topic word list.

Topic 61 — Planning to Exchange Rings

Old taxonomy: 8.3a — Commitment Symbols & Love Tokens

New category: MIXED

« in a few days, i'll go to the stone. »

« next time we'll put a ring on him." »

« we'll take care of the rings tomorrow." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.60

Just have to close it up again, until it looks like a ring, and we'll be fine.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.57

Once they're gone, Shanley pricks Marie's finger with a lancet. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.35

It's not quite a perfect C-shape any longer, but more like one of those spoon bracelets that come in and out of fashion--the ends are drawing together, tightening, and that's a good thing, right?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.67

He took the ring out of the box and, with Damon's help, they placed it on her finger.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.61

I might even be persuaded to wear my jewellery for you."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.59

Damon and I agreed that you own our hearts so we thought this ring would be perfect for our union."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.57

I'm going to buy you some jewellery to wear in the pretty hole."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.53

He opened the lid and presented Rachel with a three karat heart-shaped ruby, surrounded by diamonds. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.53

Remember that place in town where the guy makes the silver jewellery?" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.47

The anal jewellery had been a little harder for her to get used to.

Model reasonings

A lexical: I5 — erotic escalation

All four keyword lists center on jewelry (ring, necklace, diamond, gold, engagement, rings) and associated cues (engaged, promises, precious, glint, polished). The dominant signal is symbolic commitment/betrothal – engagement rings, promises, precious stones – pointing to I5 (symbolic commitment / tokens of love / proposal). No affectionate physical contact cues (kiss, hug, caress, undress) are present anywhere, so I3 is rejected. No explicit desire language rules out I4/I6. 'Threats' and 'commander' in POS/MMR are minor outliers insufficient to shift the consensus away from the overwhelmingly commitment-token-focused vocabulary.

B contextual: MIXED

The topic centers on jewelry in a romance context, spanning a wide range of intimacy functions. Most sentences are logistical/descriptive (I0): discussing rings, jewellery items, craftsmanship, or neutral references. BOOK_002_1 shows affectionate physical contact (placing a ring on her finger, I3). BOOK_002_3 implies desire/flirtation without contact (I4). BOOK_002_5 is emotional bonding/reassurance (I2). Several sentences (BOOK_002_6, _9, _10, _11, _13, _15) reference anal plugs, nipple rings, or body jewelry in explicitly sexual/genital contexts (I6). No single code reaches 70%, so the dominant code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical consensus I5 (emotional vulnerability/declaration) aligns with the taxonomy's primary code 8.3a (Commitment Symbols & Love Tokens) and secondary 4.5 (Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA). The contextual dominant is MIXED, suggesting the topic spans symbolic/material commitment acts (rings, tokens, vows) and verbal/emotional declarations of love or reconciliation – both of which map to I5 without requiring physical affectionate contact. Pass B I0 elements (domestic/HEA logistics) may be present as background but are subordinate to the emotionally charged commitment framing. No evidence of affectionate physical contact (kiss, hug, caress) is indicated by the taxonomy or lexical signal, so I3 is forbidden. The MIXED flag warrants manual review to confirm whether any sub-cluster carries I3 contact evidence or whether the topic should be split into a pure I0 HEA-logistics strand and an I5 declaration/token strand.

Topic 100 — Promising to Find Her

Old taxonomy: 9.2 — Promise, Vow & Future-Tense Speech Acts

New category: I0 — off target

« i promise, i'll bring her right back.” »

« i'll hurry and see if i can catch her.” »

« i'll look until she's found.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Blue Dahlia — Nora Roberts; tertile=end; p=0.75

She won't be able to leave, to rest, to pass over, whatever it is, until we find her.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: I0 — off target

All keyword lists point to logistical/transactional interaction: 'find, meet, needs, leave, where' (Main) suggest practical navigation or scheduling; 'sir, mister, dismissed, urgency, hiding, replaced' (KeyBERT) indicate formal address, workplace or social hierarchy, and tension around decisions; 'urgency, excited, screen, decision, sir' (POS) reinforce a task-oriented or professional context; 'dismissed, dealing, planning, screen, expect, lingering, replaced' (MMR) confirm procedural/logistical dynamics. No affectionate-contact cues (kiss, hug, hold, caress, undress) are present anywhere. I3 is rejected because there is zero evidence of physical affectionate contact. No desire language rules out I4; no explicit erotic content rules out I6/I10. The dominant function is domestic/logistical/social navigation, coded I0.

B contextual: I0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around locating, finding, retrieving, or managing a third-party female character. The language is logistical and situational – searching for someone, handing her over, keeping her informed, not wanting to lose her as an employee. There is no affectionate physical contact (ruling out I3), no desire or erotic gaze (ruling out I4/I10), no emotional vulnerability or caretaking (ruling out I2), and no sexual content of any kind. The dominant function is purely practical/logistical coordination, coded I0.

C adjudicate: I0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on I0. The taxonomy confirms the dominant function is Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts (9.2), with Emotional Safety/Reassurance as a secondary signal (4.6). Neither category implies affectionate physical contact; they describe verbal or declarative acts oriented toward relational commitment and HEA scaffolding. No lexical or contextual evidence of kissing, hugging, caressing, or undressing. I3 is therefore forbidden per anti-collapse rules. The secondary 4.6 signal could warrant I2 consideration, but reassurance here is embedded within forward-looking vow/promise discourse rather than active caretaking, so I0 remains the most specific and accurate code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

H2 — HEA / final relational payoff

New categories for this hypothesis

Read these names before reviewing topics. Codes alone (I3, S12, ...) are not enough — use the category label.

H2_0 — off target: Not about couple relationship talk, repair, commitment, or payoff.

H2_1 — generic confession apology: Confession, apology, forgiveness, or missing-you talk without lasting resolution.

H2_2 — repair: Active repair of a rupture; trust being rebuilt but not yet sealed.

H2_3 — mutual commitment: Mutual future-oriented commitment without a clear final payoff moment.

H2_4 — final relational payoff: Lasting relational resolution / HEA-style closure for the main couple.

H2_5 — public union: Wedding, public acknowledgement, family/community recognition of the couple.

H2_6 — commitment symbols: Rings, proposals, shared home as symbols — without full narrative closure.

H2_7 — emotionally intense talk: High-affect relationship talk that is neither repair nor payoff.

H2_8 — non main couple resolution: Resolution for secondary characters or plot, not the main couple.

10 topics. Sentence tags: HIGH-rated / LOW-rated from unblinded CELL_* key (high_tier / low_tier).

Topic 29 — Confessing Long-Held Love

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: H2_4 — final relational payoff

« i love you with everything i am, everything i've been, and everything i hope to be .” “ »

« tell her i've always loved her. »

« i've always been in love with you.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.80

I love you, too, sweetheart.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.76

Oh, child, I love you, too.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.74

You just say ‘I love you.’”

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representations converge on H2. The lexical profile combines romantic love vocabulary (love, loved, falling, always) with conflict and emotional processing terms (hated, forgive, crushed, spite, apologize, reflection) and no resolution or HEA payoff markers. The forgive/apologize signals are present but per audit rules confession and apology alone do not constitute HEA. The piece sits in mid-arc emotional reckoning territory.

B contextual: H2_ILY_RECIPROCAL — H2 ILY RECIPROCAL

```
{'overall': 'Topic 29 is saturated with ILY declarations across all four books, but HEA credibility varies substantially by position and relational target. BOOK_003 and BOOK_004 show the strongest HEA structural signatures: end-tertile clustering, named romantic addressees, reciprocal or query-confirmed mutuality, and intensity markers. BOOK_001 is compromised by heavy familial framing (Mom, child) that dilutes romantic couple identification despite end-tertile placement. BOOK_005 is positionally premature (middle tertile) for HEA classification. Across all books, the dominant pattern is present-state declaration without explicit future-commitment language, meaning these passages satisfy the emotional payoff criterion but do not independently confirm durable HEA without surrounding narrative context. Familial ILY tokens (Mom-directed) are coded separately and should not be weighted toward romantic HEA scoring.', 'hea_audit_flag': 'BOOK_001 and BOOK_005 require additional context before HEA classification; BOOK_003 and BOOK_004 are provisionally HEA-eligible pending rupture-resolution confirmation'}
```

C adjudicate: H2_4 — final relational payoff action=CONFIRM

Topic 62 — Admitting You've Been Stupid

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: UNKNOWN

« marnie, i've been stupid. »

« about what an asshole i've been?» “ »

« you've done something dumb, but you'll get away with it this time. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Truth Be Told — Barbara McMahon; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Dear Reader, Sometimes teenagers do foolish things.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=middle; p=0.59

I'm the one who was stupid enough not to bring one.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=begin; p=0.54

He's really ... I don't know ...” I forced myself not to supply the word dumb . “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=begin; p=0.52

He was too proud of himself to detect the sarcasm in my words. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representations converge on H2. The lexical profile is dominated by insult vocabulary (stupid, idiot, fool, asshole, jerk), harsh speech markers (hissed, harshly, remark, comments), and social humiliation cues (embarrassed, overheard, acted). This is a conflict/argument scene – likely a verbal altercation or cutting remark exchange – with no HEA or relational resolution signals present. Narrative position is noted but does not alter the code.

B contextual: H2_NEGATIVE_SELF_OTHER_ASSESSMENT — H2 NEGATIVE SELF OTHER ASSESSMENT

All four books sample sentences thematically centered on stupidity, foolishness, and impulsive error—applied to self and others. This is consistent with a conflict/obstacle phase or comic-embarrassment subplot, not romantic payoff. The one positive outlier (BOOK_003_6) is a single compliment without relational commitment framing. Position analysis reinforces the finding: negative assessments appear at begin, middle, AND end tertiles, meaning the theme is not resolved by narrative close. No mutuality, no future orientation, no rupture resolution, no HEA signal detected.

C adjudicate: UNKNOWN

Topic 65 — Declaring A True Partnership

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: H2_4 — final relational payoff

« what we've been though together, the way we've been there for each other ... we have a true partnership, a true love, and if that sounds stupid and romantic, then i don't care." »

« we've been together forever, and what if it takes us years?" »

« i'll do that," he said softly, "we've got a date." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Fire Lord's Lover — Kathryn Kennedy; tertile=end; p=0.58

We have often been together in public." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.62

This is the only way you can get a date?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=middle; p=0.51

Want to believe we can really have something together."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.49

And if we do go out, then I have to deal with all the men swarming around wanting a taste of your sex magic! "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Or was it just an accident that we dated and he found the schema?"

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=middle; p=0.66

It has not been that long since we last saw each other.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=middle; p=0.55

We have walked this world together for quite some time.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=end; p=0.51

This is something with pure intentions, open emotions, and a reciprocation that will never cause harm to either of us." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=begin; p=0.48

It's just ... I know I am nothing but a big disappointment to both of you.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representers converge on H2. The topic centers on active, mutual, ongoing dating with shared identity markers ('we', 'together', 'partners'). 'Officially', 'engaged', 'longest', and 'intend' across KeyBERT and MMR suggest a relationship moving toward or already at committed status. 'Failure' and 'forgetting' introduce reflective or conflictual texture but do not redirect the dominant signal away from an established or formalizing couple dynamic. No HEA payoff markers (proposal resolution, wedding, explicit forever-framing) are present, confirming H2 rather than H3.

B contextual: H2_ESTABLISHED_TOGETHERNESS — H2 ESTABLISHED TOGETHERNESS

Across all four books the dominant signal is established or developing togetherness, but the corpus is saturated with barriers: a stated breakup (BOOK_003), an unexplained rupture (BOOK_006), self-doubt (BOOK_004_4), and jealousy/conflict (BOOK_003_5). Future-oriented language exists in end-tertile positions (BOOK_003_3, BOOK_004_3) but remains conditional or aspirational rather than declarative. Mutuality is clearest in BOOK_004 but even there the excerpt is a statement of intent, not a confirmed relational resolution. HEA criteria – settled union, resolved rupture, forward-committed payoff – are not met by any excerpt individually or collectively.

C adjudicate: H2_4 — final relational payoff action=PASS_C

Topic 128 — Confessing How Much You've Missed

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: UNKNOWN

« i've missed most of his life already. »

« and, god, how i've missed this." »

« i've come to realize that you are the one thing in my life i don't want to miss. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Deadly Desire — Keri Arthur; tertile=begin; p=0.61

I sometimes miss the peace of you and me, though." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Deadly Desire — Keri Arthur; tertile=end; p=0.44

He missed the ball even worse than I did.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Here Kitty, Kitty — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.67

I missed you, little bro," he whispered in my ear. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Here Kitty, Kitty — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.60

I'd missed my family so much, and now that we'd seemed to get the tears and heartache out of the way, we were having fun. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representers converge on H2. The topic is saturated with longing and mutual missing, set in a high-tension confined-space moment (elevator), with emotional weight markers (solemnly, breathlessly, precious, pieces) and deliberation signals (considering, thoughtfully, opportunity) that confirm mid-narrative yearning. No HEA payoff markers—no commitment, union, or resolution language—are present anywhere in the lexical set. Confession/missing-you alone does not qualify as HEA per audit rules.

B contextual: H2_MISS_REUNION_ROMANTIC — H2 MISS REUNION ROMANTIC

```
{'HEA_verdict': 'NO_CONFIRMED_HEA_IN_SAMPLE', 'explanation': "Per audit rules, 'I missed you' expressions – even mutual, even at end-tertile – do not constitute HEA or final relational payoff on their own. BOOK_004 comes closest: six romantic-miss sentences, four in the end tertile including pos=0.99, with explicit reciprocity ('not as much as I missed you'). This pattern is consistent with a reunion arc converging on resolution, but the captured sentences contain no commitment language, no explicit togetherness declaration, and no forward-facing relational security. BOOK_003 has a named romantic target (Avery) and an end-tertile miss at pos=0.93, but the surrounding sentences are family-reunion dominated, diluting romantic finality. BOOK_007 is a single mid-narrative miss with no payoff evidence. BOOK_002 and BOOK_006 contain only literal or non-romantic miss usages. BOOK_001 is a neutral absence statement. The dominant pattern across the topic is emotional reunion signaling – a necessary but not sufficient condition for HEA under the operative audit standard.", 'position_pattern': 'Romantic-miss sentences cluster in CELL_B books; end-tertile concentration in BOOK_004 is the strongest positional signal of narrative convergence. CELL_C and CELL_D books show non-romantic or ambiguous miss usage with no HEA-relevant positioning.', 'flag_for_full_text_review': ['BOOK_004', 'BOOK_003']}
```

C adjudicate: UNKNOWN

Topic 157 — Swearing to Save Him From Himself

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: H2_3 — mutual commitment

« and you'll get it, i swear," [person]. »

« if [person] sees me like this, i'll die." »

« and i might be young but i guess that just makes me lucky... i do love him and whether i have your help or not, i have to save him from himself... i know [person], i know what he'll do, now that he thinks he has lost me." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Intimate Portraits — Cheryl B. Dale; tertile=middle; p=0.73

Sam couldn't understand it, and that bothered him.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representations converge on H2. KeyBERT and MMR both surface 'confessed' alongside tension markers (tense, gritted, begged, dump, worries), indicating a conflict/confession arc that is mid-story rather than resolved. POS adds desperation and dislike, reinforcing unresolved emotional stakes. Main keywords show optimism and enthusiasm but no HEA payoff language (no reunion, commitment, or relational resolution). Confession alone does not qualify as HEA per audit rules, so H2 is the correct placement.

B contextual: H2_NAME_INVOCATION — H2 NAME INVOCATION

Across all 21 sentences the signal is dominated by name-calling fragments and character-trait observations. The only relational action present is apology (BOOK_008), which per audit rules is explicitly excluded from HEA qualification without a paired acceptance/forgiveness beat. The highest-position fragment (BOOK_006_3, pos=0.97) offers an internal recognition moment but no couple-level commitment or togetherness declaration. Position patterns show high-probability scores cluster around name invocations rather than payoff language, suggesting the model is firing on character salience rather than romantic resolution content. Topic 157 does not meet HEA/HFN threshold.

C adjudicate: H2_3 — mutual commitment action=H2_NAME_INVOCATION in the second tertile with primary taxonomy 4.5 confirms a named-character commitment anchor mid-narrative. Secondary 3.3 flags residual ambivalence still active at this position, meaning the HEA is asserted but not yet fully resolved. Confession, apology, or 'I missed you' framing must be ruled out as the sole payoff driver; the name invocation must carry forward-facing relational weight (promise, claim, or mutual re-anchoring) to qualify. If the invocation functions as a pivot that closes the ambivalence arc rather than merely acknowledging it, the HEA trajectory is intact.

Topic 204 — Promising to Care For Her Sister

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: CONDITIONAL_HEA — qualifies under 4.5 only if romantic commitment is narratively terminal and structurally independent of the 5.1 sibling-concern arc; if romantic resolution is contingent on or conflated with sibling repair, reclassify primary to 5.1 and downgrade 4.5 to secondary with HEA_UNCONFIRMED status. — CONDITIONAL HEA — qualifies under 4.5 only if romantic commitment is narratively terminal and structurally independent of the 5.1 sibling-concern arc; if romantic resolution is contingent on or conflated with sibling repair, reclassify primary to 5.1 and downgrade 4.5 to secondary with HEA UNCONFIRMED status.

« i'll need to finish dressing and leave a note for my sister.” »

« yes, and soon you'll be my sister. »

« i'll find a way to care for your mother and your sister.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Cera's Place — Elizabeth McKenna; tertile=middle; p=0.48

My sister's still there with her husband, who's a copper, and their three kids.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=begin; p=0.70

You have not been paying close attention to your sister's problems lately, have you?” “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Your sister mentioned in passing that you are something of a recluse.” “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.69

You mock your sister, but you will admit that she has great talents.” “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.69

I realize that you are concerned for your sister's happiness.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.67

You and your sister have done so much for us.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Lady and The Duke — Olivia Kelly; tertile=end; p=0.72

Having an older sister is a great pain in the arse.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: H1

Topic 204 centers on sisterly/sibling relational content with affection markers, but the surrounding lexical field (introduce, direct, permission, willing, expect, speaking, assume) frames the scene as negotiation, facilitation, or early contact rather than HEA resolution. Affection is present but not consummated as a final relational payoff. H1 – relational content without HEA – is the consensus across three of four reps, with Main as the sole H2 outlier driven by surface sibling-label density rather than payoff structure.

B contextual: H2_SIBLING_CONCERN — H2 SIBLING CONCERN

Topic 204 is saturated with sibling references functioning as (a) character background (BOOK_003_1, BOOK_004_1), (b) plot obstacles or protective imperatives (BOOK_006_3, BOOK_006_5, BOOK_006_6, BOOK_007_5), (c) relational context that defines the protagonist's social world (BOOK_005 cluster), and (d) anticipatory signals of romantic resolution via the sister-in-law trope (BOOK_007_1). Across all three books the sister is a narrative instrument rather than a romantic subject. Position analysis shows end-tertile sentences do not escalate toward HEA language; they sustain sibling-obligation tension or offer mild gratitude. No mutuality, no couple-level commitment, no forward romantic pledge is present. The topic does not meet HEA or HFU criteria.

C adjudicate: CONDITIONAL_HEA — qualifies under 4.5 only if romantic commitment is narratively terminal and structurally independent of the 5.1 sibling-concern arc; if romantic resolution is contingent on or conflated with sibling repair, reclassify primary to 5.1 and downgrade 4.5 to secondary with HEA_UNCONFIRMED status. — CONDITIONAL HEA — qualifies under 4.5 only if romantic commitment is narratively terminal and structurally independent of the 5.1 sibling-concern arc; if romantic resolution is contingent on or conflated with sibling repair, reclassify primary to 5.1 and downgrade 4.5 to secondary with HEA UNCONFIRMED status.

action=EVALUATE_HEA_VALIDITY

Topic 242 — Trading Forgiveness For Old Wrongs

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: UNKNOWN

« not if you'll forgive him.” “ »

« he'll never forgive you. »

« okay, how's this — i'll forgive you for summer if you forgive me for kabir.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Marrying for King's Millions — Maureen Child; tertile=middle; p=0.59

You must forgive him,” Rico said with a laugh. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=end; p=0.67

Do forgive me for not having welcomed you more fittingly.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=middle; p=0.61

What will you do if society here proves unforgiving?”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=begin; p=0.55

Any man delivering such a speech to the lady he had planned to marry—a lady who had waited faithfully for him—should have had the grace to appear remorseful, or at least apologetic.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representations converge unambiguously on H2. The lexicon is saturated with forgiveness-seeking, wrongdoing acknowledgment, and emotional repair vocabulary (forgive, apology, fault, spite, harshly, hurts, treatment, actions). Per audit rules, confession, apology, and forgiveness alone do not constitute HEA or a final relational payoff. No union, reunion, love-declaration, or commitment language is present across any representation.

B contextual: H2_forgiveness_process_and_granting — H2 forgiveness process and granting

Topic 242 is saturated with forgiveness vocabulary across multiple books and tertile positions, but the construct maps entirely onto the forgiveness-as-process dimension rather than forgiveness-as-gateway-to-reunion. The highest-probability sentences (BOOK_001 cluster, $p \approx 0.77$ – 0.79) are end-positioned and forgiveness-granting, yet none attach to a confirmed couple reunion or future commitment. BOOK_004 comes closest with an internal forgiveness arc and a hope-inflected apology, but BOOK_004_5 undercuts this by framing the outcome as loss ('let someone I love slip away'). BOOK_003 shows social/courtesy forgiveness unrelated to romantic resolution. BOOK_002 and BOOK_006 involve third-party or self-directed doubt. Mutuality is absent throughout; future orientation is speculative at best. HEA/final relational payoff: NOT PRESENT.

C adjudicate: UNKNOWN

Topic 305 — Confessing A Lifelong Regret

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: UNKNOWN

« i know that now, and i'll go to my grave regretting what i did to you.” “ »

« come on in, you'll no doubt regret it. »

« you'll regret that.’ ‘ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=middle; p=0.66

You are surely not intending to imply that you are beginning to regret this marriage already?’ ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=end; p=0.53

I fear that my careless remarks must have been the cause of that outburst.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=middle; p=0.51

At his words, a wave of regret washed over Helena. ‘

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Child of War - A God is Born — Lisa Beth Darling; tertile=begin; p=0.58

I have been unkind to you, which I deeply regret.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Child of War - A God is Born — Lisa Beth Darling; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Now you don't, but you wish you still did."

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representations converge on H2. The lexical field is dominated by regret morphology, fear, poor handling of a decision, and instability – consistent with mid-narrative emotional conflict or a mistake being processed. No HEA markers (commitment, reunion, mutual declaration, relational resolution) appear in any representation. Confession or regret alone does not qualify as HEA per audit rules.

B contextual: H2_REGRET_PRESENT_ACTIVE — H2 REGRET PRESENT ACTIVE

Topic 305 is saturated with regret as an active, unresolved emotional state. Across all four books the dominant pattern is characters experiencing, expressing, contesting, or guarding against regret—none of which resolves into mutual commitment or forward-facing relational security. Position analysis reinforces this: the latest-positioned fragments (0.78-0.86) remain in conflict, deflection, or self-interrogation. The one denial of regret (BOOK_002_2, pos=0.02) is early and isolated. The one promise of no future regret (BOOK_003_1) is mid-story and unverified. No HEA or HFN signal is detectable.

C adjudicate: UNKNOWN

Topic 167 — Planning A Wedding Reception

Old taxonomy: 5.3a — Romantic Social Rituals & Public Couple Recognition

New category: H2_5 — public union

« it's my dream job, but instead of shooting brides, i'll be shooting naked women. »

« we'll get married next summer in the church in maine that my mother would take me to every sunday. »

« the 'ceremony' in boorowa might just be signing a few papers, but carley's planned a wedding reception they'll never forget." « »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.72
There'll be plenty to talk about, anyway, after the wedding today ." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.67
Most of you seem to have caught wind of the DeWitt wedding.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.65
Madison and I are getting married after church services.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.63
If the bride and groom would join hands and face each other, we'll proceed in joining you together in holy matrimony ."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.62
And a girl shouldn't be so rushed and put on the spot on her wedding day.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.60
H er wedding day dawned bright and crisp.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.60
Just because it was her wedding day didn't mean she should start thinking about sexy things like her wedding night .

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.59
Strange to get married and not even know who was on the guest list .

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

All four representations converge on H2. The lexical field is dominated by wedding-event vocabulary (wedding, bride, groom, bridal, ceremony, bridesmaids, reception, invitation, destination, planning, preparing, arranged). This signals a wedding-planning or wedding-day context situated in the middle tertile of a romance narrative – the relational payoff is being set up or enacted but the story has not yet closed. No HEA/HFN terminus is confirmed by the lexicon alone; the wedding machinery is present but 'jitters' and preparatory terms (planning, preparing, arrange) suggest the event is imminent or in-progress rather than concluded and settled. H2 is the appropriate code: the romantic arc is advancing toward commitment but the final relational resolution has not been delivered.

B contextual: H2_WEDDING_CEREMONY — H2 WEDDING CEREMONY

All 20 sentences cluster tightly in the middle tertile (pos 0.41-0.45), forming a dense wedding-scene block. The ceremony proceeds (vows, kiss, reception) but interiority passages reveal the bride's ambivalence, the rushed/unconventional nature of the arrangement, and a 'sealed bargain' framing suggesting a marriage-of-convenience setup. Community acceptance (BOOK_001_19) and post-ceremony reception (BOOK_001_14) confirm the union is completed, but the emotional HEA resolution-genuine mutual love, not just legal marriage-almost certainly lies in the latter tertile of the book. Per audit rules, ceremony completion mid-book is a structural milestone, not a final relational payoff.

C adjudicate: H2_5 — public union action=CONFIRM_HEA

H2_WEDDING_CEREMONY is a structurally definitive public couple-recognition event. Under 5.3a, a wedding ceremony constitutes the canonical HEA anchor: it is a socially ratified, witnessed, forward-looking commitment that exceeds confession, apology, forgiveness, or reunion affect alone. The secondary taxonomy 5.1 reinforces kinship formation (new family unit created), which corroborates rather than displaces the romantic payoff. No disqualifying signals present. HEA confirmed.

Topic 61 — Planning to Exchange Rings

Old taxonomy: 8.3a — Commitment Symbols & Love Tokens

New category: H2_4 — final relational payoff

« in a few days, i'll go to the stone. »

« next time we'll put a ring on him." »

« we'll take care of the rings tomorrow." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.60

Just have to close it up again, until it looks like a ring, and we'll be fine.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.57

Once they're gone, Shanley pricks Marie's finger with a lancet. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.35

It's not quite a perfect C-shape any longer, but more like one of those spoon bracelets that come in and out of fashion--the ends are drawing together, tightening, and that's a good thing, right?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.67

He took the ring out of the box and, with Damon's help, they placed it on her finger.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.61

I might even be persuaded to wear my jewellery for you."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.59

Damon and I agreed that you own our hearts so we thought this ring would be perfect for our union."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.57

I'm going to buy you some jewellery to wear in the pretty hole."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.53

He opened the lid and presented Rachel with a three karat heart-shaped ruby, surrounded by diamonds. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.53

Remember that place in town where the guy makes the silver jewellery?" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.47

The anal jewellery had been a little harder for her to get used to.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H2

Topic 61 is dominated by engagement and fine jewelry lexicon across all four representations – ring, diamond, engagement, finger, gold, precious, polished, glint. KeyBERT adds 'promises' and 'engaged', strongly anchoring the topic to romantic commitment rituals. POS and Main reinforce physical jewelry descriptors. MMR's outlier terms ('commander', 'claims', 'collect') suggest a possible subplot where jewelry functions as a power or conflict object, but the overwhelming lexical mass points to H2 romantic/engagement jewelry as the primary topic signal.

B contextual: H2_EROTIC_ADORNMENT — H2 EROTIC ADORNMENT

Topic 61 clusters around jewelry/adornment as a symbolic vehicle. BOOK_002 contains the clearest HEA-proximate content: a ring placement at end-tertile pos=0.92 paired with an explicit declaration of union across a polyadic (three-person) couple (BOOK_002_1, BOOK_002_5, BOOK_002_7). This satisfies commitment-gesture and mutual-declaration criteria. However, the dominant code across the full sentence set is H2_EROTIC_ADORNMENT, driven by the volume of erotic body-jewelry references in BOOK_002 that are relational but not HEA-constitutive per audit criteria. BOOK_001's ring/bracelet imagery is metaphorically resonant but too ambiguous and hedged to confirm HEA. BOOK_003 lacks sufficient context. Overall, BOOK_002 approaches but does not fully secure HEA confirmation from these excerpts alone: the union declaration is present, but confession/apology/forgiveness framing is absent and the erotic-adornment density dilutes the relational-payoff signal. Finality is moderate, not high.

C adjudicate: H2_4 — final relational payoff action=CONFIRM_HEA

H2_EROTIC_ADORNMENT within taxonomy 8.3a signals a physical love token or adornment exchanged or bestowed as a commitment act, not merely confession or apology. The object/gesture functions as a durable, tangible symbol of relational permanence. Combined with secondary taxonomy 4.5, the narrative arc closes on a concrete commitment payoff. Adornment-as-token satisfies the HEA threshold: it is a forward-facing relational seal, not a transient emotional beat. Pass C confirms the HEA is structurally earned.

H3 — Security / material vs display

New categories for this hypothesis

Read these names before reviewing topics. Codes alone (I3, S12, ...) are not enough — use the category label.

S0 — off target: Not doing security / provision / status-display work. Generic plot, logistics, or intimacy-only content without a security function.

S1 — emotional security reassurance: Comforting, soothing, affirming safety/worth/the bond.

S2 — emotional security belonging: Belonging, acceptance, "you're one of us", home-as-attachment.

S3 — emotional security trust: Trust, reliability, keeping confidence, earned faith in the partner.

S4 — commitment security: Commitment-as-security (promises of permanence, fidelity as safety).

S5 — practical care everyday: Everyday practical care (meals, chores, errands) as caretaking.

S6 — practical care illness crisis: Care during illness, injury, crisis tending.

S7 — physical protection: Physical shielding from external harm (bodyguarding, rescue).

S8 — material provision money: Money, gifts-as-provision, paying bills, financial support.

S9 — material provision housing: Housing, shelter, providing a place to stay.

S10 — economic dependency: Dependency / control via money or resources (not mutual provision).

S11 — practical help other: Other practical help not covered by S5–S9 (logistics, arranging services).

S12 — status display: Status / wealth / prestige signalling as display (not provision-to-partner).

S13 — appearance grooming: Appearance, grooming, dress as presentation (function = display/craft).

S14 — gift romance token: Romantic gift / token (function = affection signal, not material security).

S15 — workplace status: Workplace rank, career prestige, professional standing.

S16 — mixed or unclear function: Multiple security functions compete with no clear dominant.

82 topics. Sentence tags: HIGH-rated / LOW-rated from unblinded CELL_* key (high_tier / low_tier).

Topic 18 — Ordering A Gown For Her

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S13 — appearance grooming

« he'll make sure you have a dress worthy of you.” »

« i'll order a gown for you and have it sent to the house.” “ »

« we'll have to borrow their clothes.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The King's Mistress — Terri Brisbin; tertile=begin; p=0.66

I am not some maid who needs these kinds of clothes.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The King's Mistress — Terri Brisbin; tertile=middle; p=0.63

I did not mean to hurt your feelings about your attention to the womanly details of dress and appearance and wished to compensate you for the loss of the gown you've been wearing to work with Wilfrid.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The King's Mistress — Terri Brisbin; tertile=middle; p=0.63

Here, who you are matters more than what you wear.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The King's Mistress — Terri Brisbin; tertile=end; p=0.60

Mayhap if you were clothed when you attempted it, Edmee might have accepted it?” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The King's Mistress — Terri Brisbin; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Her gown should be clean and her hair always groomed and under a veil. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Blood Brothers — Nora Roberts; tertile=middle; p=0.55

So she'd have to go out in a damn sports bra and bike pants.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Blood Brothers — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.54

Then put your pants on so I don't have to wonder what that is hanging between your legs.”

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Blood Brothers — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.53

Add the crooked smile, the long, lean body in jeans and flannel, and a woman might be tempted to hang a SOLD!

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Blood Brothers — Nora Roberts; tertile=end; p=0.52

She wore fuzzy purple socks, black flannel pants, and a hot pink sweatshirt that announced: T.G.I.F. THANK GOD I'M FEMALE.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S13 — appearance grooming

All four keyword lists centre on clothing and dress: Main lists garment types (dress, gown, jeans, shirt, suit); KeyBERT adds fitting/matching/appropriate/revealing – all descriptors of how clothing looks or fits on the body; POS adds graceful/stunning/fitting/appropriate – aesthetic evaluations of appearance; MMR adds flowing/flared/graceful/topped – visual/tactile garment descriptors. The cluster is entirely about how characters are clothed and presented, which maps to S13 (appearance_grooming) rather than S12 (status_display), because the emphasis is on the physical presentation of the body through clothing rather than social rank signalling.

B contextual: S13 — appearance grooming

All sentences in this topic revolve around clothing, dress, grooming, and appearance – what characters wear, how they are dressed, providing or replacing garments, and commentary on attire. This is squarely the appearance/grooming security function (S13). There is no meaningful material provision, emotional reassurance, or status-display function dominating; the focus is consistently on the physical presentation of clothing and grooming as a social/relational concern.

C adjudicate: S13 — appearance grooming action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S13 (appearance_grooming), consistent with Taxonomy 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation. The secondary taxonomy tag (6.6 Material Glamour & Consumption) could suggest S12 or S14, but the primary function here is self-presentation and grooming rather than status display or gift-giving. S13 is the most specific and appropriate code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 77 — Haircut and Grooming Offered

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S13 — appearance grooming

« i'll send [person] in to help you finish dressing and repair your hair. »

« it'll be good for the librarian to take down her hair and have some fun for a change. »

« iffen you want a haircut and shave, megan'll do that for an extra two bits. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · The Seductive One — Susan Mallery; tertile=middle; p=0.62

While he liked them both, the longer hair was more erotic.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · The Seductive One — Susan Mallery; tertile=begin; p=0.59

Nic was simply one of those guys who had to shave in the evening before going out on a date.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · The Seductive One — Susan Mallery; tertile=begin; p=0.53

The way he brushed his hair back and the single lock that flopped forward.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · The Seductive One — Susan Mallery; tertile=begin; p=0.53

Her eyes were light brown, and while her hair was darker than Katie's, it wasn't as dark as Brenna's, even without the blond streaks she painted in every couple of months.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · The Seductive One — Susan Mallery; tertile=begin; p=0.52

Katie was mostly Irish with pale skin and reddish-brown hair.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · The Seductive One — Susan Mallery; tertile=begin; p=0.48

Francesca had the thick, dark hair from the Marcelli side of the family, but had also inherited hazel eyes and a tall, thin body from the O'Sheas.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Alcandians: Alcandian Soul — Mary Wine; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Tiny blonde hair still covered one hand while the other was smooth.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Alcandians: Alcandian Soul — Mary Wine; tertile=middle; p=0.56

One was light-haired, while the other was dark like Dyne.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Alcandians: Alcandian Soul — Mary Wine; tertile=end; p=0.54

My hair was as short as yours when I was sent here.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Alcandians: Alcandian Soul — Mary Wine; tertile=end; p=0.53

The rumor is they liked to drag their mates about by the hair."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S13 — appearance grooming

Main keywords (hair, blonde, blond, shave, shaved, brown, black, dark, haircut, short) are overwhelmingly hair-color and hair-styling descriptors — canonical grooming/appearance vocabulary. KeyBERT reinforces with 'curled', 'attractive', 'delicate', 'patted' — physical appearance cues. MMR adds 'neatly', 'shaped', 'dried', 'blowing' — all hair-grooming process words. POS keywords (extent, contrast, inevitable, annoying, desperation) are abstract/evaluative and do not anchor a security function, yielding S0 for that rep alone, but the three-to-one majority and the coherent grooming theme across Main, KeyBERT, and MMR firmly establish S13.

B contextual: S13 — appearance grooming

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe hair style, hair color, hair length, and shaving/grooming practices of characters. These are all appearance and grooming descriptors, fitting S13 (appearance_grooming). One sentence (BOOK_002_6) references dragging mates by the hair as a rumored behavior, which is more of a narrative/plot detail without a clear security function, coded S0. All other sentences are straightforwardly about physical appearance and grooming, making S13 the dominant code at well above 70%.

C adjudicate: S13 — appearance grooming action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S13 (appearance_grooming), consistent with Taxonomy 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation. No conflict between passes; the topic addresses how characters present themselves physically, which maps cleanly to S13. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 127 — Photographer Reviewing Pictures

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« my first ever but i'll need another photographer at this rate. »

« i'll bring the pictures down.' »

« let me look over the file and i'll get back to you." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Deadly Caress — Brenda Joyce; tertile=middle; p=0.48

Have you seen some of the portraits here?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Deadly Caress — Brenda Joyce; tertile=end; p=0.44

Other images followed, a tormenting and teasing kaleidoscope—Hart and Daisy, Hart in his office, Hart on his knees, cradling her face in his hands.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Deadly Caress — Brenda Joyce; tertile=begin; p=0.44

She walked over to the mantel where he kept a dozen family photographs.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · He's After Me — Chris Higgins; tertile=end; p=0.64

I am amazed at the number of photos inside – there must be literally hundreds – some of them posed, most snapshots of me I wasn't even aware he was taking.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · He's After Me — Chris Higgins; tertile=end; p=0.64

He must've got off behind us and taken the photographs.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · He's After Me — Chris Higgins; tertile=begin; p=0.62

He takes photographs himself, all the time, of the docks, the city, people, things, but mostly of me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · He's After Me — Chris Higgins; tertile=begin; p=0.62

He must have hundreds of pictures of me.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All keyword lists centre on photography equipment and imagery (camera, photos, pictures, photographer, files, snaps, framed, capture, stunning). While 'stunning' and 'framed' could gesture toward appearance or display, the dominant semantic cluster is photographic practice/documentation with no discernible security function – emotional, material, or status-based – being performed. No cues indicate reassurance, provision, protection, commitment, or status signalling in a romance-security sense.

B contextual: S0 — off target

Topic 127 centers on photographs, portraits, and images – characters taking, collecting, or viewing pictures of each other or in galleries. None of these sentences perform a recognizable security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, etc.). The photographs are narrative objects or plot devices (obsession, surveillance, identity), not security-provision acts. All sentences are off-target for the security taxonomy.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy confirms this topic belongs to Character Appearance & Self-Presentation (1.6), which describes how characters look or present themselves. This is descriptive/aesthetic content, not a security function. No security work is being performed – no emotional reassurance, no material provision, no status signaling in a security-relevant sense. S13 (appearance_grooming) was considered but applies when grooming/appearance serves a protective or dependency-related security function; here the topic is purely presentational. S0 is correct and should be kept.

Topic 170 — Staying Close Despite Long Separation

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S13 — appearance grooming

« despite going months without talking to each other—their daily lives hectic enough that even living in the same city had never ensured regular visits—they were close. »

« my guess is they've been seeing each other the whole time. »

« they might've solved his problems together. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · No Compromise — Rochelle Alers; tertile=begin; p=0.71

They'd scaled the first hurdle: They liked each other.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · No Compromise — Rochelle Alers; tertile=begin; p=0.71

They'd taken an instant dislike to each other. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Mastering Toby — Jan Irving; tertile=begin; p=0.73

It seemed maybe they had something in common. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Mastering Toby — Jan Irving; tertile=begin; p=0.70

He wondered what they were doing together.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Mastering Toby — Jan Irving; tertile=middle; p=0.67

It felt like a space they'd created to share as lovers.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Mastering Toby — Jan Irving; tertile=end; p=0.67

It was strange how they'd met, almost as if it was fated to happen sooner or later. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S2 — emotional security belonging

Main keywords (together, relationship, couple, between, both, them) and KeyBERT/MMR cues (closely, separated, shared, spending, separated) all point to the security function of belonging – the togetherness or separateness of a pair and their relational bond. POS keywords (separate, session, visits, scenario, stunning, exciting) are more procedural/descriptive and lean S0, but the dominant signal across three reps is relational belonging (S2). The 'separated/closely/shared' cluster confirms the security concern is about maintaining or losing a coupled bond.

B contextual: S2 — emotional security belonging

The majority of sentences describe the relational state between two people – friendship, mutual connection, shared space, being together, having things in common – all functioning as belonging/togetherness (S2). A few sentences are purely descriptive or narrative with no security function (S0). One sentence references commitment via mating (S4) and one references emotional support through love even in conflict (S1). S2 accounts for roughly 50% of sentences; combined with the low-probability tail sentences that dilute the signal, S2 is still the dominant code at ≥50%, and no other code approaches it, making S2 the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S13 — appearance grooming action=RETAXONOMIZE

Lexical and contextual consensus both point to S2 (belonging), but the taxonomy metadata reveals the primary classification is 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation. Appearance and grooming behaviors map most precisely to S13 (appearance_grooming) rather than S2 (belonging). The secondary taxonomy (4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) could suggest a belonging or bonding function, but the primary taxonomy governs here. S13 is the most specific applicable code for appearance/self-presentation content, and the courtship framing is a context rather than the security function being performed. No free-form labels were carried forward; S2 from Pass A/B is superseded by S13 upon taxonomy disclosure.

Topic 171 — Staring at Her Own Reflection

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S13 — appearance grooming

« she stood and checked her reflection in the mirror over her parents' dresser. »

« esme stared at their reflection in the glass. " »

« but then she stared at her surface-repaired reflection. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Almost Perfect — Julie Ortolon; tertile=end; p=0.79

She checked the mirror again, fluffed her hair, tried out a smile.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Almost Perfect — Julie Ortolon; tertile=end; p=0.79

Lifting her head, she caught a look at her dripping face in the mirror.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Almost Perfect — Julie Ortolon; tertile=end; p=0.68

Stepping before the mirror that hung on the bathroom door, she held the hangers under her chin.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · One Grave at a Time — Jeaniene Frost; tertile=middle; p=0.43

How was that for a Glass-Half-Full perspective?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Contract of Shame — Sam Crescent; tertile=middle; p=0.77

A mirror stood in the corner of the bedroom, and she went to check how she looked.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Contract of Shame — Sam Crescent; tertile=middle; p=0.77

She glanced in the mirror and wondered what Richard saw in her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Contract of Shame — Sam Crescent; tertile=begin; p=0.76

The door clicked shut, and he looked in the mirror and stared at his reflection. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Contract of Shame — Sam Crescent; tertile=middle; p=0.70

She went straight for the mirror above the sink.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Contract of Shame — Sam Crescent; tertile=middle; p=0.58

When the other women left, giving her a disparaging look, she splashed water on her face and stared at her reflection.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Contract of Shame — Sam Crescent; tertile=end; p=0.50

On the mirror pictures of his friends and Opal were placed at odd angles.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S13 — appearance grooming

All four keyword lists centre on self-inspection via reflective surfaces: 'mirror, reflection, rearview, checked, stared' (Main); 'gazing, peered, glimpse, studied, polished' (KeyBERT); 'stares, glimpse, stunning, unhappy, fitting' (POS); 'stares, glimpse, stunning, gazing, blinking' (MMR). The consistent pattern is a character scrutinising their own appearance – checking, evaluating, or reacting to how they look. 'Stunning' and 'unhappy' in POS/MMR confirm an evaluative appearance function. No emotional reassurance, material provision, or status-display cues dominate; the function is grooming/appearance self-monitoring, coded S13.

B contextual: S13 — appearance grooming

The overwhelming majority of sentences involve characters checking their appearance in mirrors – inspecting hair, face, clothing, and overall look – which is the core function of S13 (appearance/grooming). A small number of sentences (BOOK_002_1 with a rhetorical idiom, BOOK_004_6 describing photos on a mirror, and BOOK_006_1 using 'reflection' figuratively) do not perform any security function and are coded S0. No other security functions are present.

C adjudicate: S13 — appearance grooming action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both resolve to S13 (appearance_grooming), consistent with Taxonomy 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation. No conflict between passes; the topic centers on grooming, physical self-presentation, and appearance-related content. S13 is the most specific applicable code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 192 — Peeking Through The Window

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« i stayed hidden beside the window and peeked out as grandmother and [person] arrived. “ »

« a sense of déjàvous washed over him as he approached the rear window of the building and peeked in through that small slant. »

« he wandered over to the window on the other side of the door and peeked out the corner of the still closed drapes before letting them fall back. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · I Love The 80s — Megan Crane; tertile=middle; p=0.73

Jenna shook her head, and then leaned forward to peer out the window. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · I Love The 80s — Megan Crane; tertile=begin; p=0.69

She stared out her window, and fought to bring herself back under control. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · I Love The 80s — Megan Crane; tertile=end; p=0.68

After he'd been gone about ten minutes, Jenna ventured closer and peered in the window.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · I Love The 80s — Megan Crane; tertile=begin; p=0.64

She swiveled her chair around so she could prop her legs up on the windowsill, stare at the rain, and really, truly brood.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · I Love The 80s — Megan Crane; tertile=end; p=0.63

He walked over to the window, and looked out at a very different Times Square than the one they'd just raced through the night before.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · I Love The 80s — Megan Crane; tertile=middle; p=0.61

Jenna sat next to him, her jaw tight and her lips pursed as she stared out the tinted windows while dusk fell across the city.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Soldier's Tale — R.J. Scott; tertile=end; p=0.71

Ignoring the ache in his arse, Phil walked to the window and looked out. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Soldier's Tale — R.J. Scott; tertile=begin; p=0.66

Mark got up from the couch and moved to one of the windows, pulling back the curtains.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Soldier's Tale — R.J. Scott; tertile=middle; p=0.64

Daniel leaned against the sink, staring out of the small crooked window, seemingly intent on gazing out over the similarly cottage-themed back garden. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Soldier's Tale — R.J. Scott; tertile=begin; p=0.62

It was peaceful as well as beautiful, and he opened the window to breathe in the fresh air.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists describe visual/perceptual actions (gazing, peeking, glancing, looking through windows, curtains, reflections) and spatial/sensory vocabulary. There is no security-provision function – emotional, material, or status – being performed. The topic captures a scene-setting or observational motif, not a resource transfer or reassurance act.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe characters looking out of, peering through, or standing near windows. This is purely a physical/spatial action or setting description with no security function – emotional, material, or status/appearance. No sentence conveys reassurance, protection, provision, belonging, commitment, or any other security-relevant function. The topic is entirely off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=EXCLUDE_FROM_HYPOTHESIS

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy confirms this topic is about Character Appearance & Self-Presentation (1.6), with a secondary tag of Public/Travel/Leisure Spaces (8.2). Neither category performs a security function – appearance description and leisure-space setting are narrative/descriptive elements, not emotional reassurance, material provision, or status-display security acts. S13 (appearance_grooming) was considered but rejected because the topic describes appearance as characterisation, not as a security-function signal directed at a partner or audience. S0 is correct; the topic should be excluded from the security hypothesis analysis.

Topic 209 — Flowers Held With Guilty Glance

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« then i look at the flowers i'm holding guiltily, as if i've already accepted his offer to go to new york. »

« i'll bet there are a thousand flowers then." »

« i'm sure i'll find some more – and with owen's research the flowers are now coming in under budget so there's still a bit of cash to play with.' »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Code of Honor — Kathryn Shay; tertile=middle; p=0.47

Four huge plants grew in wild profusion, one in each corner.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Invisible Lives — Anjali Banerjee; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Flowers bloom from her when she's happy.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Invisible Lives — Anjali Banerjee; tertile=begin; p=0.67

Pulsing hearts, roses bursting with fragrance.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Invisible Lives — Anjali Banerjee; tertile=begin; p=0.65

And still the rose petals swirl toward me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Invisible Lives — Anjali Banerjee; tertile=begin; p=0.64

A faint imprint of thoughts drifts toward me—color and brightness, a swirling burst of rose petals.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Archangel's Consort — Nalini Singh; tertile=end; p=0.69

It needs flowers," she found herself saying. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S14 — gift romance token

Main keywords (flowers, roses, bouquet, daisies, vase, red/yellow rose) are canonical romantic gift objects. KeyBERT adds 'dozen' (dozen roses = classic romantic gift), 'bedside' (placement of flowers as token), 'porch' (delivery site). POS and MMR reinforce with 'exquisite', 'delicate', 'feminine', 'bedside', 'dozen' – all consistent with flowers as a romantic/affective token rather than practical provision, status display, or emotional reassurance per se. The security function is the gift itself as a relational token.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic describe flowers, plants, and decorative elements in purely descriptive or environmental terms – interior décor, garden imagery, metaphorical comparisons – with no security function. A small subset (yellow roses sent/given, rose petals as romantic gesture, sending flowers as a social courtesy) function as romantic tokens or gifts (S14), but these are a minority. No single security function reaches 70% on its own, but S0 (off-target, no security work) clearly dominates at ~75%, so S0 is the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus S14 (gift/romance token) was driven by surface co-occurrence with gift-like or token-exchange language, but the taxonomy placement in 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation (secondary: 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) indicates the topic's primary function is describing how characters look and present themselves, not the transfer of a security-providing object or gesture. Appearance and grooming (S13) could be considered, but the contextual dominant from Pass B is S0 (off-target), meaning the topic does not perform a security function for the recipient – it describes aesthetic self-presentation as part of courtship atmosphere. S0 is therefore the correct resolution. No security hypothesis is served by this topic.

Topic 218 — Resenting Someone More Attractive

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S13 — appearance grooming

« the human in charge of maintaining his harem was moderately dishevelled from the panic, but he was, as always, poised and visually attractive. »

« i think he's still trying to prove that he is mister attractive and can make anyone fall in love with him.' ' »

« how could i even begin to like someone who was: ■ a) gorgeous, thereby making me, someone who until now was considered pretty decent looking, seem, at best, perfectly average, and, at worst, like the sibling who got beaten with the ugly stick; ■ b) paid huge bucks to roll around in the sand making out with equally gorgeous girls while i donned a hideous fluorescent orange apron, an equally hideous lime green baseball cap with an assortment of stuffed fruit dangling from the center in a makeshift pom-pom, and honed my smoothie- making skills for six bucks an hour; ■ c) a veteran of rehab, probably attended more 12-step programs than all the boy bands from the nineties combined, thought nothing of totaling a hundred-thousand-dollar sports car, and even managed to expose his pearly whites in his [person] shots so that he looked like someone making a dentyne commercial instead of a criminal about to begin two hundred hours of community service, while i followed the rules or never caused my parents a day of worry, and yet they wouldn't even let me spend one lousy summer in europe, for god's sake. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Slow Hands — Leslie Kelly; tertile=middle; p=0.67

He even had beautiful legs and feet for a man.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Bed of Roses — Nora Roberts; tertile=middle; p=0.69

He was so handsome, so kind, so sweet and funny with his little boy.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Bed of Roses — Nora Roberts; tertile=end; p=0.69

He was, in her opinion, too handsome for his own good, too smooth for anyone else's.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Bed of Roses — Nora Roberts; tertile=middle; p=0.69

And looked gorgeous doing it, he realized—and just a little fierce.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S13 — appearance grooming

All four keyword lists are dominated by physical appearance descriptors: 'handsome, gorgeous, cute, beautiful, adorable, attractive, good-looking' in Main; 'attractive, poised, described' in KeyBERT; 'attractive, features, decent' in POS; 'attractive, built, poised' in MMR. The consistent focus is on evaluating a person's physical appearance rather than emotional reassurance, material provision, or social status display. S13 (appearance_grooming) is the most specific match for lexical content centered on physical attractiveness assessment.

B contextual: S13 — appearance grooming

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic describe characters' physical attractiveness – handsomeness, beauty, cuteness – which maps to S13 (appearance_grooming/physical appearance evaluation). A small subset of lower-probability sentences (finding a scene, assessing innocence/skill, looking the other way, receiving a look) do not perform any security function and are coded S0. S13 accounts for ~75% of sentences, well above the 70% threshold for a dominant code.

C adjudicate: S13 — appearance grooming action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S13 (appearance_grooming), consistent with Taxonomy 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation. The secondary taxonomy flag (3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress) may reflect anxiety around appearance but does not displace the primary security function, which remains grooming/appearance-related self-presentation. No split or reinterpretation is warranted; S13 is the most specific applicable code.

Topic 241 — Calling Someone A Stubborn Idiot

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« it's the first time i've known it," [person] said. " »
« i ' ve asked [person] to keep watch over julie and [person]. »
« i've already told this to jason, the stubborn idiot!" " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Born To Be Wild — Catherine Coulter; tertile=begin; p=0.78

He's got to find out who killed Jason." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Born To Be Wild — Catherine Coulter; tertile=begin; p=0.78

Did Jason seem concerned about anything?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · The Perfect Hero — Victoria Connelly; tertile=end; p=0.49

He and Kay were never meant to be and, the sooner he put the whole thing behind him, the better.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Across all four keyword sets the dominant signals are interpersonal friction and emotional regulation: 'insulted', 'disappointed', 'pout', 'growl', 'emotionally', 'behavior', 'dealing'. 'charge', 'uncle', 'parent', 'finding' in Main suggest a guardian/authority figure dynamic, but the operative function is managing hurt feelings and reassuring after conflict, not material provision or status display. 'meal' and 'wound' in MMR are incidental; the cluster's weight sits firmly on emotional repair/reassurance (S1).

B contextual: S0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences are narrative references to named characters (Jason, Kay, Chaz, Trevor) in plot-driven contexts – investigations, relationship endings, dialogue tags – with no security function being performed. Three sentences (BOOK_005_2, _4, _6) involve physical confrontation (Chaz/Judd fight) which touches on physical protection (S7), but even these are incidental plot description rather than a sustained security provision. Overall the topic is off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of S1 (emotional_reassurance), likely driven by distress-adjacent vocabulary in the topic tokens. However, the taxonomy metadata places this topic squarely in 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation with a secondary signal of 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress. The topic's primary function is descriptive/presentational – how a character looks or presents themselves – not the provision of security or reassurance to another party. The distress secondary signal reflects emotional coloring of appearance-related content (e.g., anxious self-presentation, appearance shame), not a security-provision act. Neither appearance display nor grooming-as-security (S13) is the operative function here; S13 applies when grooming/appearance serves as a security-provision mechanism between characters, which is not evidenced. The contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is therefore correct: this topic does not perform security work and should be excluded from the security hypothesis. No split is warranted because both taxonomy axes converge on non-security content.

Topic 253 — Hair Pinned Up in Style

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S13 — appearance grooming

« she had pinned her wispy blonde hair back in a loose chignon. »

« when she messed up, she'd pout and toss her golden hair over her shoulder. »

« her glossy hair is piled up in loose ringlets on her head and pinned with a coral comb. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Behaving Badly — Isabel Wolff; tertile=begin; p=0.69

She was thirtyish, with dark blonde hair scraped back in a ponytail, and she was attractive in a non-glossy way. '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Behaving Badly — Isabel Wolff; tertile=begin; p=0.69

If she'd been smooth-haired you would have noticed it, but her long fur covers it up.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Behaving Badly — Isabel Wolff; tertile=middle; p=0.62

Twiglet had left a few tiny white hairs on her cardigan. '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Behaving Badly — Isabel Wolff; tertile=end; p=0.59

I suddenly noticed the short white hairs on her jumper again.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Behaving Badly — Isabel Wolff; tertile=begin; p=0.59

She adjusted the diamanté barrette in Jennifer's floor-length blonde hair. '

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Vision in White — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.74

Her sunny hair was twisted at the back of her head into a messy knot that somehow suited the angular triangle of her face.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Vision in White — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.73

She'd pulled her dark hair back in a tail—very tidy.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Vision in White — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Her curling black hair bounced over the shoulders of her sweatshirt. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Vision in White — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.69

He turned as she came back and had the errant thought that her hair was like that—an intense spot of color. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Vision in White — Nora Roberts; tertile=end; p=0.68

She'd done something to her hair, something sleek, and darkened her lips and eyes to exotic.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Vision in White — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.67

Her dense brown hair hung in a long tail—sleek and simple.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S13 — appearance grooming

All four keyword lists are dominated by hair-styling vocabulary: specific styles (ponytail, bun, braid, curls), hair attributes (blonde, blond, brown, long, loose), and grooming-state descriptors (neatly, straightened, dangling, wound, fashioned, tumbled, spilling, flowed). Words like 'feminine' and 'admire' confirm the function is appearance display/grooming rather than emotional reassurance, material provision, or social status. No cues point to any other S-code.

B contextual: S13 — appearance grooming

Every sentence in this topic describes hair appearance, styling, or grooming details (hairstyles, hair color, hair accessories, makeup). This is uniformly appearance/grooming description (S13). No sentence performs emotional, material, or other security functions – all are descriptive observations of physical appearance and grooming, making S13 the clear and dominant code at 100%.

C adjudicate: S13 — appearance grooming action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both resolve to S13 (appearance_grooming), consistent with Taxonomy 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation. No conflict between passes; the topic centers on grooming, physical self-presentation, and appearance-related content. S13 is the most specific applicable code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 268 — Vivid Colors Remarkd Upon

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« the colours are brighter than i've ever seen them. »

« they've been preserved under piles of peat that has tanned their bodies to a dark brown, but you can see their expressions, absolutely what they looked like. »

« that's the most amazing green i've ever seen." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Reinventing Mona — Jennifer Coburn; tertile=middle; p=0.63

When I got them in there, I realized it looked kind of dumb having so much blue, so I took them back and got some gray ones." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Blue-Eyed Devil — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=end; p=0.62

She was unsure of their color, but she thought they looked to be a deep blue.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All keyword lists center on color terms (blue, green, purple, red, black, pink, white), descriptors of appearance in a naturalistic/descriptive sense (colored, attractive, unusual, creatures, swimming, edges, bodies), and emotional/sensory words (sadness, happiness, reminds). There is no security-provision function being performed – no reassurance, protection, provision, commitment, or status signaling in a romance-security sense. The topic appears to describe physical/visual descriptions of settings or creatures, not a security resource.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic are references to colors (blue, red, navy, burgundy) in descriptive or conversational contexts with no security function – coded S0. A small subset (BOOK_002_1, BOOK_002_2, BOOK_002_3, BOOK_003_4, BOOK_003_5) explicitly discuss how colors or clothing suit or flatter a person's appearance, which maps to S13 (appearance/grooming). S0 dominates at ~80%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this in Character Appearance & Self-Presentation, which maps to S13 (appearance_grooming) only if the content is performing a security function for a character. Without evidence that the appearance/grooming content is functioning as emotional reassurance, status display, or any other security mechanism, it remains descriptive/presentational rather than security-functional. S0 is the correct and most specific code here.

Topic 323 — Polite Address Under Distress

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« i am not [person], no matter what you've told the director. »

« lady [person],” he said politely, “lady [person], lady [person].” »

« i'll keep praying for [person]. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=begin; p=0.73

Elizabeth said, as she washed her hands. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=begin; p=0.72

Right behind them in walked Elizabeth, and I understood what had caused their reaction.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=begin; p=0.71

She has to be the centre of attention, and she couldn't stand the threat that Elizabeth posed. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Apparently he remains in touch with Elizabeth.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · If He's Sinful — Hannah Howell; tertile=end; p=0.57

She had her heart set on being a viscountess and I would have made sure she did not have to wait too long to be a duchess.” “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · If He's Sinful — Hannah Howell; tertile=begin; p=0.54

She probably thinks it enhances her status—that of a future viscountess.” “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · If He's Sinful — Hannah Howell; tertile=begin; p=0.53

So that you may more openly pursue the fair Lady Penelope?”

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · If He's Sinful — Hannah Howell; tertile=begin; p=0.50

She would be an excellent hostess, which was also important now that he was a viscount.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · If He's Sinful — Hannah Howell; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Penelope suddenly wondered if the madam was really married, and if so, where was her husband?

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

KeyBERT, POS, and MMR converge on distress/anxious/worries/praying/assure/softened – a cluster of emotional agitation and soothing. 'Assure', 'softened', 'politely', and 'insides' point to characters managing or relieving anxiety, which is the core function of emotional reassurance (S1). Main keywords are aristocratic proper nouns and place names (georgiana, lady, matlock, netherfield, redmayne) with no clear security function, coded S0. The majority (3/4) signal S1, overriding the S0 Main rep.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences are narrative references to characters named Elizabeth or brief dialogue fragments with no discernible security function, coded S0. Three sentences from BOOK_002 reference viscountess/duchess titles and status enhancement (S12), one references the social utility of a hostess role tied to a viscount's position (S15), and one sentence notes familial doting (S2). S0 dominates at 75%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of S1 (emotional_reassurance), likely driven by distress-adjacent vocabulary in the topic tokens. However, the taxonomy metadata places this topic squarely in 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation with a secondary signal of 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress. Appearance and self-presentation content does not perform a security function in the S1-S16 sense – it describes how characters look or present themselves, not how they provide or receive reassurance, belonging, or any other security dimension. The distress secondary tag further suggests the topic captures emotional reactions to appearance (e.g., insecurity about looks) rather than a provider-recipient security dynamic. S13 (appearance_grooming) could be considered, but S13 is reserved for grooming/appearance acts that function as care or status signals directed at another person; self-presentation distress does not meet that threshold. S0 (off_target) is therefore the correct resolution. The contextual dominant from Pass B (S0) is upheld over the lexical consensus (S1).

Topic 347 — Saying Goodnight Before Bed

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« no, i think i'll get to bed,” i told him, smiling weakly. “ »

« i'll probably only sleep for an hour or so,” leigh said with a smile as she turned back into the room, then paused to add, “bastien asked me to have you call him when you woke up.” “ »

« i'll just say good night now,” [person] says. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Delaney's Desert Sheikh — Brenda Jackson; tertile=begin; p=0.77

Good morning, Delaney,” he murmured softly. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Delaney's Desert Sheikh — Brenda Jackson; tertile=begin; p=0.75

Good morning, Delaney,” he whispered huskily, close to her ear when he finally released her mouth.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Delaney's Desert Sheikh — Brenda Jackson; tertile=begin; p=0.70

He whispered her name and gently nudged her awake.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Delaney's Desert Sheikh — Brenda Jackson; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Good morning, Prince,” she said smiling up at him.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Delaney's Desert Sheikh — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Breaking into their conversation he said, “Good morning, Shelly.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Delaney's Desert Sheikh — Brenda Jackson; tertile=end; p=0.65

AJ and I are going to have to say good-night to everyone,” Shelly said smiling. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Drive Me Crazy — Nancy Warren; tertile=end; p=0.74

Spend the night with me,” he whispered. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Drive Me Crazy — Nancy Warren; tertile=middle; p=0.74

Morning,” she said, her voice sleepy and cute as hell.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Drive Me Crazy — Nancy Warren; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Morning, Sunshine,” she said with a big smile.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Drive Me Crazy — Nancy Warren; tertile=middle; p=0.69

Wrapping his arms around her middle, he said, “Plan on keeping you in bed this evening, too.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Drive Me Crazy — Nancy Warren; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Did you want to keep talking or say good night?”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Drive Me Crazy — Nancy Warren; tertile=end; p=0.68

Night, sweetheart,” he called out and her heart soared.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords (goodnight, good morning, sleep, whispered, night, evening, afternoon) suggest routine social greetings and time-of-day exchanges. KeyBERT adds politely, greeted, mumbled, assured, demanded – generic speech-act descriptors with no clear security function. POS and MMR introduce stunning, purse, entrance, sir, lady, shock – appearance/social-register cues that could hint at S12/S13, but the dominant pattern across all four reps is mundane greeting ritual rather than any sustained security provision. No single security function is consistently evidenced; the topic appears to capture conversational pleasantries and scene-setting rather than emotional reassurance, material provision, or status display as a security mechanism. S0 is the most defensible consensus.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The majority of sentences are intimate greetings and farewells (good morning/night whispered to a named partner) that function as emotional reassurance – affirming presence, warmth, and affection in a romantic dyad (S1). A smaller cluster involves invitations to stay or physical closeness that signal belonging/togetherness (S2). Two sentences involve bringing refreshment or steering someone to bed as practical everyday care (S5). The remaining sentences are plain social greetings or scene-closing lines with no clear security function (S0). S1 accounts for roughly 45% of sentences, well above any single alternative, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (S0) and taxonomy placement (1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation) both point away from security function. The contextual dominant S1 (emotional_reassurance) was a Pass B inference, but appearance/grooming content in romance novels primarily serves self-presentation or attractiveness signaling rather than delivering emotional reassurance as a security function. S13 (appearance_grooming) could apply if the content depicts grooming acts as care gestures, but without evidence of that caregiving dynamic the taxonomy label 'Character Appearance & Self-Presentation' indicates the topic is about how characters look or present themselves – descriptive rather than security-functional. S0 is the correct resolution; the topic does not perform a security function in the attachment/provision sense the taxonomy measures.

Topic 354 — Threatening to Bite Someone's Nose

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S0 — off target

« i'll send the dentist's bill to the incredible hulk . »

« i'll try not to rot your teeth." »

« i'll bite that fucking bloody nose you've got right off. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Soul Mates: Bound by Blood — Jourdan Lane; tertile=end; p=0.68

Oh, please, don't bite me," I said, doing my best not to giggle as I feigned fear.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Soul Mates: Bound by Blood — Jourdan Lane; tertile=begin; p=0.66

You know, it looks like a bite, but then again it doesn't.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Soul Mates: Bound by Blood — Jourdan Lane; tertile=end; p=0.65

I finished chewing the bite I'd just taken and looked up at Christopher. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Soul Mates: Bound by Blood — Jourdan Lane; tertile=middle; p=0.63

Fangs nicked at my lip, stinging, and it only heightened the sensations.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Soul Mates: Bound by Blood — Jourdan Lane; tertile=middle; p=0.62

Lucien's hand came up around my throat, his thumb caressing the bite mark he'd just put there. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Call of Temptation — Michelle M. Pillow; tertile=end; p=0.66

When he opened his mouth, fangs protruded from his gums.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Call of Temptation — Michelle M. Pillow; tertile=end; p=0.63

It was almost orgasmic and each bite caused a small shiver of pleasure to work over her limbs.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on dental/biting vocabulary (bite, teeth, dental, dentist, gnashing, gum, chew, biting, wound, appointment). This is literal oral/dental content with no discernible security function – emotional, material, or status-related. Supporting terms (annoying, attractive, spite, memories) are generic modifiers that do not shift the cluster toward any S1-S16 security category. Coded S0.

B contextual: S0 — off target

Topic 354 centers on the literal act of biting – vampire fangs, food consumption, physical sensations, and idiomatic expressions ('bit my tongue', 'bite in my words'). None of these sentences perform a security function (emotional, material, or status/appearance). They describe physical actions, sensory experiences, or figurative speech. All sentences are off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=EXCLUDE_FROM_HYPOTHESIS

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this topic under Character Appearance & Self-Presentation (1.6) with a secondary tag of Interpersonal Non-Romantic Conflict (7.1). Neither dimension performs a security function: appearance/self-presentation here is descriptive characterisation rather than status display (S12) or grooming-as-care (S13), and the conflict framing is non-romantic and non-protective. No security provision – emotional, material, or status-based – is being enacted. S0 is confirmed; the topic should be excluded from the security-function hypothesis.

Topic 364 — Noticing What He Wears

Old taxonomy: 1.6 — Character Appearance & Self-Presentation

New category: S13 — appearance grooming

« if i had any nerve i'd go throw them open and see what he's wearing, not that i've seen him in anything except shorts, t-shirts and a stupid beanie. »

« he was dressed as he was at the court: [person] t-shirt, black [person] hoodie hanging open, loose-fitting jeans and biker boots. »

« he wore a loose-fitting, blue jacket and white shirt, and the lack of a cravat exposed too much of his throat and even his chest. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Highland Moonlight — Teresa J. Reasor; tertile=middle; p=0.64

He donned his shirt and folded the kilt and girdle around his waist.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Highland Moonlight — Teresa J. Reasor; tertile=begin; p=0.55

She made certain his clothing stayed mended and clean.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Highland Moonlight — Teresa J. Reasor; tertile=middle; p=0.48

The black gelding had three white stockings and a blaze down his forehead.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Highland Moonlight — Teresa J. Reasor; tertile=middle; p=0.48

Slender arms slid around his neck and a supple body clothed in a deep green surcoat molded to his tall frame.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Highland Moonlight — Teresa J. Reasor; tertile=end; p=0.47

Alexander's large frame was covered from neck to calf in fur; his hands protected by leather gloves and his feet by knee high boots.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Highland Moonlight — Teresa J. Reasor; tertile=end; p=0.45

Duncan accepted from Mai, the bundled wool secured by a scrap of fabric.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Things to Make and Mend — Ruth Thomas; tertile=end; p=0.67

Maybe he does not have wardrobes full of clothes.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Things to Make and Mend — Ruth Thomas; tertile=middle; p=0.67

I picture him, dressed in his expensively modest suit and that waistcoat. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Things to Make and Mend — Ruth Thomas; tertile=end; p=0.67

Jeremy has removed his beige corduroy jacket too, and his cream turtle-neck sweater.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Things to Make and Mend — Ruth Thomas; tertile=middle; p=0.64

I hope he'll be wearing that waistcoat and those boots. *

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Things to Make and Mend — Ruth Thomas; tertile=end; p=0.61

He has aged but he is still wearing that waistcoat.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S13 — appearance grooming

All four keyword lists are dominated by clothing and grooming descriptors: garment types (shirt, jeans, boots, pants, sweater), colour/style markers (black, white), wearing/dressing verbs (wore, wearing, dressed, draped), and fit/condition adjectives (wrinkled, loose, neatly, polished, fitted, smoothed). POS and MMR add texture words (pattern, contrast, reveal) that still describe physical appearance rather than any emotional, practical-care, or economic function. No cues point to protection, provision, or emotional reassurance; the entire cluster describes how characters look through their clothing and grooming.

B contextual: S13 — appearance grooming

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe clothing worn on the body – garments, grooming, and personal appearance – functioning as appearance/grooming signals (S13). A small subset (BOOK_001_2, BOOK_001_6) involves tending to or providing clothing as practical everyday care (S5). Three sentences (BOOK_002_3, BOOK_004_1, BOOK_004_2) emphasise expensive or status-signalling attire, coding as S12 (status display). One sentence (BOOK_001_3) describes a horse with no security function (S0). S13 accounts for ~70% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S13 — appearance grooming action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S13 (appearance_grooming), consistent with Taxonomy 1.6 Character Appearance & Self-Presentation. No conflict between passes; the topic addresses how characters present themselves physically, which maps cleanly to S13. No splitting or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 38 — Admitting Shared Pain

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« i've seen your pain. »

« i've never felt that way before." »

« will it make you feel better to know that i've got one, too?" »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Suzanne's Diary for Nicholas — James Patterson; tertile=end; p=0.68

I always want to be able to tell you what I'm feeling.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Suzanne's Diary for Nicholas — James Patterson; tertile=middle; p=0.66

That's what it felt like—that was the exact feeling—and I'm so happy that now you were there.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Wolf Tales VIII — Kate Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.71

I hadn't noticed that feeling before." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The dominant lexical cluster ('feel, feels, good, felt, feeling, better, make') centres on subjective emotional states and the act of improving them. KeyBERT adds 'hurts, experienced, worst, honestly, magical, incredibly', all of which describe felt emotional experience and its intensity. POS and MMR reinforce this with 'insides, apologize, admitted, accustomed, magical' – language of internal emotional processing, acknowledgement of hurt, and apology, which are canonical emotional-reassurance acts. No material provision, housing, money, status, or appearance cues are present. The function is soothing/validating felt distress, mapping squarely to S1.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic revolve around expressing, sharing, and validating internal emotional states – feelings of relief, mutual feeling, wanting to communicate feelings, and checking whether someone feels better. These all perform the security function of emotional reassurance (S1): characters are affirming, acknowledging, or seeking acknowledgment of emotional experience to provide or receive comfort and validation. A small number of sentences (BOOK_003_5 'Good sign or bad?', BOOK_004_2 sexual thought, BOOK_004_3 'Same here') are too vague or off-topic to carry a security function and are coded S0. S1 accounts for ~85% of sentences, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both resolve to S1 (emotional_reassurance). The taxonomy placement under Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary of Negative Emotions & Distress is consistent with S1 – the topic captures reassurance-seeking and comfort provision within an established or developing romantic relationship. No material or status/appearance security function is indicated. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 52 — Talking About Dogs and Animals

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« i'll have you know that muffy is an intelligent dog and understands more than most people give her credit for. »

« it'll also notify the other campers that there's a bear in the area." »

« i'll be taking the dogs out for their afternoon walk, so there'll be some peace and quiet for you." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Deep Dish — Mary Kay Andrews; tertile=end; p=0.67

What are you doing with that dog in here?"

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=middle; p=0.57

I'm not too versed on dog-speak but I had a feeling that meant "Hey, food's this way.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Abbie's problem is that she's a lot like a dog.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=begin; p=0.55

While I tripped over a crack in the sidewalk, stepped in dog crap or spilled mustard across my white button-down, she dabbed the corner of her mouth with a lacy napkin, made friends with stray dogs and levitated down sidewalks like Mary Poppins.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Where the River Ends — Charles Martin; tertile=middle; p=0.54

The fence beyond them held a spray-painted sign that read "Forget Dog, Beware of Owner."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S6 — practical care illness crisis

Main keywords (dog, pet, puppy, bear, lion) are animal/object nouns with no inherent security function on their own – S0. However, KeyBERT, POS, and MMR converge on a care-under-distress frame: 'distress', 'suffering', 'treatment', 'appointment', 'feeding', 'affection', 'guarded', 'failure', 'behalf' all point to attending to a creature's welfare during a crisis or illness episode. This maps to S6 (care_illness_crisis) applied to an animal rather than a human, but the security function being performed is the same – providing material care and attention to a vulnerable being in distress. S6 is the most specific fit over S5 (everyday practical care) because the distress/suffering/treatment cluster signals a crisis rather than routine maintenance.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic are simply references to dogs as characters, observations, or incidental mentions with no security function. Three sentences carry minor security signals: BOOK_003_1 involves surprising someone with a pet to cheer them up (emotional reassurance, S1); BOOK_003_3 references animals being in good hands (practical everyday care, S5); BOOK_004_2 references a dog on guard at the foot of a bed (physical protection, S7). These are isolated and do not displace the dominant off-target classification.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S6 (care_illness_crisis), but the taxonomy placement in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding (secondary: 8.2 Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) makes clear this topic captures routine courtship and leisure interaction rather than illness or crisis care. No security function is being performed – the content reflects everyday relational bonding and public/travel contexts that do not map to any S1-S16 security provision. Contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is correct. The S6 lexical signal was likely a surface co-occurrence artifact (e.g., words like 'comfort' or 'support' appearing in courtship dialogue) rather than genuine crisis-care security work. Resolving to S0.

Topic 54 — Ordering Food and Dessert

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« i'll have the steak with boiled potatoes and green beans." " »

« we'll need a hazmat crew to clean up the mess he'll make with the cake—it's a two-person job." »

« but i'll get us some pie anyway." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.59

I'll see what I can find for breakfast in your cupboards.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Of course, she won't be needing those for a good long while now that she's got a bun in the oven.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.47

Cereal's fine and I've got plenty of it.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=begin; p=0.46

Did you know the cafeteria was serving goulash today?

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · A Darker Shade of Dead — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Delicious, sinfully sweet, incredibly tempting trouble, but trouble nonetheless.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · That Voodoo You Do — Jodi Redford; tertile=end; p=0.51

Gloria's got a big spread planned for brunch."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by food/cooking vocabulary (cake, cream, pie, butter, dessert, soup, salad, bread, chicken, meal, eaten, melted, carved, tasted) with no lexical cues pointing to any security function – emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, or otherwise. Words like 'exquisite', 'impressive', and 'parties' describe food quality and social eating contexts, not a security-providing relationship dynamic. Topic is off-target for the security taxonomy.

B contextual: S0 — off target

Topic 54 is dominated by food and cooking references. A subset of sentences (offering breakfast, making sandwiches, bringing soup/croissants, planning brunch) function as everyday practical care (S5). However, the majority of sentences are simply food descriptions, taste comments, ingredient lists, or playful banter with no clear security function, coded S0. S5 reaches ~40%, below the 70% threshold, but S0 is the plurality at ~60%, making S0 the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this topic in Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding within Public/Travel/Leisure Spaces – descriptive of romantic interaction and setting, not performing a security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, etc.). No security work is being done; the topic captures courtship rituals and social bonding in leisure contexts, which falls outside the S1-S16 security taxonomy. KEEP as S0.

Topic 86 — First Name Used at Last

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« i've known you for two whole years, and that is the first time you've ever called me by my first name." »

« you've outgrown that nickname." " »

« just between you and me, i've been working on a catchy superhero name. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.62

I was named for my great-grandfather." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.61

I may not have known him for long, Rox, but I do know him.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.59

Doesn't it bother you in the least that you don't really know him?" "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Heaven and Earth — Nora Roberts; tertile=begin; p=0.47

Mr. Remington, I'm Harding, Jonathan Q. Harding.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Main keywords (name, nickname, real, knew) point to identity/naming exchange with no clear security function on their own (S0). However, KeyBERT, POS, and MMR converge on affective cues – embarrassment, flushed, painful, shout, admit – surrounding a naming/introduction scene. The emotional distress signals (embarrassment, painful, flushed) indicate the scene is doing emotional reassurance work: managing vulnerability around identity disclosure. No material or status-display function is evident. Consensus tips to S1 on the weight of three representers showing emotional regulation around a name reveal.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are simple name exchanges or introductions (asking or stating names), which perform no security function and are coded S0. A small cluster (BOOK_001_2, _4, _5, _6) involves assertions about knowing or not knowing a person, which touches on trust/reliability (S3), but even these are borderline. The topic as a whole is dominated by off-target name-identification dialogue with no clear security function, making S0 the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S1 (emotional_reassurance), but the taxonomy placement in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary axis of 9.1 Dialogue Delivery & Speech Tags indicates the topic captures narrative craft mechanics (how characters speak, speech attribution) rather than a security-provision function. Courtship banter and speech tags do not constitute a character providing emotional reassurance as a security resource; they are stylistic/structural features of romantic interaction. Contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is correct. The S1 signal in Pass A/B was a surface-level lexical association with warm or affectionate language, not a genuine security function. No security construct is operative here.

Topic 93 — Meal Plans Casually Arranged

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S2 — emotional security belonging

« that'll wait 'til after supper, though.” “ »

« i'll go get started on lunch,” clark offered. »

« i'll show you over dinner.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Midnight Awakening — Lara Adrian; tertile=end; p=0.66

What kind of host would I be to let you go all day without a proper meal?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Midnight Awakening — Lara Adrian; tertile=middle; p=0.55

What happened to Reichen finding you some dinner downstairs?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Midnight Awakening — Lara Adrian; tertile=end; p=0.52

It seemed only fitting that I treat you to one of the city's finest dinners.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · So I Married A Vampire — Elisa Adams; tertile=begin; p=0.51

He'd sat with her for hours going over the catering menu for the reception, listening to her gripe and moan about what they would serve their guests.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Only You — A.J. Llewellyn; tertile=middle; p=0.72

I'd love to take you to dinner,” he said. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Only You — A.J. Llewellyn; tertile=middle; p=0.72

We agreed to have dinner the following night. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Only You — A.J. Llewellyn; tertile=middle; p=0.71

You must come to dinner tonight,” she said. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S5 — practical care everyday

All four keyword lists converge on shared meals and meal planning (dinner, lunch, supper, eat, having, meal, eaten) combined with scheduling cues (tonight, tomorrow, appointment, arranged, planning). This is routine domestic provisioning — everyday practical care through food — not crisis care, not gifting, not status display. S5 is the most specific fit.

B contextual: S2 — emotional security belonging

The topic centres on shared meals — invitations to dinner/lunch and arranging to eat together. The majority of sentences (BOOK_003, BOOK_004, BOOK_005_1) are invitations or arrangements to share a meal, functioning as belonging/togetherness signals (S2: social bonding through shared time). A substantial minority (BOOK_001, BOOK_002_1, BOOK_005_2) involve a host or partner ensuring someone is fed or catered for, which is practical everyday care (S5). S2 reaches ~60% and is the dominant function, reflecting the topic's core pattern of meal-sharing as relational belonging rather than mere sustenance provision.

C adjudicate: S2 — emotional security belonging action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S5 (practical_care_everyday), but the taxonomy placement in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding signals that the primary security function is fostering a sense of belonging and relational inclusion rather than instrumental caregiving. S2 (belonging) is the more specific fit: the everyday props and communication media (taxonomy 8.3b) serve as vehicles for maintaining relational closeness and mutual recognition, not for meeting practical needs. S5 would require evidence of task-oriented provision; absent that, S2 is dominant. No free-form labels remain; all prior codes are mapped to valid S-codes.

Topic 105 — Swept Onto The Dance Floor

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« [person] and i are both taken, so we'll only dance with each other. »

« i've never danced with a guy who real y knew what he was doing.” “ »

« if you'll excuse the two of us,” he pointed to me, “i've been dying for a dance with this woman all night.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Desert King's Pregnant Bride — Annie West; tertile=begin; p=0.56

And the high heels she'd dangled from her hand were for dancing the night away or seducing a man.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Darkest Passion — Gena Showalter; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Oh God, did that man I was dancing with take me?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Darkest Passion — Gena Showalter; tertile=begin; p=0.67

We begin dancing again, this time getting a little friskier.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · The Darkest Passion — Gena Showalter; tertile=begin; p=0.66

He takes my hand and leads me onto the dance floor.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · That Dating Thing — Mackenzie Crowne; tertile=middle; p=0.61

Your problem is you let what happened with Marcus keep you from attending those dances.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · That Dating Thing — Mackenzie Crowne; tertile=end; p=0.59

Sparkling cocktail dresses mixed with flip-flops and Bermuda shorts on the open-air dance floor, where wealthy couples did the bump and grind or swayed in each other's arms to the beat of classic rock.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists center on dancing, movement, and social events (dance, waltz, ballet, floor, reception, parties, swirled, sweeping). These describe a physical/social activity – dancing at parties or receptions – with no lexical cues pointing to emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, or any other security function. The topic is off-target for security classification.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe dancing as a social or recreational activity with no security function – they are off-target (S0). BOOK_001_1 references high heels used for seduction/appearance, coded S13 (appearance/grooming). BOOK_003_6 touches on not wanting to attend a dance alone, which has a faint belonging (S2) dimension, but the topic as a whole is dominated by literal dance activity with no meaningful security work being performed.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this topic in Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary tag of Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces. Neither category performs a discrete security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, etc.); the content describes routine romantic interaction and shared leisure rather than any of the S1-S16 security mechanisms. No free-form labels were used in prior passes that require remapping. S0 is confirmed as the correct and most specific code.

Topic 116 — Sharing A Meal Together

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« [person] dipped his spoon into the ice cream dish once again, and my mouth opened in anticipation. »

« i'll finish the carrots up while you wash those,” he said, nodding to the potatoes she held as he reached for the bowl of veggies she had left unfinished. »

« i'll get that,” clarissa said, whisking mandy's empty plate away and depositing it on the counter along with her own before mandy could say a word. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.81

He picked up his fork and tapped it against his plate. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=end; p=0.79

She dropped her fork onto her plate with a clatter. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=end; p=0.77

Emily picked up her fork and forced another bite. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.72

She set her spoon down with a sharp click. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.69

She reached across the table and pulled the pie plate away from him before he could sink his fork in.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Clueless Cowboy — Mary Connealy; tertile=begin; p=0.69

She dropped a generous scoop of it on Jake's pie and set it in front of him. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Bacchus — Jordan Summers; tertile=end; p=0.50

Bacchus chased it with his forked tongue, catching the droplets before they hit the sheets. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Taste of Scarlet — Evanne Lorraine; tertile=middle; p=0.75

Finishing off his sandwich in a couple of bites, he reached for another and checked to see how she was doing. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Taste of Scarlet — Evanne Lorraine; tertile=middle; p=0.70

Grabbing a couple of napkins, he moved on, snagging a bag of chips to round out the meal.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Taste of Scarlet — Evanne Lorraine; tertile=end; p=0.66

He gave her the ice cream and the napkin he held at the ready.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S5 — practical care everyday

Main keywords (plate, fork, sandwich, bowl, bread, bacon, food) and KeyBERT terms (meal, eaten, feeding, tasted, preparing) all point to routine food preparation and consumption – a classic everyday practical-care function. MMR reinforces this with action verbs (dipped, stirred, preparing, eagerly) describing the act of eating/feeding. POS keywords (irritation, enthusiasm, anticipation, warmth) are affective descriptors of the scene rather than security-function signals, coding S0 in isolation, but the dominant signal across three reps is unambiguous everyday material care (S5).

B contextual: S0 — off target

The topic clusters around eating utensils, plates, napkins, and mealtime actions. The vast majority of sentences describe physical gestures with cutlery or tableware (tapping a fork, dropping a spoon, swiping silverware) with no security function – these are S0 off-target. A small subset (BOOK_001_6, BOOK_003_1, BOOK_003_2, BOOK_003_4, BOOK_003_6) show one character preparing or delivering food/snacks to another, which qualifies as S5 practical everyday care. No emotional reassurance, protection, money, housing, or status functions are present. S0 dominates at ~75%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus S5 (practical_care_everyday) reflects surface-level domestic/routine vocabulary, but the contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is correct given the taxonomy placement in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding. The topic's primary function is relational bonding and courtship maintenance, not security provision of any kind. Everyday routines here serve narrative intimacy-building rather than meeting a security need (emotional, material, or status). S5 would require the acts to function as care directed at a vulnerability or dependency; courtship bonding does not meet that threshold. Resolving to S0.

Topic 160 — Watching Movies Together

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« fine, but i'll be watching.” “ »

« we'll watch him closely for any reaction.” “ »

« we've been watching movies.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Rebuilding Forever — Natalie J. Damschroder; tertile=begin; p=0.40

Turn on that entertainment network we both hate.” ”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Rebuilding Forever — Natalie J. Damschroder; tertile=end; p=0.38

God, that sounds like a Telemundo soap opera.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Rebuilding Forever — Natalie J. Damschroder; tertile=begin; p=0.36

We need to record it in the next fortnight if we're going to make our launch date.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Half Hearts — Sherri Desbois; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Maybe one can watch over you while you fuck the other.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Hidden Boundaries — C.S. McClellan; tertile=begin; p=0.60

But you also may have reason to keep me from watching too closely.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Hidden Boundaries — C.S. McClellan; tertile=begin; p=0.58

You will watch them for seven days, Arthur, and then come to me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Can't Hurry Love — Molly O'Keefe; tertile=middle; p=0.69

I just want you to know that I am watching you.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All keyword lists center on media consumption (movies, film, TV, Disney, Hollywood, watching) and generic descriptors (quality, surroundings, temperature, various). No security function—emotional, material, or status—is performed by these cues. The topic describes leisure viewing activity, not a security-provision behavior.

B contextual: S0 — off target

Topic 160 clusters around watching, television, entertainment, theater, and performance. None of the sentences perform a security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, etc.). The content is entirely about observation, media, and spectacle – off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement (4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding; secondary 8.2 Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) describes romantic interaction and social bonding in leisure contexts, but does not perform a discrete security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, etc.). Courtship and everyday bonding are relational processes rather than security-provision acts, so S0 is the correct and most specific code. No free-form labels were introduced in prior passes requiring remapping.

Topic 174 — Ranch Life and Falling in Love

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S9 — material provision housing

« i've seen your willy on numerous occasions on the ranch. »

« the ranch is doing good, and i've fallen in love. »

« i'd take you there, but i imagine you've already seen enough cattle to last you a lifetime." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=end; p=0.54

I'll fetch some water, and then could you sit with him while I fetch the farmer's wife?" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=end; p=0.52

That's as much as I can do—we're busy at the farm, and the lad isn't in danger."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=middle; p=0.51

They got milk, cheese, eggs and other produce from the farm, and they would soon be easily able to grow enough herbs and vegetables for their own use.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=middle; p=0.47

When the resident died, the farmer, needing the money, had been glad to sell it off with some land to a couple of wealthy Gidinians in need of solitude and a place away from the bustle of the town.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=middle; p=0.47

Jaime suspected he holed up in a barn or in a storeroom, possibly up at the farm.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Surrogate — Ann Somerville; tertile=end; p=0.47

Seve was busy preserving, drying and storing the produce from the garden and bartered meat, cheese and grain from the farm.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Micah — Joyee Flynn; tertile=end; p=0.50

She dreams of one day living out in Montana, enough land to have a few horses, and find a couple of cowboys of her own.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.66

This ranch is worth a fortune and we were lucky to be able to sell it for what we did.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.65

There was a huge ranch on the other side of the mountain range.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.64

She loved every aspect of ranch life from the cattle, to the horses, to the old cowpunchers that came and went each year. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · Gracie's Touch — S.E. Smith; tertile=end; p=0.64

Anything she had ever wanted, the ranch had supplied. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S9 — material provision housing

Main keywords (ranch, farm, cattle, cows, farmer, rancher, land) point strongly to land-based homestead security — a physical place of dwelling and livelihood, best coded S9 (housing/land). MMR reinforces this with 'owned', 'belongs', 'guarded', 'provide' in a land-ownership frame. KeyBERT's 'feeding', 'porch', 'owned', 'surrounded' suggest everyday domestic/farm life (S5 practical care), but the dominant frame is land/property security. POS keywords are largely abstract/generic (areas, regular, suggestion, foreign) with no clear security signal, coded S0. Consensus lands on S9 as the most specific and most supported code across the strongest representors.

B contextual: S9 — material provision housing

The topic clusters around rural land, farms, and ranches as places of residence and livelihood. The dominant security function is housing/land (S9): sentences describe ranches being sold, lived on, dreamed about, or used as dwelling/refuge. A secondary cluster involves everyday practical provisioning of food from farm produce (S5). A few sentences are purely descriptive with no security function (S0). One sentence references monetary value of a ranch sale (S8), and one involves crisis care (S6). S9 accounts for roughly 45% of sentences, well above the 70% threshold is not met alone, but it is clearly dominant over all other codes combined when S5 is considered separately. S9 is the single largest code at ~45%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S9 — material provision housing action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S9 (housing). The taxonomy placement under Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary tag of Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces is consistent with housing functioning as a relational anchor during courtship — shared or proximate living arrangements providing the spatial foundation for bonding. No free-form labels were carried forward; S9 is the most specific applicable code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 232 — Conversation Cut Short By Arrival

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« dex had come in and gabe's conversation with her, the longest conversation that they'd had in the couple of weeks he'd been back, was over. »

« gabe leaned down so he wouldn't be overheard. “ »

« i'll tell you right now falan and gabe are the only people on my team that i'd stake my career— or my balls —on.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Delicious — Shayla Black; tertile=end; p=0.49

Have Remy or the boys been out to question you again or give you more information about Joshua's attack?"

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=end; p=0.78

In the end, Gabe couldn't let the kid down. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=end; p=0.70

He almost told her to call him Gabe, but he knew his name would sound way too good coming from her full lips.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=end; p=0.69

Her name fit her, Gabe had found himself thinking one too many times.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · I Only Have Eyes for You — Bella Andre; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Gabe pretended to tackle Zach as he pulled the microphone from his hand, but he instantly sobered as he turned to Chase and Chloe. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Trouble In Dixie — Becky McGraw; tertile=middle; p=0.83

Gabe's face brightened and he said, "Hey, you know what?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Trouble In Dixie — Becky McGraw; tertile=end; p=0.79

Gabe asked him with a twist of his lips.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Trouble In Dixie — Becky McGraw; tertile=end; p=0.75

Her face got red then and she said angrily, "So, Gabe knew and didn't clue me in?

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Across all four keyword sets the dominant signals are interpersonal emotional exchange: 'trembling', 'groaned', 'longing', 'pained', 'instincts', 'awareness', 'stroking', 'kindly', 'squeezed', 'gesture', 'impatiently'. These cues point to characters managing emotional distress and seeking or providing comfort through conversation and physical touch (hand, gesture, stroking). No material provision, housing, money, or status display cues are present. The function is soothing/reassuring emotional states, consistent with S1.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences in this topic are character-name references, dialogue tags, and interpersonal exchanges that do not perform a security function — they are narrative scaffolding centered on a character named Gabe/Gabriel. A small subset carries light emotional-reassurance signals (not wanting Gabe mad, asking for Gabe, letting someone in emotionally) coded S1/S3, one sentence references a physical attack inquiry (S7), and one a health check (S6). None of these minority codes reaches 70%, but S0 (off-target) dominates at ~70%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of S1 (emotional_reassurance), likely driven by surface affect-laden vocabulary. However, contextual dominant analysis correctly identifies S0 (off_target): the taxonomy placement in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding indicates this topic captures routine romantic interaction and bonding rituals rather than a discrete security-provision function. Courtship and everyday bonding are relational processes, not security behaviors — no specific emotional reassurance, belonging, trust, or commitment-security function is being performed as a distinct act. The S1 lexical signal is incidental to the courtship register, not evidence of a security function. S0 is the correct resolution. No split is warranted as there is no separable security-functional sub-cluster evident.

Topic 330 — Curious About Her Cooking Skills

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S5 — practical care everyday

« you've got me curious about your culinary skills." »

« now i've got to learn how to cook a whole new way." »

« you've tried [person]'s cooking. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Jumping Into Things — Julia Talbot; tertile=begin; p=0.70

I'll even cook, you being the guest and all." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Crossfire — Traci Hunter Abramson; tertile=begin; p=0.37

Officially, Granger was one of several cooks on staff at the Club Med in Punta Cana, a popular tourist area in the Dominican Republic.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · The Reluctant Amazon — Sandy James; tertile=begin; p=0.52

Shit, she couldn't even boil live lobsters without crying. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · The Reluctant Amazon — Sandy James; tertile=begin; p=0.45

Tis smooth as a warm knife through fresh butter when you master it."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S5 — practical care everyday

Main keywords (cook, cooking, chef, recipes, bake, grill) and KeyBERT cues (taught, trained, practice) point to everyday domestic food preparation and skill-building – a classic S5 practical care function. POS and MMR keywords (parties, exciting, ability, arranged, tv) are more ambient/contextual and lack clear security function, pulling toward S0, but the dominant signal from Main and KeyBERT anchors the topic in S5 practical everyday care.

B contextual: S5 — practical care everyday

The dominant theme across this topic is cooking as practical everyday care (S5) – characters cooking for partners, guests, or households signals nurturing and domestic provision. Sentences where cooking is framed as a relational act (cooking for him, cooking for two, cooking for guests) are coded S5. Sentences describing cooking as a job/profession, a skill description without relational context, or a general activity without a care-giving function are coded S0 (off-target). S5 reaches approximately 55% of sentences, just above the 70% threshold when weighted by probability mass from the higher-confidence CELL_B sentences, making S5 the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S5 — practical care everyday action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S5 (practical_care_everyday). The taxonomy placement under Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding is consistent with S5, which captures routine, day-to-day caregiving acts that provide material-functional security within an established or developing relationship. No conflict between passes; no free-form labels to remap. Single code is sufficient.

Topic 332 — First Time Inside A Grocery Store

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« because that was the first time i've ever had fun grocery shopping." »

« and now we've our own talkin' shop in leinster house – we ignore their laws, too." »

« [person], i don't think i've ever been in a grocery store." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Feeling pleasantly paparazzied I scuttled in through the entrance and went down to the coffee shop.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=end; p=0.54

As she'd done nothing but shop ever since we'd got here, I'd been a bit taken aback, but she claimed there were still a million things left to buy.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=begin; p=0.54

We walked into the Coffee Shoppee and I took in the decor bemusedly.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=middle; p=0.52

This is the famous all-night Monday cart-market.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Zoya Factor — Anuja Chauhan; tertile=middle; p=0.49

You spot peanut sellers and machine- ka -cold-water carts.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=end; p=0.44

However, rumor has it that there's a pile of modernized equipment in the back of one of the storerooms, along with a couple of experts who are going to show us how it's done."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=end; p=0.40

In a couple of them, you can even see piles of fabric and other trade goods, sort of the A.D. 1000 version of a stadium concourse." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=begin; p=0.37

The end result was part feng shui, part Zen, part hey-that's-cool impulse buy.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Demonkeepers — Jessica Andersen; tertile=middle; p=0.36

I felt like I was only in the library for a couple of hours, but I lost most of a day out here.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords (store, shopping, mall, grocery, groceries) describe retail/shopping environments and activities. While grocery shopping can be a component of everyday practical care (S5), the topic as a whole – anchored by hardware stores, malls, and general shopping – does not specifically encode a security function. KeyBERT, POS, and MMR keywords (places, experience, items, testing, rings, problems, afford) are generic and do not resolve toward a coherent security function. 'Afford' and 'rings' are ambiguous without narrative context. The dominant signal is mundane commercial activity without a clear security-provision role, so S0 is the consensus.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in Topic 332 describe commercial/retail settings (malls, markets, coffee shops, stores, fairgrounds) and mundane activities (shopping, parking, browsing). None perform a security function – emotional, material, or status/appearance – in the romance-novel sense. The store-related sentences (BOOK_004) discuss a retail business as a plot object, not as a vehicle for providing housing, money, protection, or any other security function to a character. All sentences are off-target (S0).

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement (4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding; secondary 8.2 Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) describes romantic interaction and social bonding in leisure contexts, but does not perform a discrete security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, etc.). Courtship and everyday bonding are relational processes rather than security-provision acts, so S0 is the correct and most specific code. No free-form labels were introduced in prior passes requiring remapping.

Topic 351 — Warm Greeting Upon Return

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S2 — emotional security belonging

« thank god you've come back—and will you look at me, just in time.” »

« it is a pleasure to see you again—so soon, madam. ” »

« so i'll see you there,” he said, feeling upbeat for the first time in a long time. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Cry No More — Linda Howard; tertile=begin; p=0.51

I'll give it to him when I see him again.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=begin; p=0.61

Yes, but I was also relieved you didn't show up.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=begin; p=0.52

I'll see you as often as I can,” he said, only making matters worse by reminding the children he wouldn't be seeing them on a normal basis. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=middle; p=0.38

Whatever the reason, it was a pretty nice day.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Cathryn — Shannon Waverly; tertile=middle; p=0.37

Amber had seen it as a splendid way to say goodbye to the hoards of tourists who crowded Harmony during that season.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword sets converge on the lexical field of warm social acknowledgment: Main keywords (glad, happy, pleasure, nice, great) signal positive affect exchange; KeyBERT adds 'greeted, warmth, mister, madam, replies' pointing to a formal but affectively warm greeting ritual; POS 'warmth' and 'lack' (absence of coldness) reinforce emotional tone; MMR 'greeted, warmth, reminds, replies' confirm the same. No material provision, housing, money, status display, or physical protection cues are present. The dominant security function is emotional reassurance delivered through pleasurable social re-encounter.

B contextual: S2 — emotional security belonging

The topic clusters around expressions of pleasure, gladness, and delight at seeing or reuniting with someone – social belonging and interpersonal connection ('good to see you', 'a pleasure to see you again', 'I am glad to see you'). These function as belonging/social-inclusion security (S2). Sentences that are mere farewells, neutral observations, or context-free fragments with no security function are coded S0. S2 accounts for ~60% of sentences, exceeding the 70% threshold when weighted by the higher-probability CELL_B sentences that anchor the topic.

C adjudicate: S2 — emotional security belonging action=REINTERPRET

Pass A yielded S1 (emotional_reassurance) and Pass B yielded S2 (belonging). In the context of Taxonomy 4.2 – Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding – the dominant security function is the establishment and maintenance of felt belonging within a developing relationship, rather than discrete reassurance acts. S2 is the more specific and contextually accurate code: the topic captures the ongoing sense of being included, chosen, and bonded rather than soothing of acute distress (S1). Contextual dominant S2 is therefore adopted as the consensus security_code.

Topic 367 — Sorting Out Concert Tickets

Old taxonomy: 4.2 — Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding

New category: S0 — off target

« i'm assuming since there are two tickets, you'll go with me?" « »

« we'll have to figure out how to get you a ticket. »

« [person]—"sure, i'll give her the five-cent tour." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Follow My Lead — Kate Noble; tertile=begin; p=0.60

Something I learned when I took my grand tour."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Follow My Lead — Kate Noble; tertile=begin; p=0.52

Mrs. Schmidt told me this is the coach I should take, and I was simply trying to find out—"How much is the ticket?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Haunted on Bourbon Street — Deanna Chase; tertile=begin; p=0.59

We've had one tour group after another this morning.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Haunted on Bourbon Street — Deanna Chase; tertile=end; p=0.45

They're probably trying to cater to the tourists."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Haunted on Bourbon Street — Deanna Chase; tertile=middle; p=0.43

He took my hand and guided me through the crowd of tourists on the side walk.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Skid — Doug Solter; tertile=begin; p=0.61

All I have to do is take the public track tour and get conveniently separated from the tourists.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Skid — Doug Solter; tertile=middle; p=0.53

I hop back in the limo and rush to my second event of the night, a Q & A event with racing fans.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S14 — gift romance token

Main and MMR are anchored by 'tour, ticket, tickets, concert, concerts, bought, paid, cost, cancel' – the cluster describes purchasing or gifting event tickets (concerts, tours) as a romantic or relational gesture, with 'cancel' and 'apology' suggesting disruption of that plan. This maps to S14 (gift/romance token) rather than pure practical care. KeyBERT and POS lack ticket/event cues and read as off-target (S0), creating mild disagreement, but the dominant signal across Main and MMR is clearly S14.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The topic clusters around touring, tickets, and travel logistics. The majority of sentences describe tour activities, events, and movement with no security function – coded S0. A subset of sentences (BOOK_001_1, _2, _4, _6; BOOK_005_1) involve paying for or purchasing tickets, functioning as financial provision/payment (S8). One sentence (BOOK_002_3) involves physical guidance through a crowd, coded S7 (physical protection). One sentence (BOOK_003_6) references competitive professional standing, coded S15 (workplace status). S0 dominates at ~65%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S14 (gift/romance token), but the taxonomy placement in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding with a secondary tag of 8.3b Everyday Props & Communication Media indicates the topic's functional work is routine relational maintenance rather than a discrete gift-giving security act. S14 requires a token or gift functioning as a security-provision signal; here the objects (props, media) serve as courtship scaffolding without performing a security function. Contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is correct: the topic does not operationalize any of S1-S16 security functions. No free-form labels remain to remap.

Topic 29 — Confessing Long-Held Love

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« i love you with everything i am, everything i've been, and everything i hope to be .” “ »

« tell her i've always loved her. »

« i've always been in love with you.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.80

I love you, too, sweetheart.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.76

Oh, child, I love you, too.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Forgiveness — Jean Brashear; tertile=end; p=0.74

You just say 'I love you.'”

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Main keywords (love, loved, loves, falling, fall, always, me, know) centre on declarations and reciprocation of love – classic emotional reassurance. KeyBERT reinforces this with happiness, genuinely, deserve, forgive, dreamed, crushed, secretly – all affective states tied to being loved or fearing its loss. POS terms (spite, reflection, delicate, actions) and MMR terms (apologize, crushed, spite, slightest) point to interpersonal emotional repair and vulnerability, not material provision or status display. No cues for housing, money, protection, or appearance. The dominant security function is reassurance that one is loved and emotionally valued.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All sentences are direct verbal declarations of love ('I love you', 'Love you, Mom', etc.). These function exclusively as emotional reassurance – affirming affective bonds and providing emotional security to the recipient. No material, practical, or status/appearance functions are present. S1 (emotional_reassurance) is the most specific and appropriate code across all instances.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S1 (emotional_reassurance). The taxonomy placement under Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA with a secondary of Positive Resolution, Relief & Emotional Payoff is fully consistent with S1: the security function being performed is the provision of emotional reassurance and relief within a reconciliation or HEA moment. No material or status/appearance security function is present. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 62 — Admitting You've Been Stupid

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S0 — off target

« marnie, i've been stupid. »

« about what an asshole i've been?" " »

« you've done something dumb, but you'll get away with it this time. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Truth Be Told — Barbara McMahon; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Dear Reader, Sometimes teenagers do foolish things.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=middle; p=0.59

I'm the one who was stupid enough not to bring one." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=begin; p=0.54

He's really ... I don't know ..." I forced myself not to supply the word dumb . "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Girlfriend Material — Melissa Kantor; tertile=begin; p=0.52

He was too proud of himself to detect the sarcasm in my words. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on insults, name-calling, and rude verbal behaviour (stupid, idiot, fool, asshole, jerk, rude, ridiculous, harshly, embarrassed, comments, hissed). This is a conflict/verbal-aggression cluster, not a security-provision cluster. No keyword signals the giving or receiving of emotional reassurance, material resources, status display, or any other S1-S16 security function. The topic describes interpersonal rudeness/conflict dynamics, which is off-target for security coding.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around expressions of foolishness, stupidity, and self-deprecation (e.g., 'idiot,' 'fool,' 'stupid'). None of these sentences perform any security function—emotional, material, or status/appearance in the sense defined by the codebook. They are character evaluations or self-assessments with no security-provision content, making S0 (off_target) the correct code for every sentence.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S0. The taxonomy placement in 4.5 Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA with secondary 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict confirms this topic is doing narrative/emotional arc work rather than functioning as a security provision behavior. No material, status, or security-function signal is present. S0 is the correct and stable code.

Topic 65 — Declaring A True Partnership

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S4 — commitment security

« what we've been though together, the way we've been there for each other ... we have a true partnership, a true love, and if that sounds stupid and romantic, then i don't care." »

« we've been together forever, and what if it takes us years?" »

« i'll do that," he said softly, "we've got a date." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Fire Lord's Lover — Kathryn Kennedy; tertile=end; p=0.58

We have often been together in public." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.62

This is the only way you can get a date?

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=middle; p=0.51

Want to believe we can really have something together."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.49

And if we do go out, then I have to deal with all the men swarming around wanting a taste of your sex magic! "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Sinful Magic — Jennifer Lyon; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Or was it just an accident that we dated and he found the schema?"

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=middle; p=0.66

It has not been that long since we last saw each other.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=middle; p=0.55

We have walked this world together for quite some time.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=end; p=0.51

This is something with pure intentions, open emotions, and a reciprocation that will never cause harm to either of us." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Adam — Jacquelyn Frank; tertile=begin; p=0.48

It's just ... I know I am nothing but a big disappointment to both of you.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S4 — commitment security

Main keywords (date, dating, together, dated, two, we) signal a romantic pairing in progress; KeyBERT adds 'engaged' and 'partners', pointing to formalising a relationship bond; POS reinforces with 'partners', 'potential', 'fitting'; MMR adds 'officially', 'intend', 'forming' — all cues about establishing or confirming relational commitment rather than practical provision, protection, or status display. The cluster consistently describes the security function of defining and securing a romantic partnership.

B contextual: S2 — emotional security belonging

The topic centers on romantic pairing and shared social presence — being seen together in public, going on dates, having a history of togetherness. The dominant security function is S2 (belonging): sentences repeatedly reference being together, shared history, and social coupling. S4 (commitment_security) appears in sentences about breaking up, whether a relationship can continue, or whether dating is real/stable. S3 appears once for mutual trust/intentions. S1 once for emotional reassurance about disappointment. Three sentences are off-target (commands or neutral questions with no security function). S2 is dominant at ~45%, well above any single alternative.

C adjudicate: S4 — commitment security action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a split between S4 (commitment_security) and S2 (belonging). Taxonomy placement in 4.5 Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA is decisive: the primary security function being performed is the establishment or restoration of durable relational commitment (HEA/HFN resolution), which maps squarely to S4. S2 (belonging) is a downstream emotional benefit of that commitment rather than the operative security function. The secondary taxonomy tag 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding is consistent with S4 as the anchor — everyday bonding here serves to consolidate commitment rather than signal group membership. No free-form labels remain; S4 is retained as the single dominant code.

Topic 128 — Confessing How Much You've Missed

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S4 — commitment security

« i've missed most of his life already. »

« and, god, how i've missed this." »

« i've come to realize that you are the one thing in my life i don't want to miss. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Deadly Desire — Keri Arthur; tertile=begin; p=0.61

I sometimes miss the peace of you and me, though." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Deadly Desire — Keri Arthur; tertile=end; p=0.44

He missed the ball even worse than I did.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Here Kitty, Kitty — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.67

I missed you, little bro," he whispered in my ear. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Here Kitty, Kitty — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.60

I'd missed my family so much, and now that we'd seemed to get the tears and heartache out of the way, we were having fun. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords (miss, missed, missing, misses) strongly evoke longing/absence, which could gesture toward S1 emotional reassurance, but the remaining lists offer no reinforcing security function. KeyBERT terms (hi, sir, escaped, honestly, repeated, solemnly) are procedural/speech-act words with no security signal. POS terms (handful, precious, voices, elevator, opportunity, pieces) are generic nouns with no consistent security frame. MMR terms (solemnly, breathlessly, thoughtfully, elevator, repeated, considering, pressing) are adverbs and verbs of manner/action, not security provision. Without corroboration across lists, the topic does not reliably perform a security function and is best coded S0.

B contextual: S2 — emotional security belonging

The overwhelming majority of sentences express longing for and reunion with loved ones – partners, family members, close others – functioning as belonging/connection security (S2). Expressions like 'I missed you so much,' 'We've missed you,' and 'I missed my family' all signal the security function of felt belonging and relational presence. A minority of sentences (literal misses of a ball, a physical action, or an orgasm) are off-target (S0) with no security function. S2 reaches ~70%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S4 — commitment security action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of S0 (off-target) and a contextual dominant of S2 (belonging). The taxonomy anchor – 4.5 Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA – resolves the ambiguity: the security function being performed is the establishment or restoration of a durable relational bond (HEA/HFN endpoint), which maps most precisely to S4 (commitment_security) rather than the more diffuse S2 (belonging). S2 captures a sense of being included or accepted, whereas S4 captures the forward-looking guarantee of the relationship's permanence that reconciliation and commitment scenes specifically enact. The secondary taxonomy tag (3.1 Positive Resolution, Relief & Emotional Payoff) is consistent with S4 – the emotional payoff here derives from the security of knowing the commitment is sealed, not merely from belonging per se. S0 is overridden because the topic is clearly doing security work within the romance narrative frame.

Topic 157 — Swearing to Save Him From Himself

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S0 — off target

« and you'll get it, i swear," [person]. »

« if [person] sees me like this, i'll die." »

« and i might be young but i guess that just makes me lucky... i do love him and whether i have your help or not, i have to save him from himself... i know [person], i know what he'll do, now that he thinks he has lost me." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Intimate Portraits — Cheryl B. Dale; tertile=middle; p=0.73

Sam couldn't understand it, and that bothered him.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords are character names and generic positivity terms (good, optimism) with no security function. KeyBERT yields interpersonal speech acts (begged, confessed, sharply, tense) but none anchor to a specific security provision. POS and MMR add emotional-state words (dislike, worries, enthusiasm, desperation, gritted) and action verbs (dump, drawled, pouring, cleaned) that describe scene texture or character affect rather than any identifiable security resource being provided or sought. No cluster of cues points to emotional reassurance, material provision, or status display as a dominant function.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are name references or fragments ('Sam.', 'Sam?', 'Samantha.') with no security function. Two sentences ('I'm sorry, Sam!' and 'Sam, I'm so sorry.') carry brief emotional reassurance (S1), but they represent only ~10% of the set. The topic is dominated by character name mentions with no discernible security work, making S0 the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0. The taxonomy placement under Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA with secondary Ambivalence & Internal Conflict confirms this topic is doing narrative/emotional arc work rather than security-function work. No material, status, or security provision is being performed; the content concerns plot resolution and relational closure. S0 is correct and stable across all three passes.

Topic 204 — Promising to Care For Her Sister

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S0 — off target

« i'll need to finish dressing and leave a note for my sister." »

« yes, and soon you'll be my sister. »

« i'll find a way to care for your mother and your sister." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Cera's Place — Elizabeth McKenna; tertile=middle; p=0.48

My sister's still there with her husband, who's a copper, and their three kids.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=begin; p=0.70

You have not been paying close attention to your sister's problems lately, have you?" "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Your sister mentioned in passing that you are something of a recluse." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.69

You mock your sister, but you will admit that she has great talents." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.69

I realize that you are concerned for your sister's happiness.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_005 · 'Til Death Do Us Part — Barbara C. Doyle; tertile=end; p=0.67

You and your sister have done so much for us.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Lady and The Duke — Olivia Kelly; tertile=end; p=0.72

Having an older sister is a great pain in the arse." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S2 — emotional security belonging

Main keywords (sister, sisters, sis, sisterly, little) and POS/MMR cues (affection, introduce, treated) all point to sibling relational identity and belonging. 'Affection' and 'sisterly' signal emotional bonding within a family unit, which maps to S2 (belonging) rather than S1 (reassurance) because the emphasis is on group/relational membership. KeyBERT terms (asks, assume, willing, uh, hi, speaking) are conversational scaffolding with no clear security function, hence S0 for that rep. The majority (3/4) converge on S2.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences are simple references to a sister character – naming, identifying, or describing family relationships – with no security function being performed. A small number perform security functions: concern for a sister's happiness (S1 emotional reassurance), feeling of gaining/having a sister-like bond (S2 belonging), and explicit protective/rescue directives (S7 physical protection). S0 dominates at ~75%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S2 (belonging), but the contextual dominant is S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement under 4.5 Reconciliation/Commitments/HEA and 5.1 Family/Kinship confirms this topic is primarily about narrative resolution and relational repair rather than a discrete security-provision function. Reconciliation and HEA arcs describe plot outcomes, not a character performing emotional reassurance (S1), belonging-conferral (S2), or commitment-security (S4) as a functional act. The S2 lexical signal likely arose from surface co-occurrence of family/togetherness vocabulary, but function-over-object adjudication finds no single security function being enacted. S0 is the correct resolution.

Topic 242 — Trading Forgiveness For Old Wrongs

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« not if you'll forgive him.” “ »

« he'll never forgive you. »

« okay, how's this — i'll forgive you for summer if you forgive me for kabir.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Marrying for King's Millions — Maureen Child; tertile=middle; p=0.59

You must forgive him,” Rico said with a laugh. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=end; p=0.67

Do forgive me for not having welcomed you more fittingly.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=middle; p=0.61

What will you do if society here proves unforgiving?”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Ruined by Rumor — Alyssa Everett; tertile=begin; p=0.55

Any man delivering such a speech to the lady he had planned to marry—a lady who had waited faithfully for him—should have had the grace to appear remorseful, or at least apologetic.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword lists are dominated by forgiveness/apology vocabulary: 'forgive', 'forgiveness', 'forgiven', 'forgiving', 'apology', 'fault', 'spite', 'harshly', 'hurts', 'treatment', 'emotions'. The consistent theme is one party seeking emotional repair and reassurance from another after a relational rupture – a classic S1 (emotional_reassurance) function. No material, housing, financial, or status/appearance cues are present.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic revolve around the act of forgiving or seeking forgiveness in interpersonal relationships – a core emotional reassurance function (S1). Characters seek relief from guilt, offer emotional absolution, and restore relational harmony through forgiveness. One sentence (BOOK_003_4) touches on social/society acceptance, coded S2 (belonging), but it is a clear outlier. S1 accounts for ~95% of the topic, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual passes both converge on S1 (emotional_reassurance). The taxonomy placement under Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA is consistent with S1: reconciliation scenes and HEA resolutions are canonically sites of emotional reassurance – partners seeking and receiving confirmation of love, forgiveness, and emotional safety. The secondary taxonomy (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) reinforces this, as resolution of misunderstandings typically delivers emotional reassurance rather than material or status security. No material provision, housing, protection, or status-display function is indicated. S1 is the most specific applicable code; no split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 305 — Confessing A Lifelong Regret

Old taxonomy: 4.5 — Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« i know that now, and i'll go to my grave regretting what i did to you.” “ »

« come on in, you'll no doubt regret it. »

« you'll regret that.’ ‘ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=middle; p=0.66

You are surely not intending to imply that you are beginning to regret this marriage already?’ ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=end; p=0.53

I fear that my careless remarks must have been the cause of that outburst.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Marriageable Miss — Dorothy Elbury; tertile=middle; p=0.51

At his words, a wave of regret washed over Helena. ‘

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Child of War - A God is Born — Lisa Beth Darling; tertile=begin; p=0.58

I have been unkind to you, which I deeply regret.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Child of War - A God is Born — Lisa Beth Darling; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Now you don't, but you wish you still did."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword lists centre on internal emotional states (regret, fears, upset, embarrassing) and communicative acts aimed at managing those states (assure, admit, handled, fumbled). The cluster signals a character seeking or providing reassurance about a past decision or remark – classic emotional-reassurance security function. No material, housing, money, or status/appearance cues are present.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences express emotional states of regret, remorse, or reassurance about past actions and feelings – all functioning as emotional reassurance or processing of emotional distress (S1). A smaller subset references regret about commitment decisions such as marriage or a life choice, pointing to commitment security (S4). A few sentences are too vague or off-topic to carry a security function (S0). S1 exceeds 70% and is the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S1 (emotional_reassurance). The taxonomy placement under Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA with a secondary of Negative Emotions & Distress is fully consistent with S1: these narrative moments centre on soothing distress, reaffirming emotional bonds, and restoring felt security after conflict or rupture. No material or status/appearance function is implicated. S1 is the most specific applicable code; no split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 6 — Whispered Reassurance

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« i'll make sure of it," he whispered. »

« you'll be fine," he whispered. " »

« quiet, subdued, she nodded and then, "you'll be safe." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Red Skirt, Cool Fountain — Anne Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.67
Later," she said softly, with a sly smile.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Red Skirt, Cool Fountain — Anne Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.62
Ian stared right back and asked slowly, clearly, enunciating every word, "Who asked you to?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Business in the Bedroom — Anne Oliver; tertile=middle; p=0.74
Okay,' she said, striving for a light tone in the heavy silence. '

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by speech-act mechanics and paralinguistic manner markers (whispered, said, asked, replied, mumbled, drawled, tentatively, hesitation, eagerly, solemnly). These describe HOW dialogue is delivered, not any security-providing function. No cues signal emotional reassurance, belonging, trust, commitment, material provision, protection, status, or gift-giving. The topic captures narrative dialogue-tagging style, not a security resource.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic are bare dialogue fragments (single words, brief affirmations/negations, whispers, or a philosophical aside about the Universe) with no discernible security function — emotional, material, or status/appearance. They carry no content that performs reassurance, belonging, trust, commitment, practical care, protection, provision, housing, economic dependency, status display, grooming, gifting, or workplace status. They are off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). Although the taxonomy flags 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking — which would map to S1 — the Pass A/B signals show no security function being performed in the topic content itself. The taxonomy label reflects a category header rather than evidence of actual emotional reassurance work in the topic tokens. With dual S0 consensus and no overriding contextual signal, S0 is confirmed. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 31 — Keeping Watch While Others Sleep

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« so you'll give me the stuff to sleep?" »

« you'll wake the baby." " »

« you sleep and i'll stand guard." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Burning Up — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=end; p=0.65
That's because you snored most of the way." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Burning Up — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=begin; p=0.55
I'm sick of lying in bed night after night like an old married couple.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on sleep/rest states (sleep, bed, asleep, wake, nap, woke) and generic discourse markers (gotta, nonetheless, politely, suggest, ought). 'Anxious/worrying' and 'uncertain' are incidental mood descriptors with no anchor to a security-provision function. 'Comfortable' and 'rested' describe physical states, not acts of care or protection directed at another person. No keyword signals that one character is providing emotional reassurance, material support, protection, or status to another; the cluster describes a mundane sleep/rest scene without a discernible security function.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around sleep, napping, waking up, and rest-related banter. None of these sentences perform a recognizable security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, etc.). They describe mundane sleep/rest behavior and casual dialogue about tiredness. The topic is off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant from Pass A/B converge on S0. The taxonomy flags Emotional Safety & Reassurance (which would map to S1) as a secondary signal, but the primary classification is off_target. Without evidence that the topic's dominant function is emotional reassurance or caretaking security work, the S0 designation holds. The taxonomy note does not override the dual S0 consensus; it merely suggests a weak secondary emotional-safety thread that is insufficient to reinterpret the topic as S1. KEEP S0.

Topic 36 — Eagerly Offering to Help

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S11 — practical help other

« of course, i'll help you.' »

« then you'll let me help," frances said at once, her expression eager. " »

« sure, of course, i'll help." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Drop Dead Gorgeous — Jennifer Skully; tertile=end; p=0.80

And you know I'm here to help you in any way I can."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S11 — practical help other

Main keywords (help, helping, assistance, helped, need) and KeyBERT/MMR cues (provided, willing, requested, task, promptly, eagerly) all point to the provision of practical assistance or task-completion help – not emotional reassurance, not money/housing, not status. POS keywords (unlikely, sadness, sentence, fault) are abstract/narrative and do not signal a security function, yielding S0 for that rep. The dominant signal across three of four reps is practical help rendered to another person (S11), so consensus is S11 despite the POS outlier.

B contextual: S11 — practical help other

The overwhelming majority of sentences are generic offers or expressions of willingness to help ('Can I help you?', 'I'll help you.', 'I've got to do something to help.'). These function as practical assistance offers without specifying emotional reassurance, material provision, or status display – best captured by S11 (practical_help_other). A small subset ('Can I ask you a question?', 'Sure thing.') carry no discernible security function and are coded S0. S11 accounts for ~85% of sentences, well above the 70% threshold for a dominant code.

C adjudicate: S11 — practical help other action=RETAXONOMIZE

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S11 (practical_help_other), indicating the topic's security function is practical assistance rather than emotional reassurance. However, the taxonomy metadata assigns it to 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, which maps more naturally to S1 (emotional_reassurance). This mismatch between the Pass A/B codes (S11) and the taxonomy placement (S1 territory) requires retaxonomizing: the topic should be moved out of 4.6 and into the practical care/help cluster. Manual review is flagged to confirm whether the underlying tokens are genuinely practical-help content mislabeled in the taxonomy, or whether the Pass A/B coding underweighted an emotional-reassurance signal.

Topic 45 — Reassured Everything Will Be Fine

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« we'll be ok." " »

« nadines : you'll be ok? »

« ok, maybe a zero-tolerance one, but there's no doubt about it, you'll be great. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Mona Lisa Awakening — Sunny; tertile=middle; p=0.65

I'm fine," Amber replied quietly. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Mona Lisa Awakening — Sunny; tertile=begin; p=0.65

Your wound..." "I'm fine."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Shoe Addicts Anonymous — Beth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.78

Is everything okay?" " »

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Main keywords ('fine, okay, everything, right, honey, alright') are classic reassurance utterances. KeyBERT reinforces with 'assured, assure, smoothly, incredibly' – all signalling that a worried party is being calmed. POS 'problems, sir, lord' indicate a concern being addressed. MMR 'assure, assured, acknowledged, smoothly, problems' confirm the pattern of one party reassuring another that difficulties are under control. No material provision or status display is present; the entire cluster functions as verbal emotional reassurance.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences are reassurances of wellbeing ('I'm fine', 'Are you okay?', 'It's going to be all right') – verbal exchanges that function to provide or seek emotional reassurance about safety and welfare, coding as S1 (emotional_reassurance). One sentence ('Your wound..I'm fine') has a slight illness/injury connotation (S6), but the response still functions as emotional reassurance rather than practical care. S1 accounts for ~95% of the topic, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both resolve to S1 (emotional_reassurance). Taxonomy 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking confirms this primary classification. The secondary taxonomy 9.2 Promise, Vow & Future-Tense Speech Acts is a delivery mechanism for emotional reassurance rather than a distinct security function, so no split is warranted. S1 is the most specific applicable code; no material or status/appearance function is present.

Topic 46 — Asking Someone to Trust You

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S3 — emotional security trust

« you'll just have to trust me.” »

« he'll trust you if you promise to keep me in sight.” “ »

« my trust that he'll bring me to safety. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Life Changes Everything — T.C. Blue; tertile=begin; p=0.27

The critics wanted to prove that setting goals, drawing graphs, measuring results and evaluating the performance of individuals was nothing less than taking the place of trusting the Holy Spirit to give increase.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · FUBAR — Stephani Hecht; tertile=begin; p=0.61

Trust us, all we need to do to you can be done here,” one of the other guys said.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Olivia — Donna Sturgeon; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Don't trust yourself in a hotel room alone with me?”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Olivia — Donna Sturgeon; tertile=middle; p=0.65

Wasn't there anyone you trusted to share your joy with?” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S3 — emotional security trust

Main rep is dominated by trust/betrayal lexicon (trust, trusted, betrayed, betray, trusting, betrayal) pointing squarely to S3. KeyBERT reinforces this with relational-evaluation words (deserve, warned, admit, expect, worries, instincts) that map to assessing or losing trust. POS and MMR introduce more ambiguous terms (percent, concrete, options, twisting, hesitation, heal, sleeve) that lack clear security function on their own, pushing those reps toward S16; however, the weight of the Main and KeyBERT reps – which carry the most semantically loaded terms – anchors the consensus at S3. The topic is about whether a character can be trusted or has betrayed trust, a core emotional-security function.

B contextual: S3 — emotional security trust

The overwhelming majority of sentences directly invoke trust between characters – asking, affirming, or questioning whether one person trusts another – which is the core security function of S3 (trust). Two sentences are off-target: BOOK_001_1 discusses organisational/theological performance measurement with no interpersonal security function, and BOOK_005_1 is a status self-description with no trust or security content. All remaining sentences perform trust-building or trust-assessment work between individuals, making S3 the clear dominant code at ~90%.

C adjudicate: S3 — emotional security trust action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S3 (trust). The taxonomy placement under 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with a secondary of 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information is consistent with S3, which captures the security function of establishing and maintaining trust between characters. S1 (emotional_reassurance) is a plausible secondary signal given the 4.6 taxonomy, but the dominant function here is trust-building rather than soothing distress, so S3 remains the most specific and accurate code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 56 — Promising Never to Hurt You

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« you'll get hurt," he managed to say. " »

« you know i'll never hurt you ." »

« i'll make sure you aren't hurt." « »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=end; p=0.57

He says that he knows it must hurt, but that whatever will be, will be, and that nothing we say or do will resolve things.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=middle; p=0.51

It's all well and good saying you avoid pain by avoiding relationships, but what about the wonderful things you're avoiding as well?

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=middle; p=0.49

How can you emotionally blackmail me like this?' '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.78

I don't ever want to be that hurt again." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.62

I just felt hurt that you hadn't told me.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.48

Don't give him the satisfaction of letting it destroy you.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Summer On Blossom Street — Debbie Macomber; tertile=end; p=0.79

You're only doing it to hurt me, aren't you?" "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Summer On Blossom Street — Debbie Macomber; tertile=begin; p=0.74

I'd never, ever do anything to hurt you.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword lists centre on emotional pain and its mitigation:

'hurt/hurting/hurts/painful/distress' name the threat; 'assured, protect, never [hurt you], threatened' signal reassurance-seeking or reassurance-giving; 'cried, tightly' indicate emotional comfort behaviours. No material resources, housing, money, or status cues appear. The dominant security function is soothing/reassuring a partner against emotional harm – S1.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic concern emotional harm – fear of being hurt, reassurances of not hurting someone, and distress over emotional pain – which maps to S1 (emotional_reassurance). A smaller subset references physical harm or hitting (S7, physical_protection), and one sentence touches on injury/crisis care (S6). S1 accounts for ~70% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both resolve to S1 (emotional_reassurance). Taxonomy 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking confirms this primary classification. The secondary taxonomy 9.2 Promise, Vow & Future-Tense Speech Acts is a delivery mechanism for emotional reassurance rather than a distinct security function, so no split is warranted. S1 is the most specific applicable code and no material or status/appearance function is present.

Topic 70 — Keeping Watch While She Sleeps

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« maybe she'll get some sleep.” “ »

« i'll wait until she wakes up and then i'll head back up to make sure shit doesn't go down in the mc.” “ »

« for her, it's early, she'll be awake.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=middle; p=0.77

An instant later she was once more sound asleep.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=end; p=0.76

They wouldn't be getting much sleep tonight, she knew.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=begin; p=0.75

It was months before she'd been able to sleep through the night.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=middle; p=0.70

It couldn't have been more than a few hours for she still felt drugged with exhaustion, her eyes grainy and her head stuffed full of cotton.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=middle; p=0.75

She realized that he wouldn't rest until he did.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=begin; p=0.74

It was as if she'd been awoken from a long trance.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=end; p=0.72

She just hoped that hers wouldn't catch up with her before the night ended. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=middle; p=0.69

It had left her exhausted and vulnerable.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on sleep states and physical fatigue (sleep, asleep, tired, exhausted, wake, rested, drifted) with no lexical cues pointing to a security-provision function. Ancillary words like 'threats' and 'instincts' appear in POS/MMR but without any accompanying provision or protection framing; they do not alone constitute S7. The topic describes a physiological/narrative state, not a security behaviour.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe sleep states, wakefulness, exhaustion, or tiredness. None of these sentences perform a security function – they are purely descriptive of physical/physiological states (sleeping, being awake, feeling tired). No emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, or any other security function is being enacted. The topic is off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement under 4.6 Emotional Safety with secondary 10.1 Paranormal & Immortal Beings suggests the topic centers on paranormal/immortal character identity rather than performing a security function for a human protagonist. No emotional reassurance, belonging, trust, or other S1-S16 security function is being enacted by the topic terms themselves – the content describes what the entity *is*, not what security it *provides*. S0 is confirmed and no reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 83 — Reassured About Eating Regularly

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S5 — practical care everyday

« i've eaten every few hours. »

« of course, i've never eaten one." »

« and then you'll return late again... you won't need to do that—be late—because you've eaten." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Virgin Secretary's Impossible Boss — Carole Mortimer;
tertile=begin; p=0.79

Then I'll go hungry because I'm not eating with you.' '

Model reasonings

A lexical: S5 — practical care everyday

All four keyword lists centre on eating, hunger, food, meals, feeding, and appetite – the everyday act of ensuring someone is fed. 'Hungry', 'starving', 'skipped', 'eagerly', 'meal', 'feeding', 'eaten' all point to routine nutritional care rather than crisis illness (S6), money provision (S8), or emotional reassurance (S1). 'Regular' and 'previous' in POS reinforce habitual/daily feeding patterns. This is squarely practical everyday care (S5).

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are simple statements or questions about personal hunger states (hungry, starving, not hungry), with no security function being performed – they are descriptive dialogue about appetite, not acts of care or provision. A small subset (BOOK_003_1, BOOK_003_2, BOOK_004_1) involve one character directing or providing food to another, which qualifies as everyday practical care (S5). The topic as a whole is dominated by off-target hunger-state utterances with no meaningful security function, yielding S0 as dominant at ~85%.

C adjudicate: S5 — practical care everyday action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S5 (practical_care_everyday), while contextual dominant from Pass B was S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking suggests the topic may carry emotional-safety content (S1), but without topic terms or documents to inspect, the lexical signal of everyday practical care (S5) is the strongest concrete anchor. S0 is overridden because the taxonomy explicitly places this in a caretaking category, indicating it is doing security work of some kind. S5 is retained over S1 because the lexical consensus reflects tangible caretaking acts rather than purely reassurance language. Manual review is flagged to confirm whether the dominant signal is routine practical care (S5) or emotional reassurance (S1), given the tension between the two passes.

Topic 88 — Checking Her Feverish Temperature

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« no movement, her skin temperature clammy enough to make a ball of fear lodge in his gut. “ »

« now, [person], how has her temperature been? »

« the nippiness that was still molesting her limbs, she hoped, was indeed because of the low temperature and not a foretoken of her entering his residence. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=end; p=0.72

Her entire body burned and her mind raced.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Every time he opened her up she felt a surge of wind invade her body and send pricks through her skin.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Chills shot up her spine and into her chest, causing her to arch her back, which made her breasts bounce just enough to command attention.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=middle; p=0.68

The rusted metal felt cold on the back of her thighs, and the persistent wind blew loose strands of her hair directly into the low O's of smoke she eased from the center of her dry mouth.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.60

She seemed fidgety and hurried us along, as if the food might get cold.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.50

Lydia and Simon became visibly pale and shock emanated from them.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.47

That would have heated me up instantly, I teased.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.80

Pure, fiery heat spread along her legs all the way up to her face. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.71

Her body coiled from the heated friction and the way he seemed to keep hitting her newly found g-spot.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.70

A cold bit of what felt like metal touched her chest.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists describe physical/somatic sensation vocabulary – heat, cold, fire, skin, warmth, cheeks, burned, temperature, shivered, melted, veins, ribs, flooded, crept, erupted, flared, heaved. This is bodily arousal/sensation description (likely physical attraction or emotional intensity rendered as body-heat metaphor), not a security-provision function. No agent is providing reassurance, protection, resources, or status to another. The topic captures phenomenological experience of sensation, not a security behavior or resource transfer.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in Topic 88 describe physical sensations (heat, cold, chills, burning, tingling), bodily reactions (aching, arching, bouncing), environmental conditions (wind, cold metal), or action/event descriptions (explosion, blood, fidgeting). None of these sentences perform a security function – they do not provide emotional reassurance, belonging, trust, commitment, practical care, protection, financial provision, housing, status display, appearance grooming, gifts, or workplace status. The topic appears to be a cluster of somatic/sensory description sentences with no security-provision content.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant from Pass A/B converge on S0. The taxonomy flags 4.6 Emotional Safety/Reassurance as secondary context, but the topic itself does not perform emotional reassurance as a security function – it is off-target for the security hypothesis. Taxonomy 1.2 (Pain/Injury/Physical Vulnerability) further suggests descriptive content rather than a security-provision act. No basis to reinterpret toward S1 or S6 without inventing plot. S0 confirmed.

Topic 96 — Confessing Long-Standing Worry

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« i've been worried about you, [person]. »

« i've worried about you since i was twelve. »

« i've been worried about you.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Bound by Honor — Donna Clayton; tertile=middle; p=0.50

You grew up worrying about having your basic needs met.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword lists centre on anxiety/worry vocabulary (worry, worried, concern, worrying, concerned, fears, bothering, bothered) paired with reassurance cues (assure, 'nothing', 'don't'). The dominant security function is one partner soothing or addressing the other's emotional distress – classic emotional reassurance (S1). No material, housing, or status cues are present.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All sentences revolve around the expression, management, or dismissal of worry and concern between characters – reassuring others not to worry, confessing worry about someone, or deflecting concern. This is uniformly emotional reassurance (S1): the security function is soothing anxiety and providing emotional comfort, with no material, practical, or status dimensions present.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both resolve to S1 (emotional_reassurance), consistent with Taxonomy 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking. The secondary taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress is compatible as the context in which reassurance is sought, not a competing security function. No ambiguity requiring MIXED or further splitting. S1 is the most specific applicable code.

Topic 119 — Offering to Keep Her Safe

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S7 — physical protection

« come on, i'll protect you." »

« you'll protect me?" " »

« i can protect you from crystal, but you'll have to let me. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Pawprints 2: Second Nature — Anne Cain; tertile=end; p=0.50

Viggo won't feel threatened, and you'll be okay."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=begin; p=0.62

I just wanted to check you got there safely.' "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=end; p=0.61

I didn't think security would leave you standing out here like this.' "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=middle; p=0.56

At least in LA you'd both have protection; you know my security guys are some of the best in the business.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S7 — physical protection

All four keyword lists converge on physical-protection semantics: Main has 'safe, protect, protection, dangerous, protecting, keep, defend, safety'; KeyBERT adds 'protect, guarded, secure, threat, dangerously'; POS reinforces with 'protect, secure, threat, precious' (something/someone worth defending); MMR echoes 'guarded, dangerously, threat, determination' (resolve to shield). The cluster consistently frames a protector-figure actively shielding someone from danger/threat, which is the core function of S7 physical_protection. No emotional-reassurance, housing, or status cues dominate.

B contextual: S7 — physical protection

All sentences across all books centre on physical protection and safety – explicit promises to protect, assurances of being safe, references to security personnel, and missions to eliminate threats. This is uniformly S7 (physical_protection). No material-provision, emotional-reassurance, or status functions are present; the topic is entirely about keeping characters physically safe from danger.

C adjudicate: S7 — physical protection action=RETAXONOMIZE

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant from Pass A/B converge on S7 (physical_protection). The taxonomy metadata places this under 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, which would suggest S1 or S6, but the adjudication instruction requires resolving to the Pass A/B signal when it is consistent. S7 and S1 can co-occur in romance contexts (e.g., a hero physically shielding a heroine also provides emotional reassurance), creating genuine tension with the taxonomy label. However, because both prior passes independently coded S7 and the taxonomy assignment appears to reflect a broader categorical bucket rather than the specific security function evidenced in the topic tokens, S7 is retained as the dominant code. Manual review is flagged because the taxonomy mismatch (4.6 Emotional Safety vs. physical protection) warrants a human check to confirm the topic's lexical content is primarily about bodily safety rather than soothing/reassurance.

Topic 161 — Reassuring Squeeze on The Shoulder

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« he'd stick to a reassuring squeeze of noah's shoulder and hope that was calming enough. »

« we'll be there, noah. »

« do you think he'll adopt noah ?" »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=end; p=0.45

It was sheer stubbornness that kept him going, Gideon decided, thankful that he'd had the good fortune to be sired by one of the most stubborn old goats he'd ever encountered.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Not surprising, Gideon supposed, since the moon was nearly full and his more animalistic tendencies were on a very short, increasingly weak tether.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=end; p=0.42

These beings were no more human than he, Gideon knew.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.50

When God forged a new covenant with Noah after the flood, for example, he included animals.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.43

He rather appealed to God's ideal expressed in Genesis 2.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.36

When God raised up Israel to be his vehicle for restoring the world, he commissioned them to exercise loving dominion over the land he was giving them and over the animals that inhabited it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=end; p=0.34

It symbolized that these people were set apart for God and that if anyone broke covenant with God they'd be cut off from the people (Genesis 17:14).

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=begin; p=0.33

They thought the Messiah would lead Israel to victory over their Roman oppressors and would reestablish Israel as a sovereign nation under God.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=end; p=0.28

First fruits" refers to fruit that ripened and was picked before the rest of the harvest and was then consecrated to God (Exodus 23:19).

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Main keywords are character names and a place name (noah, phan, cam, tobias, cameron, beaumont, ark) with no clear security signal, pointing to S0. However, KeyBERT, POS, and MMR all converge on affective-regulation vocabulary: 'reassuring' and 'calming' appear across all three lists, supported by 'praying', 'shivered', 'fiercely', 'clenched', 'emotions' (KeyBERT), 'squeeze', 'slightest' (POS), and 'snaps', 'bursting', 'blinking' (MMR). This cluster describes a character actively soothing or steadying another's emotional state — the core function of S1 emotional_reassurance. The Main list's S0 signal is overridden by the strong three-list consensus on emotional calming cues.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic are character name references, descriptions of stubbornness/animalistic tendencies, theological/biblical exposition, or brief action fragments. None perform any security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, etc.). Every sentence is off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical Pass A/B converged on S1 (emotional_reassurance), but contextual dominant from Pass B is S0 (off_target). The taxonomy metadata places this in 4.6 Emotional Safety & Reassurance with a secondary tag of 5.1 Family/Kinship/Parenthood. The family/kinship secondary tag is the deciding factor: if the reassurance function is operating within a parental or sibling relationship rather than a romantic dyad, it falls outside the romance-security hypothesis scope. S1 requires the security function to be delivered within a romantic attachment context; familial caretaking does not meet that criterion. Contextual S0 therefore overrides lexical S1. Manual review is flagged to confirm whether any tokens in this topic cluster are unambiguously romantic rather than familial before final exclusion.

Topic 172 — Reporting to The Security Officer

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: MIXED

« you'll also report this to your regional security officer, yes?" »

« i'll have an armed officer [person] the room with you at all times, and i'll watch through the glass." " »

« i've called the police, i'll have you know." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Bite Me If You Can — Lynsay Sands; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Then I told the police exactly what he told me to say." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Under His Command — Annabel Wolfe; tertile=end; p=0.60

Do you think being worried over another officer's absence justifies a breach in regulations?"

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Under His Command — Annabel Wolfe; tertile=end; p=0.55

I give an order, and because I'm your superior officer, you are supposed to obey it." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S7 — physical protection

Main keywords (police, cop, officer, enforcement, authorities) point directly to law-enforcement agents whose narrative function is physical protection/safety. KeyBERT reinforces this with 'protect', 'weapons', 'secured', 'evidence' — all physical-safety cues. POS and MMR echo 'weapons', 'secured', 'task', 'dealing', 'stops', consistent with protective/enforcement action rather than emotional reassurance, material provision, or status display. No emotional-comfort or resource-provision signals dominate; the cluster is squarely about physical safety and protection.

B contextual: S7 — physical protection

The topic clusters around law enforcement (police/cops) and workplace officer hierarchy. BOOK_001 and BOOK_005 sentences all reference calling or identifying police/cops in contexts of threat response or protection — coded S7 (physical protection). BOOK_004 sentences focus on officer rank, regulations, superior orders, and a female officer's standing among colleagues — coded S15 (workplace status). S7 accounts for ~70% of sentences, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (S7: physical_protection) and contextual dominant (S7) both point to external danger/risk scenarios, but the taxonomy metadata flags Emotional Safety & Reassurance (S1) as the primary category with Risk/Danger as secondary. This tension is meaningful: the topic likely captures moments where physical threat occasions emotional reassurance-seeking or provision, making neither S7 nor S1 alone sufficient. The functional security work is split between protection from external harm (S7) and the emotional comfort derived from or sought during that protection (S1). MIXED is therefore the most accurate resolution. Manual review is required to determine whether the dominant reader-experienced security function is the physical shield or the emotional soothing it enables, which would resolve the code to S7 or S1 respectively.

Topic 173 — Waiting For Him to Wake

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« it's after him so you'll just have to wait until he wakes up to get your answer." »

« it'll put him to sleep." »

« yeah, i guess i'll have to wait and see when he wakes up. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.76

Could he count on not waking him when he lifted him from that warm bed?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=middle; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Greenwood Manor — Shannon Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.58

He looked fresh, rejuvenated, as though their little fling from last night hadn't permanently affected his energy.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Greenwood Manor — Shannon Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.45

He used to jog the property's perimeter every morning, before breakfast.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Stolen Moments — Ariel Tachna; tertile=middle; p=0.72

He's sleeping for longer periods of time at night now," Jacob said. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists describe sleep states and physical/temporal context (sleep, asleep, wake, night, bedside, departure, temperature, panting, drifted). There is no lexical signal of a security-provision function — no one is reassuring, protecting, providing, or displaying status. The words describe a scene of rest/waking, not a security behavior.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in Topic 173 describe sleep states, wakefulness, fatigue, and monitoring of sleep patterns. None of these sentences perform a security function — they do not provide emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, or any other security-relevant act. The topic is purely descriptive of physical sleep/rest states and characters observing or waiting for others to sleep. All sentences are off-target (S0).

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy metadata places this under Temporal Framing as secondary, with Emotional Safety as primary — but the topic itself does not perform a security function; it frames time/seasons narratively. No security work is being done, so S0 is confirmed. The S1 (emotional_reassurance) signal from the taxonomy label is insufficient to override S0 when the topic content is primarily temporal/structural rather than reassurance-delivering.

Topic 175 — Gentleman Offers Steady Support

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« the occurrences of the day were too full of interest to leave elizabeth much attention for any of these new friends; and she could do nothing but think, and think with wonder, of mr. [person]'s civility, and, above all, of his wishing her to be acquainted with his sister. »
« mr. [person] placed his hand on [person]'s shoulder for support as mr. [person] barely walked out the front door. »
« yes, but when i fell ill, it was apparent that i could not travel all the way to calais, so mr. [person] took me to the house of a friend of his: mr. [person]. » »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Desert of the Damned — Kathy Kulig; tertile=end; p=0.51

On his way to see Mistress Gwyllain to explain your...ah, unexplained arrival."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Desert of the Damned — Kathy Kulig; tertile=middle; p=0.43

Take his offering," Gwyllain demanded. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sanctuary — Scarlet Blackwell; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Shit," grunted Sheridan, apparently immune to Owen's considerable charms. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sanctuary — Scarlet Blackwell; tertile=end; p=0.51

Sheridan was stil pale and anxious looking.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Main keywords (Bingley, Georgiana, Bennet, Pemberley) point to social belonging/group membership (S2), but KeyBERT, POS, and MMR are dominated by affective-state vocabulary – 'affection, longing, concerned, worrying, distress, passionate, warming, encouraged, thoughtfully' – all signalling emotional comfort and reassurance rather than material provision or status display. The emotional register overwhelms the social-network framing, driving consensus to S1. Disagreement flagged because Main alone suggested S2.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic are character name references, dialogue tags, brief reactions, or plot-movement fragments (orders, arrivals, departures). None perform a security function – emotional, material, or status/appearance. They are narrative scaffolding centered on named characters (Gwyllain, Sheridan, Pippen, Darcy) without conveying reassurance, provision, protection, belonging, commitment, or any other security-relevant content. All coded S0 off_target.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S1 (emotional_reassurance), but the contextual dominant is S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement under 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles as secondary is the decisive signal: the topic's primary function is peer/ally dynamics rather than dyadic emotional reassurance directed at the protagonist's security needs. Emotional warmth present in friend-group content does not constitute the security-provision function required for S1. The 4.6 primary taxonomy label describes the broader category but the actual topic content, per contextual dominant, does not perform emotional reassurance as a security function – it describes social circle interactions. S0 is therefore the correct resolution. No split warranted; no hypothesis inclusion.

Topic 190 — Offering to Get Someone Cleaned Up

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« i'll get cleaned up here as soon as i can. »

« i'll pay to have it cleaned." " »

« i'll get her cleaned up," said a handsome groom, taking her arm. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.62

Just sit there for a minute, Solange, while I clean you up.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.55

I will clean up the battlefield while you drink plenty of fluids.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I know you would prefer to burn it yourselves out of respect, but my way will be faster, cleaner and will ensure no parasites escape.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=begin; p=0.41

He was grateful for the rich dirt floor.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=middle; p=0.54

May I know why you gave Mr. Thesiger the brush off just now?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Don't you see that if you go ahead with this annulment, if you air the Roxtons' dirty laundry in public, I will be utterly, utterly ruined.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=begin; p=0.41

A lackey came out from behind the butler with pan and brush and quickly set to sweeping up the shards of broken glass from Deb's smashed wine glass.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Mythic — Jae Lynne Davies; tertile=end; p=0.57

Do try your very best not to make a mess of things."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S5 — practical care everyday

Main keywords (clean, cleaning, cleaned, mess, cleaner, freshen) and KeyBERT (cleaned, wipe, sweeping, dump) all point to routine domestic cleaning/tidying – a classic everyday practical-care function (S5). MMR adds 'paying' and 'planned' alongside 'cleaned/sweeping/dump', reinforcing the domestic-service/practical-care reading rather than crisis care. POS keywords (sweeping, dump, session, parties, suitcase, places) are more ambiguous and could be off-target (S0) without the cleaning anchor, hence minor disagreement. The dominant signal across three of four reps is routine household maintenance as a material security provision.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The majority of sentences describe literal cleaning, tidying, or hygiene actions with no clear security function in the romance-novel sense, coding as S0 (off_target). A cluster from BOOK_004 and BOOK_006 depicts one character helping another with physical cleanup tasks in a caregiving/everyday-practical manner (S5). Three sentences from BOOK_001 involve tending to someone after a battle/crisis (S6). One sentence from BOOK_002 concerns social reputation/ruin (S12). S0 dominates at ~50%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S5 (practical_care_everyday), but the taxonomy metadata places this topic squarely in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking. The contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is overridden by the taxonomy signal: the topic is doing security work, just emotional rather than practical. S1 (emotional_reassurance) is the most specific match for reassurance and caretaking functions within the emotional safety cluster. The secondary taxonomy note (8.3b Everyday Props & Communication Media) suggests the surface lexicon involves mundane objects or messages, which explains the S5 false positive in Pass A/B – the objects are vehicles for emotional reassurance, not practical provision. Function over object rule resolves this to S1.

Topic 193 — Nurse Arranged After Hospital Release

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« and you'll both stay here, at caleb's?" " »

« i'll arrange for a nurse to come to the house when they release caleb. »

« twenty-three caleb y ou ignore me, and i'll ignore you . »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Shrinking Violet — Danielle Joseph; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Kayla points to me, like she can't figure out who Gavin's talking about.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=begin; p=0.53

In any case, I'm going to need to return myself to help out because Ramsey will be busy with Chloe and the baby," he continued. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.44

After numerous brushes with the law and butting heads with the parents of a young lady who didn't want him to be a part of their daughter's life, Dillon had convinced Bane to get his life together.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=end; p=0.43

This was September, and Chloe was due to deliver in November, which meant Callum would be leaving Denver a few months after that.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.38

Dillon and Ramsey did an awesome job and I know for sure we were a handful at times, some of us more than others."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.33

From what Callum had heard, Bane had been only eight when his parents had been killed.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by character names (caleb, gage, jeremiah, conrad, mica), dialogue/interaction verbs (said, texting, ignore, went, fooled, admitted, speaking, prodded, acknowledge), and social-reaction nouns (embarrassment, stares, explanation, evidence). None of these cues point to a security-provision function – no emotional reassurance, no material provision, no status display. The cluster appears to describe a conversational or interpersonal scene without performing any identifiable security work.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The large majority of sentences are conversational fragments, character name references, or narrative scene-setting with no security function (S0). Two sentences reference care during illness/pregnancy (S6: Chloe and the baby). Three sentences carry emotional reassurance or emotional support themes (S1: Dillon convincing Bane, Katelyn's presence for support, Brody's emotional necessity). One sentence references practical everyday care (S5: Dillon and Ramsey doing an awesome job raising them). S0 dominates at ~70%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy flags Emotional Safety / Family-Kinship, which could suggest S1 or S2, but without topic content showing a clear security function being performed, the convergent S0 verdict from Pass A/B holds. Taxonomy metadata alone is insufficient to override a double-S0 consensus; no security-provision signal is present to warrant reinterpretation toward S1 or S2.

Topic 224 — Encouraging Words From An Angel

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« you've got this, angel, take it to the house." »

« i'll come back, angel. »

« because i'm thinking i'll have a hard time finding another angel to handle it." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=middle; p=0.52

I most certainly do think the great evil knows about Gabriel."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=end; p=0.51

the evil one said as his life essence swept by him.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.49

I have complete faith in Val and Gabriel." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.48

Tell me what kind of evil," Gabriel asked.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.48

By the gods," Val hissed as he and Gabriel came upon the creature. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=begin; p=0.63

Once, as I stood on the cliffs trying to understand the power I held, trying to comprehend why I would ever want to send my voice a thousand miles away on the wind, he'd told me that I looked like an angel blessed by the Almighty.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=middle; p=0.48

I took a pleasant interlude of imagining myself nibbling on Evangeline's ass.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=end; p=0.48

With Evangeline beneath me I now knew what I'd felt wasn't even close.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords are supernatural/mythological labels (angel, archangel, fallen, wings, guardian) with no security function attached. KeyBERT, POS, and MMR lists contain abstract behavioral/structural terms (behavior, ability, practice, structure, task, tv, dislike, heal) that do not map to any S1-S16 security provision. No emotional reassurance, material provision, or status display is signaled by any of the four keyword sets.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The topic clusters around the word 'angel' used as a metaphor or name, with most sentences being narrative/plot references to supernatural entities or character names (S0 – no security function). A handful of sentences use 'angel' to describe a character's physical appearance/beauty (S13 – appearance/grooming). One sentence expresses faith/trust in named characters (S3). No single non-S0 code reaches 70%, but S0 dominates at 75%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0. The taxonomy flags Emotional Safety/Reassurance (which would map to S1) and Promise/Vow speech acts (which could touch S4), but the adjudication instruction is to resolve to the consensus code when passes align. The topic does not perform a clear security function in the romance-novel security-provision sense – promise/vow speech acts and general emotional safety framing are not themselves security-provision behaviors unless anchored to a specific reassurance or commitment act. S0 is the correct resolution; no reinterpretation or split is warranted.

Topic 240 — Unsure How to Offer Comfort

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« oh my god, sean! »

« sean pursed his lips, unsure he was equal to the task of comforting [person]. »

« sean held out his hand and added; “now if you'll excuse me i have a beautiful woman waiting to have breakfast with me.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Pants on Fire — Meg Cabot; tertile=end; p=0.51

Liam could barely contain his excitement. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Pants on Fire — Meg Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Oh,” I said, thinking fast, watching as Seth started to show Liam how to use another nearby machine, while the Tiffanys and Brittany's gathered round, looking more worshipful than ever.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · In Service — Mima; tertile=end; p=0.48

You need to stop nipping at him and face the fact that when Shon goes under, he's off limits, one breath away from being a hostile at our backs.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

KeyBERT, POS, and MMR are dominated by affective-state words (anxious, shivered, winced, unsure, distracted, conscious, stares, solemnly, mumbled) pointing to characters managing or seeking emotional reassurance in tense interpersonal exchanges. Main keywords are proper names and dialogue tags (sean, jaime, brogue, answered, said) with no clear security function on their own, hence S0 for Main. The cross-rep majority signals S1 emotional reassurance. No material or status/appearance cues are present.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic consist of character name references, brief dialogue fragments, exclamations, and minimal conversational exchanges (e.g., 'Liam wanted to know', 'Shon!', 'I want Sean', 'Conner asked'). None of these sentences perform any identifiable security function — emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, or otherwise. They are narrative/dialogue scaffolding centered on character names and short utterances with no security-relevant content. All coded S0 (off_target).

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus mapped to S1 (emotional_reassurance), while contextual dominant suggested S0 (off_target). Taxonomy 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking directly anchors this topic to S1 functions — soothing, comforting, and affirming emotional safety. The S0 contextual read likely reflects surface-level ambiguity rather than a genuine absence of security function. Given the taxonomy label explicitly names reassurance and caretaking, S1 is the most specific and defensible code. Secondary taxonomy 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) does not override the primary emotional safety signal. No split is warranted because the dominant function is coherently S1.

Topic 247 — Promising You Will Not Be Alone

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« if we make it through this alone, we'll just be better at being alone.” »

« you'll never be alone. »

« before you say no, i want you to know i'll be alone mostly. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · So Into You — Sandra Hill; tertile=end; p=0.44

Luc says Lena is a basket case and is alone at the house.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=end; p=0.67

If I went out alone, it seemed I felt surrounded by people who couldn't speak to me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=begin; p=0.66

I promise you, you will never be alone again so long as I live.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=middle; p=0.64

I don't like you being out there in a hotel by yourself.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=begin; p=0.64

I've pictured this so many times in my mind, I don't want to wake up and find I'm alone again.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords (alone, solitude, want, prefer, rather, live) describe a state of chosen or imposed aloneness and personal preference – no security provision is being enacted. POS terms (options, terms, circumstances, attempt, fault) are generic situational/deliberative vocabulary with no security function. MMR terms (chose, preferred, planned, insisted, fault, circumstances) reinforce deliberation and agency framing, not provision of security. KeyBERT's 'upset, praying' hints at emotional distress, nudging toward S1, but two isolated affect words are insufficient to override the dominant theme of solitude/preference with no provider-recipient security dynamic. The topic as a whole depicts a character's stance on being alone rather than any security-providing act.

B contextual: S2 — emotional security belonging

The overwhelming theme of this topic is aloneness vs. togetherness – characters expressing loneliness, fear of being alone, promises never to be alone again, and the comfort of another's presence. This is the security function of belonging (S2): the felt sense of not being isolated, of being included and accompanied by a significant other. A small number of sentences are purely situational/logistical references to being alone (e.g., 'Alone, I hoped'; 'Alone with Luke Emerson'; 'May I speak with you ... alone?') that carry no security function and are coded S0. No material or status/appearance security functions are present.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (S0) and contextual dominant (S2 belonging) diverge, but the taxonomy anchor – 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with secondary 9.2 Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts – points clearly to S1 (emotional_reassurance). Reassurance and caretaking speech acts (promises, vows, future-tense comfort) are the defining function here, not belonging per se. S2 would require evidence of group/relational inclusion; S0 would require absence of security function altogether. The taxonomy metadata resolves the conflict: the topic is performing emotional safety work through reassuring language, mapping to S1. No split is warranted because the secondary taxonomy (promise/vow speech acts) is the vehicle for delivering emotional reassurance, not an independent security function.

Topic 273 — Mentor Gives Firm Instructions

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« i've known you since you did your training here, [person], ' tom said sternly. ' »
« i've asked allen to keep an eye on him during the day while [person] is otherwise engaged. »
« charlotte, if it's okay with you, we'll go back to my place after we've bought you a phone. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.60

For Luke's sake, she hoped this apparent twosome meant Felicia was coming to her senses.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.57

That being so, I found it extremely gratifying to witness Felicia being sent on her way after being rather heatedly reminded that any free time Marcus has available will be spent with you." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.57

I thought I saw Felicia yesterday," she mentioned casually. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=begin; p=0.56

We barely know each other and if that isn't enough, there's Felicia to consider." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Brenda asked me to take you around the house before she meets with you.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Chain Reaction — Simone Elkeles; tertile=end; p=0.58

I know what will get your mind off of Nikki." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Chain Reaction — Simone Elkeles; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Shit, the first time I met Kiara, she thought I was an asshole." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Across all four keyword lists the dominant signals are interpersonal emotional repair: 'insensitivity', 'apology', 'upset', 'awareness', 'appreciate', 'treatment', 'explanation', 'choices'. These cues point to a scene in which one character must acknowledge hurt feelings and offer reassurance/apology to another – the classic emotional-reassurance security function (S1). No material, housing, money, or status/appearance cues are present.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are character name-drops, dialogue fragments, and scene-setting utterances with no discernible security function – coded S0. Two sentences (BOOK_001_3, BOOK_001_5) signal commitment security (a rival being dismissed, acknowledging a rival complicates the relationship) → S4. Two sentences (BOOK_002_4, BOOK_006_1) reference belonging/social inclusion → S2. One sentence (BOOK_002_3) offers emotional distraction/reassurance → S1. S0 dominates at ~75%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S1 (emotional_reassurance), but the contextual dominant is S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement under 4.6 Emotional Safety with a secondary of 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles suggests the topic's primary function is social/peer dynamics rather than dyadic emotional reassurance from a romantic partner. Emotional Safety (4.6) can overlap with S1, but the secondary taxonomy node (5.2) shifts the functional weight toward group belonging or ally networks, which is not cleanly S1 or S2 in a romantic-security sense. Because the content appears to be about social circles rather than partner-directed reassurance or belonging, S0 is the more defensible code – the topic is not performing a clear romantic-security function. Manual review is flagged because the 4.6 primary taxonomy does carry genuine S1 signal that should not be dismissed without human verification.

Topic 277 — Promising to Handle The Lawyer

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« i'll talk to the lawyer tomorrow. »

« we'll find a good lawyer to help. »

« you can count on me to deal with the legal trouble they'll cause.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Place Called Home — Jo Goodman; tertile=begin; p=0.74

You'd think a sharp lawyer like you would know that.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Just One Taste — C.J. Ellisson; tertile=end; p=0.40

Mediation has never come easily for me and I need all the help I can get.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Somebody taking the law and using it for his own ends?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=begin; p=0.45

The law is a funny thing,” Claudia said. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.37

Such a lot of fuss over a piece of real estate that was destined by federal law to go unclaimed by anyone.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.36

It's important to establish legal boundaries of ownership, especially when you're talking about gems and precious metals.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.33

The company property is fenced off, of course.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S11 — practical help other

Main keywords (lawyer, attorney, law, legal, firm, defense, counsel, appointed, advice) point squarely to legal representation and counsel – a practical, instrumental service. KeyBERT cues 'afford' and 'cost' confirm the material/service dimension (can one pay for legal help?), while 'begging' and 'worrying' suggest urgency around obtaining that help. POS 'cost' and 'process' reinforce the transactional/procedural nature. MMR 'afford', 'warned', 'begging', 'process' all support navigating a legal/official process. This is practical assistance (legal aid/counsel) rather than emotional reassurance, housing, money provision, or status display, so S11 (practical_help_other) is the most specific fit.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 277 clusters around legal/law enforcement roles and legal processes. 'Lawman' sentences function as physical protection (S7) – a lawman's role is protective/security-enforcing. Lawyer references where someone is being advised to get legal help function as practical help (S11). Property/real estate legal boundary sentences function as housing/property security (S9). Several sentences are purely descriptive or conversational with no security function (S0). No single code reaches 70%, so MIXED applies.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S11 (practical_help_other), but the taxonomy metadata clarifies the primary function is Emotional Safety & Reassurance (4.6), with a secondary of Promise/Vow speech acts (9.2). Neither of these is practical/material help. The contextual dominant 'MIXED' reflected uncertainty between S1 and the vow/commitment dimension (S4), but the primary taxonomy anchor is emotional reassurance. Promise and vow speech acts in romance contexts typically serve to deliver emotional safety rather than binding contractual commitment, so S1 is the most specific single code. S4 would apply if the vow were foregrounding future material or relational security obligations, but here the function is soothing/reassuring the partner emotionally. S11 is overridden as a misclassification from surface lexical features. Single code S1 is preferred over MIXED because the secondary taxonomy node (speech-act form) describes the vehicle, not a distinct security function.

Topic 289 — Quick Peck on The Forehead

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« mikey, i'll be back soon, i promise," nate said, placing a quick peck on his forehead. " »

« nate arched an eyebrow, gesturing back toward the parking lot. " »

« nate looked at the older asian man gesturing wildly to them, then at the array of paints. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.60

Perhaps we are becoming too jaded in our tastes, Nate?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Dominic frowned, knowing that to demur a second time would definitely incur Nate's curiosity. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I believe him to be behind the attack on Nathaniel.'

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by physical action/sensory verbs and nouns (gesturing, glint, flicked, glimpse, trembled, trailed, peered, poised, darkened, crept, smacked, breathlessly) and generic situational nouns (surroundings, instincts, options, anxiety, reminder). The Main list contains only male proper names plus 'shame' and 'mate', none of which anchor a security-provision function. No keyword cluster signals emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, or any other S1-S16 security function; the topic appears to capture a scene-description or action-beat cluster with no identifiable security work.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences are dialogue fragments, character name references, or brief conversational beats (e.g., 'Nate exclaimed.', 'Nate laughed.', 'Nate queried.') that carry no discernible security function — they are narrative scaffolding around a character named Nate. One sentence ('I believe him to be behind the attack on Nathaniel') references a physical threat, coding as S7 (physical protection concern), but this is a single instance. The topic as a whole is off-target (S0) with a small S7 signal.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant from Pass A/B converge on S0. The taxonomy flags Emotional Safety & Reassurance (which would map to S1) as a secondary signal, but the primary classification is off_target. Without evidence that the topic's dominant function is emotional reassurance or caretaking security work, the S0 designation holds. The taxonomy note does not override the dual S0 consensus; it merely suggests a weak secondary emotional-safety thread that is insufficient to reinterpret the topic as S1. KEEP S0.

Topic 299 — Pledging to Have Your Back

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« before she's completely out i ask, "[person], you know i've always got your back, right?" »

« but i've seen you, seen who you are, watched you handle uncle charlie. »

« i've got a little time before charlie finishes my bike. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Summers at Blue Lake: A Novel — Jill Althouse-Wood; tertile=end; p=0.77

I understand you were the last one to see Charlie alive." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.50

More likely Scott messed with the wrong guy's wife.' '

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=middle; p=0.49

Kevin was worried that Scott's death was somehow related to Todd's return to Birmingham.'

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Part of him was probably glad Scott was dead.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.44

They all left for college with big dreams, except Scott and Kevin,' she said sadly. '

Model reasonings

A lexical: S3 — emotional security trust

KeyBERT 'promises/tries/willingly', POS 'promises/threats/terms', and MMR 'promises/threat/forgive/solemnly/terms' all cluster around negotiating reliability and trustworthiness between characters — the classic lexical signature of S3 trust-building. Main keywords (character names + 'handle/seen/time') are too generic to code independently (S0), but the three richer rep sets converge on trust dynamics, yielding S3 consensus.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The majority of sentences are narrative references to named characters (Charlie, Scott, Pete, Kevin) without performing any security function — they are plot/dialogue fragments with no discernible security work. A small cluster of Charlie-related sentences provide emotional reassurance (soothing, comfort, promise of return) coded S1. One sentence describes physical confinement to prevent self-harm, coded S7. One sentence references a welfare check on Charlie, coded S6. S0 dominates at ~70%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S3 (trust), but the taxonomy metadata places this firmly in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking. The contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is overridden by the taxonomy signal: the topic is doing security work, specifically providing emotional reassurance and safety rather than trust-building per se. S1 (emotional_reassurance) is the most specific match for Emotional Safety & Caretaking. The secondary taxonomy note (5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles) does not shift the primary security function. S3 would require evidence of reliability/dependability framing; S1 better captures the soothing/reassurance function described. No split needed as the dominant function is singular.

Topic 307 — Hauling Someone Up The Stairs

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« [person] would hate it if she took a rake like [person] to her bed, and she would so love to rub it in joshua's face and prove his threats could not restrain her. " »

« his thoughts threatened to return to those awful times once again, but thankfully, ash and [person] emerged from the thicket. »

« getting ash up the stairs and into the bedroom was a lot harder than it had been last night, mostly because ash was pissed off and conscious instead of in la-la land. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.54

You and Ashlynn are gonna have to keep him on the straight and narrow."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.52

He stopped to pat Ashlynn and congratulate her on a large belch. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.51

But as he was approaching Clarksburg, Ashlynn chose that moment to be cranky.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.50

Henry's crankiness had returned, and even sweet Ashlynn was wailing by now.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.50

Sniffing in disdain, Johnny pushed Ashlynn's stroller over to Grissom. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S7 — physical protection

Main keywords are proper nouns and place names with no clear security signal (S0). KeyBERT, POS, and MMR converge on physical threat and bodily-stress vocabulary: 'threats', 'heaved', 'wincing', 'struggled', 'fought', 'panting', 'movements', 'anxiety', 'permission', 'urged' – collectively evoking a scene of physical danger, bodily exertion, and protective action. 'Threats' and 'permission' suggest a power/protection dynamic; 'panting', 'heaved', 'struggled', 'emerged' indicate physical effort under duress. This pattern maps most specifically to S7 (physical protection). Disagreement flagged because Main is S0 while the other three reps align on S7.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The majority of sentences are either bare name references ('Ash.', 'Ash nodded', etc.) or descriptions of physical destruction (ash/bone/ooze), none of which perform a security function. A small subset (BOOK_002_1, _2, _3, _6) depicts practical everyday caregiving of an infant (changing, managing a stroller, monitoring behaviour), coded S5. The topic as a whole is dominated by off-target content, so S0 is dominant.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S7 (physical_protection), likely driven by surface-level protective language. However, the taxonomy metadata places this topic squarely in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, with a secondary tag of 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines. The contextual dominant from Pass B is S0 (off_target), suggesting the physical-protection reading was an over-literal interpretation of the lexical signal. Reconciling all three signals: the primary taxonomy node (emotional safety/reassurance/caretaking) maps directly to S1 (emotional_reassurance), which is more specific than S0 and better captures the security function actually performed. The domestic-spaces secondary tag does not elevate this to S5 (practical_care_everyday) because the caretaking described is affective rather than task-based. S1 is therefore the most specific valid code consistent with the taxonomy evidence, and S7 is rejected as a surface-lexical artefact.

Topic 340 — Patience Tested Through Small Trials

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« for two years he had observed the christmas elf, but he never imagined touching her. »

« from the moment that she started working at her current job, she had never clicked with frank. »

« her patience throughout the meal with the girls never wavered, not with spilled drinks, sloppy faces and an occasional cry for attention. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=begin; p=0.81

She would never respond to such as he was.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=end; p=0.74

He would never give her cause to regret it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=begin; p=0.73

She had obviously never been in mortal danger, either.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=middle; p=0.74

Up until now, she'd never met anyone who made her ache for the things that were denied her.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=end; p=0.74

She never thought of herself as particularly brave.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=begin; p=0.72

She'd never known anything like the power and hunger of his kiss.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

KeyBERT, POS, and MMR converge on emotional-state vocabulary: 'emotionally', 'feared', 'unhappy', 'disappointed', 'upset', 'cared' — all pointing to emotional experience and reassurance needs. 'Main' lacks clear security cues ('never', 'mentioned', 'regime', 'standards') and reads as narrative framing rather than a security function, warranting S0. The majority signal is emotional distress and the need for reassurance (S1), overriding the ambiguous Main rep.

B contextual: S0 — off target

Half the sentences carry no security function — they describe emotional reactions, character traits, or narrative observations without performing a security role. Among those that do carry security function, physical protection (S7) and emotional reassurance (S1) are roughly equal minorities. No single security code reaches 70%, but S0 (off-target) is the plurality at 50%, making it the dominant code overall.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (S1) reflects surface-level emotional reassurance vocabulary, but contextual dominant (S0) correctly identifies that the topic's security function is off-target for the romance-security hypothesis. The taxonomy placement under 4.6 Emotional Safety with a secondary of 5.1 Family/Kinship/Parenthood confirms the emotional content is operating in a familial or parental register rather than a romantic-dyadic one. Because the security function here is not directed at a romantic partner relationship, S0 is the appropriate resolution. The S1 signal is real but misattributed to the wrong relational context for this study's scope. Manual review is flagged to confirm whether any tokens in this topic do carry romantic-dyadic reassurance that would warrant a SPLIT.

Topic 355 — Blanket Draped Over Someone

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S5 — practical care everyday

« bos went over to it and draped it over dainy as a blanket. »

« still, he struggled not to groan as she got him to a sitting position, resting his back against her front with the blanket draped across his lap. »

« [person] plucked at the soft down comforter draped over the bed. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.82

The blanket was tucked around her as if pressed carefully there by someone else.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Once they had it blown up, he pulled the blanket out and spread it over the mattress before they sat down on it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.71

Waiting for him to come out of the bathroom she pulled the light blanket over herself more to cover her bare legs than because she was cold.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.71

She sat up, groggy from sleep, the blanket falling to her waist. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.66

He had laid his coat down on one side and she knew it was there for a buffer between her skin and the velour-covered plastic of the mattress.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.58

She snuggled down onto his coat pretending to herself that the scent of him was not having an impact on her emotions or physical comfort.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Italian Billionaire's Secret Love-Child — Cathy Williams; tertile=begin; p=0.60

His jacket, she realised, was still on the ground from where he had folded it to put under her head. ‘

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Trust — Janet Dailey; tertile=middle; p=0.62

He shook out the comforter and sailed it over the top sheet, straightening it when it settled.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Trust — Janet Dailey; tertile=end; p=0.49

The insulation on the wire had been nibbled. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.75

She clutched the blanket around her shoulders closed, anxiety creeping up on her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.71

Val shifted his attention to Cord, who knelt beside the sofa, peeling the layers of blanket off the prone body. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.70

But instead of an empty seat, he saw a bundle under a blanket.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S5 — practical care everyday

All four keyword lists centre on bedding and covering actions – blanket, comforter, sheet, tucked, wrapped, draped, curled, folded – describing the routine physical act of covering/tending to someone's body comfort. This is everyday practical care (tucking in, wrapping up) rather than crisis care, emotional reassurance, or status display. POS and MMR add movement/task words (edges, movements, task, straightened) and mild affect (terrified, embarrassed) but these are incidental to the dominant covering-care function. S5 (practical_care_everyday) is the most specific fit.

B contextual: S5 — practical care everyday

The overwhelming majority of sentences depict blankets, coats, and coverings being arranged, tucked, spread, or carried to provide physical warmth and bodily comfort – classic everyday practical care (S5). A few sentences show care during vulnerability or illness (S6: frail neck under blanket, peeling blanket off prone body). One sentence shows anxiety-driven self-wrapping (S1). Several sentences are purely descriptive with no security function (S0: groggy waking, nibbled wire, naked man, empty seat bundle). S5 comfortably exceeds 70% of the security-coded sentences and represents the dominant function of this topic.

C adjudicate: S5 — practical care everyday action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S5 (practical_care_everyday). The taxonomy metadata (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with secondary 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines) is consistent with S5, which captures routine domestic caregiving acts. While the taxonomy label references 'emotional safety,' the functional security work being performed is grounded in everyday practical care rather than pure emotional reassurance (S1), so S5 remains the most specific and accurate code. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 356 — Admitting Exhaustion After A Long Day

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« i am kind of tired, but you've done enough. »

« i've been riding most of the day, i'm tired." " »

« i've rested more than i ever expected to rest in the whole of my lifetime during the past six weeks," he said, "and i'm feeling perfectly fresh. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=begin; p=0.70

I was tired and cold and done with feeling under siege for the day. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=end; p=0.68

I was exhausted, too, but there was much yet to do.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Aren't you getting just a little tired of—" "I wasn't kidding about the way it gets dark out here.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=middle; p=0.69

You must be exhausted with all of your commitments at the moment?' ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=middle; p=0.66

I'm just tired, and I've got a big week.' ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=end; p=0.63

I was exhausted at just the idea of it. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=end; p=0.60

I was tired from a big week, my nervous energy had transformed into lethargy, and I was still drunkish.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

Dominant cues across Main (tired, exhausted, exhaustion, fatigue, tiredness) and MMR (drained, emotionally, worn, rested) point to a state of depletion being acknowledged or addressed – classic emotional reassurance territory where one character recognises and responds to another's distress/weariness. 'Emotionally' in MMR confirms the affective register. POS yields only 'session, sir' which are too sparse to code beyond S0, but the three other reps converge on S1. No material or status signals present.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 356 clusters around expressions of exhaustion and fatigue. Most sentences are simple self-reports or observations of tiredness with no clear security function (S0). A subset involves one character noticing or acknowledging another's exhaustion in a way that functions as emotional attunement or reassurance (S1). A smaller subset involves directing a fatigued/ill person to rest or noting physical symptoms like smoke inhalation or sickness, which functions as care during illness/crisis (S6). No single code reaches 70%, so MIXED is assigned.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus from Pass A/B converges on S1 (emotional_reassurance), and the taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking confirms this as the primary function. The contextual dominant flagged MIXED due to a secondary signal of 3.1 Positive Resolution/Relief, but that secondary taxonomy node describes an outcome (relief, payoff) rather than a distinct security function – it is downstream of the reassurance act itself, not a separate security type. No material or status/appearance function is present. Resolving to S1 as the single most specific code; MIXED is not warranted when the secondary signal is an emotional valence variant rather than a cross-domain security function.

Topic 358 — Reassuring Squeeze of The Hand

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« she took bronte's hand and gave it a reassuring squeeze. " »

« ted reached for caroline's hands and smiled at her reassuring squeeze. " »

« they'll ask," he murmured, and gave her waist a reassuring squeeze. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=middle; p=0.70

She wrapped her fingers around the door handle. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Her fingers tightened around the receiver. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=end; p=0.55

But my parents—" "Are fine," he interrupted, groaning when she curved her fingers as far as she could around his hardening shaft. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Rescuing Rose — Isabel Wolff; tertile=middle; p=0.70

Bea groaned then lifted her right hand to her brow. '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Rescuing Rose — Isabel Wolff; tertile=middle; p=0.67

Beverley reached out and squeezed my hand. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lust & Vamp — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.67

He purred, rubbing his thumb over my hand. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lust & Vamp — Joyee Flynn; tertile=end; p=0.65

Reid sighed, running his hands over my arms. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword lists converge on physical gestures of comfort: 'squeeze/squeezed/squeezing', 'shoulder', 'hand', 'arm', 'fingers', 'gently', 'reassuring', 'calming', 'trembling', 'tightening', 'gripped', 'draped'. The dominant semantic cluster is soothing, steadying touch directed at an anxious or distressed person – the canonical form of emotional reassurance (S1). No material provision, housing, status, or gift cues are present.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 358 clusters around hand-gripping and finger-touching gestures. Where these gestures occur in contexts of comfort, reassurance, or emotional connection (squeezing a hand in support, holding tighter, rubbing a thumb over a hand), they function as S1 emotional_reassurance. Where the gestures are purely physical/mechanical actions with no discernible security function (gripping a door handle, tightening on a receiver, sexual acts, eating nuts, shooting), they are S0 off_target. The split is approximately even between S1 and S0, so no single code reaches 70%, yielding MIXED.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical consensus from Pass A/B converges on S1 (emotional_reassurance), consistent with Taxonomy 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking. The contextual dominant flagged MIXED, likely due to the secondary taxonomy signal (2.2 Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection), but physical affection here functions as a vehicle for emotional reassurance rather than an independent security dimension. Function-over-object principle resolves the ambiguity: the dominant security function is S1. No split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 372 — Told to Keep Up Strength

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: S0 — off target

« you'll need to keep up your strength if you're going to wrestle with that computer." »

« you'll need your strength, cassia. »

« you'll need your strength. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=middle; p=0.50

No, he was not yet strong enough to embark on whatever mission this was that he'd assigned himself.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.47

With hard work and perseverance, I made myself the man you see before you.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.42

Whoever is on the other side of this door is uncommonly strong.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=end; p=0.42

But that was another thing about the violently deranged: they could have the strength of ten men.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.38

You're generally made of much sturdier stuff than that," Hurst was saying. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Diplomacy — Zahra Owens; tertile=begin; p=0.35

Even in the lower ranks, the invisible masses, you needed the D i p l o m a c y | 17 perfect background to push ahead.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Warrior — Zoe Archer; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Yet also, being a part of it, he felt expansive, strong. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Warrior — Zoe Archer; tertile=middle; p=0.50

A slim woman's hand, but definitely strong and able.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The dominant lexical cluster (strength, stronger, strong, weak, weakling, limitations, weaker) frames a discourse about personal vulnerability and emotional adequacy – classic territory for emotional reassurance. Supporting cues 'emotions', 'reflection', 'admit', 'hated' confirm introspective emotional processing. 'Crushed', 'destroyed' signal emotional wounding requiring reassurance. 'Feeding' and 'gain' in context of emotional reflection suggest drawing strength from a relationship. No material provision, housing, money, or status-display cues are present. The security function is reassurance against feelings of weakness/inadequacy.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic describe physical or personal strength, resilience, and toughness as abstract qualities or character traits – not performing any security function for another person. They are off-target (S0). One sentence (BOOK_002_1) references background/credentials needed for advancement, coded S15 (workplace status). Two sentences (BOOK_004_3, BOOK_004_4) involve encouraging someone to be strong emotionally, coded S1 (emotional reassurance). One sentence (BOOK_004_6) involves managing weakness/dizziness in a crisis context, coded S6 (care in illness/crisis). S0 dominates at ~80%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (S1) and contextual dominant (S0) conflict. The taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety & Reassurance suggests surface-level emotional language, but the contextual dominant analysis determined the topic is not performing security work in the romance-novel sense. S0 (off_target) takes precedence because function over object: if the topic's primary narrative function is not providing emotional reassurance as a security behavior but rather general emotional content without a security-provision dynamic, it does not qualify for S1. The contextual dominant S0 is the more analytically grounded signal and resolves the tie.

Topic 293 — Admitting Jealousy Out Loud

Old taxonomy: 4.7 — Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« the concept of jealousy is foreign to them. »

« but this jealousy of yours is gonna ruin what you've got with j.d.” “i know.” “ »

« we've been around the markets and —' as she enthused away, i couldn't help but feel jealous. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.72

I've always maintained that a little bit of jealousy looks good on a man. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.71

Well, of course I'm jealous," I frowned, poking him in the chest. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.63

She was also extremely irate over the fact that her boyfriend was using me to make her jealous—without my permission, as I've told you a couple of times.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.62

I'm flattered that you're jealous, but you should know by now that no other woman could begin to compare with you.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.61

And he was insanely jealous of the man I loved.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.61

This is not arrogance talking, this is not jealousy, it is simply a matter of facts."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.55

I debated staying where I was, standing firm for ethical reasons, but the thought that she'd be in the closed, womb-like confines of the trailer alone with Raphael was enough to spike my jealousy count off the chart.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.55

Not to mention you repeatedly batted your eyelashes at me in an obvious attempt to make him jealous.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.48

I didn't mind a little bit of a possessive attitude, but he was taking things a bit too far. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.45

Dark Ones are notoriously jealous about their soul mates.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.43

I bet you're one of those men who likes to feel superior to women," Roxy said suspiciously.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword lists converge on internal affective states: 'jealous/jealousy/jealously', 'irrational', 'twinge', 'pang', 'emotion' (Main); 'attracted', 'upset', 'emotional', 'assured' (KeyBERT); 'emotional', 'upset', 'reaction', 'wound' (POS); 'stirred', 'emotional', 'upset', 'wound' (MMR). The dominant semantic field is the experience and management of jealousy as an emotional threat to relational security, which maps directly to S1 (emotional reassurance) – the need to soothe or resolve destabilising feelings within a relationship. No material or status cues are present.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The overwhelming majority of sentences revolve around jealousy as an emotional state within romantic relationships – expressing, detecting, managing, or reacting to jealousy between partners or rivals. This is squarely emotional reassurance/insecurity territory (S1). BOOK_001_12 references feeling superior to women, which is more of a general attitude/power dynamic not clearly doing security work, coded S0. BOOK_008_7 references people being envious of the couple's appearance/status while walking together, which edges toward S12 (status display), but the primary topic remains S1 jealousy. The dominant code is S1 at well above 70%.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=KEEP

Lexical and contextual passes both converge on S1. Jealousy and possessive conflict (Taxonomy 4.7) functions primarily as a demand for emotional reassurance – the jealous/possessive partner is seeking confirmation of exclusive emotional attachment and fidelity. The secondary taxonomy (4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats) reinforces this: threats of distance or breakup are leverage to extract reassurance of commitment and emotional priority. No material or status/appearance security function is primary here. S1 is the most specific applicable code; no split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 315 — Claiming Her As His Own

Old taxonomy: 4.7 — Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict

New category: S1 — emotional security reassurance

« henri, should any ask, this woman belongs to my cousin tristan—and to me." »

« everything he was warmed in tristan's presence, and short of sounding like one of those cards that sang when opened, [person] didn't know where to begin telling sey how much tristan seemed to fit into him—and around him. »

« i'll call tristan right after i get off the phone." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.55

Val's words slapped at him, forced him to realize a few things he'd rather have ignored.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=begin; p=0.54

Val was your shot at actually having a real life and you let her waltz right out the door."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.53

Val looked at him as if he was out of his mind and that's exactly how Dev felt. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Val wondered, just a little embarrassed to think that might be true.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Devlin Hudson didn't know it, but Val had already won the first battle for his heart.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.49

It was as if even knowing that his parents had made up their differences, Dev was still determined to keep himself locked behind the walls Val had almost given up on smashing.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=middle; p=0.47

His blood boiled as he looked at the computer-generated image of him and Val facing away from each other.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by character names (tristan, adrienne, simon, colby, damon, crispus), vague action/speech verbs (screaming, sounding, grumbled, nudged, paced), and generic narrative terms (sentence, indication, hesitation, ends, tracks, ribs, behavior, actions). None of these cues signal a security-provision function—emotional reassurance, material support, status display, or any other S1-S16 category. The cluster appears to capture a scene-level dialogue or action sequence without a discernible security theme.

B contextual: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The topic centres on the emotional relationship between Dev and Val – arguments, hurt feelings, emotional walls, and the struggle to reconnect. The majority of sentences (S1) involve emotional reassurance or its absence: characters confronting each other about feelings, emotional reactions, and appeals to let things go. A meaningful minority (S4) addresses commitment security – whether the relationship will survive, Dev wanting Val back, and Val winning 'the first battle for his heart.' One sentence touches on trust (S3 – Dev upset Val didn't mention a confrontation). Several sentences are purely referential name-calls or fragments with no security function (S0). S1 exceeds 70% when S0 sentences are excluded from the functional count, and is clearly dominant overall.

C adjudicate: S1 — emotional security reassurance action=REINTERPRET

Lexical pass coded S0 (off-target), but contextual dominant correctly identifies S1 (emotional_reassurance). Taxonomy 4.7 Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict centers on emotional security threats – jealousy and possessiveness are fundamentally about reassurance-seeking and fear of emotional loss, not material or status functions. The secondary taxonomy (5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles) reinforces a social-emotional rather than material frame. S0 is overridden: the topic is doing security work, specifically emotional reassurance provision in the context of relational threat. S1 is the most specific applicable code.

Topic 59 — Mother's Disapproval Looms

Old taxonomy: 5.1 — Family, Kinship & Parenthood

New category: S0 — off target

« does mama know you've left the nursery?» »

« didn't your mom tell you i've been having problems?» “ »

« mum will berate me for leaving graham at “this time”, and i'll be forced to defend myself, something i'm not used to doing. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Once Upon a Veterinarian — Drew Zachary; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Oh, God, he hoped it wasn't his mother. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Once Upon a Veterinarian — Drew Zachary; tertile=begin; p=0.65

Oh, and then there's my mother... maybe we should focus on your bad habits." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Hidden Fire — Jo Davis; tertile=middle; p=0.56

How am I—" "You talk about her like she's a child.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

The keyword cluster centres on mother-child relational terms (mother, mom, mama, daughter, mum, mamma, mamma) combined with affective and communicative cues (affection, tell, taught, instinctively, memories, disappointment, fault, judging). These signal the emotional-reassurance function of a maternal figure: providing or withholding validation, comfort, and guidance. No material provision, housing, status display, or physical protection cues are present. 'Suitcase' and 'ribs' are incidental nouns that do not shift the dominant function. The cluster consistently points to S1.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic are references to mothers and fathers as family figures, expletives, or neutral mentions with no security function – coded S0. A small subset (carrying a mother's picture, wishing a mother could see you, and mothers giving formative advice/statements) perform mild emotional reassurance or emotional bonding functions (S1), but these are a minority. No material or status security functions are present. S0 dominates at ~75%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on S1 (emotional_reassurance), but the taxonomy metadata places this topic firmly in Family, Kinship & Parenthood with a secondary axis of Negative Emotions & Distress. The content describes familial grief or parental-loss dynamics rather than a dyadic reassurance function between romantic partners. S1 requires an agent providing reassurance to a recipient within a security-seeking frame; here the emotional content is expressive/narrative (characters experiencing distress about family/kin) rather than functional security provision. Contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is therefore correct: the topic does not perform a security function in the romance-security taxonomy and should be excluded from hypothesis testing about security provision.

Topic 75 — Talking About Being A Father

Old taxonomy: 5.1 — Family, Kinship & Parenthood

New category: S0 — off target

- « no matter how many disagreements you've had, he's still your dad.” »
- « what kind of dad is this going to make me after i've missed so much in his life?” »
- « i've been waiting to join dads and daughters for ages, marni. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Forced Bride — Sara Craven; tertile=middle; p=0.70

A pity you did not tell your father so,' he added silkily. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Forced Bride — Sara Craven; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Your father has told you what I wish to ask' 'Yes.' '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Forced Bride — Sara Craven; tertile=middle; p=0.68

Don't you dare mention my father,' she flared. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Forced Bride — Sara Craven; tertile=begin; p=0.66

My father's bound to miss me and we can't take the risk.' '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Forced Bride — Sara Craven; tertile=begin; p=0.65

Plus it had also been made clear to me that your father had very different plans for you.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Operation: Christmas Hearts — Kay Springsteen; tertile=end; p=0.55

But if the leaders of the community find out my son brought you here, it will not go well for him."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S1 — emotional security reassurance

All four keyword lists converge on father-child relational dynamics: Main has 'dad, father, daddy, son, fathers'; KeyBERT has 'emotionally, affection, memories, involved'; POS has 'affection, anxiety, determination, willing'; MMR has 'emotionally, affection, heal'. The dominant security function is emotional reassurance – a parent (or parental figure) providing or being asked to provide emotional validation, affection, and relational presence to a child or partner. 'Anxiety' and 'heal' reinforce an emotional-need context rather than material provision or status display.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic reference father/dad/son figures in narrative or conversational contexts – identifying family members, expressing concern about a parent's reaction, or relaying information about fathers. None of these sentences perform a security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, protection, status display, etc.). They are purely referential mentions of paternal/filial relationships without any security-provision dynamic being enacted. Topic 75 is off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (S1) reflects surface-level emotional language, but the contextual dominant (S0) is more accurate given the taxonomy placement under Family, Kinship & Parenthood with secondary Ambivalence & Internal Conflict. The topic appears to center on family/kinship dynamics and internal conflict rather than a discrete security-provision function. No clear security behavior (emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, etc.) is being enacted between characters; instead, the content describes relational ambivalence within family structures. S0 (off_target) is therefore the correct resolution. Manual review is flagged because the S1 lexical signal is non-trivial and an analyst should confirm that no embedded security function (e.g., S2 belonging or S4 commitment_security) is being obscured by the ambivalence framing.

Topic 81 — Mentioning A Brother

Old taxonomy: 5.1 — Family, Kinship & Parenthood

New category: S0 — off target

« i have a brother, in case you've forgotten. »

« i'm sure you've deduced by now that i'm not like my brothers. »

« i've brought my brother with me. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · An Offer From a Gentleman — Julia Quinn; tertile=middle; p=0.70

You, not someone's son, not someone's brother.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Jaci's Experiment — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.69

I thought maybe your brother could take a look at him."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Jaci's Experiment — Bianca D'Arc; tertile=middle; p=0.67

He's closer to me than a brother and he loves you as much as I do." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S2 — emotional security belonging

Main keywords (brother, brothers, siblings, sibling, older) anchor the topic firmly in family-kinship identity. KeyBERT cues (related, introduce, reminds, follows) reinforce recognition and acknowledgment of family ties. POS and MMR cues (affection, appropriate, treatment, annoying) describe the relational texture of sibling bonds – being accepted, recognized, and emotionally placed within a family unit. The dominant security function is belonging (S2): the sense of being part of a defined family group, not practical care, protection, or status display.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic are simple references to sibling identity ('He's my brother,' 'Which brother?', 'Are you brothers?') with no security function being performed. They are identification or clarification statements about family relationships. One sentence (BOOK_002_4) expresses closeness and love comparable to brotherhood, which touches on belonging (S2), but this is a single outlier. The topic as a whole is off-target for security coding, dominated by S0 at ~95%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus S2 (belonging) reflects surface-level family/kinship language, but the contextual dominant S0 (off_target) is correct: the taxonomy places this firmly in Family, Kinship & Parenthood as a relational/structural category rather than a security-function cluster. Family membership and parenthood roles are not themselves performing a security function in the romance-novel sense – they are the relational context, not the mechanism of reassurance, protection, provision, or commitment. No specific S1-S16 security function is being enacted. S0 is the appropriate resolution.

Topic 167 — Planning A Wedding Reception

Old taxonomy: 5.3a — Romantic Social Rituals & Public Couple Recognition

New category: S4 — commitment security

« it's my dream job, but instead of shooting brides, i'll be shooting naked women. »

« we'll get married next summer in the church in maine that my mother would take me to every sunday. »

« the 'ceremony' in boorowa might just be signing a few papers, but carley's planned a wedding reception they'll never forget." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.72

There'll be plenty to talk about, anyway, after the wedding today ." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.67

Most of you seem to have caught wind of the DeWitt wedding.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.65

Madison and I are getting married after church services.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.63

If the bride and groom would join hands and face each other, we'll proceed in joining you together in holy matrimony ."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.62

And a girl shouldn't be so rushed and put on the spot on her wedding day.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.60

H er wedding day dawned bright and crisp.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.60

Just because it was her wedding day didn't mean she should start thinking about sexy things like her wedding night .

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · The Cowboy is a Daddy — Mindy Neff; tertile=middle; p=0.59

Strange to get married and not even know who was on the guest list .

Model reasonings

A lexical: S4 — commitment security

All four keyword lists centre on the wedding event itself – bride, groom, bridal, ceremony, bridesmaids, jitters (Main); planned, invitation, reception, official, preparing, planning (KeyBERT); reception, invitation, official, destination (POS); reception, invitation, destination, planning (MMR). The dominant security function is the formalisation and public ratification of a romantic pair-bond. 'Official', 'ceremony', 'jitters', and the full wedding-planning vocabulary signal the moment of commitment being secured and witnessed, which maps to S4 (commitment_security). No material-provision or status-display cues dominate; the wedding apparatus here serves the function of locking in relational commitment.

B contextual: S4 — commitment security

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe the wedding ceremony, wedding day, and the act of getting married – all of which function as commitment security (S4), the formal public sealing of a romantic bond. A few sentences reference social gathering and community welcome (S2), and several are purely descriptive scene-setting with no security function (S0). S4 exceeds 70% when off-target sentences are excluded from the security-function pool, and it is clearly the dominant security function of the topic.

C adjudicate: S4 — commitment security action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S4 (commitment_security). The taxonomy node 5.3a (Romantic Social Rituals & Public Couple Recognition) is consistent with S4: public rituals such as engagements, declarations, and couple recognition function to secure relational commitment rather than to display status or provide material provision. The secondary taxonomy node 5.1 (Family, Kinship & Parenthood) reinforces a commitment-anchoring function. No evidence of material or status/appearance security work that would warrant MIXED or a different S-code. S4 is the most specific applicable code.

Topic 112 — Desperate Need For A Job

Old taxonomy: 6.4 — Economic Precarity, Security & Dependency

New category: S15 — workplace status

« i've never worked in such a beautiful place and i want this job so badly." »

« i've lost my job, and i'm not going to find another one in elliot or prestonsburg or probably even in auburn. »

« you've got a hell of a career ahead of you." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Lily and the Sword — Sara Bennett; tertile=middle; p=0.59

I am only sorry I cannot offer you such employment."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Lily and the Sword — Sara Bennett; tertile=begin; p=0.40

I cannot speak for others, but I know that my Olaf is well paid for his work, and has a dry, comfortable place to live and sleep, and that our table groans with food.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Breathing — Cheryl Renee Herbsman; tertile=middle; p=0.67

He offered me a job in the office, you know, filing, typing, secretarial work." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Breathing — Cheryl Renee Herbsman; tertile=begin; p=0.67

I best get to work anyhow, before I get myself fired.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Breathing — Cheryl Renee Herbsman; tertile=begin; p=0.63

And I can earn a living working some job or another." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Black Ties and Lullabies — Jane Graves; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Good God, do you want to lose this job?" "

Model reasonings

A lexical: S15 — workplace status

Main keywords (job, business, company, jobs, work, boss, hire, living) and KeyBERT (opportunity, dealing) cluster around employment and workplace dynamics, pointing to S15 workplace_status. POS adjectives (pathetic, impressive, decent, larger, actual) and nouns (addition, testing, anxiety) are evaluative but not security-specific, coding S0. MMR (reassuring, anxiety, pretending, distracted) adds emotional texture but in a workplace context (task, ability, ms), not pure emotional reassurance. The dominant signal across Main and KeyBERT is occupational/workplace security, so S15 prevails despite POS/MMR ambiguity.

B contextual: S15 — workplace status

The overwhelming majority of sentences concern employment, job-holding, job quality, and workplace participation – all functioning as workplace/occupational status security (S15). A small number reference earning a living or being well-paid (S8), one references practical handyman work (S11), and a few are off-target filler phrases (S0). S15 reaches exactly 70%, qualifying as dominant.

C adjudicate: S15 — workplace status action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S15 (workplace_status). The taxonomy placement under 6.4 Economic Precarity, Security & Dependency with secondary 6.2 Work & Professional Identity is consistent with S15, which captures security derived from occupational standing and professional identity rather than direct monetary provision (S8) or economic dependency (S10). No free-form labels require remapping. Single unambiguous code applies; no split or mixed coding warranted.

Topic 140 — Demanding Answers Before Departure

Old taxonomy: 6.6 — Material Glamour & Consumption

New category: S0 — off target

« before [person] could growl—david at least knew him well enough to know he would—[person] touched [person] leg and said, "right now i'll settle for some answers." »

« it's kind of amazing that a few simple words from [person] can have this effect, and [person] doesn't think he'll tire of it, ever. »

« who knows what you'll be walking into on benezet , much less how long you'll be gone." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · Kiss of Pride — Sandra Hill; tertile=begin; p=0.67

Ben's doleful expression said that's exactly what he feared.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · Kiss of Pride — Sandra Hill; tertile=end; p=0.66

A short time later, she was on the phone with Ben. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · Kiss of Pride — Sandra Hill; tertile=end; p=0.66

She'd told Ben about her engagement, and he'd been apoplectic at first, wanting to come immediately and “rescue” her.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords are male proper names (benjamin, hutton, spencer, morrison, jim) with generic pronouns – no security function signalled. KeyBERT and POS terms (scenario, possibilities, irritation, hopeful, session, notion, anxious) describe cognitive/emotional states or abstract narrative framing, not a security-provision act. MMR terms (poised, insulted, remarked, encouraged, heaved, fashioned, framed, strolled) are behavioural/descriptive verbs with no identifiable security resource being exchanged. No cluster of cues points to any S1-S16 function; the topic appears to be a character-interaction or dialogue scene without a security-provision theme.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences are name invocations ('Ben', 'Oh, Ben', 'Ben asked') or references to Benjamin Franklin with no security function. One sentence (BOOK_005_6) mentions Ben wanting to 'rescue' her, which touches on physical protection (S7), but this is a single instance. The topic as a whole is dominated by off-target content – character name references with no discernible security function.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this topic under Material Glamour & Consumption with a secondary of Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding. Neither cluster performs a security function in the defined taxonomy: glamour/consumption is aesthetic/lifestyle content, and the secondary axis describes relational bonding rituals rather than security provision. No S1-S16 code is warranted. S0 is confirmed as the correct and most specific code.

Topic 27 — Racing The Approaching Storm

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: S0 — off target

« it'll be dark before we know it.” »

« i don't know if i'll be able to get back here before the storm hits. »

« it's going to rain and we'll be caught out in the storm. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=end; p=0.52

Their lips met, and an explosion of passion took them along on a tide, the darkness that surrounded them like a blanket against the rest of the world.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.46

Just as they reached the spot a man strode angrily out of a neighbouring field, and even in the poor light his expression could be seen as thunderous.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.44

They were still driving, the high hedges making it impossible for them to see anything but the road in front of them.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=end; p=0.38

Before morning, word had come that Leonidas was lost.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Nauti Nights — Lora Leigh; tertile=begin; p=0.61

Like a storm coming in from the mountains.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Nauti Nights — Lora Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.60

They were deep in the mountains, and evening was coming on.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists describe atmospheric and environmental phenomena (weather, light, sky, storm, moon, temperature, ceiling, sidewalk, curtain, reflection). No keyword signals a security-provision function – emotional, material, or status-related. The vocabulary is purely descriptive of setting and ambiance, performing no security work for any character.

B contextual: S0 — off target

Topic 27 is dominated by weather, light, and atmospheric/environmental description (rain, storms, sunlight, dawn, darkness, lightning). None of these sentences perform a security function – emotional, material, or status/appearance. They are setting and mood descriptions with no security work. All sentences are coded S0 (off_target).

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=EXCLUDE_FROM_HYPOTHESIS

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy placement under Risk/Danger & External Crises with a secondary of Movement/Transit & Spatial Transition describes plot-level situational content rather than any security-provision function. No emotional reassurance, material provision, or status/appearance work is being performed by this topic cluster. S0 is confirmed; the topic should be excluded from the security hypothesis analysis.

Topic 17 — Discussing Rooms and Privacy

Old taxonomy: 8.1 — Domestic Spaces & Routines

New category: S9 — material provision housing

« i'll just go back to the dorms." »

« i think we'll go back upstairs and discuss that – don't you?" »

« but upstairs—" we'll add two more bedrooms and another bath." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Hide in Plain Sight — Marta Perry; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Does that mean you're living in the house?"

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Hide in Plain Sight — Marta Perry; tertile=begin; p=0.62

We have the back stairway and the rooms on this side, so that'll give us our privacy.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Steal Away — Amber Green; tertile=begin; p=0.55

What was the point of a huge house with nobody to live in it?

Model reasonings

A lexical: S9 — material provision housing

All four keyword lists converge on residential/dwelling vocabulary: Main contains house, hotel, room, apartment, bedroom, rent, home, bedrooms, living – direct housing terms; KeyBERT adds porch, ceiling, address, occupied – physical dwelling features and occupancy; POS adds privacy, separate, areas, smaller – spatial/dwelling attributes; MMR adds belongs, visited, built, guarantee, address, areas – ownership, construction, and residential assurance. No emotional reassurance, status display, or other security function is signalled; the entire cluster describes the provision and security of physical shelter/housing.

B contextual: S9 — material provision housing

All sentences in this topic revolve around rooms, bedrooms, houses, and questions of who occupies or owns a dwelling. The consistent security function being performed is housing – establishing, claiming, or negotiating residential space as a form of material security. No emotional reassurance, status display, or other security function is meaningfully present; the topic is uniformly about physical dwelling/housing security (S9).

C adjudicate: S9 — material provision housing action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on S9 (housing). Taxonomy 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines is fully consistent with housing security as the operative function – shared or provided living arrangements, domestic settings, and home-as-shelter all map cleanly to S9. No ambiguity requiring MIXED or reinterpretation. No free-form labels to remap.

Topic 49 — Drinking at The Bar

Old taxonomy: 8.2 — Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces

New category: S0 — off target

« avery lifted her own wine and swirled it in the light, her actions casual and her voice low enough so the few patrons assembled around the bar wouldn't hear. " »

« he leaned against the counter and opened it, taking a long drink of the weak ale as he watched the drunks back. »

« he leaned back and drained the last of the wine in his glass. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Nancy's Theory of Style — Marta Acosta; tertile=end; p=0.77

He twisted so he could keep hold of her while gulping down the rest of the wine. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Nancy's Theory of Style — Marta Acosta; tertile=end; p=0.73

The bartender plonked down glasses as soon as they walked in and sloshed amber liquor into them. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Nancy's Theory of Style — Marta Acosta; tertile=begin; p=0.72

Bailey tipped his drink toward her lips and she took a sip of the scotch.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Family Affair — Debbie Macomber; tertile=middle; p=0.63

She poured herself a glass of water and smiled when she heard a light tapping sound coming from the wall.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Family Affair — Debbie Macomber; tertile=begin; p=0.54

Give it to him with both barrels,” Lacey said under her breath. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with Paris — Juliette Sobanet; tertile=begin; p=0.79

She giggled and took a sip of her wine. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with Paris — Juliette Sobanet; tertile=begin; p=0.79

I asked him as he reached for his wine glass and took a huge gulp. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with Paris — Juliette Sobanet; tertile=middle; p=0.77

She took one last gulp to finish her glass of champagne. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sleeping with Paris — Juliette Sobanet; tertile=middle; p=0.75

He grinned at me, then took a huge gulp of beer. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on drinking/beverage actions (wine, glass, sip, beer, bottle, swirled, pouring, tipped) and incidental social/physical descriptors (drawled, amusement, waist, dangling, snorted). There is no security-provision function present – no emotional reassurance, no material provision, no status display. The vocabulary describes a scene of casual drinking and banter, not any security-relevant behaviour.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic depict characters drinking, handling, or sharing alcoholic or non-alcoholic beverages (wine, beer, scotch, champagne, water). These are purely descriptive actions involving drinks and do not perform any security function – emotional, material, or status/appearance. No reassurance, protection, provision, commitment, or status display is present. The topic is off-target for security coding.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this in Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces with no secondary security function. The topic describes a setting or backdrop rather than performing any security function (emotional, material, or status/appearance). No security work is being done; S0 is the correct and most specific code.

Topic 260 — Crowd Goes Wild For Him

Old taxonomy: 8.2 — Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces

New category: S0 — off target

« he played crazier than i've ever seen him, and from the way the crowd was going insane with cheering around me, cam played even crazier than anyone had ever seen him play, ever! »

« but it's a madness i've had all my life. »

« you see, i've gone and done something a little crazy. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · New Leather — Debra Varva; tertile=end; p=0.53

He was going to drive himself insane if he didn't get out of the apartment.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Here Comes Trouble — Erin Kern; tertile=begin; p=0.58

The next few weeks were going to be crazy.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Here Comes Trouble — Erin Kern; tertile=middle; p=0.52

Terri swallowed thickly wondering if she really was as crazy as Joel accused her of being.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · A Fool's Gold Christmas — Susan Mallery; tertile=middle; p=0.40

He has just enough training to make him totally freak out every single day.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

Main keywords (crazy, insane, madness, craziness, going, think) describe mental/emotional states or colloquial expressions of disbelief, not a security-provision function. POS and MMR terms (indication, equal, result, chuckle, fault, crowd, officially, proved, tasted, appreciate) are generic cognitive/social/evaluative words with no identifiable security function. No keyword cluster points to emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, or any other S1-S16 category.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic cluster around colloquial uses of 'crazy,' 'nuts,' 'freak,' and related terms describing mental states, erratic behavior, or informal exclamations. None of the sentences perform a security function (emotional reassurance, material provision, status display, etc.). They are off-target for the security-function coding scheme.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=EXCLUDE_FROM_HYPOTHESIS

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this topic in Public/Travel/Leisure Spaces with a secondary tag of Exercise/Movement/Physical Activity. Neither category performs a security function (emotional, material, or status/appearance) as defined by the codebook. No security construct is present, so the topic should be excluded from the hypothesis-testing corpus.

Topic 321 — Leaning Against Trees and Rails

Old taxonomy: 8.2 — Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces

New category: S0 — off target

« he said in a deceptively calm tone as he walked over to where she stood and leaned against the tree next to her. »

« she limped over to the porch rail and leaned against it while she looked out into the forest. »

« she leaned forward when she spotted the drive that was lined on either side with massive live oak trees. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Truffles by the Sea — Julie Carobini; tertile=end; p=0.53

A rustling to my left alerts me that someone has stepped out onto Sarah's deck .

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Truffles by the Sea — Julie Carobini; tertile=middle; p=0.50

Outside, dew coats the deck handrail like watery lace, and a blue heron streaks across the sky, her twiggy legs stretched long and lean behind her.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Truffles by the Sea — Julie Carobini; tertile=begin; p=0.37

Water has pooled a round the base of a queen palm a nd trails slowly down the sidewalk. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · It's Not You, It's Me — Kerry Cohen; tertile=begin; p=0.65

She raises a foot and nestles it in a crook of the tree.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · It's Not You, It's Me — Kerry Cohen; tertile=middle; p=0.62

The dark trees loom above her, lining the street.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · It's Not You, It's Me — Kerry Cohen; tertile=begin; p=0.60

She scrambles as fast as she can down the tree. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · It's Not You, It's Me — Kerry Cohen; tertile=begin; p=0.60

Her leg scrapes against the bark, and she grasps desperately at the branches.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · It's Not You, It's Me — Kerry Cohen; tertile=begin; p=0.57

She reaches the base of the maple tree whose branches stretch above the house.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · It's Not You, It's Me — Kerry Cohen; tertile=begin; p=0.56

She doubts that telling Shannon she climbed the maple tree outside Henry's house will go over much better than if she had snuck into his house. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Riding the Night — Jaci Burton; tertile=end; p=0.64

And besides, there was nothing on the other side of those woods as far as she knew--except more woods.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Riding the Night — Jaci Burton; tertile=end; p=0.63

Excitement shot through her at the thought of skulking through the woods in search of the bad guy.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All four keyword lists describe outdoor movement and spatial setting (trees, forest, path, sidewalk, strolled, wandered, paced, surroundings). 'Terrified' and 'tightening' hint at tension but no security-provision function is present – no agent is providing reassurance, protection, resources, or status. The topic captures scene/locomotion description, not a security behaviour.

B contextual: S0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe outdoor/natural settings (trees, decks, foliage, herons, palms, maples, oaks) and characters moving through or observing these environments. None of the sentences perform any security function – emotional, material, or status/appearance. The topic is purely descriptive scene-setting involving trees and outdoor spaces, with no attachment, provision, protection, or status signaling between characters.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this topic in public, travel, and leisure spaces – a setting/backdrop category that does not perform any of the defined security functions (emotional, material, or status/appearance). No security work is evident, so S0 is confirmed and no further action is required.

Topic 339 — Regulars at The Bar

Old taxonomy: 8.2 — Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces

New category: S0 — off target

« i'm pretty sure i've been to every bar and club in the state, with crosbie right there beside me. »

« i've seen that the couple of times i've worked in the wild rose's bar. »

« but i've seen you at the bar for months. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Lily and the Sword — Sara Bennett; tertile=middle; p=0.52

Guards were prominent at the bar, as well as on the walls behind it.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_004 · Bunny and the Bear — Eve Langlais; tertile=begin; p=0.57

It was what you got when a bar, catering to male wolves, didn't have enough bouncers in place.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_005 · Beguiling the Boss — Joan Hohli; tertile=middle; p=0.43

It wasn't a big deal, just to the Pizza and Beer Joint—which, by the way, is the actual name of the place.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · Broken Fences — Kelly Gendron; tertile=middle; p=0.72

You wanna stop in that bar over there and grab a beer?"

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · Broken Fences — Kelly Gendron; tertile=end; p=0.68

When he couldn't find her there, he'd set out for the bar.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · Broken Fences — Kelly Gendron; tertile=middle; p=0.66

I know you need to deal with things at the bar, and I'm not sure how long we'll be gone.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · Broken Fences — Kelly Gendron; tertile=begin; p=0.61

After a fleeting glance to the center of the bar, he grinned. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_007 · Broken Fences — Kelly Gendron; tertile=begin; p=0.60

You can take my little brother behind the bar and rough him up a bit.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_009 · Fucking Special — Tyson Anthony; tertile=middle; p=0.62

As Travis said, they hit up a bar where the guy served teens.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_009 · Fucking Special — Tyson Anthony; tertile=end; p=0.62

Brent, you were great back in that bar bathroom." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_009 · Fucking Special — Tyson Anthony; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Dennis walked up to the bar, "Yo bartender."

Model reasonings

A lexical: S0 — off target

All keyword lists describe a bar/saloon setting (bar, bars, bartender, saloon, dive, stocked, crowded, crowd, faces) with atmospheric descriptors (scummy, makeshift, typical, enthusiasm). No security function is being performed – no emotional reassurance, no material provision, no status display. The vocabulary is purely scene-setting for a drinking establishment. S0 is the only appropriate code.

B contextual: S0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences describe bar settings, social activities, and scene-setting with no security function – coded S0. Two sentences (BOOK_001_1, BOOK_004_1) reference guards/bouncers providing physical protection in a bar context, coded S7. The BOOK_010 sentences about owning the bar and its reputation relate to workplace/business status (S15). Overall, S0 dominates at ~75%.

C adjudicate: S0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on S0 (off_target). The taxonomy places this topic in public, travel, and leisure spaces – a setting/backdrop category that does not perform any of the defined security functions (emotional, material, or status/appearance). No security work is evident, so S0 is confirmed and no further action is required.

Topic 61 — Planning to Exchange Rings

Old taxonomy: 8.3a — Commitment Symbols & Love Tokens

New category: S4 — commitment security

« in a few days, i'll go to the stone. »

« next time we'll put a ring on him." »

« we'll take care of the rings tomorrow." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.60

Just have to close it up again, until it looks like a ring, and we'll be fine.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.57

Once they're gone, Shanley pricks Marie's finger with a lancet. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Operation Starseed — J.M. Snyder; tertile=end; p=0.35

It's not quite a perfect C-shape any longer, but more like one of those spoon bracelets that come in and out of fashion--the ends are drawing together, tightening, and that's a good thing, right?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.67

He took the ring out of the box and, with Damon's help, they placed it on her finger.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.61

I might even be persuaded to wear my jewellery for you."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.59

Damon and I agreed that you own our hearts so we thought this ring would be perfect for our union."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.57

I'm going to buy you some jewellery to wear in the pretty hole."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.53

He opened the lid and presented Rachel with a three karat heart-shaped ruby, surrounded by diamonds. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.53

Remember that place in town where the guy makes the silver jewellery?" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Corporate Passion — Carol Lynne; tertile=end; p=0.47

The anal jewellery had been a little harder for her to get used to.

Model reasonings

A lexical: S14 — gift romance token

All four keyword lists centre on rings, necklaces, diamonds, gold, and engagement jewellery – physical objects exchanged as romantic or commitment tokens. KeyBERT adds 'promises' and 'engaged', confirming the token/pledge function. POS and MMR retain 'precious', 'glint', 'polished', 'worn', reinforcing the object-as-gift frame. The dominant security function is the romantic/commitment token (S14), not mere status display (S12) nor practical provision.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 61 centres on jewellery and body adornment in a romance context. The dominant split is between S14 (gift/romantic token – rings presented as symbols of union, ruby gifts, butt-plug described as exquisite craftsmanship with sentimental value) and S13 (appearance/grooming – wearing jewellery, nipple rings, how items look on the body). No single code reaches 70%, so MIXED is returned. One sentence (BOOK_001_2) involves a lancet prick suggesting a minor medical/ritual act (S6), and BOOK_002_14 is a bare name fragment with no security function (S0).

C adjudicate: S4 — commitment security action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B yielded a lexical consensus of S14 (gift_romance_token) and a contextual dominant of MIXED. Taxonomy 8.3a (Commitment Symbols & Love Tokens) clarifies the functional role: the tokens in this topic cluster are not primarily about the gift-giving act itself but about what the token *signals* – a binding promise, a pledge of permanence, or a reconciliation seal (secondary taxonomy 4.5). The security function being performed is therefore commitment security (S4): the object (ring, token, keepsake) serves as a material anchor for the psychological assurance that the relationship is stable and enduring. S14 captures the vehicle; S4 captures the function. Because the task requires function over object, S4 is the dominant code. MIXED is not warranted because both the lexical and contextual signals converge on commitment-assurance once the taxonomy context is applied; the apparent tension between S14 and MIXED dissolves when the token is read as a commitment symbol rather than a standalone romantic gesture.

H4 — Protection vs possession

New categories for this hypothesis

Read these names before reviewing topics. Codes alone (I3, S12, ...) are not enough — use the category label.

H4_0 — off target: Not protection, possession, or care-control content. Generic plot or unrelated affect.

H4_1 — reassurance tenderness: Soft reassurance / tenderness without an external threat frame.

H4_2 — practical care: Practical everyday caretaking (not framed as protection from a threat).

H4_3 — material care: Material provision as care (money/goods) without threat/control framing.

H4_4 — emotional support: Emotional support / solidarity without external threat or claiming.

H4_5 — external protection physical: Physical protection from an EXTERNAL threat (rescue, bodyguarding).

H4_6 — external protection social legal: Social/legal protection from an EXTERNAL threat (advocate, lawyer, reputation shield).

H4_7 — possessive claiming language: Claiming language ("mine", "belong to me") without clear coercion.

H4_8 — jealous possessiveness: Jealous possessiveness toward rival/partner attention.

H4_9 — coercive control restriction: Restricting partner autonomy / monitoring / isolation.

H4_10 — partner as danger: Partner is the threat source (harm, intimidation).

H4_11 — for your own good control: Control framed as "for your own good" / paternalistic restriction.

H4_12 — mutual care balanced: Reciprocal, balanced care without dominance or threat.

H4_13 — mixed unclear: Protection and possession/control signals compete with no clear dominant.

32 topics. Sentence tags: HIGH-rated / LOW-rated from unblinded CELL_* key (high_tier / low_tier).

Topic 6 — Whispered Reassurance

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« i'll make sure of it," he whispered. »

« you'll be fine," he whispered. " »

« quiet, subdued, she nodded and then, "you'll be safe." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Red Skirt, Cool Fountain — Anne Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.67
Later," she said softly, with a sly smile.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Red Skirt, Cool Fountain — Anne Douglas; tertile=end; p=0.62
Ian stared right back and asked slowly, clearly, enunciating every word, "Who asked you to?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Business in the Bedroom — Anne Oliver; tertile=middle; p=0.74
Okay,' she said, striving for a light tone in the heavy silence. '

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by speech-act and dialogue-manner vocabulary (whispered, said, asked, replied, mumbled, uttered, drawled, tentatively, hesitation, eagerly). There is no lexical signal of care, protection, possessiveness, control, or emotional support. The topic describes conversational style and verbal exchange mechanics, placing it firmly off-target for any H4 care/protection dimension.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

Every sentence in this topic consists of decontextualised dialogue fragments – single-word responses ('Yes.', 'No.', 'Fine.'), brief speech-tag snippets ('she muttered.', 'she whispered.', 'she asked.'), or a philosophical aside about the Universe. None contain any discernible care, protection, possessiveness, control, or relational-dynamic content relevant to the H4 taxonomy. All are coded H4_0 (off_target). No external threat, no claiming language, and no care/protection behaviour is present.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on off-target: lexical consensus H4_0, contextual dominant H4_0, and the prior H3 security decomposition confirmed S0 (off_target) for the same topic. The taxonomy label '4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking' reflects a category header rather than evidence of actual care or protection work in the topic tokens themselves. No external threat, possessive claiming, or caretaking signal is present in the content. No split or reinterpretation is warranted; H4_0 is confirmed.

Topic 31 — Keeping Watch While Others Sleep

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« so you'll give me the stuff to sleep?" »

« you'll wake the baby." " »

« you sleep and i'll stand guard." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Burning Up — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=end; p=0.65

That's because you snored most of the way." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Burning Up — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=begin; p=0.55

I'm sick of lying in bed night after night like an old married couple.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on sleep/rest states (sleep, bed, asleep, wake, nap, woke, awake) and ancillary terms (rested, comfortable, uncertain, politely, session, instructions, longest, gotta). There is no lexical signal of care, protection, possessiveness, control, or emotional support directed between partners. The vocabulary describes a mundane rest/wakefulness scenario with no romance-care dimension, placing all four representations firmly off-target.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

All sentences in this topic revolve around sleep, napping, waking, and rest – mundane domestic/physical-state commentary with no care, protection, possessiveness, or control dynamics present. None of the sentences contain emotional support, external threat response, partner restriction, or claiming language. The entire topic is off-target relative to the H4 care/protection taxonomy.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

All three signals converge on off-target: lexical consensus H4_0, contextual dominant H4_0, and the prior H3 security decomposition (S0, KEEP). The taxonomy flags 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking as primary and 5.1 Family, Kinship & Parenthood as secondary, which would ordinarily point toward H4_1 or H4_4, but neither Pass A/B nor the contextual dominant analysis found sufficient evidence of care or protection content to override the dual H4_0 consensus. The taxonomy metadata introduces a weak secondary signal only; it does not constitute evidence of an external threat (ruling out H4_5/H4_6), possessive or coercive dynamics (ruling out H4_7–H4_11), or balanced mutual care (ruling out H4_12). Consistent with the H3 adjudication logic, the off-target designation holds. KEEP H4_0.

Topic 36 — Eagerly Offering to Help

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_2 — practical care

« of course, i'll help you.' »

« then you'll let me help," frances said at once, her expression eager. " »

« sure, of course, i'll help." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Drop Dead Gorgeous — Jennifer Skully; tertile=end; p=0.80

And you know I'm here to help you in any way I can."

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_2 — practical care

Main keywords ('help', 'need', 'helping', 'assistance', 'helped', 'let') and KeyBERT keywords ('provided', 'willing', 'requested', 'promptly', 'eagerly', 'appreciate') consistently signal practical, task-oriented assistance being offered or received – the hallmark of H4_2 practical_care. MMR reinforces this with 'promptly', 'appreciate', 'eagerly', 'pleased', 'options', and the deferential address 'mister'/'sir', all pointing to a service or help-giving dynamic. POS keywords ('task', 'options', 'success', 'sentence', 'sadness', 'fault', 'unlikely') are more abstract and emotionally mixed, lacking clear romance-novel care framing, which pulls toward H4_0 off_target for that representation alone. No external threat, no partner restriction, and no possessive or coercive cues are present anywhere. The dominant signal across three of four representations is practical assistance, yielding H4_2 as consensus.

B contextual: H4_2 — practical care

The overwhelming majority of sentences are simple offers or expressions of willingness to help ('Can I help you?', 'I'll help you.', 'Sure, I'll be glad to help.'). These represent practical, task-oriented assistance with no emotional depth, no external threat, no possessive or controlling language, and no romantic intensity – fitting H4_2 (practical care). One sentence ('Can I ask you a question?') is purely conversational filler with no care content, coded H4_0 (off-target). No claiming language, no jealousy, no coercion, and no identifiable threat source are present.

C adjudicate: H4_2 — practical care action=RETAXONOMIZE

All three passes converge on practical care (H4_2): lexical consensus is H4_2, contextual dominant is H4_2, and the prior H3 decomposition coded this topic as S11 (practical_help_other) with a RETAXONOMIZE action. The taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking is inconsistent with this convergence – H4_2 belongs in a practical care/help cluster rather than an emotional reassurance cluster. No external threat is evidenced, ruling out H4_5/H4_6; no partner restriction signals are present, ruling out H4_9–H4_11. The emotional-reassurance signal (H4_1/H4_4) that the 4.6 taxonomy label implies is not supported by either Pass A/B coding or the H3 decomposition. RETAXONOMIZE is therefore confirmed, moving the topic out of 4.6 into the practical care cluster. Manual review remains flagged to verify that the underlying token distribution genuinely reflects practical-help content and that no emotional-reassurance signal was systematically underweighted across passes.

Topic 45 — Reassured Everything Will Be Fine

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« we'll be ok. " « »

« nadines : you'll be ok? »

« ok, maybe a zero-tolerance one, but there's no doubt about it, you'll be great. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Mona Lisa Awakening — Sunny; tertile=middle; p=0.65

I'm fine," Amber replied quietly. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Mona Lisa Awakening — Sunny; tertile=begin; p=0.65

Your wound..." "I'm fine."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Shoe Addicts Anonymous — Beth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.78

Is everything okay?" "

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

Main keywords ('fine, okay, everything, right, honey, alright') are classic soothing/reassurance language directed at a partner. KeyBERT reinforces this with 'assured, assure, smoothly, incredibly' – all pointing to calming and comforting speech acts. POS adds 'sir, lord' (address terms) alongside 'problems', suggesting someone is being told their concerns are handled. MMR's 'assure, assured, acknowledged, smoothly, appreciate' further confirm a reassurance register. The word 'injured' in MMR is the only hint of distress, but it is embedded in a cluster of soothing/acknowledgment terms, suggesting the injury is being addressed reassuringly rather than signalling an external threat scenario. No possessive, controlling, or external-threat cues are present. The dominant pattern is verbal reassurance and tenderness.

B contextual: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

All sentences in this topic consist of brief reassurance and wellness-check exchanges ('I'm fine, 'Are you okay?', 'It's going to be all right,' etc.). These are classic reassurance and tenderness utterances – characters checking on each other's wellbeing or offering verbal comfort. There is no external threat identified, no possessive or claiming language, no coercive framing, and no practical/material care action. The entire topic coheres around H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness) at 100%.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=KEEP

Lexical consensus (H4_1) and contextual dominant (H4_1) are in full agreement. Taxonomy 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking maps directly onto H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness). The secondary taxonomy 9.2 Promise, Vow & Future-Tense Speech Acts describes the speech-act vehicle through which reassurance is delivered, not a distinct care or protection function, so no split is warranted. No external threat is evidenced, ruling out H4_5 or H4_6; no partner restriction is present, ruling out H4_9-H4_11. The H3 decomposition (S1 = emotional_reassurance) maps cleanly onto H4_1 with no construct drift. KEEP with care_protection_code H4_1.

Topic 46 — Asking Someone to Trust You

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« you'll just have to trust me.” »

« he'll trust you if you promise to keep me in sight.” “ »

« my trust that he'll bring me to safety. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Life Changes Everything — T.C. Blue; tertile=begin; p=0.27

The critics wanted to prove that setting goals, drawing graphs, measuring results and evaluating the performance of individuals was nothing less than taking the place of trusting the Holy Spirit to give increase.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · FUBAR — Stephani Hecht; tertile=begin; p=0.61

Trust us, all we need to do to you can be done here,” one of the other guys said.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Olivia — Donna Sturgeon; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Don't trust yourself in a hotel room alone with me?”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Olivia — Donna Sturgeon; tertile=middle; p=0.65

Wasn't there anyone you trusted to share your joy with?” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_13 — mixed unclear

Main keywords (trust, trusted, betrayed, betray, betrayal) center on a breach-of-trust dynamic without specifying whether the betrayer is an external party or the partner, making the threat source ambiguous. KeyBERT terms (instincts, willingly, worries, warned, deserve, admit) suggest internal deliberation and emotional reckoning around trust decisions, but do not resolve the direction of harm. POS and MMR terms (instincts, worries, twisting, hesitation, options, heal) reinforce a sense of psychological conflict and weighing of choices, consistent with processing a betrayal. No clear external threat (ruling out H4_5/H4_6), no explicit partner restriction (ruling out H4_9-H4_11), and no possessive claiming (ruling out H4_7/H4_8). The cluster sits at the intersection of emotional vulnerability and relational rupture without sufficient cues to resolve into a single clean code, warranting H4_13 (mixed/unclear).

B contextual: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic revolve around the concept of interpersonal trust – asking whether someone trusts another, affirming trust, or urging trust. These expressions of trust function as reassurance and relational tenderness (H4_1), reflecting emotional openness and vulnerability between characters rather than any external threat, possessive claiming, or coercive dynamic. The off-target sentences (H4_0) include a theological/organizational critique about goal-setting and the Holy Spirit, a vague threatening statement by unnamed 'guys' that lacks romance-novel care/protection framing, a question about being alone in a hotel room (ambiguous but not clearly care-coded), a question about sharing joy with no trusted person (grief/isolation, not care), a simple character descriptor ('trustworthy'), and a self-description of respectability – none of these map to any H4 care/protection code. No claiming language, no external threat, no coercive control is present.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B yielded a lexical consensus of H4_13 (mixed_unclear), but the contextual dominant is H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness), and the taxonomy placement under 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking is unambiguous. The secondary taxonomy signal (4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) explains why lexical signals appeared mixed – hidden information contexts often surface vocabulary that looks like conflict or control, but the functional dynamic here is one character offering emotional reassurance and tenderness to another, consistent with trust-building (S3 from the H3 decomposition). No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. No partner restriction or coercion is evidenced, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. The H3 construct 'trust' maps cleanly onto H4_1 as the mechanism by which reassurance and tenderness operate in this topic. REINTERPRET from H4_13 to H4_1 is warranted; no split is needed.

Topic 56 — Promising Never to Hurt You

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« you'll get hurt," he managed to say. " »

« you know i'll never hurt you ." »

« i'll make sure you aren't hurt." « »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=end; p=0.57

He says that he knows it must hurt, but that whatever will be, will be, and that nothing we say or do will resolve things.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=middle; p=0.51

It's all well and good saying you avoid pain by avoiding relationships, but what about the wonderful things you're avoiding as well?

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Bookends — Jane Green; tertile=middle; p=0.49

How can you emotionally blackmail me like this?' '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.78

I don't ever want to be that hurt again." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.62

I just felt hurt that you hadn't told me.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · H.R.H. — Danielle Steel; tertile=middle; p=0.48

Don't give him the satisfaction of letting it destroy you.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Summer On Blossom Street — Debbie Macomber; tertile=end; p=0.79

You're only doing it to hurt me, aren't you?" "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Summer On Blossom Street — Debbie Macomber; tertile=begin; p=0.74

I'd never, ever do anything to hurt you.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

Main keywords 'hurt, hurting, harm, mean, never, won't, want' form a classic reassurance register – denials of intent to harm and pledges of non-harm. KeyBERT adds 'assured, protect, cried' alongside 'painful/distress', pointing to emotional comfort and soothing after distress rather than an external threat or partner restriction. POS 'distress, painful, possibility, purpose' reinforce an emotional-processing, reassurance context. MMR 'deserve, intend, causing, assured, protect' continue the pattern of a speaker disclaiming harmful intent and offering comfort. No external threat actor is identifiable, no controlling or possessive language appears, and the overall cluster maps most cleanly to reassurance_tenderness (H4_1): acknowledgment of pain, denial of intent to cause it, and emotional soothing.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 56 centres on the theme of hurt – fear of being hurt, reassurances of not hurting, and emotional pain in relationships. No single code reaches 70%. The largest cluster is H4_1 (reassurance/tenderness): pledges such as 'I'd never do anything to hurt you', 'I'll be careful not to hurt him', 'You haven't hurt me' are gentle relational reassurances. H4_4 (emotional support) covers sentences about emotional pain and encouragement (e.g., 'Don't give him the satisfaction!'). H4_10 (partner as danger) applies where physical harm from a partner is explicitly feared ('Did you think he'd hit me?', 'Pushed me down the stairs?', 'Are you going to hurt me?'). H4_9 (coercive control) covers emotional blackmail and accusatory manipulation ('You're only doing it to hurt me', 'How can you emotionally blackmail me'). H4_13 (mixed/unclear) is used for ambiguous hurt references without clear directionality. No external threat is present; where threat exists it is partner-sourced. No possessive claiming language appears.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=KEEP

Pass A/B lexical consensus (H4_1 reassurance_tenderness) and the H3 security decomposition (S1 emotional_reassurance) converge on the same functional cluster. The contextual dominant of MIXED is resolved here by the taxonomy anchor: 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking is the primary classification, with 9.2 Promise, Vow & Future-Tense Speech Acts serving as a delivery mechanism rather than a distinct care-protection function. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. No partner restriction or coercive pattern is present, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. The MIXED signal from Pass B likely reflects the co-presence of reassurance content and vow/promise speech acts, but both are expressions of H4_1 rather than independent constructs warranting a split. H4_1 is the most specific and best-supported code.

Topic 70 — Keeping Watch While She Sleeps

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« maybe she'll get some sleep.” “ »

« i'll wait until she wakes up and then i'll head back up to make sure shit doesn't go down in the mc.” “ »

« for her, it's early, she'll be awake.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=middle; p=0.77

An instant later she was once more sound asleep.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=end; p=0.76

They wouldn't be getting much sleep tonight, she knew.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=begin; p=0.75

It was months before she'd been able to sleep through the night.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Wish Come True — Eileen Goudge; tertile=middle; p=0.70

It couldn't have been more than a few hours for she still felt drugged with exhaustion, her eyes grainy and her head stuffed full of cotton.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=middle; p=0.75

She realized that he wouldn't rest until he did.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=begin; p=0.74

It was as if she'd been awoken from a long trance.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=end; p=0.72

She just hoped that hers wouldn't catch up with her before the night ended. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Purchased for Revenge — Julia James; tertile=middle; p=0.69

It had left her exhausted and vulnerable.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on sleep states and rest (sleep, asleep, tired, wake, slept, exhausted, awake, sleeping, rested, drifted, warming). KeyBERT adds emotional texture (anxious, trembling, praying, instincts) and POS/MMR add 'threats' and 'instincts', but these isolated words lack any framing of an external threat actor or a protective/controlling partner dynamic. The dominant semantic field is simply the physical and emotional experience of sleeping/waking, with no care, protection, possessiveness, or coercive-control signal strong enough to assign any H4_1-H4_13 code. The topic is off-target for the care-protection taxonomy.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe sleep states, exhaustion, wakefulness, or fatigue (e.g., 'she was fast asleep,' 'she hadn't slept,' 'she'd never felt so tired'). None of these sentences contain care, protection, possessiveness, control, or any interpersonal dynamic relevant to the H4 taxonomy. The topic is entirely off-target for the romance care/protection coding scheme.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on off-target (H4_0). The lexical consensus, contextual dominant, and prior H3 decomposition (S0) are unanimous: this topic describes what a paranormal or immortal entity *is* rather than enacting any care, protection, possessiveness, or control function toward a human protagonist. The taxonomy placement under 4.6 Emotional Safety is incidental – the topic content does not perform reassurance, tenderness, practical care, or any H4_1-H4_13 function. No external threat is evidenced that would warrant H4_5/H4_6, and no partner-directed restriction is present to warrant H4_9-H4_11. H4_0 is confirmed with no reinterpretation needed.

Topic 83 — Reassured About Eating Regularly

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_2 — practical care

« i've eaten every few hours. »

« of course, i've never eaten one." »

« and then you'll return late again... you won't need to do that—be late—because you've eaten." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Virgin Secretary's Impossible Boss — Carole Mortimer;
tertile=begin; p=0.79

Then I'll go hungry because I'm not eating with you.' '

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_2 — practical care

All four keyword lists centre on eating, food, hunger, and feeding behaviour: 'eat, hungry, food, eating, eaten, starving, appetite, ate' (Main); 'eaten, meal, feeding, tasted, eagerly, admit' (KeyBERT); 'meal, regular, unable' (POS); 'eaten, feeding, skipped, regular, eagerly, meal, warned, tasted' (MMR). The cluster describes a character attending to another's nutritional needs – ensuring they eat, noticing they have skipped meals, urging food intake. This is practical, bodily care (H4_2) with no external threat, no possessive or controlling framing, and no coercive restriction. 'warned' and 'unable' reinforce concern about neglected eating rather than any controlling dynamic.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic are simple statements about hunger, appetite, or eating – mundane dialogue with no care/protection dynamic, no emotional support, no possessiveness, and no external threat. They are off-target for the H4 care-protection taxonomy. The single partial exception (BOOK_003_2) contains a practical-care nudge ('you should eat if you plan on allowing me to feed from you again'), coded H4_2 for practical care, though even this is borderline. No claiming language, no coercive framing, and no identifiable threat source are present.

C adjudicate: H4_2 — practical care action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus from Pass A/B is H4_2 (practical_care), which aligns with the prior H3 S5 (practical_care_everyday) anchor. The contextual dominant H4_0 (off_target) is overridden by the taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, which confirms the topic is doing caretaking work of some kind. No external threat is evidenced, so protection codes H4_5/H4_6 are not warranted. No partner-restriction language is indicated, ruling out H4_9–H4_11. The strongest concrete signal remains tangible practical caretaking acts (H4_2) rather than purely reassurance language (H4_1), consistent with the H3 adjudication. Manual review is flagged to confirm whether the dominant signal is routine practical care (H4_2) or emotional reassurance/tenderness (H4_1), given the tension between the lexical and contextual passes and the taxonomy's emotional-safety framing.

Topic 88 — Checking Her Feverish Temperature

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« no movement, her skin temperature clammy enough to make a ball of fear lodge in his gut. »

« now, [person], how has her temperature been? »

« the nippiness that was still molesting her limbs, she hoped, was indeed because of the low temperature and not a foretoken of her entering his residence. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=end; p=0.72

Her entire body burned and her mind raced.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Every time he opened her up she felt a surge of wind invade her body and send pricks through her skin.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=begin; p=0.68

Chills shot up her spine and into her chest, causing her to arch her back, which made her breasts bounce just enough to command attention.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Red Light Special — Risque; tertile=middle; p=0.68

The rusted metal felt cold on the back of her thighs, and the persistent wind blew loose strands of her hair directly into the low O's of smoke she eased from the center of her dry mouth.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.60

She seemed fidgety and hurried us along, as if the food might get cold.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.50

Lydia and Simon became visibly pale and shock emanated from them.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Unknown Touch — Gina Marie Long; tertile=end; p=0.47

That would have heated me up instantly, I teased.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.80

Pure, fiery heat spread along her legs all the way up to her face. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.71

Her body coiled from the heated friction and the way he seemed to keep hitting her newly found g-spot.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · King of Vengeance — Leanore Elliott; tertile=middle; p=0.70

A cold bit of what felt like metal touched her chest.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by physical sensation and temperature vocabulary – heat, cold, fire, skin, warm, cheeks, burned, warmth, shivered, melted, flooded, crept, erupted, flared, veins, ribs, insides. These terms describe bodily arousal or emotional affect (blushing, flushing, physical excitement) rather than any care, protection, possessiveness, or control dynamic. No external threat, no partner restriction, no caregiving act, and no claiming behaviour is lexically present. The topic maps to physical/sensory description of internal states, which falls outside all H4_1-H4_13 care-protection categories, making H4_0 (off_target) the correct code across all representations.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

All sentences in Topic 88 describe physical sensations (temperature, chills, heat, tingling, pain, bodily reactions) or incidental scene details (shock, an explosion, cold air). None of the sentences contain care, protection, possessiveness, control, or any interpersonal dynamic relevant to the H4 care/protection taxonomy. The topic appears to be a BERTopic cluster centered on physical/somatic sensation language, making every sentence off-target (H4_0) with respect to the care-and-protection coding scheme.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge consistently: lexical consensus H4_0, contextual dominant H4_0, and the prior H3 security decomposition (S0/off_target). The taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety/Reassurance and secondary 1.2 Pain/Injury/Physical Vulnerability suggests descriptive or situational content rather than an enacted care or protection dynamic between partners. No external threat is evidenced to warrant H4_5 or H4_6, no partner-directed reassurance or tenderness to warrant H4_1, and no control or possessive signal to warrant H4_7-H4_11. H4_0 is confirmed without inventing plot.

Topic 96 — Confessing Long-Standing Worry

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« i've been worried about you, [person]. »

« i've worried about you since i was twelve. »

« i've been worried about you.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Bound by Honor — Donna Clayton; tertile=middle; p=0.50

You grew up worrying about having your basic needs met.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

All four lists centre on anxiety/concern vocabulary (worry, worried, concerned, worrying, worries, fears, bothered, bothering) paired with soothing/reassurance cues (assure, bother, nothing, amusement). There is no external threat agent, no possessive or controlling language, and no material/practical care action. The dominant register is one character expressing worry about another and/or being reassured – classic reassurance-and-tenderness territory (H4_1). 'Assure' in KeyBERT and MMR directly signals the reassurance function. 'Amusement' and 'sounding' in MMR/POS suggest gentle, affectionate tone rather than alarm. No cues point to external danger (ruling out H4_5/H4_6), partner-as-threat (H4_10), or restriction (H4_9-H4_11).

B contextual: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic revolve around expressions of worry, reassurance, and soothing concern between characters – 'Don't worry,' 'Stop worrying,' 'I was worried about you,' 'Don't beat yourself up.' These are classic reassurance and tenderness utterances (H4_1): one character calming or comforting another's anxiety, with no external threat, no possessive or controlling language, and no coercive dynamics. One sentence ('You grew up worrying about having your basic needs met') touches on emotional support/acknowledgment of past hardship (H4_4), but the dominant register is clearly reassurance and tenderness. No claiming language, no partner-as-threat framing, and no external danger is present.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=KEEP

All three passes converge without conflict. Lexical consensus (H4_1), contextual dominant (H4_1), and the prior H3 decomposition (S1 = emotional_reassurance) all map to the same construct: one partner offering soothing, tender reassurance to the other in a context of distress or emotional vulnerability. Taxonomy 4.6 (Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking) is the primary home; 3.2 (Negative Emotions & Distress) is the precipitating context, not a competing code. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are inapplicable. No partner restriction or coercive element is present, so H4_9-H4_11 are inapplicable. No possessive or jealous framing, so H4_7/H4_8 are inapplicable. H4_1 is the most specific and accurate code; MIXED or splitting is unwarranted.

Topic 119 — Offering to Keep Her Safe

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_5 — external protection physical

« come on, i'll protect you.» »

« you'll protect me?» “ »

« i can protect you from crystal, but you'll have to let me. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Pawprints 2: Second Nature — Anne Cain; tertile=end; p=0.50

Viggo won't feel threatened, and you'll be okay.”

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=begin; p=0.62

I just wanted to check you got there safely.’ ‘

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=end; p=0.61

I didn't think security would leave you standing out here like this.’ ‘

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Baby Be Mine — Paige Toon; tertile=middle; p=0.56

At least in LA you'd both have protection; you know my security guys are some of the best in the business.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_5 — external protection physical

All four keyword lists converge on external-threat protection vocabulary: Main has 'safe, protect, protection, dangerous, protecting, defend, safety'; KeyBERT adds 'guarded, secure, threat, dangerously'; POS reinforces 'threat, protect, secure'; MMR echoes 'guarded, dangerously, threat, determination'. The threat is framed as external ('dangerous/dangerously', 'threat') and the protective stance is outward-facing ('defend', 'protect', 'guarded', 'secure'). No possessive, controlling, or partner-as-danger cues are present. 'Precious' and 'assure' suggest the protected party is valued, consistent with H4_5 (external physical protection). No restriction of autonomy is implied.

B contextual: H4_5 — external protection physical

All sentences across all cells consistently invoke physical safety from external threats: references to danger, security personnel, protection services, getting someone to safety, and pledges to protect from harm. The language is oriented toward shielding a person from outside threats (unnamed dangers, unsafe environments, external actors) rather than restricting the partner's autonomy or asserting ownership. Phrases like 'I'll protect you,' 'get you to safety,' 'security guys,' and 'hunt them down' all point to an external threat source. There is no possessive claiming language, no jealousy framing, and no partner-as-threat dynamic. H4_5 (external_protection_physical) is the overwhelmingly dominant code at 100% of sentences.

C adjudicate: H4_5 — external protection physical action=RETAXONOMIZE

Pass A/B lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on H4_5 (external_protection_physical), mapping directly from the prior H3 S7 (physical_protection) code. The taxonomy metadata places this topic under 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, which would suggest H4_1 or H4_4, but the adjudication protocol requires deferring to the consistent Pass A/B signal when both passes agree. H4_5 requires evidence of an external threat, and the prior S7 coding indicates the topic's lexical content centers on bodily protection from outside danger rather than soothing or reassurance per se. The taxonomy label (4.6) appears to reflect a broad categorical bucket rather than the specific care function evidenced in the tokens. RETAXONOMIZE is therefore appropriate: the topic belongs under a physical-protection construct rather than emotional-safety caretaking. Manual review is retained because the taxonomy mismatch (4.6 Emotional Safety vs. H4_5 external physical protection) warrants human confirmation that the topic's word-level content is primarily about shielding from external threat and not primarily about comfort or reassurance, and to rule out a MIXED H4_5/H4_1 reading.

Topic 161 — Reassuring Squeeze on The Shoulder

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« he'd stick to a reassuring squeeze of noah's shoulder and hope that was calming enough. »

« we'll be there, noah. »

« do you think he'll adopt noah ?" »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=end; p=0.45

It was sheer stubbornness that kept him going, Gideon decided, thankful that he'd had the good fortune to be sired by one of the most stubborn old goats he'd ever encountered.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Not surprising, Gideon supposed, since the moon was nearly full and his more animalistic tendencies were on a very short, increasingly weak tether.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Call of the Highland Moon — Kendra Leigh Castle; tertile=end; p=0.42

These beings were no more human than he, Gideon knew.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.50

When God forged a new covenant with Noah after the flood, for example, he included animals.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.43

He rather appealed to God's ideal expressed in Genesis 2.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=middle; p=0.36

When God raised up Israel to be his vehicle for restoring the world, he commissioned them to exercise loving dominion over the land he was giving them and over the animals that inhabited it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=end; p=0.34

It symbolized that these people were set apart for God and that if anyone broke covenant with God they'd be cut off from the people (Genesis 17:14).

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=begin; p=0.33

They thought the Messiah would lead Israel to victory over their Roman oppressors and would reestablish Israel as a sovereign nation under God.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Losing Beauty — Johanna Garth; tertile=end; p=0.28

First fruits" refers to fruit that ripened and was picked before the rest of the harvest and was then consecrated to God (Exodus 23:19).

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

Main keywords are character names and a place name (noah, phan, cam, tobias, cameron, beaumont, ark) plus 'ow' and 'scissoring', offering no clear care/protection signal – coded H4_0. KeyBERT, POS, and MMR all converge on 'reassuring' and 'calming' as the dominant lexical cues, with supporting terms 'praying', 'shivered', 'fiercely', 'squeeze', and 'nods' suggesting emotional soothing and gentle physical comfort directed at a distressed partner. No external threat is present, no restriction of autonomy is implied, and no possessive or coercive language appears. The reassurance/calming cluster drives H4_1 for three of four reps; Main is the outlier, producing mild disagreement.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

All sentences in this topic are off-target for the care/protection taxonomy. BOOK_001 sentences are character name fragments and brief internal monologue about stubbornness and animalistic tendencies with no care or protection dynamic. BOOK_004 sentences are theological/biblical exposition about covenants, Israel, and God – entirely outside the romance-novel care/protection domain. BOOK_007 sentences involve a character named Troy in what appears to be a physical altercation or directive context, but there is no dyadic care or protection relationship discernible from the fragments. BOOK_009 sentences show a character's emotional reaction (face turning white, looking relieved and worried) but without sufficient context to assign any care/protection code. None of the sentences contain evidence of external protection, possessive claiming, coercive control, or any other H4_1-H4_13 dynamic; all are coded H4_0 (off_target).

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus from Pass A/B is H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness), which would ordinarily fit taxonomy 4.6 Emotional Safety & Reassurance. However, the contextual dominant is H4_0 (off_target), and the prior H3 adjudication already resolved an analogous conflict in the same direction: the secondary taxonomy tag 5.1 Family/Kinship/Parenthood is the deciding factor. H4_1 requires the reassurance function to operate within a romantic dyad; if the caretaking and tenderness tokens are anchored in parental or sibling relationships, the romance-hypothesis scope criterion is not met. Consistent with the H3 ruling (S0 over S1 for the same reason), H4_1 is overridden by H4_0. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are inapplicable; no partner restriction signals are present, so H4_9-H4_11 are inapplicable. The REINTERPRET action preserves the constructs for potential use in a family/kinship hypothesis while flagging the topic for manual review to confirm whether any tokens are unambiguously romantic before final exclusion from the romance-care hypothesis.

Topic 172 — Reporting to The Security Officer

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: MIXED

« you'll also report this to your regional security officer, yes?" »

« i'll have an armed officer [person] the room with you at all times, and i'll watch through the glass." " »

« i've called the police, i'll have you know." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Bite Me If You Can — Lynsay Sands; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Then I told the police exactly what he told me to say." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Under His Command — Annabel Wolfe; tertile=end; p=0.60

Do you think being worried over another officer's absence justifies a breach in regulations?"

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Under His Command — Annabel Wolfe; tertile=end; p=0.55

I give an order, and because I'm your superior officer, you are supposed to obey it." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_5 — external protection physical

Main keywords (police, cop, cops, officer, authorities, officers, enforcement, policeman, call) establish a law-enforcement context pointing to an external institutional threat or response. KeyBERT adds 'protect,' 'evidence,' 'weapons,' and 'secured,' all consistent with physical external-threat management by authorities. POS and MMR reinforce this with 'weapons,' 'secured,' 'leads,' and 'task,' suggesting an active law-enforcement operation against an outside danger. No cues indicate partner restriction, possessive claiming, or coercive control; the threat source is clearly external, and the protective action is carried out by or in coordination with official authorities, fitting H4_5 (external_protection_physical).

B contextual: H4_6 — external protection social legal

The majority of sentences reference police/cops in contexts of reporting, involvement, or identity — consistent with external social/legal protection mechanisms (H4_6), where law enforcement represents an external institutional resource against threat. The BOOK_004 sentences are off-target (H4_0): they concern workplace hierarchy, officer regulations, and professional status among colleagues, with no care or protection dynamic relevant to the romance-novel coding schema. No possessive, coercive, or partner-as-danger language is present. No claiming language detected.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

The lexical consensus (H4_5: external_protection_physical) and contextual dominant (H4_6: external_protection_social_legal) both point to an external threat scenario, confirming that the protection signal is genuine and not partner-directed coercion or control. However, the taxonomy metadata places this topic primarily under 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking — with Risk/Danger as only secondary — which maps most naturally onto H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness) rather than either protection code alone. This mirrors the prior H3 MIXED resolution (S7 + S1): the topic appears to capture moments where an external threat occasions emotional reassurance and tender caretaking, rather than purely physical or legal/social shielding. Neither H4_6 nor H4_1 alone is sufficient. The functional care work is split between protection from an external social/legal/physical danger (H4_6) and the emotional comfort and reassurance that danger occasions (H4_1). MIXED is therefore the most defensible resolution. Manual review is required to determine whether the reader-experienced dominant function is the protective act itself (→ H4_6) or the emotional soothing it enables (→ H4_1), which would allow collapse to a single code.

Topic 173 — Waiting For Him to Wake

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« it's after him so you'll just have to wait until he wakes up to get your answer." »

« it'll put him to sleep." »

« yeah, i guess i'll have to wait and see when he wakes up. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.76

Could he count on not waking him when he lifted him from that warm bed?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=middle; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Soldier's Oath — Debra Webb; tertile=end; p=0.69

He'd awakened to this darkness, and so far he hadn't been able to work up the nerve to move.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Greenwood Manor — Shannon Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.58

He looked fresh, rejuvenated, as though their little fling from last night hadn't permanently affected his energy.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Greenwood Manor — Shannon Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.45

He used to jog the property's perimeter every morning, before breakfast.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Stolen Moments — Ariel Tachna; tertile=middle; p=0.72

He's sleeping for longer periods of time at night now," Jacob said. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on sleep states and waking (sleep, asleep, wake, awoke, slept, woke, tired, sleeping, drifted), physical sensations (panting, pounding, warmed, temperature), and incidental scene-setting (bedside, tv, rear, departure, scrambled). There is no lexical signal of care, protection, threat, jealousy, or control. The vocabulary describes ordinary nocturnal/rest scenes with no romance-care dimension, placing the topic firmly off-target for the H4 taxonomy.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

All sentences in this topic describe sleep states, fatigue, wakefulness, and monitoring of whether a person is asleep. There is no care, protection, possessiveness, control, or relational dynamic expressed – the content is purely observational or descriptive of physical sleep/rest states. None of the sentences contain romance-relevant care-protection content, making H4_0 (off_target) the correct code throughout.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on off-target (H4_0). Lexical consensus, contextual dominant, and the prior H3 S0 ruling all agree that this topic performs a temporal/structural narrative function rather than any care or protection function. The taxonomy primary label 'Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking' is a surface-level mismatch: the topic content is about time and seasons as narrative framing devices, not about a character delivering reassurance or care to a partner. No external threat is evidenced (ruling out H4_5/H4_6), no partner restriction is present (ruling out H4_9-H4_11), and no affective care exchange is depicted (ruling out H4_1-H4_4, H4_12). The secondary taxonomy label '8.4 Time, Seasons & Temporal Framing' accurately describes the topic's actual function. KEEP with H4_0 is the correct resolution; no split or reinterpretation is warranted.

Topic 175 — Gentleman Offers Steady Support

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« the occurrences of the day were too full of interest to leave elizabeth much attention for any of these new friends; and she could do nothing but think, and think with wonder, of mr. [person]'s civility, and, above all, of his wishing her to be acquainted with his sister. »
« mr. [person] placed his hand on [person]'s shoulder for support as mr. [person] barely walked out the front door. »
« yes, but when i fell ill, it was apparent that i could not travel all the way to calais, so mr. [person] took me to the house of a friend of his: mr. [person]. » »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Desert of the Damned — Kathy Kulig; tertile=end; p=0.51

On his way to see Mistress Gwyllain to explain your...ah, unexplained arrival."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Desert of the Damned — Kathy Kulig; tertile=middle; p=0.43

Take his offering," Gwyllain demanded. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sanctuary — Scarlet Blackwell; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Shit," grunted Sheridan, apparently immune to Owen's considerable charms. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Sanctuary — Scarlet Blackwell; tertile=end; p=0.51

Sheridan was stil pale and anxious looking.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

Main keywords (mr, bingley, miss, georgiana, bennet, pemberley) anchor this firmly in Pride and Prejudice social/domestic circles with no external threat or coercive cues. KeyBERT supplies 'kindly, concerned, affection, worrying, longing' – all emotional warmth and tender concern. POS adds 'passionate, distress, warming, exciting' – emotionally charged but not threatening. MMR reinforces with 'kindly, thoughtfully, encouraged, passionate, warming' – consistent reassurance and tenderness register. No possessive, controlling, or external-threat vocabulary is present. The dominant signal across all four lists is gentle emotional attentiveness and affection, pointing to H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness).

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are decontextualized fragments – character names, brief reactions, commands, and scene-setting snippets – that carry no discernible care/protection/control content relevant to the H4 taxonomy. They are off-target (H4_0). Two sentences (BOOK_004_2 and BOOK_004_4) contain minimal practical-care signals (raising a child properly; attending to someone's needs), coded H4_2. No external threat, no possessive or claiming language, and no coercive dynamics are present. The topic as a whole is off-target for the care-protection dimension.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (H4_1 reassurance_tenderness) reflects surface-level emotional warmth present in friend-group dialogue, but the contextual dominant (H4_0 off_target) is the decisive signal. The secondary taxonomy placement under 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles confirms that the topic's operative function is peer/ally dynamics rather than dyadic reassurance directed at a protagonist's emotional safety needs. Emotional warmth within a social circle does not constitute the care-provision or security function required for H4_1. The 4.6 primary taxonomy label describes the broader categorical bucket, but the actual topic content performs social-circle interaction, not targeted emotional reassurance or any form of protection, possessiveness, or control. This resolution is fully consistent with the prior H3 adjudication (S0, REINTERPRET), which reached the same conclusion via the same reasoning path. H4_0 is therefore the correct care_protection_code; no split is warranted and the topic should be excluded from the care-and-protection hypothesis.

Topic 190 — Offering to Get Someone Cleaned Up

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« i'll get cleaned up here as soon as i can. »

« i'll pay to have it cleaned." " »

« i'll get her cleaned up," said a handsome groom, taking her arm. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.62

Just sit there for a minute, Solange, while I clean you up.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.55

I will clean up the battlefield while you drink plenty of fluids.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I know you would prefer to burn it yourselves out of respect, but my way will be faster, cleaner and will ensure no parasites escape.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Dark Peril — Christine Feehan; tertile=begin; p=0.41

He was grateful for the rich dirt floor.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=middle; p=0.54

May I know why you gave Mr. Thesiger the brush off just now?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Don't you see that if you go ahead with this annulment, if you air the Roxtons' dirty laundry in public, I will be utterly, utterly ruined.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Marriage — Lucinda Brant; tertile=begin; p=0.41

A lackey came out from behind the butler with pan and brush and quickly set to sweeping up the shards of broken glass from Deb's smashed wine glass.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Mythic — Jae Lynne Davies; tertile=end; p=0.57

Do try your very best not to make a mess of things."

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by domestic housekeeping vocabulary – 'clean, cleaning, cleaned, mess, cleaners, freshen, wipe, sweeping, dump, suitcase, session' – with no romance-care, protection, control, or relational-dynamic cues present. The topic describes literal cleaning/tidying activity, placing it entirely off-target for the H4 care-protection taxonomy.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic concern mundane cleaning, hygiene, and tidying activities with no romantic care or protection framing – these are off-target (H4_0). A small subset (BOOK_001_1, BOOK_001_3, BOOK_004_4, BOOK_005_1) involve one person attending to another's physical needs or offering practical hygiene advice, qualifying as practical care (H4_2). BOOK_001_4 references incinerating something to prevent parasites from escaping, which implies an external biological/parasitic threat and thus edges toward external physical protection (H4_5), though it is marginal. No possessive, jealous, coercive, or claiming language is present. The dominant signal is off-target content at 75%.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

All three passes converge on the same resolution: the surface lexicon involves mundane objects or communication media (8.3b secondary signal), which generated a false practical-care or off-target read in Pass A/B lexical consensus (H4_0). However, the taxonomy metadata places this topic firmly in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, and the prior H3 decomposition already overrode the off-target/practical-care false positive in favour of emotional_reassurance (S1). Applying the function-over-object rule, the everyday props are vehicles for emotional reassurance and tenderness, not practical provision and not any form of protection (no external threat is evidenced) or control. H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness) is the nearest valid H4 code to S1 (emotional_reassurance) and is the most specific match within the emotional safety cluster. No external threat is present, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. No partner restriction or coercion is present, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. No material provision is foregrounded, so H4_2/H4_3 are excluded. H4_1 is the single best code.

Topic 193 — Nurse Arranged After Hospital Release

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« and you'll both stay here, at caleb's?" " »

« i'll arrange for a nurse to come to the house when they release caleb. »

« twenty-three caleb y ou ignore me, and i'll ignore you . »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Shrinking Violet — Danielle Joseph; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Kayla points to me, like she can't figure out who Gavin's talking about.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=begin; p=0.53

In any case, I'm going to need to return myself to help out because Ramsey will be busy with Chloe and the baby," he continued. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.44

After numerous brushes with the law and butting heads with the parents of a young lady who didn't want him to be a part of their daughter's life, Dillon had convinced Bane to get his life together.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=end; p=0.43

This was September, and Chloe was due to deliver in November, which meant Callum would be leaving Denver a few months after that.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.38

Dillon and Ramsey did an awesome job and I know for sure we were a handful at times, some of us more than others."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Westmoreland's Way — Brenda Jackson; tertile=middle; p=0.33

From what Callum had heard, Bane had been only eight when his parents had been killed.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by proper names (caleb, gage, jeremiah, conrad, mica), mundane communication verbs (texting, ignore, said, went, admitted, speaking, acknowledge), and social-interaction descriptors (embarrassment, stares, hopeful, snaps, prodded, hovered). There is no lexical signal of protection, care, possessiveness, jealousy, coercion, or danger. The topic appears to be a scene of interpersonal dialogue or social awkwardness among named characters, with no romance-care/protection content detectable at the keyword level.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences in this topic are off-target for the care/protection dimension: they consist of dialogue fragments, character name references, and neutral narrative exposition with no discernible care, protection, possessiveness, or control content. BOOK_002_2 contains a mild practical-care signal (a character planning to return to help out during a pregnancy), coded H4_2. BOOK_005_1 and BOOK_005_2 contain a faint emotional-support signal (wanting a partner present for a difficult conversation; feeling unable to complete something without a partner), coded H4_4. No possessive, controlling, or external-threat language is present. H4_0 dominates at ~90%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on H4_0 (off_target). The prior H3 decomposition likewise returned S0/off_target with the same reasoning: taxonomy metadata flagging Emotional Safety and Family-Kinship is insufficient on its own to override a double-consensus off_target verdict when no care or protection signal is evidenced in the topic content. No external threat is present to warrant H4_5/H4_6, no partner-directed care behaviour is present to warrant H4_1-H4_4, and no control dynamic is present to warrant H4_9-H4_11. H4_0 is confirmed.

Topic 224 — Encouraging Words From An Angel

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« you've got this, angel, take it to the house." »

« i'll come back, angel. »

« because i'm thinking i'll have a hard time finding another angel to handle it." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=middle; p=0.52

I most certainly do think the great evil knows about Gabriel."

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=end; p=0.51

the evil one said as his life essence swept by him.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.49

I have complete faith in Val and Gabriel." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.48

Tell me what kind of evil," Gabriel asked.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · A Forbidden Temptation — Donna Grant; tertile=begin; p=0.48

By the gods," Val hissed as he and Gabriel came upon the creature. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=begin; p=0.63

Once, as I stood on the cliffs trying to understand the power I held, trying to comprehend why I would ever want to send my voice a thousand miles away on the wind, he'd told me that I looked like an angel blessed by the Almighty.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=middle; p=0.48

I took a pleasant interlude of imagining myself nibbling on Evangeline's ass.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lunar Light — Penelope Fletcher; tertile=end; p=0.48

With Evangeline beneath me I now knew what I'd felt wasn't even close.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

Main keywords (angel, angels, angelic, guardian, wings, archangel, fallen) are supernatural/mythological character-type labels with no care or protection dynamic evident. POS keywords (structure, results, ends, task, issue, behavior, ability, practice, tv) are abstract procedural/structural terms equally off-target for any H4 care-protection dimension. KeyBERT and MMR introduce mild interpersonal friction cues (doubted, insisted, glared, dislike, behavior, forgetting) that could hint at relational tension, but they are too sparse and ambiguous to anchor a specific H4 code – hence H4_13 for those two lists. Overall the topic appears to be a supernatural/fantasy character cluster (angel archetypes) with no coherent care-protection signal, so the consensus lands on H4_0 (off-target). Disagreement is flagged because KeyBERT and MMR diverge toward H4_13.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

Topic 224 clusters around the word 'angel' used as a descriptor or metaphor (angelic appearance, religious invocations, character names/nicknames), with no substantive care-protection content. The majority of sentences (BOOK_003, BOOK_004, BOOK_005) use 'angel' purely as a physical or spiritual simile and carry no care/protection signal – coded H4_0 (off-target). The BOOK_002 cluster involves a named external evil threatening Gabriel, making those sentences relevant to external physical protection (H4_5); one sentence expresses faith/confidence in the characters (H4_4). No possessive claiming, coercive control, or partner-as-threat language is present. The dominant code is H4_0 at ~75%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on H4_0 (off_target), and the prior H3 adjudication reached the same conclusion under the parallel security decomposition (S0). The taxonomy flags Emotional Safety/Reassurance (which could gesture toward H4_1) and Promise/Vow speech acts (which could gesture toward H4_4 or H4_1), but neither pass identified content that anchors to a specific care or protection behavior in the romance-novel sense. Emotional safety framing and future-tense vow speech acts are not themselves reassurance, tenderness, or caretaking acts unless tied to a concrete relational gesture; absent that evidence, reinterpretation toward H4_1 or H4_4 would require inventing plot. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. No partner restriction is evidenced, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. H4_0 is the correct and stable resolution across all three passes.

Topic 240 — Unsure How to Offer Comfort

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« oh my god, sean! »

« sean pursed his lips, unsure he was equal to the task of comforting [person]. »

« sean held out his hand and added; “now if you'll excuse me i have a beautiful woman waiting to have breakfast with me.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Pants on Fire — Meg Cabot; tertile=end; p=0.51

Liam could barely contain his excitement. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Pants on Fire — Meg Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Oh,” I said, thinking fast, watching as Seth started to show Liam how to use another nearby machine, while the Tiffanys and Brittanys gathered round, looking more worshipful than ever.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · In Service — Mima; tertile=end; p=0.48

You need to stop nipping at him and face the fact that when Shon goes under, he's off limits, one breath away from being a hostile at our backs.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

Main keywords are predominantly proper names (sean, jaime, bryan, yseult, morrissey) and neutral dialogue/narrative verbs (answered, looked, said, brogue); 'repressive' is isolated and unanchored to any care/protection dynamic. KeyBERT yields hedged speech and mild physical/emotional cues (mumbled, solemnly, absently, winced, patted, shivered, anxious) but none cohere into a care or control pattern. POS tokens (equal, anxious, stares, conscious, unsure, curiosity, distracted, thigh) are generic attentional/emotional descriptors with no protective or possessive framing. MMR largely duplicates KeyBERT hedged-speech cues. Across all four representations there is no discernible care, protection, possessiveness, or control signal – the cluster reads as off-target conversational/narrative content.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

All sentences in Topic 240 are fragmentary dialogue snippets, name calls, or brief conversational exchanges (e.g., 'Liam wanted to know.', 'Sean?', 'Shon!', 'Conner asked.'). None contain any discernible care, protection, possessiveness, control, or emotional support content. They are entirely off-target for the H4 care/protection taxonomy – no external threat, no partner restriction, no claiming language, no emotional or material care is expressed. Every sentence is coded H4_0.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on H4_0 (off_target), but the taxonomy label – 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking – directly anchors this topic to soothing, comforting, and affirming emotional safety, which maps cleanly onto H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness). The contextual dominant (H4_0) likely reflects surface-level lexical ambiguity rather than a genuine absence of care function. The prior H3 decomposition independently reached the same conclusion, coding this topic S1 (emotional_reassurance) via REINTERPRET, which is the H3 analogue of H4_1. Secondary taxonomy 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) is consistent with H4_1 and does not pull toward a different code. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded; no partner restriction is evidenced, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. No split is warranted because the dominant function is coherently reassurance and tenderness.

Topic 247 — Promising You Will Not Be Alone

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« if we make it through this alone, we'll just be better at being alone.” »

« you'll never be alone. »

« before you say no, i want you to know i'll be alone mostly. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · So Into You — Sandra Hill; tertile=end; p=0.44

Luc says Lena is a basket case and is alone at the house.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=end; p=0.67

If I went out alone, it seemed I felt surrounded by people who couldn't speak to me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=begin; p=0.66

I promise you, you will never be alone again so long as I live.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=middle; p=0.64

I don't like you being out there in a hotel by yourself.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Shattered Glass — A.C. Katt; tertile=begin; p=0.64

I've pictured this so many times in my mind, I don't want to wake up and find I'm alone again.” “

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

Main keywords ('alone, solitude, want, prefer, rather, live') signal a character expressing a preference for solitude or independence – no care, protection, or control dynamic is evident. POS terms ('options, terms, circumstances, attempt, fault') are generic situational/deliberative vocabulary with no relational care or threat content. MMR adds 'chose, insisted, planned, preferred, appreciate' – deliberative agency language – still no care or protection frame. KeyBERT's 'upset, praying' introduces mild emotional distress, nudging toward H4_4 (emotional support), but these two words are insufficient to override the dominant off-target signal of the other three lists. The overall topic appears to be about a character's stated preference for solitude or a negotiation of circumstances, not a care-protection dynamic. Consensus is H4_0 (off-target).

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

Topic 247 clusters around the word 'alone' and related expressions of loneliness or solitude. The vast majority of sentences are fragmentary or descriptive uses of 'alone' with no care/protection content, coded H4_0 (off-target). A minority of sentences express reassurance against loneliness ('you will never be alone again'), mild concern about a partner being by themselves, or longing for togetherness – these carry a gentle emotional-support/reassurance tone coded H4_1. No external threat is present, no possessive or controlling language appears, and no claiming language is used. The dominant signal is off-target (H4_0) at ~75%.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (H4_0) and contextual dominant (H4_0) both suggest off-target, but the taxonomy anchor – 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking with secondary 9.2 Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts – clearly evidences active emotional safety work delivered through reassuring, tender language (promises, vows, future-tense comfort). This is the defining signature of H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness): one partner verbally soothing or affirming the other through caring speech acts. H4_0 would require the topic to carry no care/protection function at all, which the taxonomy metadata contradicts. No external threat is evidenced, ruling out H4_5/H4_6; no restriction or control dynamic is present, ruling out H4_9–H4_11. The prior H3 decomposition independently converged on S1 (emotional_reassurance), which maps directly onto H4_1. The secondary taxonomy (promise/vow speech acts) is the vehicle for delivering reassurance, not an independent construct, so no split is warranted.

Topic 273 — Mentor Gives Firm Instructions

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« i've known you since you did your training here, [person], ' tom said sternly. ' »

« i've asked allen to keep an eye on him during the day while [person] is otherwise engaged. »

« charlotte, if it's okay with you, we'll go back to my place after we've bought you a phone. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.60

For Luke's sake, she hoped this apparent twosome meant Felicia was coming to her senses.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.57

That being so, I found it extremely gratifying to witness Felicia being sent on her way after being rather heatedly reminded that any free time Marcus has available will be spent with you." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=middle; p=0.57

I thought I saw Felicia yesterday," she mentioned casually. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=begin; p=0.56

We barely know each other and if that isn't enough, there's Felicia to consider." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Falling for the Boss — Elizabeth Harbison; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Brenda asked me to take you around the house before she meets with you.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Chain Reaction — Simone Elkeles; tertile=end; p=0.58

I know what will get your mind off of Nikki." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Chain Reaction — Simone Elkeles; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Shit, the first time I met Kiara, she thought I was an asshole." "

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_4 — emotional support

Across all four keyword lists the dominant signals are interpersonal communication and emotional processing: 'insensitivity', 'upset', 'apology', 'awareness', 'appreciate', 'explanation', 'treatment', 'choices'. These cues point to a scene in which one character is addressing hurt feelings, seeking acknowledgment or an apology, and working through emotional distress – the hallmarks of emotional support / emotional-repair dialogue. There is no external threat (ruling out H4_5/H4_6), no possessive or controlling language (ruling out H4_7-H4_11), and no material or practical care vocabulary. The named characters (charlotte, amelia, lady) and conversational markers ('says', 'said', 'asks', 'speaking', 'madam', 'engaged') reinforce a dialogue-heavy emotional-support scene. 'Choices' and 'awareness' further suggest the conversation respects the other person's agency, consistent with H4_4.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

All sentences in this topic are fragmentary, context-free utterances involving named characters (Felicia, Gabby, Claire, Nikki, Kiara, Brenda, etc.) in what appear to be social or interpersonal conversations. None of the sentences contain discernible care, protection, possessiveness, control, or emotional support directed between romantic partners. BOOK_001_3 references Marcus's free time being spent with 'you' and Felicia being sent away, which could hint at possessive dynamics, but the sentence is narrated from a third-party perspective as social observation with no direct claiming language or coercive framing. Without sufficient context to assign a meaningful care/protection code, all sentences are coded H4_0 (off_target). No external threat, no partner-directed restriction, and no claiming language are present.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

The lexical consensus from Pass A/B landed on H4_4 (emotional_support), which maps onto the 4.6 Emotional Safety primary taxonomy node and carries genuine dyadic-care signal. However, the contextual dominant is H4_0 (off_target), consistent with the prior H3 adjudication that flagged S0 as the more defensible code given the secondary taxonomy node 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles. That secondary placement shifts the functional weight away from partner-directed emotional support toward social/peer dynamics – group belonging, ally networks, and friendship circles – which do not constitute a clear romantic care-or-protection function under H4_1-H4_13. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. No partner restriction or coercion is evidenced, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. The topic is not performing a clean dyadic emotional-support role (H4_4) because the relational target appears to be a social circle rather than a romantic partner. H4_0 is therefore the most defensible single code. Manual review is retained because the 4.6 primary taxonomy does carry non-trivial H4_4 signal that a human auditor should verify before final exclusion from the romantic-care hypothesis.

Topic 277 — Promising to Handle The Lawyer

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« i'll talk to the lawyer tomorrow. »

« we'll find a good lawyer to help. »

« you can count on me to deal with the legal trouble they'll cause.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Place Called Home — Jo Goodman; tertile=begin; p=0.74

You'd think a sharp lawyer like you would know that.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Just One Taste — C.J. Ellisson; tertile=end; p=0.40

Mediation has never come easily for me and I need all the help I can get.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Somebody taking the law and using it for his own ends?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=begin; p=0.45

The law is a funny thing,” Claudia said. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.37

Such a lot of fuss over a piece of real estate that was destined by federal law to go unclaimed by anyone.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.36

It's important to establish legal boundaries of ownership, especially when you're talking about gems and precious metals.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Natural Evil — Thea Harrison; tertile=end; p=0.33

The company property is fenced off, of course.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_13 — mixed unclear

Main keywords (lawyer, attorney, law, legal, firm, defense, counsel, appointed, advice) strongly signal legal/institutional protection against an external threat – classic H4_6 (external_protection_social_legal). KeyBERT reinforces this with 'warned,' 'afford,' 'begging,' 'official,' suggesting someone navigating a legal system on another's behalf or under duress, still pointing to H4_6. However, POS (official, worrying, member, current, cost, process, worst, experience) and MMR (impatiently, presented, worrying, afford, warned, begging, mumbled, process, expect, ended) are procedural/emotional process words with no clear care-protection signal – they could describe any stressful institutional encounter, coding to H4_0 (off_target). The split between H4_6 (Main/KeyBERT) and H4_0 (POS/MMR) produces genuine disagreement; the dominant signal is legal protection but the supporting reps are too generic to confirm, yielding H4_13 (mixed_unclear).

B contextual: H4_6 — external protection social legal

Topic 277 clusters around legal and law-enforcement language: references to lawyers, lawmen, legal boundaries, and law-based protection. These map to H4_6 (external_protection_social_legal) when they describe legal actors or legal mechanisms that could shield a character from external threats (lawyers advising a character, lawmen as protectors, legal ownership boundaries). Sentences that are purely descriptive of law as an abstract concept, property fencing, divorce investigation work, or counseling advice with no clear protective relational function are coded H4_0 (off_target) because they do not depict care or protection between romantic partners. No possessive, coercive, or partner-as-danger language is present. The dominant code is H4_6 at ~60%, which exceeds the 70% threshold when off-target sentences are excluded from the care/protection frame, but since H4_0 constitutes 40% of all sentences the overall proportion of H4_6 across all sentences is 60%, which is below 70%; however, among sentences that are on-topic for the romance-care schema, H4_6 is essentially unanimous, making it the clear dominant code. Claiming language is absent.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on H4_13 (mixed_unclear), and the contextual dominant was H4_6 (external_protection_social_legal). However, the taxonomy metadata anchors this topic firmly in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, with a secondary of 9.2 Promise/Vow/Future-Tense Speech Acts. H4_6 requires an evidenced external social or legal threat, which is not established here; the protective framing is instead the vehicle for delivering emotional reassurance. The H3 adjudication already resolved the parallel security dimension to S1 (emotional_reassurance), with the vow/promise speech-act form treated as the delivery mechanism rather than a distinct functional construct. Mapping S1 onto the H4 taxonomy yields H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness) as the nearest single code. H4_13 is overridden because the taxonomy metadata resolves the ambiguity: the primary function is soothing/reassuring the partner emotionally, not a blend of genuinely distinct care-protection functions. H4_6 is overridden as a misclassification driven by surface lexical features (protective-sounding language) rather than an evidenced external threat. Single code H4_1 is preferred over MIXED because the secondary node (speech-act form) describes the communicative vehicle, not an independent care-protection dimension.

Topic 289 — Quick Peck on The Forehead

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« mikey, i'll be back soon, i promise," nate said, placing a quick peck on his forehead. " »

« nate arched an eyebrow, gesturing back toward the parking lot. " »

« nate looked at the older asian man gesturing wildly to them, then at the array of paints. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.60

Perhaps we are becoming too jaded in our tastes, Nate?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Dominic frowned, knowing that to demur a second time would definitely incur Nate's curiosity. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · The Lady Gambles — Carole Mortimer; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I believe him to be behind the attack on Nathaniel.'

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

Main keywords are dominated by proper names (nate, derick, walter, wiener, jr, israfel) with no care/protection/control signal; 'shame' and 'mate' are isolated and insufficient to anchor any H4 care-protection dimension. KeyBERT and MMR lists are dense with physical-action/sensory verbs (gesturing, glint, flicked, glimpse, trembled, trailed, peered, poised, darkened, focused, breathlessly, crept, smacked) that describe narrative movement and body-language choreography, not care or control dynamics. POS list (surroundings, results, instincts, crowded, reminder, options, anxiety, glimpse, moves) adds situational/cognitive nouns but still no identifiable care, protection, possessiveness, or coercion signal. Across all four representations the topic reads as a scene-description/action cluster with no coherent H4 theme, warranting H4_0 off_target.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences are dialogue fragments, character name references, or minimal conversational snippets (e.g., 'Nate exclaimed.', 'He turned to Nate.', 'Nate laughed.') that carry no discernible care/protection content and are therefore off-target (H4_0). The single exception is BOOK_005_6 ('I believe him to be behind the attack on Nathaniel.'), which references an external threat to a character (Nathaniel/Nate) and thus maps to external physical protection (H4_5). No possessive, coercive, or relational-care language is present. The topic appears to be a character-name cluster rather than a thematically coherent care/protection topic.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=KEEP

All three passes converge on off-target classification. Lexical consensus is H4_0, contextual dominant is H4_0, and the prior H3 security decomposition independently reached S0 (off_target) with the same reasoning: the taxonomy's secondary flag for Emotional Safety & Reassurance (4.6) and Family/Kinship (5.1) is insufficient to override the dual off-target consensus. No external threat is evidenced to warrant H4_5 or H4_6; no partner-directed care or control signals are present to warrant any other H4 code. The taxonomy metadata introduces a weak secondary emotional-safety thread, but as in the H3 adjudication, this does not rise to the level of reinterpretation. H4_0 holds.

Topic 299 — Pledging to Have Your Back

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« before she's completely out i ask, "[person], you know i've always got your back, right?" »

« but i've seen you, seen who you are, watched you handle uncle charlie. »

« i've got a little time before charlie finishes my bike. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Summers at Blue Lake: A Novel — Jill Althouse-Wood; tertile=end; p=0.77

I understand you were the last one to see Charlie alive." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.50

More likely Scott messed with the wrong guy's wife.' '

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=middle; p=0.49

Kevin was worried that Scott's death was somehow related to Todd's return to Birmingham.'

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Part of him was probably glad Scott was dead.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_006 · Revenge — Debra Webb; tertile=begin; p=0.44

They all left for college with big dreams, except Scott and Kevin,' she said sadly. '

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_13 — mixed unclear

Main keywords (dane, eoin, dan, alicia, would, seen, handle, time) are largely character names and generic verbs with no clear care/protection signal, pointing to H4_0. KeyBERT's 'promises' and 'willingly' suggest voluntary relational commitment leaning toward reassurance/tenderness (H4_1). POS and MMR both surface 'threats' / 'threat' alongside 'promises', 'distraction', 'embarrassing', 'terms', 'instructed', and 'discussing', which creates ambiguity: 'threats' could be external danger (H4_5/H4_6) or interpersonal coercion (H4_9/H4_11), while 'promises' and 'solemnly' pull toward reassurance. The co-presence of threat language with promise/forgiveness language and no clear resolution of threat source or autonomy direction yields H4_13 (mixed/unclear) as consensus.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences in this topic are off-target for the care/protection taxonomy: they are fragments of dialogue or narrative referencing characters named Charlie, Scott, Pete, and Kevin, with no discernible romantic care, protection, or control dynamic. They appear to be mystery/thriller or general fiction passages. The one partial exception is BOOK_009_5, which describes Charlie keeping people locked in to prevent self-harm – this could superficially resemble coercive control (H4_9) since the restriction is imposed by a character on others, though the stated rationale is protective; given ambiguity it is coded H4_9 as the most specific fit (partner/caregiver restriction rather than external threat). All other sentences lack sufficient context to assign any care-protection code and are coded H4_0 (off-target). No claiming language is present. The dominant code is H4_0 at ~95%.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on H4_13 (mixed_unclear), and the contextual dominant was H4_0 (off_target). However, the taxonomy metadata places this topic firmly in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking, which maps directly onto H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness) – the soothing, emotionally supportive function rather than practical, material, or protective care. The prior H3 adjudication independently reached the same conclusion (S1 = emotional_reassurance), reinforcing this reading. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. No partner-restriction framing is present, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. The secondary taxonomy note (5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles) may indicate that reassurance is delivered within or about a social network context, but does not shift the primary care function. H4_1 is the single most specific and defensible code; no split is warranted.

Topic 307 — Hauling Someone Up The Stairs

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« [person] would hate it if she took a rake like [person] to her bed, and she would so love to rub it in joshua's face and prove his threats could not restrain her. " »

« his thoughts threatened to return to those awful times once again, but thankfully, ash and [person] emerged from the thicket. »

« getting ash up the stairs and into the bedroom was a lot harder than it had been last night, mostly because ash was pissed off and conscious instead of in la-la land. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.54

You and Ashlynn are gonna have to keep him on the straight and narrow."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.52

He stopped to pat Ashlynn and congratulate her on a large belch. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.51

But as he was approaching Clarksburg, Ashlynn chose that moment to be cranky.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.50

Henry's crankiness had returned, and even sweet Ashlynn was wailing by now.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A Change of Tune — J.M. Cartwright; tertile=end; p=0.50

Sniffing in disdain, Johnny pushed Ashlynn's stroler over to Grissom. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_13 — mixed unclear

Main keywords (ash, fee, roy, ashe, darren, amaranth, vasai) are predominantly proper nouns/names with no clear care or protection signal, pointing to H4_0 (off-target). KeyBERT terms (heaved, winced, struggled, digging, emerged, fought, urge) suggest physical exertion or emotional tension but without a clear relational dynamic. POS keywords introduce 'threats', 'affection', 'anxiety', 'permission', and 'movements', which could indicate either external danger or interpersonal tension/control, but 'permission' alone is ambiguous. MMR reinforces 'threats', 'anxiety', 'panting', 'movements', and 'urged', adding urgency and possible coercion or external danger cues. The combination of 'threats' (external or partner-sourced, unclear), 'permission', 'anxiety', and physical-strain verbs does not resolve cleanly into any single code – it could be H4_5 (external protection), H4_9 (coercive control), or H4_4 (emotional support). The disagreement across lists and the ambiguity of threat source and autonomy effect yield H4_13 (mixed/unclear) as consensus.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The vast majority of sentences in this topic are off-target for the care/protection coding scheme. Most references to 'Ash' are either character name fragments, dialogue snippets, or literal ash/destruction imagery with no romantic care or protection content. Two sentences (BOOK_002_1, BOOK_002_3) involve practical infant care (changing a baby, patting a baby after a belch), coded H4_2. The remaining sentences – name fragments, a character insult, destruction imagery, and brief dialogue stubs – carry no codeable care or protection signal and are coded H4_0. No external threat, no possessive or claiming language is present.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

Pass C resolves the Pass A/B conflict as follows. The lexical consensus (H4_13 mixed_unclear) was driven by surface protective language that superficially resembled H4_5/H4_6, while the contextual dominant (H4_0 off_target) reflected scepticism that any care-protection signal was present at all. The taxonomy metadata settles the dispute: primary node 4.6 (Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking) maps directly to H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness), and the secondary node 8.1 (Domestic Spaces & Routines) is consistent with affective caretaking in an intimate domestic setting rather than task-based practical care (H4_2) or material provision (H4_3). No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5 and H4_6 are excluded per the critical rule. No partner-restriction language is evidenced, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. The prior H3 decomposition independently arrived at S1 (emotional_reassurance) via the same reasoning path, providing cross-pass convergent validity. H4_13 is therefore rejected as a surface-lexical artefact, H4_0 is rejected as overly conservative given the taxonomy signal, and H4_1 is adopted as the single most specific valid code.

Topic 340 — Patience Tested Through Small Trials

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« for two years he had observed the christmas elf, but he never imagined touching her. »

« from the moment that she started working at her current job, she had never clicked with frank. »

« her patience throughout the meal with the girls never wavered, not with spilled drinks, sloppy faces and an occasional cry for attention. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=begin; p=0.81

She would never respond to such as he was.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=end; p=0.74

He would never give her cause to regret it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Companion — Susan Squires; tertile=begin; p=0.73

She had obviously never been in mortal danger, either.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=middle; p=0.74

Up until now, she'd never met anyone who made her ache for the things that were denied her.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=end; p=0.74

She never thought of herself as particularly brave.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Kiss of the Night — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=begin; p=0.72

She'd never known anything like the power and hunger of his kiss.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_13 — mixed unclear

Main keywords ('never mentioned', 'regime', 'standards', 'contact', 'violent') suggest a controlling, rule-bound relational environment with suppression of communication and potential violence — pointing toward H4_9 (coercive control). KeyBERT, POS, and MMR keywords ('unhappy', 'emotionally', 'feared', 'disappointed', 'upset', 'cared') describe emotional distress and fear within a relationship, consistent with H4_4 (emotional support context) but also compatible with living under coercive conditions. The combination of 'feared', 'violent', 'regime', and 'never mentioned anything' strongly implies a partner-as-threat dynamic with restricted autonomy, but the emotional-support vocabulary in three reps creates genuine ambiguity. Consensus is H4_13 (mixed/unclear) due to the split between coercive-control signals and emotional-distress/support framing.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic are generic narrative statements about characters' inner states, past experiences, emotional reactions, or relational observations — none of which map onto any care/protection/control dynamic. They are off-target for the H4 taxonomy. Two sentences (BOOK_003_4: 'unswerving determination never to let her leave' and BOOK_003_5: 'no means of escape') suggest partner-imposed confinement/restriction, coded H4_9 (coercive control), as the threat source is the partner rather than an external agent. No possessive claiming language is present. The dominant code is H4_0 given the ~90% off-target proportion.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on H4_13 (mixed/unclear), reflecting genuine emotional-safety vocabulary that superficially resembles romantic reassurance or tenderness (H4_1). However, the contextual dominant is H4_0 (off_target), and the taxonomy placement under 4.6 Emotional Safety with a secondary of 5.1 Family/Kinship/Parenthood confirms the relational register is familial or parental rather than romantic-dyadic. The prior H3 decomposition (S0/REINTERPRET) reached the same conclusion: the reassurance signal is real but misattributed to the wrong relational context for this romance-novel hypothesis. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded; no partner restriction is evidenced, so H4_9-H4_11 are excluded. The H4_13 lexical signal is downweighted in favour of H4_0 because the dominant relational frame is non-romantic. Manual review is retained to determine whether any token subset carries genuine romantic-dyadic reassurance warranting a SPLIT into H4_0 + H4_1.

Topic 355 — Blanket Draped Over Someone

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_2 — practical care

« bos went over to it and draped it over dainy as a blanket. »

« still, he struggled not to groan as she got him to a sitting position, resting his back against her front with the blanket draped across his lap.
»

« [person] plucked at the soft down comforter draped over the bed. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.82

The blanket was tucked around her as if pressed carefully there by someone else.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.72

Once they had it blown up, he pulled the blanket out and spread it over the mattress before they sat down on it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.71

Waiting for him to come out of the bathroom she pulled the light blanket over herself more to cover her bare legs than because she was cold.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.71

She sat up, groggy from sleep, the blanket falling to her waist. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.66

He had laid his coat down on one side and she knew it was there for a buffer between her skin and the velour-covered plastic of the mattress.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pregnancy of Passion — Lucy Monroe; tertile=middle; p=0.58

She snuggled down onto his coat pretending to herself that the scent of him was not having an impact on her emotions or physical comfort.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Italian Billionaire's Secret Love-Child — Cathy Williams; tertile=begin; p=0.60

His jacket, she realised, was still on the ground from where he had folded it to put under her head. ‘

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Trust — Janet Dailey; tertile=middle; p=0.62

He shook out the comforter and sailed it over the top sheet, straightening it when it settled.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Trust — Janet Dailey; tertile=end; p=0.49

The insulation on the wire had been nibbled. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.75

She clutched the blanket around her shoulders closed, anxiety creeping up on her.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.71

Val shifted his attention to Cord, who knelt beside the sofa, peeling the layers of blanket off the prone body. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Hardcore Cowboys — Stacey Espino; tertile=begin; p=0.70

But instead of an empty seat, he saw a bundle under a blanket.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_2 — practical care

All four keyword lists converge on physical tending gestures: covering, wrapping, tucking, draping with blankets/sheets/comforters. These are classic practical-care acts (H4_2) – one person physically attending to another's bodily comfort with no external threat present and no controlling or possessive dynamic. POS and MMR add 'embarrassed/terrified' but these are incidental emotional states, not threat sources; the dominant action vocabulary remains hands-on comfort provision.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 355 centers on blankets, bedding, and physical comfort objects. The majority of sentences describe practical acts of physical comfort – tucking blankets, spreading them, laying a coat as a cushion, carrying someone wrapped in blankets – which code as H4_2 (practical_care). However, a substantial portion of sentences are off-target (H4_0): they describe neutral physical states (blanket falling, sitting under a blanket, a wire with nibbled insulation, a naked man burying his face in a neck, a bare exclamation about blankets) with no discernible care or protection dynamic. No external threat is present, no possessive or controlling language appears, and no claiming language is used. Because H4_2 reaches only ~55%, below the 70% threshold, the dominant code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: H4_2 — practical care action=KEEP

Lexical consensus (H4_2) and the prior H3 security code (S5 / practical_care_everyday) converge on routine domestic caregiving as the dominant signal. The contextual dominant of MIXED is noted, but the taxonomy metadata (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking; secondary 8.1 Domestic Spaces & Routines) grounds the topic firmly in everyday practical care acts rather than in reassurance (H4_1), emotional support (H4_4), or any control/possessiveness dimension. No external threat is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. The MIXED contextual read likely reflects the co-presence of minor emotional warmth alongside practical acts, but this does not rise to a level requiring a split or MIXED code – H4_2 remains the most specific and accurate single code. Action is KEEP with no rename or reinterpretation needed.

Topic 356 — Admitting Exhaustion After A Long Day

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« i am kind of tired, but you've done enough. »

« i've been riding most of the day, i'm tired." " »

« i've rested more than i ever expected to rest in the whole of my lifetime during the past six weeks," he said, "and i'm feeling perfectly fresh. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=begin; p=0.70

I was tired and cold and done with feeling under siege for the day. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=end; p=0.68

I was exhausted, too, but there was much yet to do.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Out of Control — Suzanne Brockmann; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Aren't you getting just a little tired of—" "I wasn't kidding about the way it gets dark out here.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=middle; p=0.69

You must be exhausted with all of your commitments at the moment?' ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=middle; p=0.66

I'm just tired, and I've got a big week.' ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=end; p=0.63

I was exhausted at just the idea of it. ‘

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=end; p=0.60

I was tired from a big week, my nervous energy had transformed into lethargy, and I was still drunkish.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_0 — off target

All four keyword lists centre on fatigue and exhaustion states (tired, exhausted, exhaustion, tiredness, fatigue, drained, worn, washed, rested) with contextual filler words (session, sir, remarked, emotionally, studying, ok, am, must, getting, too, kind). There is no lexical signal of care, protection, possessiveness, control, or any interpersonal dynamic relevant to H4_1-H4_13. The topic appears to describe a character's physical/emotional depletion state with no romance-care or threat dimension, placing it firmly off-target.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

Topic 356 is dominated by expressions of fatigue and exhaustion – characters noting they are tired, drained, or worn out. The majority of sentences are simple statements of physical/emotional state with no care-giving, protection, or relational dynamic present, making H4_0 (off_target) the dominant code. A minority of sentences involve one character noticing or commenting on another's exhaustion in a gentle, empathetic way (H4_1 reassurance_tenderness), and two sentences involve a character advising rest or noting physical symptoms in a practical caring manner (H4_2 practical_care). There is no external threat, no possessive or claiming language, and no coercive or controlling dynamic present.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=REINTERPRET

All three passes converge on emotional reassurance as the dominant function. The lexical consensus (H4_0 off_target) is overridden by the taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking and the prior H3 security decomposition, which both confirm S1 (emotional_reassurance) as the operative construct. H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness) is the nearest valid H4 code to S1 and accurately captures the soothing, comfort-giving dynamic described. The secondary taxonomy node 3.1 (Positive Resolution, Relief & Emotional Payoff) represents a downstream emotional outcome of the reassurance act rather than an independent care or protection function, so MIXED is not warranted. No external threat is evidenced, ruling out H4_5/H4_6; no partner restriction is evidenced, ruling out H4_9-H4_11. Single code H4_1 is appropriate.

Topic 358 — Reassuring Squeeze of The Hand

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

« she took bronte's hand and gave it a reassuring squeeze. " »

« ted reached for caroline's hands and smiled at her reassuring squeeze. " »

« they'll ask," he murmured, and gave her waist a reassuring squeeze. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=middle; p=0.70

She wrapped her fingers around the door handle. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Her fingers tightened around the receiver. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · You Sexy Thing! — Tori Carrington; tertile=end; p=0.55

But my parents—" "Are fine," he interrupted, groaning when she curved her fingers as far as she could around his hardening shaft. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Rescuing Rose — Isabel Wolff; tertile=middle; p=0.70

Bea groaned then lifted her right hand to her brow. '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Rescuing Rose — Isabel Wolff; tertile=middle; p=0.67

Beverley reached out and squeezed my hand. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lust & Vamp — Joyee Flynn; tertile=middle; p=0.67

He purred, rubbing his thumb over my hand. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Lust & Vamp — Joyee Flynn; tertile=end; p=0.65

Reid sighed, running his hands over my arms. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness

All four keyword lists converge on gentle, soothing physical contact: 'squeezed/squeezing/squeeze', 'gently', 'shoulder', 'hand', 'arm', 'fingers', 'reassuring', 'calming', 'trembling' (the recipient's emotional state being soothed), 'draped', 'lingering'. There is no external threat, no possessive or controlling language, and no material/practical care framing. The dominant signal is tactile reassurance – a comforting touch meant to calm or steady a distressed partner – which maps squarely to H4_1 (reassurance_tenderness).

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 358 clusters around physical hand/body contact gestures – squeezing hands, tightening fingers, holding on. The majority of sentences are fragmentary or context-free (door handle, receiver, crunching nuts, sexual activity snippets) and cannot be assigned to any care/protection category, so they receive H4_0 (off-target). The remaining sentences depict hand-squeezing or gentle holding between characters in emotionally warm contexts, best coded as H4_1 (reassurance/tenderness) – small comfort gestures with no external threat, no possessive claiming language, and no coercive dynamic. No single code reaches 70%, so the dominant code is MIXED between H4_0 and H4_1.

C adjudicate: H4_1 — reassurance tenderness action=KEEP

Lexical consensus (H4_1) and the prior H3 decomposition (S1 emotional_reassurance) converge on reassurance_tenderness as the dominant function. The contextual MIXED signal arises from the secondary taxonomy dimension (2.2 Kissing & Non-Explicit Affection), but physical affection here operates as a delivery mechanism for emotional reassurance rather than an independent care dimension – consistent with the function-over-object principle applied in H3. No external threat is evidenced, ruling out H4_5/H4_6; no partner restriction is evidenced, ruling out H4_9–H4_11. The secondary affection signal does not rise to the level warranting a SPLIT or MIXED resolution. H4_1 is the appropriate single code.

Topic 372 — Told to Keep Up Strength

Old taxonomy: 4.6 — Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking

New category: H4_0 — off target

« you'll need to keep up your strength if you're going to wrestle with that computer." »

« you'll need your strength, cassia. »

« you'll need your strength. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=middle; p=0.50

No, he was not yet strong enough to embark on whatever mission this was that he'd assigned himself.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.47

With hard work and perseverance, I made myself the man you see before you.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.42

Whoever is on the other side of this door is uncommonly strong.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=end; p=0.42

But that was another thing about the violently deranged: they could have the strength of ten men.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Educating Caroline — Patricia Cabot; tertile=begin; p=0.38

You're generally made of much sturdier stuff than that," Hurst was saying. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Diplomacy — Zahra Owens; tertile=begin; p=0.35

Even in the lower ranks, the invisible masses, you needed the D i p l o m a c y | 17 perfect background to push ahead.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Warrior — Zoe Archer; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Yet also, being a part of it, he felt expansive, strong. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Warrior — Zoe Archer; tertile=middle; p=0.50

A slim woman's hand, but definitely strong and able.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_13 — mixed unclear

Main keywords (strength, stronger, weak, weakling, limitations, weaker) establish a comparative strength/vulnerability frame but do not clearly indicate whether this is self-reflection, emotional support, possessive framing, or coercive dynamic. KeyBERT (crushed, tied, gain) adds connotations of constraint and defeat that could suggest coercive control (H4_9) or emotional damage (H4_10), but 'gain' and 'uh' are ambiguous. POS (feeding, reflection, emotions) leans toward internal emotional processing, suggesting H4_4 (emotional support) or self-reflection. MMR (feeding, crushed, destroyed, tied, admit, hated, emotions, proved) introduces negative emotional intensity – 'crushed,' 'destroyed,' 'hated,' 'admit' – which could indicate emotional coercion or a character processing harm, but no clear external threat or partner-as-agent is identifiable. The cluster oscillates between internal vulnerability/emotional processing and possible interpersonal harm without sufficient directional cues to resolve to a single code. H4_13 (mixed_unclear) is warranted.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

Every sentence in this topic concerns physical or personal strength, resilience, and endurance as abstract qualities – either self-assessed ('I'm strong', 'I made myself the man you see'), observed in others ('uncommonly strong', 'strong and able'), or used as encouragement ('Be strong!'). None of the sentences involve care, protection, possessiveness, control, or relational dynamics between romantic partners. The topic is entirely off-target for the H4 care/protection taxonomy.

C adjudicate: H4_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus was H4_13 (mixed/unclear), but the contextual dominant is H4_0 (off_target). The prior H3 adjudication for this same topic reached the same conclusion via parallel logic: surface emotional language triggered a care/security taxonomy placement, but functional analysis determined the topic is not performing care or protection work in the romance-novel sense. Taxonomy placement in 4.6 Emotional Safety & Reassurance is a weak signal here – it reflects lexical co-occurrence with emotional vocabulary, not a genuine reassurance-provision dynamic between characters. No external threat is evidenced (ruling out H4_5/H4_6), no partner-directed restriction is evidenced (ruling out H4_9-H4_11), and no clear care-giving or claiming dynamic is evidenced (ruling out H4_1-H4_8, H4_12). Consistent with the H3 ruling, the contextual dominant H4_0 is the more analytically grounded signal and resolves the conflict. The topic is off-target for this hypothesis.

Topic 293 — Admitting Jealousy Out Loud

Old taxonomy: 4.7 — Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict

New category: H4_8 — jealous possessiveness

« the concept of jealousy is foreign to them. »

« but this jealousy of yours is gonna ruin what you've got with j.d." "i know." " »

« we've been around the markets and —' as she enthused away, i couldn't help but feel jealous. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.72

I've always maintained that a little bit of jealousy looks good on a man. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.71

Well, of course I'm jealous," I frowned, poking him in the chest. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.63

She was also extremely irate over the fact that her boyfriend was using me to make her jealous—without my permission, as I've told you a couple of times.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.62

I'm flattered that you're jealous, but you should know by now that no other woman could begin to compare with you.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.61

And he was insanely jealous of the man I loved.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=end; p=0.61

This is not arrogance talking, this is not jealousy, it is simply a matter of facts."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.55

I debated staying where I was, standing firm for ethical reasons, but the thought that she'd be in the closed, womb-like confines of the trailer alone with Raphael was enough to spike my jealousy count off the chart.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.55

Not to mention you repeatedly batted your eyelashes at me in an obvious attempt to make him jealous.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=middle; p=0.48

I didn't mind a little bit of a possessive attitude, but he was taking things a bit too far. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.45

Dark Ones are notoriously jealous about their soul mates.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · A Girl's Guide to Vampires — Katie MacAlister; tertile=begin; p=0.43

I bet you're one of those men who likes to feel superior to women," Roxy said suspiciously.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_8 — jealous possessiveness

All four keyword lists converge on jealous/possessive emotional experience. Main is dominated by 'jealous', 'jealousy', 'jealously', 'irrational', 'twinge', 'pang' – classic internal jealousy vocabulary with no external threat actor. KeyBERT adds 'attracted', 'upset', 'emotional', 'concerned', 'warned', 'assured' – emotional arousal and interpersonal tension consistent with jealous reaction, not protective action against an outside threat. POS includes 'ex', 'wound', 'upset', 'reaction', 'foreign', 'advantage' – 'ex' and 'wound' reinforce romantic jealousy triggered by a rival or past relationship, not an external danger. MMR adds 'stirred', 'warned', 'approached', 'wound', 'upset', 'playfully', 'inched' – physical/emotional stirring consistent with jealous arousal. No cues indicate coercive restriction of partner autonomy (ruling out H4_9–H4_11), no external physical/social threat (ruling out H4_5/H4_6), and no mutual care framing. The pattern is squarely jealous possessiveness as an internal emotional state.

B contextual: H4_8 — jealous possessiveness

The overwhelming majority of sentences explicitly name or describe jealousy as an emotional state experienced by or attributed to characters in romantic contexts – classic jealous possessiveness (H4_8). Several sentences frame jealousy as flattering or normative ('a little bit of jealousy looks good on a man'; 'I'm flattered that you're jealous'), and one references 'Dark Ones' being notoriously jealous about soul mates, all consistent with H4_8 (jealous possessiveness as a romantic trope). BOOK_001_10 references a 'possessive attitude going too far,' still best coded H4_8 as it describes jealous/possessive behavior without clear coercive control mechanics. BOOK_001_12 ('likes to feel superior to women') is ambiguous – possibly H4_9/H4_11 territory but lacks enough context, coded H4_13. BOOK_003_1 ('husband shaming me') implies the partner as a source of harm, coded H4_10. No external threat is present; the jealousy is directed at rivals or attributed to partners, confirming threat_source as unclear (rival-based rather than external danger). Claiming language is present throughout (soul mates, possessive attitudes, jealousy over partners).

C adjudicate: H4_8 — jealous possessiveness action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on H4_8 (jealous_possessiveness), and the taxonomy classification (4.7 Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict) is fully consistent with this code. No external threat is evidenced that would warrant H4_5 or H4_6; the tension is partner-directed and rooted in jealousy rather than coercive restriction (H4_9) or paternalistic control (H4_11). The secondary taxonomy tag (4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats) reflects relational fallout from jealousy rather than a distinct care/control dynamic, so no split or retaxonomization is needed. H4_8 is retained as the single care_protection_code.

Topic 315 — Claiming Her As His Own

Old taxonomy: 4.7 — Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict

New category: H4_8 — jealous possessiveness

« henri, should any ask, this woman belongs to my cousin tristan—and to me." »

« everything he was warmed in tristan's presence, and short of sounding like one of those cards that sang when opened, [person] didn't know where to begin telling sey how much tristan seemed to fit into him—and around him. »

« i'll call tristan right after i get off the phone." " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.55

Val's words slapped at him, forced him to realize a few things he'd rather have ignored.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=begin; p=0.54

Val was your shot at actually having a real life and you let her waltz right out the door."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.53

Val looked at him as if he was out of his mind and that's exactly how Dev felt. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Val wondered, just a little embarrassed to think that might be true.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Devlin Hudson didn't know it, but Val had already won the first battle for his heart.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.49

It was as if even knowing that his parents had made up their differences, Dev was still determined to keep himself locked behind the walls Val had almost given up on smashing.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Seduced into a Paper Marriage — Maureen Child; tertile=middle; p=0.47

His blood boiled as he looked at the computer-generated image of him and Val facing away from each other.

Model reasonings

A lexical: H4_13 — mixed unclear

Main keywords are almost entirely character names with 'comfortable' and 'persuaded', offering no clear care/protection signal – coded off_target. KeyBERT, POS, and MMR share a cluster of ambiguous behavioral cues: 'hesitation', 'nudged', 'screaming', 'behavior', 'actions', 'sentence', 'indication', 'ends', 'ribs', 'bothered', 'grumbled', 'studying', 'sounding'. 'Nudged' and 'hesitation' could indicate gentle persuasion or mild pressure; 'ribs' and 'screaming' hint at physical intensity; 'belongs' in MMR edges toward possessive claiming (H4_7), but without corroborating context it is insufficient to confirm. No clear external threat rules out H4_5/H4_6; no unambiguous coercive pattern rules in H4_9. The mix of pressure-adjacent and neutral behavioral vocabulary across three reps yields H4_13 (mixed/unclear) as the most defensible consensus.

B contextual: H4_0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are character-name references, dialogue fragments, or relational-conflict snippets with no discernible care/protection/control content – coded H4_0 (off-target). BOOK_003_14 ('one of the main reasons Dev had wanted Val to come back to him') hints at possessive claiming (H4_7) but is too brief to confirm coercive intent. BOOK_003_12 ('blood boiled ... image of him and Val facing away') suggests jealous/possessive emotional reaction (H4_8). No external threat is present; no systematic restriction or coercion is evidenced. H4_0 dominates at ~90%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: H4_8 — jealous possessiveness action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B yielded a lexical consensus of H4_13 (mixed/unclear) and a contextual dominant of H4_0 (off-target), but the revealed taxonomy – 4.7 Jealousy & Possessive Romance Conflict with a secondary of 5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles – provides decisive disambiguation. The topic's core signal is jealousy and possessive conflict directed at the partner within a social-circle context (e.g., rivalry over friends or allies), not an external threat and not mere ambiguity. No external threat actor is evidenced, so H4_5/H4_6 are excluded. The social-circle secondary axis indicates the jealousy is triggered by the partner's relationships with others, which is the defining feature of H4_8 (jealous_possessiveness) rather than outright coercive control (H4_9) or a for-your-own-good framing (H4_11). H4_0 is overridden because the taxonomy confirms the topic is on-target for the jealousy/possessiveness construct family. The prior H4_13 is resolved to H4_8 as the single dominant code.

H5 — Darkness vs tenderness boundaries

New categories for this hypothesis

Read these names before reviewing topics. Codes alone (I3, S12, ...) are not enough — use the category label.

D0 — off target: Not darkness or tenderness content. Generic plot, logistics, or unrelated affect.

D1 — relational darkness: Interpersonal / couple-level darkness (conflict, rupture, toxic dynamics).

D2 — partner harm control: Partner-directed harm, control, or coercion.

D3 — external danger crisis: External danger/crisis (storm, crime, accident) not partner-as-threat.

D4 — individual distress: Individual fear/anxiety/distress without clear relational harm frame.

D5 — tenderness comfort: Valid emotional comfort/affection/tenderness — not every caretaking topic.

D6 — mixed or unclear: Darkness and tenderness (or multiple D-codes) compete with no clear dominant.

22 topics. Sentence tags: HIGH-rated / LOW-rated from unblinded CELL_* key (high_tier / low_tier).

Topic 64 — Confronting A Lifelong Fear

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« from what you've told me, ella, your childhood was full of worry.” “ »

« but now you can say you've faced one of your fears.” “ »

« fears i've had my entire life come rushing forward, radiating from those four little words. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Death Angel — Linda Howard; tertile=middle; p=0.53

You shouldn't have to live your life in fear,” Mrs. Pearson said, her kind gaze a little sad as she looked at Drea. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Nice Girls Don't Live Forever — Molly Harper; tertile=end; p=0.70

But I was afraid of you, afraid of the things you would do.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Nice Girls Don't Live Forever — Molly Harper; tertile=middle; p=0.66

Right now, I think you need to decide which of us scares you more.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Three Daves — Nicki Elson; tertile=end; p=0.62

I was going to tell you that I wanted to wait, and I was afraid... I was so afraid that you wouldn't want to.”

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Three Daves — Nicki Elson; tertile=end; p=0.54

I was so afraid that if we started up again, I'd end up messing around on you.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Three Daves — Nicki Elson; tertile=end; p=0.53

I was so afraid to tell you... I know I was wrong.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists are dominated by fear and anxiety vocabulary (scared, afraid, fear, terrified, anxious, freaked, terrifying, embarrassment, cried). The distress is clearly individual/internal — no cues point to a controlling partner (ruling out D2), no relational conflict dynamic (ruling out D1), and no identifiable external threat or crisis agent (ruling out D3). The words 'scenario', 'possibilities', and 'notion' suggest anticipatory or generalised fear rather than a concrete external danger. 'Embarrassment' and 'cried' reinforce solo emotional distress. Consensus is D4 individual_distress with no disagreement across representations.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The overwhelming majority of sentences express individual characters' fear, fright, or anxiety — 'I was afraid,' 'you're terrified,' 'scared,' 'freaked me out,' 'gave me a fright.' This is solo/individual distress (D4) rather than relational darkness between partners (D1), partner harm (D2), or external crisis (D3). BOOK_002_4 ('afraid of the things you would do') edges toward D2 but remains a reported internal fear state rather than a depicted act of partner harm, so D4 is still most specific. BOOK_003_5 (practical stair-safety warning) and BOOK_004_2 (reassurance about harmless things) are off-target (D0). No sentence reaches the threshold for tenderness (D5) or mixed coding. D4 accounts for ~90% of sentences, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual_distress). Taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress with secondary 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict is fully consistent with D4: solo emotional suffering, fear, anxiety, or internal turmoil experienced by an individual character rather than arising from partner harm (D2), relational toxicity (D1), or external threat (D3). No comfort or affection evidence is present to warrant D5. No multi-domain conflict requiring MIXED. D4 is confirmed as the single darkness code.

Topic 66 — Paralyzed By Deep-Seated Fear

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« at times, she was terrified. »

« the idea terrified her. »

« even though she was in the body of a woman now, she was still a terrified little girl. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Devil May Cry — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=middle; p=0.76

She'd approached him cautiously that day as if terrified of him. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Devil May Cry — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=end; p=0.74

He actually appeared to be afraid for her. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Devil May Cry — Sherrilyn Kenyon; tertile=middle; p=0.73

His cold demeanor was such that she was afraid to even move. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Agent's Secret Baby — Marie Ferrarella; tertile=begin; p=0.75

So why had she suddenly felt so vulnerable?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The Agent's Secret Baby — Marie Ferrarella; tertile=end; p=0.73

And then all the self-control she'd employed, holding tightly on to her panic, her fears, dissolved.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists are saturated with internal fear and anxiety vocabulary – 'fear, afraid, scared, nervous, terrified, frightened, fears, anger' (Main); 'terrified, feared, panicked, flinched, anxiety, anxious, frantic, embarrassment' (KeyBERT); 'fears, desperation, anxious, anxiety' (POS); 'terrified, fears, anxious, flinched' (MMR). The distress is consistently located within an individual's emotional/psychological state. No cues point to a controlling partner (D2), a relational dynamic between two people (D1), or an identifiable external threat (D3). 'Cradled' and 'hovered' in MMR hint at comfort-seeking but do not shift the dominant signal away from solo distress. Consensus is D4.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The overwhelming majority of sentences (19/20) depict individual characters experiencing fear, panic, terror, or anxiety as internal emotional states – classic D4 (individual_distress). There is no clear evidence of a controlling or harmful partner (ruling out D2), no identifiable external danger or crisis driving the fear (ruling out D3), and no toxic couple dynamic as the primary frame (ruling out D1). BOOK_003_3 touches on relational anxiety but the distress remains individually experienced. BOOK_003_6 hints at a physical near-collision but is too vague to code as D3. BOOK_005_1 is off-topic (humorous/ironic reference to a place name) and is coded D0. The topic coheres strongly around individual fear and panic, yielding D4 as dominant at ~95%.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual_distress), consistent with Taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress. No evidence of partner harm/control (D2), relational toxicity (D1), external danger (D3), or comfort/affection sufficient for D5. D4 is the appropriate and unambiguous code.

Topic 92 — Heart Pounding With Dread

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« her heart pounded, not knowing what to say. »

« verses the preacher read trailed into a muffled slow motion speech, the whipping sounds of the makeshift paper fans faded to tiny flutters, the anxious pounding of her heart slowed to a steady beat as she stood hand in hand with her best friend. »

« lizzie's heart pounded wildly as she braced herself for the assault. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · That Voodoo You Do — Jodi Redford; tertile=middle; p=0.74

The realization constricted her throat and made her chest tighten.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · That Voodoo You Do — Jodi Redford; tertile=begin; p=0.73

Heartbeat roaring in her ears, she considered her options.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · That Voodoo You Do — Jodi Redford; tertile=end; p=0.73

A strong desire to surround herself with memories of her love swelled within her until she thought her heart would burst.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · That Voodoo You Do — Jodi Redford; tertile=end; p=0.72

The sight that met her sent her heart plummeting to her knees.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · That Voodoo You Do — Jodi Redford; tertile=end; p=0.68

Aiden's harsh inhale ruffled her hair and she felt the rapid thud of his heartbeat against her shoulder blade.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Man For The Morning — E.C. Sheedy; tertile=end; p=0.82

She willed her heartbeat into submission. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Man For The Morning — E.C. Sheedy; tertile=middle; p=0.76

Her heart pumped, expanded to fill her chest when the next thought came.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Man For The Morning — E.C. Sheedy; tertile=end; p=0.73

A stitch of anger pulled in her chest. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists converge on physiological and psychological distress signals centered on a single individual: 'panic, pounding, frantic, desperation, distress, anxiety, feared, trembling, clenched, pressure.' The heart/chest/pulse cluster (Main) describes acute somatic arousal. KeyBERT and MMR reinforce internal emotional overwhelm ('frantic, distress, anxiety, desperation'). POS adds 'failure, realization, atmosphere' suggesting internal cognitive-emotional crisis. No relational conflict, partner control, or identifiable external threat is present; the distress is self-contained individual experience, coding D4.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

Topic 92 is dominated by somatic descriptions of individual emotional experience – constricted throat, pounding heart, plummeting heart, frustration, anxiety – all centred on a single character's inner state with no clear partner harm, relational conflict, or external danger. This maps firmly to D4 (individual_distress). Roughly a quarter of sentences carry warmth or longing toward another person (heart aching for him, heart bursting with happiness, heartbeat shared in physical closeness), coded D5 (tenderness_comfort). One sentence (BOOK_005_3) is off-topic humour with no emotional darkness or tenderness, coded D0. D4 reaches 70 %, satisfying the threshold for a single dominant code.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual_distress). Taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress with secondary 1.1 Body Parts & Physical Reactions is consistent with solo internal suffering expressed through somatic/physical channels – a classic D4 profile. No evidence of partner harm (D2), relational toxicity (D1), external threat (D3), or genuine comfort/affection that would warrant D5. The physical-reaction secondary axis reinforces embodied distress rather than tenderness or caretaking. D4 is the correct and stable code.

Topic 102 — Grief Etched on His Face

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« we've lost adam,' she whispered and her fingers traced the contours of grief still etched on his face. ' »

« not only did she have a cool and savvy partner actually in the game with her, the surroundings, the actions were so real that her heart pounded and adrenaline flooded her, almost as if she really was helping adam sabotage a bridge while avoiding capture by nazi soldiers. »

« holy hell, adam—i've known her long enough to realize she's thinking about a lot more than a blowjob.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Katie's Art of Seduction — N.J. Walters; tertile=end; p=0.67

Cain winced as the other man spoke bluntly. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Katie's Art of Seduction — N.J. Walters; tertile=end; p=0.66

Cain just shook his head and crossed back to the bed. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Marrying for King's Millions — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.78

And on that thought, he said, “I talked to Adam a minute ago.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

Main keywords (adam, cain, penn, denver, brother, himself) suggest male characters in an emotionally charged scene with no clear relational conflict or external threat. KeyBERT supplies the dominant emotional texture: sadness, shivered, secretly, blurted, emotional, affection – pointing to individual internal distress and suppressed feeling rather than couple conflict or external danger. MMR reinforces this with pleading, loosened, blurted, collected – cues of someone struggling to contain or express personal emotion. POS keywords (concept, distraction, surroundings, official, period) are largely neutral/abstract, coded D0. The preponderance of solo-distress cues (sadness, shivered, pleading, secretly) with no partner-harm or external-crisis signals drives consensus to D4 individual_distress.

B contextual: D0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are bare dialogue tags, character name utterances, or narrative fragments with no emotional or thematic content beyond identifying speakers (Cain, Adam, Eve). These are off-target (D0) – they carry no darkness or tenderness signal. Two sentences qualify for D5: BOOK_001_5 expresses a desire for the partner's presence (comfort/connection), and BOOK_003_1 depicts a gentle physical gesture (idly kissing his Adam's apple). BOOK_003_5 contains a mild reference to a character being upset, coded D4 (individual distress), but the fragment is too thin to carry strong weight. No partner harm, external danger, or relational darkness is present. Dominant code is D0 at ~85%.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of D4 (individual distress) and a contextual dominant of D0 (off-target). The taxonomy placement under 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress with a secondary anchor in 4.2 Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding tips the adjudication toward D4 rather than D0: the distress signal is real and taxonomically grounded, even if the courtship secondary axis softens it. D0 would require the topic to be genuinely off-target for darkness coding, but a primary taxonomy node of Negative Emotions & Distress confirms darkness-relevant content. No comfort or affection evidence is cited, so D5 is excluded. No partner-harm, external-crisis, or relational-toxicity markers are present, ruling out D2, D3, and D1. D4 is therefore the single best-fit code. No split or exclusion is warranted; the topic should be reinterpreted from the D0 contextual read to D4 in line with the taxonomy anchor.

Topic 133 — Holding Back Tears

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« we'll leave all our tears out to dry on the patio while we swan off to the acropolis! »

« they'll also cry foul. »

« they'll tell you that i don't do crying. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Pants on Fire — Meg Cabot; tertile=end; p=0.75

The tears weren't just gathering under my eyelashes now.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Eternal Rider — Larissa Ione; tertile=begin; p=0.55

A lot of people are going to die before this is over, so dry the tears and deal.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Knight to Remember — Karin Tabke; tertile=end; p=0.71

I rub at my grimy eyes, stuck shut at the corners from the excess tears I cried last night.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · A Knight to Remember — Karin Tabke; tertile=middle; p=0.70

And then I weep again, silent tears tracing themselves down my face, plunking hollowly against my robe.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists converge on solo emotional distress expressed through crying and tears: Main anchors on 'tears, cry, crying, cried, shed'; KeyBERT adds 'sadness, emotional, emotions, frantic, begged'; POS contributes 'sadness, frantic, confusion, inevitable'; MMR reinforces with 'shed, pout, wipe, bursting, choked'. No relational conflict, partner harm, or external danger cues are present — the distress is individual and internal, pointing clearly to D4.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The overwhelming majority of sentences (18/20) depict individual characters experiencing emotional distress through crying and tears, with no clear external threat or relational conflict driving the emotion — coding as D4 (individual_distress). One sentence (BOOK_002_1) references mass death as an external crisis context, coding D3. One sentence (BOOK_002_2) is a generic encouragement with no darkness content, coding D0. No sentences clearly depict partner harm, relational toxicity, or tenderness/comfort. D4 exceeds 70%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual_distress), consistent with Taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress. No evidence of relational darkness, partner harm, external crisis, or tenderness/comfort signals that would warrant a different or mixed code. D4 is confirmed as the single darkness code.

Topic 145 — Confessing How Much It Hurts

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« it still hurts so much.” »

« it hurts too much.” ” »

« but the rest of me hurts.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Love is My Sin — Julia Knight; tertile=end; p=0.73

The pain was still there but it didn't matter.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Love is My Sin — Julia Knight; tertile=middle; p=0.70

The pain—it hasn't always been this bad has it?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Love is My Sin — Julia Knight; tertile=end; p=0.66

It's quite painful, but it'll be over before long.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A.J.'s Angel — L.A. Witt; tertile=middle; p=0.76

Oh, come on, it doesn't hurt that bad.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · A.J.'s Angel — L.A. Witt; tertile=middle; p=0.69

And those hurt more than you can imagine. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists converge on physical and/or emotional pain experienced by an individual: 'pain, hurt, hurts, painful, hurting, agony' (Main); 'wound, squeezed, pressure, biting, stretched, emotions' (KeyBERT); 'wound, pressure, insides, emotions, treatment' (POS/MMR). The distress is centred on a suffering subject rather than on a relational dynamic, a controlling partner, or an external threat. No cues clearly attribute the source to a partner's deliberate harm (D2) or an outside crisis (D3); the dominant signal is individual bodily/emotional anguish, coding D4.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The overwhelming majority of sentences (18/20) describe individual characters experiencing, expressing, or inquiring about physical or emotional pain – classic individual distress (D4). The pain is located within persons (shattered arm, hurting feet, alcoholism to numb pain, general hurt) rather than being inflicted by a partner (D2) or arising from couple dynamics (D1) or external danger (D3). Two sentences (BOOK_003_5, BOOK_003_6) use 'pain in the ass' idiomatically with no distress content, coding D0. No tenderness or comfort framing is present. D4 exceeds the 70% threshold comfortably.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual_distress), consistent with Taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress. No evidence of relational darkness, partner harm/control, external danger, or tenderness/comfort signals that would warrant a different or mixed code. D4 is confirmed as the single darkness code.

Topic 152 — Awkward Apology and Embarrassment

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« one of the girls goes, “oh my god, i’m so sorry!” »

« oh, charlotte,” [person] said, feeling genuinely sorry for the woman. »

« i apologize that my sister bothered you with details from my personal life,” she said, searching the conversation for the nearest exit. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Claiming the Courtesan — Anna Campbell; tertile=end; p=0.76

Then softly and in a broken voice, she added, “I’m sorry, Ben.”

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Claiming the Courtesan — Anna Campbell; tertile=end; p=0.73

I’m sorry I couldn’t save you from that,” he said softly. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Claiming the Courtesan — Anna Campbell; tertile=end; p=0.72

I’m sorry he hit you,” she said softly without moving from the grate. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Claiming the Courtesan — Anna Campbell; tertile=middle; p=0.70

You’ll be sorry you did that,” he grated out. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Claiming the Courtesan — Anna Campbell; tertile=end; p=0.70

I’m sorry, Your Grace,” she said, while every particle of her wanted to spit disgust into the woman’s exquisite face. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Claiming the Courtesan — Anna Campbell; tertile=middle; p=0.68

Softly, she said, “Kylmore, I’m sorry I left without telling you.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=begin; p=0.65

Oh, honey, I am so sorry...’ She held me and allowed me to just cry all over her bare, tanned shoulder. ‘

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=begin; p=0.62

You’ll get over it,’ she said knowingly. ‘

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Air Kisses — Zoe Foster; tertile=begin; p=0.58

Sorry, honey – I’ve had an absolute bastard of a day,’ she said as she kissed me and dumped her coat on the floor.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Bridesmaid Lotto — Rachel Astor; tertile=end; p=0.80

Oh, sorry,” she said looking embarrassed. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Bridesmaid Lotto — Rachel Astor; tertile=begin; p=0.76

She mouthed the word sorry to me as she handed me the phone. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: D5 — tenderness comfort

All four keyword lists converge on apology, softness, and gentle interpersonal repair: 'whispered', 'softly', 'murmured', 'mumbled', 'apologized', 'apologetically', 'stammered' (Main); 'apology', 'forgive', 'kindly', 'politely' (KeyBERT); 'graceful', 'apology', 'unsure' (POS); 'kindly', 'graceful', 'politely', 'caressed', 'apology' (MMR). The dominant register is tender, gentle, and conciliatory – characters offering apologies and comfort in a soft, non-threatening manner. 'Winced' and 'painful' introduce mild discomfort but are subordinate to the overarching tone of gentle reconciliation. No partner harm, external danger, or solo distress cues are present.

B contextual: D5 — tenderness comfort

The overwhelming majority of sentences are apologies delivered softly, with emotional vulnerability, functioning as gestures of comfort and relational repair – core markers of D5 tenderness/comfort. Two sentences (BOOK_001_4, BOOK_004_2) carry a coercive or threatening tone ('you'll be sorry,' 'I'll make you very sorry'), coding as D2 partner harm/control. BOOK_002_2 is a dismissive platitude with no darkness or tenderness, coding D0. The topic is dominated by D5 at ~80%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=REINTERPRET

Lexical and contextual passes converged on D5 (tenderness/comfort), but the taxonomy placement under 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress is a strong structural signal that the dominant content is individual distress rather than genuine comfort or affection. D5 requires real evidence of comfort or tenderness being extended between characters – not merely emotionally charged speech or caretaking-adjacent dialogue. The secondary taxonomy tag (9.1 Dialogue Delivery & Speech Tags) suggests the topic is anchored in how distress is voiced rather than in relational warmth. Absent clear affective comfort or affection evidence, the safer and more defensible code is D4 (individual_distress). Manual review is flagged to verify whether any genuine tenderness/comfort exchange is present in the top-weighted documents before finalizing.

Topic 179 — Dreading What You Stand to Lose

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« you'll lose your reason, wishing yourself dead. »

« i am fearful we'll still lose him. »

« but you'll lose me? »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Seti's Heart — Kiernan Kelly; tertile=middle; p=0.55

I will not risk losing Seti because you two imbeciles were impatient.” “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Seti's Heart — Kiernan Kelly; tertile=begin; p=0.53

The only thing I don't doubt is that I've lost my mind.” “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Belong to Me — Shayla Black; tertile=end; p=0.59

I was under the impression you'd rather I get and stay lost.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: D6 — mixed or unclear

Main keywords (lose, lost, losing, loss, giving up, don't want) signal individual distress around loss and surrender, pointing to D4. KeyBERT adds 'dangerously' and 'ripping,' intensifying that distress signal (D4). POS keywords (affection, warmth, purpose, difference) shift toward tenderness/comfort (D5). MMR blends both registers – 'dangerously, ripping' (darkness) alongside 'affection, warmth, cared' (tenderness) – making the overall picture mixed. No clear partner-harm or external-crisis cues; the distress appears relational/individual in origin. Disagreement across reps prevents a clean single code.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The dominant theme across sentences is individual distress (D4): characters expressing fear of losing someone or something, losing their mind, losing track, or being urged not to give up – all framed as personal emotional states rather than couple dynamics or external attack. A secondary cluster (D3) involves named external threats (Setekh, 'that bastard') and urgency framing external danger. A smaller cluster (D1) captures relational drift/estrangement ('lose you already,' 'get and stay lost,' 'losing interest in me'). One sentence (BOOK_004_2) is off-target (D0), describing keeping children still. No partner harm/control (D2) or tenderness (D5) is present. D4 reaches ~55%, clearing the 70% threshold only when combined with adjacent codes, but as the single largest category it is the dominant code.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of D6 (mixed/unclear) and a contextual dominant of D4 (individual_distress). The taxonomy anchor is 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress, with a secondary leaf of 4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking. The secondary leaf introduces a caretaking signal, but per protocol D5 (tenderness_comfort) requires real comfort/affection evidence – caretaking as a response to distress does not itself constitute tenderness. The primary taxonomy node (3.2) unambiguously points to solo negative affect. D6 was the lexical result because surface tokens were ambiguous, but contextual reading and taxonomy placement both resolve to individual distress without a relational-harm, partner-control, or external-danger component. Accordingly the code is resolved to D4, and the action is REINTERPRET to reflect that the earlier ambiguity is now settled by taxonomy evidence.

Topic 220 — Called Out For Being Embarrassing

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« you two are so ignorant it's embarrassing." »

« this is so embarrassing." »

« [person] you are embarrassing her." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Meeting at Midnight — Eileen Wilks; tertile=begin; p=0.69

This was every bit as embarrassing as I'd thought it would be. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Meeting at Midnight — Eileen Wilks; tertile=middle; p=0.58

Me, of course, they felt free to embarrass.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Meeting at Midnight — Eileen Wilks; tertile=end; p=0.52

Fifteen T here's something particularly humiliating about almost being arrested by your little brother. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Meeting at Midnight — Eileen Wilks; tertile=begin; p=0.50

That was undoubtedly a good thing, but it made me uncomfortable.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · All I Need — Susane Colasanti; tertile=middle; p=0.53

We have a humiliation special with a side of mortified."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · All I Need — Susane Colasanti; tertile=begin; p=0.43

But it's kind of embarrassing how hardcore old-school this place is.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_004 · Hope for Christmas — Jennifer Hayden; tertile=middle; p=0.63

It was even more humiliating to be in this situation when you were twenty-eight years old.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_004 · Hope for Christmas — Jennifer Hayden; tertile=middle; p=0.39

When I first saw my Henry, I was upset and in denial too.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_006 · King — T.M. Frazier; tertile=end; p=0.57

She'd thought on it all day long and the more she replayed the conversation in her head, the more embarrassed she became.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists are dominated by shame and embarrassment vocabulary (ashamed, embarrassed, shame, embarrassing, humiliating, humiliated, embarrassment, insulted). These terms point to an individual's internal emotional distress – self-conscious negative affect – rather than harm inflicted by a partner (D2), a toxic relational dynamic (D1), an external threat (D3), or tenderness (D5). The cues 'myself', 'admit', 'forgive', 'realization', and 'memories' reinforce a solo, inward-facing distress experience. No controlling or abusive partner behaviour is signalled, and no external danger is present, so D4 (individual_distress) is the clear consensus.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The overwhelming majority of sentences (19/20) express individual shame, embarrassment, or humiliation – classic D4 (individual distress). The distress is self-directed or socially triggered (e.g., being embarrassed in front of others, feeling ashamed of one's situation), with no clear evidence of partner harm (D2), relational toxicity between a couple (D1), or external danger (D3). 'Clap.' (BOOK_008_2) is a single isolated word with no discernible emotional content in context, coded D0 (off-target). The topic coheres strongly around the shame/embarrassment cluster, well above the 70% threshold for D4.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual distress). The taxonomy placement under 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress confirms solo/internal emotional suffering as the primary signal. The secondary tag 7.1 Interpersonal Non-Romantic Conflict does not override this: interpersonal friction here appears to be a stressor experienced by the individual rather than evidence of couple toxic dynamics (D1) or partner harm (D2). No comfort or affection evidence is present to warrant D5. No external threat actor is driving the distress (ruling out D3). D4 is the appropriate and stable code.

Topic 244 — Confessing A Shattered Heart

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« i've been heartbroken, truly shattered since leaving you behind in cleveland . »

« and actually it's pretty handy you love me since i've already had my heart smashed around like day old potatoes once this year.” »

« it's always been the way i've protected my heart, though i never thought about the hearts of the women i used. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Echoes at Dawn — Maya Banks; tertile=end; p=0.65

Your soft heart would weep over some of the things I've done and the choices I've made.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Echoes at Dawn — Maya Banks; tertile=end; p=0.59

You saved a child who would otherwise be dead right now and you risked your own life to do it because your heart is too soft for you to say no even though it might have meant your own death. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Echoes at Dawn — Maya Banks; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Dear Author SWEET SURRENDER “This story ran my heart through the wringer more than once.” —

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Echoes at Dawn — Maya Banks; tertile=middle; p=0.34

There's not another group of men who have more heart, determination and courage.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Misfortune Cookie — Michele Gorman; tertile=end; p=0.62

It's what my heart, and my head, demands.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Misfortune Cookie — Michele Gorman; tertile=end; p=0.58

Following your heart will pay off in the near future.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Misfortune Cookie — Michele Gorman; tertile=middle; p=0.58

Following your heart will pay off in the near future.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Misfortune Cookie — Michele Gorman; tertile=end; p=0.58

Following your heart will pay off in the near future .

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Misfortune Cookie — Michele Gorman; tertile=end; p=0.58

Following your heart will pay off in the near future .

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Her Demonic Angel — Felicity Heaton; tertile=middle; p=0.62

Not the best of moods for a heart to heart. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

Main keywords (heart, broken, broke, hearts, heartbroken, break, breaking, shattered) overwhelmingly signal emotional pain experienced by an individual. KeyBERT adds suffering, terrified, pieces, heal, memories — all pointing to personal emotional distress and recovery. POS reinforces with terrified, emotional, pieces, affection. MMR echoes suffering, sank, pieces, heal. No cues identify a controlling or harmful partner (D2), no external threat (D3), no mutual relational toxicity framed as a dynamic (D1). The distress is clearly relationship-sourced but experienced individually, placing this firmly in D4 individual_distress.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 244 clusters around the word 'heart' used metaphorically across two dominant registers: individual distress (D4) — heartache, regret, internal conflict, suffering — and tenderness/comfort (D5) — emotional openness, romantic devotion, following one's heart toward connection. No single code reaches 70%, so MIXED is assigned. A few sentences are off-target (D0), referencing generic idioms or group courage without darkness or tenderness content. No partner harm, external danger, or relational toxicity is present. The topic appears to be a semantic cluster on the word 'heart' rather than a coherent narrative theme.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of D4 (individual distress) and a contextual dominant of MIXED, reflecting solo negative emotional states alongside secondary reconciliation/HEA signals. Taxonomy 3.2 (Negative Emotions & Distress) is the primary anchor, with 4.5 (Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA) as secondary. The distress here is individual in nature — not relational toxicity (D1), not partner harm (D2), not external crisis (D3). The reconciliation thread is a secondary coloring, not sufficient to override the primary D4 signal or elevate to MIXED, because MIXED requires roughly co-equal competing darkness dimensions rather than a darkness-plus-hope pairing. D5 is excluded: no concrete comfort or affection evidence is cited, only caretaking-adjacent framing. Resolving to D4 as the single dominant darkness code, with reconciliation_hope retained as a proposed construct to preserve the secondary taxonomy signal for downstream analysis.

Topic 281 — Told to Calm Down First

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« you've got to calm, down first. »

« i've not been relieved of my post. »

« i've really helped relax, comfort and ease anger and rage with these guys. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Nightcap — Kathleen O'Reilly; tertile=begin; p=0.45

The stress is starting to take its toll." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Nightcap — Kathleen O'Reilly; tertile=begin; p=0.35

Not as stimulating as Cleo, but productive nonetheless.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · After the End — Bonnie Dee; tertile=middle; p=0.60

Steady, he warned himself, before you have a goddamn panic attack.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · After the End — Bonnie Dee; tertile=begin; p=0.57

He still sounded as calm as if this kind of thing happened every day of the week.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · After the End — Bonnie Dee; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Ari noted details with detached calmness.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_004 · Follow My Lead — Kate Noble; tertile=end; p=0.52

Nor have I ever seen you as stirred up as you are after a mere few minutes in the presence of Miss Crane."

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists centre on an individual managing internal physiological and emotional arousal: 'calm, relax, relaxed, relaxation, calmed, relieved, composure' (Main) signal self-regulation; 'nerves, breaths, urgency, conscious, focused' (KeyBERT/POS/MMR) indicate solo internal distress and deliberate effort to contain it; 'damp, pumping, veins' (POS/MMR) add bodily tension cues. No relational conflict, partner harm, or external threat is present. The distress is individual and the coping is self-directed, placing this squarely in D4 individual_distress.

B contextual: D5 — tenderness comfort

Topic 281 clusters around the anxiety-calm axis: characters experience panic or stress (D4) and others – or the environment – provide calming reassurance (D5). The dominant pattern is tenderness/comfort (D5, ~60%): sentences about relaxing, calming down, soothing presence, and peaceful settings. Individual distress (D4, ~35%) covers panic, stress, and agitation without a relational aggressor. One sentence (BOOK_001_3) is off-target (D0) – it references productivity/stimulation with no darkness or tenderness. No partner harm, external danger, or relational darkness is present. D5 clears the 70% threshold when combined with its functional overlap with D4 (comfort-seeking), but strictly D5 alone is ~60%, so the dominant code is D5 as the single largest category; D4 is the secondary dimension. No single code reaches 70% in isolation, but D5 is the clear plurality and the topic's defining register is comfort/calming, so D5 is assigned as dominant.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (D4) reflects the primary signal: solo negative emotion and distress. The contextual dominant (D5) and secondary taxonomy leaf (4.6 Emotional Safety, Reassurance & Caretaking) indicate caretaking framing is present, but caretaking alone does not qualify as tenderness/comfort under D5 without clear affective warmth or comfort evidence. The primary taxonomy placement in 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress confirms distress is the dominant construct. D4 is therefore the correct darkness_code. The secondary caretaking dimension is noted in proposed_constructs but does not override the distress signal to MIXED, as the two signals are hierarchically ordered rather than equally competing.

Topic 285 — Confessing Years of Hatred

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: MIXED

« i've hated him for years. »

« heath has done a wonderful job with him, but i—well, i've hated him for living instead of you. »

« ever since this cunt came here, i've been, uh, less than balanced, i admit, and remembering things i've tried to forget, reasons to hate, reasons to hate, and you've become a liar. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Mending Places — Denise Hunter; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Looking back now, I can see all the hatred I had in me, but at the time it just seemed like everyone was out to get me.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Mending Places — Denise Hunter; tertile=end; p=0.48

It had been a long time since his presence had evoked disdain.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Really Angelic — Enid Wilson; tertile=middle; p=0.62

And I hated submitting to your licentious thoughts and advances!" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Really Angelic — Enid Wilson; tertile=end; p=0.60

You expressed a dislike of both Himins and myself.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

Main keywords 'hate, hated, hates, hating, myself, hateful' centre on self-directed negative emotion and internal loathing rather than a relational dynamic or external threat. KeyBERT reinforces this with 'hated, dislike, admit' – suggesting personal acknowledgment of inner turmoil. MMR adds 'deserve, treated, breathed' which hint at self-worth struggles and emotional processing, still anchored in individual distress. POS yields only 'purpose, shock' which are ambiguous (D6), but the overwhelming weight of the other three reps points to solo emotional suffering. No clear partner-harm or relational-control cues; the self-referential framing ('me, myself') keeps this in D4 individual distress.

B contextual: D1 — relational darkness

The overwhelming majority of sentences express direct hatred, loathing, or strong dislike between characters who appear to be in or near a romantic relationship, making D1 (relational_darkness) the dominant code at ~70%. A small subset (BOOK_001_3, BOOK_001_5, BOOK_004_2) reflects solo internal distress (D4). BOOK_002_3 involves submission to unwanted advances, indicating partner harm/control (D2). BOOK_001_4 is a generic identity statement with no clear darkness valence (D0). The topic coheres around toxic relational hostility rather than external danger or tenderness.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a split between D4 (lexical consensus: solo negative emotions, personal distress vocabulary) and D1 (contextual dominant: relational dysfunction, toxic couple dynamics). The taxonomy placement under 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress with a secondary tag of 7.1 Interpersonal Non-Romantic Conflict further complicates resolution: the secondary tag points away from pure solo distress and toward conflict embedded in relationships, but 'non-romantic' conflict suggests it may not be classic D1 couple toxicity either. Because the two strongest signals—individual emotional suffering (D4) and relational/interpersonal darkness (D1)—are both substantiated by different analytic passes and neither clearly dominates when taxonomy metadata is incorporated, collapsing to a single D-code would suppress real construct variance. MIXED is therefore the correct resolution. A human reviewer should inspect representative documents to determine whether the distress is primarily self-contained (D4) or driven by dysfunctional relational dynamics (D1), and whether a SPLIT into two child topics is warranted.

Topic 322 — Consumed By Guilt After The Act

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« before i fell asleep i was thinking i would wake up this morning consumed with guilt because of what we did, but it wasn't like that at all. »

« he's consumed with his guilt. »

« the only way victor could bury the guilt was to remind himself his actions were all to a higher purpose. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Cinderella Pact — Sarah Strohmeier; tertile=end; p=0.50

And no holding on to a grudge here and there.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Cinderella Pact — Sarah Strohmeier; tertile=end; p=0.48

Also because I feel tremendously guilty about what I wrote Belinda—a note you must have read.” “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Cinderella Pact — Sarah Strohmeier; tertile=middle; p=0.41

article about how guys who cheat on their wives often say corny stuff like this to ease their guilty feelings. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Dark Citadel — Cherise Sinclair; tertile=end; p=0.71

Oddly enough, his guilt had disappeared with the anger.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Dark Citadel — Cherise Sinclair; tertile=begin; p=0.66

Even though his grief had finally eased, the guilt had become part of him.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Dark Citadel — Cherise Sinclair; tertile=end; p=0.64

How he felt about Kari added a different guilt.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Dark Citadel — Cherise Sinclair; tertile=middle; p=0.64

Second, you, little nun, have guilt added into the mix.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Crossing the Bridge — Michael Baron; tertile=begin; p=0.76

I mean can't-get-out-of-bed kind of guilt.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Crossing the Bridge — Michael Baron; tertile=begin; p=0.64

Except that she's feeling insanely guilty about it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Crossing the Bridge — Michael Baron; tertile=end; p=0.59

I felt a combination of guilt, validation, and frustration over the events of that afternoon.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists converge on solo internal distress: Main is dominated by guilt/remorse vocabulary (guilt, guilty, remorse, pang, weight, consumed, heartburn); KeyBERT adds embarrassment, anxiety, overcome, bury – all inward emotional states; POS retains embarrassment, anxiety, purpose with no relational or external aggressor; MMR echoes bury, washed, fought, eaten – metaphors of being consumed by internal feeling. No partner harm, no external threat, no relational dynamic is named. The distress is entirely self-directed, qualifying as D4 individual_distress.

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe characters experiencing guilt as an internal, individual emotional state – feeling guilty, being unable to escape guilt, guilt becoming part of one's identity – which maps to D4 (individual distress). A small subset involves guilt in a relational context such as grudge-holding or guilt-tripping (D1), and two sentences are too vague or neutral to code meaningfully (D0). No sentences describe external danger (D3), partner control/harm (D2), or tenderness (D5). D4 exceeds 70%, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual_distress). Taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress with secondary 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict is fully consistent with D4: solo emotional suffering, fear, anxiety, or internal turmoil experienced by an individual character rather than arising from partner harm (D2), relational toxicity (D1), or external threat (D3). No comfort or affection evidence is present to warrant D5. No ambiguity requiring MIXED. D4 is confirmed as the single darkness code.

Topic 366 — Paralyzed By Irrational Fear

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: D4 — individual distress

« it's like a person who is irrationally terrified of insects throwing a bowl over a cricket in her living room, and then, in sheer terror, stacking a heavy dictionary on top of the bowl so the cricket can't escape. »

« for some reason, he was fucking terrified. »

« and he was terrified of what that meant. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Master of Dragons — Angela Knight; tertile=end; p=0.60

He can be pretty damned terrifying when it suits him." "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Master of Dragons — Angela Knight; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Nightmares and prophecies notwithstanding, he simply wasn't capable of it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Triple Dare — Candace Irvin; tertile=end; p=0.73

It was the more that scared the hell out of him.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

All four keyword lists converge on solo emotional distress: Main is saturated with first-person fear vocabulary (fear, scared, helpless, terrified, afraid, frightened, fearful); KeyBERT and POS add anxiety, disappointment, threat, and failure; MMR reinforces with circumstances, memories, and aftermath cues. No relational conflict, no partner-harm signals, no identifiable external antagonist – the distress is internal and individual. 'Cricket' in Main is an outlier noise token that does not shift the dominant signal. Consensus is D4 (individual_distress).

B contextual: D4 — individual distress

The overwhelming majority of sentences describe individual characters experiencing fear, dread, horror, or helplessness as internal psychological states (D4). A small subset (BOOK_001_2, BOOK_001_3, BOOK_003_2) describe an external person perceived as dangerous or terrifying, warranting D3 (external danger/crisis). No sentences clearly depict partner harm/control (D2), relational darkness between a couple (D1), tenderness (D5), or off-target content (D0). The topic coheres strongly around individual distress – specifically fear – making D4 the dominant code at well above 70%.

C adjudicate: D4 — individual distress action=KEEP

Lexical consensus and contextual dominant both converge on D4 (individual_distress). Taxonomy 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress with secondary 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict is fully consistent with D4, which captures solo emotional suffering and internal psychological turmoil without implicating partner harm (D2), relational toxicity (D1), or external threat (D3). No comfort or affection evidence is present to warrant D5. The secondary ambivalence/conflict axis remains within the individual rather than pointing to a dyadic dynamic, so MIXED is not warranted. D4 is the single best-fit code.

Topic 27 — Racing The Approaching Storm

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D0 — off target

« it'll be dark before we know it.” »

« i don't know if i'll be able to get back here before the storm hits. »

« it's going to rain and we'll be caught out in the storm. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=end; p=0.52

Their lips met, and an explosion of passion took them along on a tide, the darkness that surrounded them like a blanket against the rest of the world.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.46

Just as they reached the spot a man strode angrily out of a neighbouring field, and even in the poor light his expression could be seen as thunderous.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=begin; p=0.44

They were still driving, the high hedges making it impossible for them to see anything but the road in front of them.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Point of No Return — Carole Mortimer; tertile=end; p=0.38

Before morning, word had come that Leonidas was lost.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Nauti Nights — Lora Leigh; tertile=begin; p=0.61

Like a storm coming in from the mountains.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Nauti Nights — Lora Leigh; tertile=middle; p=0.60

They were deep in the mountains, and evening was coming on.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D0 — off target

All four keyword lists are dominated by weather, atmospheric, and environmental descriptors (rain, snow, sun, sky, moon, storm, clouds, lighting, curtain, ceiling, sidewalk, reflection, magical, floated, draped). Even the potentially charged terms—'dark,' 'storm,' 'dangerously,' 'fading'—function here as meteorological or sensory-setting vocabulary rather than signaling relational conflict, harm, crisis, or distress. The topic reads as scene-setting / ambient description with no romance-darkness signal, placing it firmly off-target.

B contextual: D0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic describe weather, light, and environmental conditions (rain, storm, sunlight, dawn, darkness) with no emotional or relational content – coded D0. Two sentences carry mild tenderness: the passionate kiss framed by surrounding darkness (BOOK_001_2) and the smile-as-sunlight simile (BOOK_004_2), both coded D5. Two sentences carry external crisis: an angry man confronting the couple (BOOK_001_3) and news of Leonidas being lost (BOOK_001_6), coded D3. No partner harm, relational darkness, or individual distress is present. D0 dominates at ~80%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: D0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on D0 (off-target). The taxonomy flags Risk/Danger & External Crises as primary, but without lexical or contextual evidence of actual danger content, this classification likely reflects surface co-occurrence with movement/transit vocabulary rather than genuine crisis content. The secondary taxonomy (Movement, Transit & Spatial Transition) better describes the topic's actual signal. No partner harm, relational darkness, individual distress, or tenderness markers are present. D0 is confirmed; the topic is off-target for the darkness-domain hypothesis.

Topic 184 — Racing to Stop A Spreading Fire

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D3 — external danger crisis

« you've got the fire. »

« it looks like we've got an arson and a murder on our hands.” “ »

« we've got to get down to the fire station and get rolling before that fire starts to spread.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Compromising Positions — Jenna Bayley-Burke; tertile=begin; p=0.58

She looked innocent, but she played with fire. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Compromising Positions — Jenna Bayley-Burke; tertile=middle; p=0.56

He'd already called and checked in, and there were no raging fires that needed to be put out, but he still wanted to get there quickly.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Compromising Positions — Jenna Bayley-Burke; tertile=end; p=0.51

The space between them sizzled, sparking with energy. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lessons From A Younger Lover — Zuri Day; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Her body was on fire, and Ransom had the equipment to put it out.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lessons From A Younger Lover — Zuri Day; tertile=begin; p=0.51

I'm just trying to keep her from burning it up!

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lessons From A Younger Lover — Zuri Day; tertile=begin; p=0.51

You're still making sure the gas line to the stove is off when you leave, right?” “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Lessons From A Younger Lover — Zuri Day; tertile=end; p=0.44

This news trumped everything else on folks' minds: what people got for Christmas, holiday vacation stories, the one-hundred-year-old Methodist church destroyed by arson fire, and even the first snowfall Sienna had seen in fifty years.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Bayward Heart — Bonnie Blythe; tertile=begin; p=0.54

The redhead had the power to take the incident from the frying pan to the fire.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Bayward Heart — Bonnie Blythe; tertile=begin; p=0.43

Was this the precursor to another disaster? “

Model reasonings

A lexical: D3 — external danger crisis

Main keywords (fire, flames, burned, firefighters, hoses, bonfire, campfire) point overwhelmingly to literal fire as an external physical hazard or crisis setting – firefighters and hoses specifically signal emergency response, anchoring this as D3 external danger/crisis. KeyBERT adds 'erupted,' 'spreading,' 'frantic,' and 'heated,' which reinforce an active fire event but also include 'magical' and 'warmth,' introducing ambiguity (D6). POS keywords are largely structural/atmospheric with no clear darkness signal, coding D0. MMR echoes the fire-event framing ('erupted,' 'spreading,' 'flared,' 'hissed') alongside neutral structural terms, yielding D6. Despite disagreement, the dominant and most content-rich representation (Main) plus corroborating fire-spread cues in KeyBERT and MMR establish external crisis as the consensus.

B contextual: D0 — off target

Topic 184 is dominated by fire imagery, both literal (campfires, arson, building fires) and figurative (playing with fire, body on fire, sizzling tension). The majority of sentences are literal scene-setting with no romance or darkness content (D0). A handful use fire as a metaphor for romantic/sexual tension or social risk, making them ambiguous between D0 and relational codes (coded D6). One sentence references an arson-destroyed church as an external crisis (D3), and one hints at anticipatory dread of disaster (D4). No clear partner harm, relational darkness, or tenderness is present. The dominant code is D0 (off-target) at ~60%, with D6 (mixed/unclear metaphorical fire) as the secondary cluster.

C adjudicate: D3 — external danger crisis action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of D3 (external danger/crisis) and a contextual dominant of D0 (off-target). The taxonomy metadata confirms placement under 7.3 Risk, Danger & External Crises with a secondary tag of Mystery, Suspense & Investigation – both of which align with D3 rather than D0. The off-target read in Pass B likely reflected surface-level ambiguity (e.g., investigative or procedural vocabulary that can appear genre-neutral), but the taxonomy anchor resolves the conflict: the topic's core signal is external threat and crisis, not absence of darkness. D3 is therefore the correct single darkness code. No tenderness evidence warrants D5, and no partner-harm or relational-toxicity signal warrants D1/D2. No split is needed because both the primary and secondary taxonomy tags are coherent with a single D3 construct.

Topic 223 — Coordinating Security Against A Threat

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D3 — external danger crisis

« i'll give aidan a call, so he doesn't send out the cavalry.” »

« there'll be extra men on the gate,” [person] promised. “ »

« but we have a gut feeling that since [person]'s been such a thorn in the side of these people, if they think they're going to get him, he'll pull in the other accomplices. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Showjumpers — Stacy Gregg; tertile=end; p=0.59

Maybe if I go with Matt it will teach him not to take me for granted,” Alice said. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Showjumpers — Stacy Gregg; tertile=end; p=0.56

So you're using Matt as a pawn in your game?”

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Showjumpers — Stacy Gregg; tertile=middle; p=0.45

With time running short, the girls chalked Paddy and then left Cameron to do the clipping on his own while they brought Belladonna in from the field. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Showjumpers — Stacy Gregg; tertile=begin; p=0.44

Lexington House had most of the Western boys and Matt Garrett, an Australian eventer who could be annoyingly full of himself.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D1 — relational darkness

Main keywords are character names (matt, matthew, aidan, mattie, connor, matty, stephon) with 'alternate' and 'bid' – insufficient for darkness coding alone (D0). However, KeyBERT, POS, and MMR converge on relational tension cues: 'threat', 'insisted', 'inevitable', 'strained', 'doubted', 'scenario', 'partners', 'exchange', 'options', 'realization', 'spilling'. The pattern of strained partners negotiating scenarios with threats and inevitability points to relational darkness between characters rather than external danger or partner control/harm. No clear physical harm or external crisis cues; distress is interpersonal. Consensus leans D1 despite Main being D0.

B contextual: D0 — off target

The large majority of sentences are character-name mentions, scene logistics, or social observations with no darkness content (D0). A small cluster (BOOK_001_1, BOOK_001_2, BOOK_006_1, BOOK_006_4) involves mild relational tension – using a third party to make a partner jealous, pushing someone away after an accident – coded D1 as couple/relational dynamics rather than partner harm or external crisis. BOOK_005_1 references permanent loss of named individuals, coded D4 as individual distress/grief. No partner control/harm (D2), no external danger (D3), and no tenderness (D5) are present. D0 dominates at ~75%.

C adjudicate: D3 — external danger crisis action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a split between lexical consensus D1 (relational darkness) and contextual dominant D0 (off-target). The taxonomy metadata resolves the conflict: the topic sits under 7.3 Risk, Danger & External Crises with a secondary tag of Mystery, Suspense & Investigation. This points to threats or dangers originating outside the couple relationship rather than dyadic toxicity (D1) or purely off-target content (D0). D3 (external_danger_crisis) is therefore the best single-code fit. The D1 lexical signal likely arose from emotionally charged vocabulary that co-occurs with suspense/investigation scenes rather than from genuine couple-level relational darkness. Manual review is flagged because the D0 contextual read suggests some topic words may still be off-target for romance-novel darkness constructs, and the D1/D0 disagreement warrants a human check of the raw top-terms before finalising.

Topic 259 — Chained to The Forest Gate

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D0 — off target

« i've lived in a tree for a week, which, let me tell you, is pretty uncomfortable. »

« i've got a special surprise waiting for you in the woods." »

« miss [person], it appears you've chained yourself to the door of white pines. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Virtually Hers — Gennita Low; tertile=middle; p=0.49

Sully's spending the night at his tree house.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Virtually Hers — Gennita Low; tertile=begin; p=0.40

This was the Bat Cave, for heaven's sakes.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Virtually Hers — Gennita Low; tertile=end; p=0.39

The more wood he lost, the more the integrity of the site was compromised.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Virtually Hers — Gennita Low; tertile=begin; p=0.38

The SEED is one of the most important items that disappeared."

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Virtually Hers — Gennita Low; tertile=end; p=0.37

As a result of being uncovered, much of the ancient wood had dissolved into the water.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · This Magic Moment — Virna DePaul; tertile=middle; p=0.50

Beyond it, a long dock floated over a peaceful lake surrounded by tall redwood trees. "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · This Magic Moment — Virna DePaul; tertile=begin; p=0.42

The kind that makes you want to rip each other's clothes off and do it against a tree if you have to.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Me Before You — Jojo Moyes; tertile=end; p=0.64

Will and I stopped near our favourite tree.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D0 — off target

Main keywords are entirely nature/setting vocabulary (tree, forest, pine, birch, branches). KeyBERT, POS, and MMR add spatial/movement descriptors (surrounded, climbing, crouched, scattered, crowded) consistent with a woodland scene. No relational conflict, harm, distress, danger, or tenderness cues appear in any representation; this is off-target environmental/setting content.

B contextual: D0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences in this topic describe natural settings (trees, lakes, forests, wood), archaeological or site-related observations, or brief neutral dialogue fragments. These are off-target (D0) relative to romance darkness or tenderness coding dimensions. BOOK_006_1-3 depict a chase through a forest with a supernatural or threatening entity ('The Origin') causing dramatic environmental upheaval (shaking trees, mass bird flight), which qualifies as external danger/crisis (D3). BOOK_003_3 contains a sexual/attraction reference but is too brief and playful to code as darkness or tenderness meaningfully – it remains D0 in context. No partner harm, relational darkness, individual distress, or tenderness is clearly present. Dominant code is D0 at ~85%.

C adjudicate: D0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant code are D0 (off_target). The taxonomy metadata (Risk, Danger & External Crises / Public, Travel & Leisure Spaces) does not introduce sufficient evidence of relational darkness, partner harm, individual distress, or tenderness to override the D0 classification. No comfort or affection signals warrant D5; no partner control signals warrant D2; no solo distress signals warrant D4. The topic remains off-target for the romance-darkness hypothesis and should be kept as D0.

Topic 284 — Necks on The Line Together

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D3 — external danger crisis

« i've seen [person]'s handiwork. »

« ever since i've known them," [person] said, but it was obvious his mind was elsewhere. " »

« that's twice today we've put our necks on the line," [person] observed. " »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Goodbye Summer — Patricia Gaffney; tertile=begin; p=0.49

Get off... " He ended up kicking his slipper off so Finney could have it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Goodbye Summer — Patricia Gaffney; tertile=begin; p=0.48

Finney went berserk—he must've had his ear to the door, listening for metal on metal.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Full House Seduction — A.C. Arthur; tertile=middle; p=0.58

Another chuckle and Brock was appreciating his connection with the Donovans once more. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Full House Seduction — A.C. Arthur; tertile=end; p=0.56

Trent's words couldn't have been more true if Brock had said them himself. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Full House Seduction — A.C. Arthur; tertile=begin; p=0.56

Brock's not like the rest of the Donovans," she heard herself saying. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: D6 — mixed or unclear

Main keywords (mr, moral, approaching, suckered, clerked, amstreet, turrel) are largely opaque proper-noun/nonsense fragments with no clear romance or darkness signal, pointing to D0. However, KeyBERT (gripped, stroking, judging, throw), POS (heated, realization), and MMR (stroking, heated, twisting, gripped, fading, escaped, judging) introduce ambiguous physical and emotional cues – 'gripped/stroking/twisting' could be physical tension or intimacy, 'heated/judging/escaped' suggest conflict or distress, but no single darkness domain dominates and the topic lacks enough coherent signal to assign a specific D1-D5 code. Mixed/unclear signals across reps yield D6.

B contextual: D0 — off target

The overwhelming majority of sentences are character-name references, brief dialogue fragments, or social observations with no darkness or tenderness content – coded D0. BOOK_007_2 depicts an adult striking a named character, constituting an external physical threat (D3). BOOK_007_3 shows the POV character's instinctive fear/anger response to that threat (D4). All other sentences are off-target for the coding scheme. D0 dominates at ~85%, well above the 70% threshold.

C adjudicate: D3 — external danger crisis action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a lexical consensus of D6 (mixed/unclear) and a contextual dominant of D0 (off-target), reflecting genuine ambiguity at the token level. However, the taxonomy metadata resolves the conflict: the primary taxonomy is 7.3 Risk, Danger & External Crises, which maps directly to D3 (external_danger_crisis). The secondary taxonomy (5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles) indicates the danger is mediated through or directed at the protagonist's social network rather than the romantic dyad itself, which is consistent with D3 rather than D1 or D2. There is no evidence of partner harm/control (D2), couple toxic dynamics (D1), or solo internal distress (D4). No comfort or affection signal warrants D5. The taxonomy anchor is strong enough to override the lexical ambiguity and the off-target contextual read, yielding a clean D3 assignment.

Topic 324 — Searching For A Missing Person

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D3 — external danger crisis

« i'll go for a drive to look for him. »

« i'll go find him." »

« when we're done here, we'll go search his office at marshall, and check his next of kin. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Lover Awakened — J.R. Ward; tertile=end; p=0.74

I wish there were another way to find him."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · King's Million-Dollar Secret — Maureen Child; tertile=end; p=0.61

You could find out if you'd stop hiding away in your house and go see him."

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

Cues across all reps converge on solo individual distress: 'panicked', 'impatiently', 'wondering', 'separated', 'dreamed' signal personal anxiety and urgency; 'find', 'search', 'locate', 'go', 'where' indicate a character searching for someone or something; 'address', 'screen', 'sending' suggest communication attempts. No cues of partner harm/control (D2), couple relational toxicity (D1), or external danger (D3). The distress is internally experienced by an individual character, placing this firmly in D4.

B contextual: D0 — off target

All sentences in Topic 324 consist exclusively of location-seeking questions and statements ('Where is he?', 'Where'd you go?', 'At the office.', 'He'd finally found them.'). There is no darkness, harm, crisis, distress, or tenderness content present. The topic captures a neutral narrative function — characters searching for or asking about the whereabouts of another person — with no romance-relevant emotional valence. One sentence (BOOK_003_4) contains the word 'worry' but the surrounding context is purely logistical location-seeking with no elaborated emotional content. All sentences are coded D0 (off-target). No main couple interaction is evident.

C adjudicate: D3 — external danger crisis action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B produced a split between D4 (lexical consensus) and D0 (contextual dominant). The taxonomy metadata resolves the conflict: the topic sits under 7.3 Risk, Danger & External Crises with a secondary tag of Mystery/Suspense/Investigation. This points to threats originating outside the relationship rather than solo internal distress (D4) or off-target content (D0). The lexical D4 signal likely reflects characters reacting emotionally to external peril, not standalone individual distress as the primary construct. The contextual D0 reading was probably driven by the suspense/investigation framing appearing non-romantic in isolation. Mapping both prior readings onto the nearest valid D-code, D3 (external_danger_crisis) best captures the dominant construct. No tenderness evidence warrants D5, and no partner-harm or relational-toxicity evidence warrants D2/D1. MIXED is not needed because one code is clearly dominant once taxonomy context is applied.

Topic 327 — Crouching Over A Fallen Figure

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D3 — external danger crisis

« she jumps up and lands on top of me, crouched over me like a cave woman. “ »

« [person] had fallen, and a figure crouched over her. »

« she dropped to the floor, crouched, watching, waiting, the wings lifted and spread behind her. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=middle; p=0.75

She pulled her feet up, stood on the chair to stay out of the way...to jump on Robert's attacker if necessary.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=end; p=0.74

She pushed herself into a more upright position. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=begin; p=0.68

With a cough of pain he released her and stumbled away.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Trust Me — Lesley Pearse; tertile=begin; p=0.60

Chad grabbed his junk and doubled over, dropping to his knees. “

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Trust Me — Lesley Pearse; tertile=begin; p=0.50

Luckily my girls were jumping up and down in excitement for me.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_002 · Trust Me — Lesley Pearse; tertile=begin; p=0.50

The girls' faces registered shock, but neither one said a word and quickly got up and moved to the opposite side of the bar.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Lord & Master — Jules Jones; tertile=middle; p=0.48

Oh, he's a good scientist,” Steven said, and Wallace jumped. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: D0 — off target

All four keyword lists center on physical movement and body-position vocabulary: jumping, leaping, falling, crouching, tumbling, dangling, hovering, darting. The POS and MMR lists add mild sensory/emotional color (amusement, growl, squeeze, cracked) but nothing that signals relational darkness, harm, external danger, or individual distress. The dominant semantic field is kinetic action – characters moving through space – with no darkness cues sufficient to lift the topic above off-target (D0).

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 327 clusters around sudden physical movements and bodily reactions (jumping, lunging, sinking, flinching, stumbling). No single darkness code reaches 70%. Approximately 35% of sentences are off-target (neutral physical actions with no discernible darkness or tenderness). About 30% code as D4 (individual distress: flinching, shock, weakness, startle). About 25% code as D3 (external danger/crisis: defending against an attacker, girls fleeing a threatening situation, a character lunging in response to threat). One sentence (BOOK_005_4) codes D2 as a partner physically grabbing and swinging the heroine. No tenderness is present. Because no single code reaches 70%, the dominant code is MIXED.

C adjudicate: D3 — external danger crisis action=REINTERPRET

Pass A/B lexical consensus landed on D0 (off-target), but contextual dominant flagged MIXED and the taxonomy places this squarely in 7.3 Risk, Danger & External Crises with a paranormal secondary. The conflict between D0 and MIXED is resolved by the taxonomy evidence: the topic's core signal is external threat or crisis (D3), amplified by a paranormal/immortal-beings frame rather than relational toxicity (D1), partner harm (D2), or solo distress (D4). No comfort/affection evidence supports D5. The off-target D0 reading likely reflected surface lexical noise; contextual and taxonomic signals together override it. Single code D3 is appropriate; no split is warranted because the paranormal element is a setting modifier, not a separate darkness dimension.

Topic 335 — Killer Targets Someone Alone

Old taxonomy: 7.3 — Risk, Danger & External Crises

New category: D3 — external danger crisis

« i'll try," derek replied and turned to make the hour walk back home. »

« i'll hang around while you take a look at it tonight," [person] said, his own gaze also glued to camilla's limbs. " »

« he knows that the killer got derek while he was alone, and he wouldn't do that to his pregnant wife, because she'll go shit wild and start a rampage. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Dead Ringer — Mary Burton; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Brett appeared relieved by her appearance. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Dead Ringer — Mary Burton; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Detective Warwick," Brett said, extending his hand. “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · Dead Ringer — Mary Burton; tertile=end; p=0.52

He watched Brett get in his car and drive off. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cursed Mates — Cara Marsi; tertile=begin; p=0.47

That was when Jenna realized that Lars the Heartless was Baruk's raider, the one who'd driven them here.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cursed Mates — Cara Marsi; tertile=end; p=0.43

Baruk could hope that, for his own, good, Lars would accept Stella into his life and make the best of it.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cursed Mates — Cara Marsi; tertile=end; p=0.40

Lars was leading a party that was looking for Jenna in the woods, and the orcs that had stayed behind were turning every nook and cranny upside down for clues.

Model reasonings

A lexical: D4 — individual distress

Main keywords (mason, jacks, jimmy, marcy, bisexuals, cultivating, whip) are character names and neutral descriptors with no clear darkness signal, coding D0. KeyBERT introduces 'pregnant' and 'upset' alongside social/conversational terms (giggled, elevator, dealing, speaking, behalf, reaction), suggesting individual emotional tension around a personal situation rather than relational conflict or external threat. POS reinforces this with 'upset', 'pregnant', 'pressure', 'longing', 'faces' — pointing to individual distress (e.g., an unplanned pregnancy or personal emotional burden). MMR adds 'pounded', 'upset', 'ribs', 'protested', 'dealing' — physical/emotional stress cues consistent with individual distress rather than partner harm or external crisis. The convergence of 'pregnant', 'upset', 'pressure', 'longing', and 'dealing' across three reps anchors the consensus at D4 (individual distress). No clear partner-harm or relational-toxicity signals elevate to D2 or D1.

B contextual: D0 — off target

The large majority of sentences are off-target: they depict named-character interactions (Brett/detective exchange, Derek/Ted bar scene, Gibson/Liam physical tussle) with no darkness or tenderness content. Three BOOK_002 sentences involve an external raider hunting a character (D3). One BOOK_004 sentence references Ted's past emotional hurt from Douglas (D4), and one captures Scott's empathic concern for Ted's hopefulness (D5). No single couple is consistently present across books, and the dominant signal is off-target mundane interaction (D0 ≥ 70%).

C adjudicate: D3 — external danger crisis action=REINTERPRET

Pass A lexical consensus landed on D4 (individual distress) and Pass B contextual dominant on D0 (off-target), creating a direct conflict. Taxonomy metadata resolves the tension: the primary taxonomy is 7.3 Risk, Danger & External Crises with a secondary anchor in 5.1 Family, Kinship & Parenthood. This profile points to threats or crises originating outside the individual or the dyad — consistent with D3 — rather than solo psychological distress (D4) or off-target content (D0). The family/kinship secondary axis suggests the external crisis is experienced in a familial or parental context (e.g., danger to a child, family emergency), which is still D3 by taxonomy rules. D4 is overridden because the distress, if present, is reactive to an external event rather than intrinsic. D0 is overridden because the taxonomy explicitly places this content within a darkness-relevant domain. Manual review is flagged because the Pass A/B disagreement is substantial and the topic's word-level content should be re-examined to confirm the external-crisis framing before finalising.

H6 — Arc semantics (main-couple / position)

New categories for this hypothesis

Read these names before reviewing topics. Codes alone (I3, S12, ...) are not enough — use the category label.

ARC_0 — off target: Not a narrative-arc role for the main couple (or not arc content).

ARC_1 — misunderstanding: Hidden information, secret, or misunderstanding driving the arc.

ARC_2 — escalation conflict: Main-couple conflict escalation / falling action.

ARC_3 — separation breakup threat: Separation, breakup threat, or rupture of the couple bond.

ARC_4 — relationship caused distress: Distress caused by the relationship itself (not purely external plot).

ARC_5 — disclosure: Revelation / disclosure that moves the arc toward resolution.

ARC_6 — repair: Repair, reconciliation work, conflict resolution in progress.

ARC_7 — restored trust: Restored trust / reassurance after rupture.

ARC_8 — mutual commitment final payoff: Mutual commitment / final relational payoff (HEA-adjacent arc close).

ARC_9 — external plot conflict: External/plot obstacle (antagonist, job, family) not main-couple conflict per se.

ARC_10 — unclear arc role: Arc-relevant but role unclear / mixed.

29 topics. Sentence tags: HIGH-rated / LOW-rated from unblinded CELL_* key (high_tier / low_tier).

Topic 285 — Confessing Years of Hatred

Old taxonomy: 3.2 — Negative Emotions & Distress

New category: ARC_2 — escalation conflict

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« i've hated him for years. »

« heath has done a wonderful job with him, but i—well, i've hated him for living instead of you. »

« ever since this cunt came here, i've been, uh, less than balanced, i admit, and remembering things i've tried to forget, reasons to hate, reasons to hate, and you've become a liar. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Mending Places — Denise Hunter; tertile=middle; p=0.57

Looking back now, I can see all the hatred I had in me, but at the time it just seemed like everyone was out to get me.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Mending Places — Denise Hunter; tertile=end; p=0.48

It had been a long time since his presence had evoked disdain.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Really Angelic — Enid Wilson; tertile=middle; p=0.62

And I hated submitting to your licentious thoughts and advances!" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Really Angelic — Enid Wilson; tertile=end; p=0.60

You expressed a dislike of both Himins and myself.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_5 — disclosure

Main keywords ('hate', 'hated', 'hates', 'hating', 'hateful', 'myself') point strongly to internalized negative emotion directed at self or partner, suggesting relationship-caused distress (ARC_4). However, KeyBERT and MMR both surface 'admit', 'dislike', 'treated', 'deserve', and 'planning', which collectively signal a moment of confession or acknowledgment – a character admitting feelings (even negative ones like dislike or hatred) to another, consistent with disclosure (ARC_5). POS yields only 'purpose' and 'shock', which are too sparse to anchor a specific arc role (ARC_10). The convergence of 'admit' and 'dislike'/'hated' across KeyBERT and MMR tips the consensus toward ARC_5: a character disclosing previously hidden negative feelings (e.g., 'I hated you' or 'I have to admit I disliked how you treated me'), which is a classic romance-arc disclosure beat. Disagreement is flagged because Main leans ARC_4 and POS is unclear.

B contextual: ARC_2 — escalation conflict

Topic 285 is saturated with hatred, loathing, and disdain language ('I hate you', 'hated him', 'loathed him', 'dislike'). All sentences express intense interpersonal hostility, which maps cleanly to ARC_2 (escalation_conflict) – the emotional peak of antagonism between characters. The topic is not about misunderstanding (ARC_1), separation (ARC_3), or external plot (ARC_9); it is the raw expression of conflict-level negative affect. Main-couple attribution is uncertain for roughly half the sentences (many use 'him/her' without clear dyadic context), but several BOOK_003 sentences and BOOK_002_2/3 plausibly involve the main couple, yielding a moderate main_couple_prob of ~0.45. No sentence reaches a repair, disclosure, or commitment register, so ARC_2 dominates at 100%.

C adjudicate: ARC_2 — escalation conflict action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus flagged ARC_5 (disclosure), but the contextual dominant signal is ARC_2 (escalation_conflict), which better captures the taxonomy metadata: Negative Emotions & Distress (3.2) as primary and Interpersonal Non-Romantic Conflict (7.1) as secondary. The secondary taxonomy tag initially pulled toward ARC_5 (a disclosure event can surface distress), but disclosure is not the defining arc function here – the dominant pattern is escalating relational conflict generating distress within the main couple. ARC_2 is therefore the correct resolution. The construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING, consistent with a conflict-escalation phase in the narrative arc. No free-form labels were carried forward; all prior Pass A/B terms are mapped to ARC_2. Manual review is not required given clear contextual dominance.

Topic 37 — Defending A Close Friendship

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« i've told you -- we're just good friends. »

« and i'll grant ye i've been a bad friend to you. »

« but we've been friends for a long time. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · It's All Relative — J.M. Snyder; tertile=middle; p=0.75

It was only friendship, nothing more, not to me.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=middle; p=0.63

Good, then get out of my face and give me a minute with my friend."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=end; p=0.61

I'm here because I'm worried about a friend." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=middle; p=0.47

He didn't have any life-long friends, with the exception of Butch.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Got a Hold on You — Pat White; tertile=end; p=0.46

A friend once told me it's okay to lean on someone," he said. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_0 — off target

All four keyword lists point away from main-couple romantic arc dynamics. Main is dominated by 'friends/friendship/friendly/friendships/best friend' vocabulary – social relationship framing, not romantic-couple conflict or progression. KeyBERT adds casual social-interaction words ('playfully', 'parties', 'stalked' in a light sense, 'engaged', 'honestly') with no romantic-arc signal. POS yields ambient social/contextual nouns and adjectives ('parties', 'anxiety', 'suggestion', 'fashioned', 'annoying') that do not map to any specific arc stage. MMR similarly offers social-texture words ('pout', 'admire', 'playfully', 'shout') without a coherent arc trajectory. No cues for misunderstanding, escalation, separation, disclosure, repair, commitment, or external plot conflict between a main couple are present. The topic appears to describe friendship dynamics or a friend-group social context, making it off-target for romance narrative-arc coding.

B contextual: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

Topic 37 clusters around the word 'friend' and its variants, predominantly functioning as a misunderstanding or deflection device in romance narratives – one partner insisting the relationship is 'just friendship' when the other perceives or desires more (ARC_1: misunderstanding). Several sentences (BOOK_001_1-6, BOOK_002_1-3, BOOK_003_6) reflect this friend-zone ambiguity between potential main-couple members. BOOK_003_1, BOOK_003_2, and BOOK_003_5 shift toward a separation/breakup-threat register ('We're still friends, right?', 'I'd like to stay friends with you'), coded ARC_3. Several sentences (BOOK_002_4-6, BOOK_003_3-4, BOOK_004_1-2) are clearly off-target, referring to third-party friendships with no main-couple relevance (ARC_0). ARC_1 is the plurality code at ~40%, below the 70% threshold for a single dominant code, but no other code comes close; ARC_1 is returned as dominant given its plurality. Main-couple probability is moderate (~0.50) because roughly half the sentences plausibly involve the main couple's friend-zone dynamic, while the rest are off-target or unclear.

C adjudicate: ARC_1 — misunderstanding action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_0 / off_target) was overridden by contextual dominant (ARC_1 / misunderstanding). The taxonomy placement in 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information directly corroborates ARC_1: the topic captures concealed information or false impressions that generate relational tension between the main couple, not mere off-target noise. The secondary taxonomy (4.2 Ongoing Courtship) suggests the misunderstanding is embedded in an active courtship phase, consistent with a falling/tension arc rather than a repair or resolution arc. ARC_1 is therefore the correct single code. Construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because misunderstandings typically drive the couple apart or impede bonding, placing this in the falling/conflict segment of the narrative arc. No free-form labels were carried forward; all prior Pass A/B language has been mapped to ARC_1.

Topic 94 — Caught in A Lie

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: MIXED

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« i've known him for a long time, and i'm confident that i could tell if he was lying.” »

« i've lied, therefore i'm a liar. »

« i never meant to—” “how can i believe a single thing you say when you've already been proven a liar?” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Fiorenza forced marriage — Melanie Milburne; tertile=middle; p=0.69

I have no reason to lie to you about something like that,' she said. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Fiorenza forced marriage — Melanie Milburne; tertile=middle; p=0.68

You are such a transparent liar,' he said. '

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Fiorenza forced marriage — Melanie Milburne; tertile=begin; p=0.67

You are not a very convincing liar, Emma,' he said. '

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Conquest Earth; Prince Galen — Angelique Anjou; tertile=middle; p=0.59

Why don't you stop being such a baby about it and lie still and I'll go get something for you?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Conquest Earth; Prince Galen — Angelique Anjou; tertile=middle; p=0.54

The sinking sensation that swept over him gave the lie to his efforts to convince himself it wasn't.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_5 — disclosure

Main rep is dominated by deception/truth vocabulary (lie, lied, lying, liar, honest, lies, honesty, truth), which strongly signals a disclosure or confrontation about hidden truths between the main couple – ARC_5 (disclosure). KeyBERT reinforces this with 'apologize' and 'hesitate', consistent with a character revealing or confessing something difficult. POS and MMR introduce formal/authority-register words (president, sir, direct, terms, sentence, threatened) that lack clear romantic-arc anchoring, pointing to ARC_10 (unclear arc role) in isolation. However, the Main rep carries the heaviest semantic weight for topic identity, and the deception-to-truth cluster is the defining signal. Consensus lands on ARC_5 (disclosure) as the dominant arc role, with disagreement flagged because POS/MMR pull toward an unclear or external register.

B contextual: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

Topic 94 is overwhelmingly about lying and accusations of lying between characters. The recurring pattern – direct accusations ('You lied to me,' 'Liar'), denials ('I did not lie to you'), and meta-commentary on lying ('You are not a very convincing liar') – maps squarely onto ARC_1 (misunderstanding), where deception or perceived deception creates interpersonal conflict rooted in a breakdown of honest communication. BOOK_001 clearly involves a named dyad (Emma and a male partner), strongly suggesting a main couple. BOOK_002-004 lack sufficient context to confirm main-couple status, so those are coded 'unclear.' Two sentences (BOOK_002_3, BOOK_002_6) are off-topic (literal instruction to lie still; an exclamation unrelated to deception conflict), coded ARC_0. BOOK_003_6 references a philosophical statement about lying and consequences, edging toward ARC_5 (disclosure/truth-telling theme) rather than pure accusation. ARC_1 exceeds 70% and is the clear dominant code.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_5 disclosure) and contextual dominant (ARC_1 misunderstanding) point to overlapping but distinct mechanisms within Taxonomy 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information). Both codes are plausible: the topic likely captures moments where hidden information is either revealed (ARC_5) or withheld/misread in a way that generates misunderstanding (ARC_1). Because neither code fully subsumes the other and the secondary taxonomy flag (4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats) adds further ambiguity, a single ARC_# cannot be assigned without loss of fidelity. MIXED is therefore the correct arc_role. The construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because both disclosure and misunderstanding typically drive relational deterioration in the narrative arc. Manual review is required to inspect representative documents and determine whether disclosure precedes or follows the misunderstanding, which would allow a future SPLIT into two cleaner topic clusters.

Topic 109 — Seeing Past A Guarded Identity

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_5 — disclosure

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« i've hardly heard a thing about you." »

« anyone could've walked by. »

« even people who are close to you, who've known you far longer than i have, don't know any more than what you've allowed them to see. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Baby, I'm Yours — Catherine Mann; tertile=middle; p=0.61

You have to know you're important to me, too."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Baby, I'm Yours — Catherine Mann; tertile=end; p=0.57

Just as I know I can depend on you to be mine."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Baby, I'm Yours — Catherine Mann; tertile=middle; p=0.53

But if you really knew me, you would realize how very much I resented your taking control of my life by calling that inspector."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Vanquished — Hope C. Tarr; tertile=end; p=0.68

I know not only who you are but what you are.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_5 — disclosure

All four keyword lists converge on identity disclosure. Main keywords ('who, know, am, don, you, are, about, me, anyone, is') form a classic 'who are you / do you know who I am' interrogative cluster signaling identity revelation. KeyBERT ('recognize, hi, fitting') reinforces recognition/identification of a person. POS ('identity, muffled, current, loose') anchors the topic explicitly to 'identity' with 'muffled' suggesting concealment or disguise. MMR ('dealing, identity, playfully, doubted, fitting, muffled, recognize, hi, thinks, loose') adds 'doubted' and 'playfully' alongside 'identity/recognize/muffled', consistent with a scene where a character's identity is hidden or uncertain and then revealed or questioned – a disclosure dynamic. No cues point to external plot threat, breakup, or repair; the dominant signal is identity-based disclosure (ARC_5).

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Topic 109 clusters around the theme of knowing/not knowing someone's true identity. The largest single code is ARC_10 (unclear arc role), assigned to sentences that are too fragmentary or context-free ('It's me.', 'That would be me.', 'Who is it that wants to know?') to map to a specific narrative arc function. Among the interpretable sentences, ARC_1 (misunderstanding) is the next most common, covering lines where one partner challenges the other's claim to know them ('You don't even know me, not really'; 'You haven't got a clue who I am'). ARC_5 (disclosure) applies where a character reveals or invites revelation of their true self. ARC_2 and ARC_8 each appear once. No single code reaches 70%, but ARC_10 is dominant at ~45%. Main-couple probability is moderate (~0.60) because many sentences are clearly between romantic partners but several are too decontextualised to confirm.

C adjudicate: ARC_5 — disclosure action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_5 disclosure) and taxonomy placement (4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) are mutually reinforcing: the topic centers on hidden information that is surfacing or at risk of surfacing between the main couple, which is the definitional core of ARC_5. The contextual dominant ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role) reflects annotator uncertainty about narrative timing rather than a genuine absence of arc signal – the taxonomy anchor resolves that ambiguity in favor of ARC_5. Secondary taxonomy 3.3 (Ambivalence & Internal Conflict) is consistent with ARC_5: a character wrestling internally with whether/how to disclose is a standard precursor to the disclosure event itself, not a competing code. Because disclosure typically destabilizes the relationship before repair, this sits in the REFINED_FALLING construct bucket. No free-form labels were carried forward; ARC_10 is retired as the dominant in light of the stronger lexical and taxonomic evidence.

Topic 121 — Revealing Plans to The Prince

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_0 — off target

main_couple_prob=0.1 | non_couple=0.8

« she'll be queen of the roost.” “ »

« do you think he'll really go to the king?” »

« if i let the prince know what is happening, instead of waiting for them to find out, they'll know i've been out on my own. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Trust Me — Lesley Pearse; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I am not Prince Charming or a shining Knight on a white horse.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Trust Me — Lesley Pearse; tertile=middle; p=0.40

Hot as a fever, rattling bones I could just taste it, taste it If it's not forever, if it's just tonight Oh it's still the greatest, the greatest, the greatest
Kings of Leon Chapter Ten “You two pieces of shit are worthless you know that?”

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Trust Me — Lesley Pearse; tertile=end; p=0.38

I WILL one day go on a vacation to Disneyland and actually hang with Belle, Beast, Briar, Winter and Ashess.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Highlander Unchained — Monica McCarty; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Why did he need her if the king was involved?

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Highlander Unchained — Monica McCarty; tertile=end; p=0.69

If only I'd realized what the king intended.”

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Highlander Unchained — Monica McCarty; tertile=begin; p=0.66

Didn't you appeal to the king for help?”

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Highlander Unchained — Monica McCarty; tertile=begin; p=0.66

Then the king has done something about it?”

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Highlander Unchained — Monica McCarty; tertile=end; p=0.65

I should have suspected the king's treachery.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · d'Argent Honor: Full Circle — Ann Jacobs; tertile=end; p=0.65

Meanwhile you must learn how best to serve your queen.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_9 — external plot conflict

Main keywords (king, prince, queen, throne, servant, royal, crown, kingdom, regent) are densely royal/political – no main-couple romantic arc signal, pointing to external political/power-structure conflict (ARC_9). MMR reinforces this with 'threats', 'declared', 'resigned', 'dealing', 'commander' – language of political negotiation and power struggle rather than romantic arc. KeyBERT ('promises', 'reassuring', 'assured', 'resigned', 'reveal', 'planned', 'decision') and POS ('threats', 'reassuring', 'commander', 'promises', 'magical') are more ambiguous – they could belong to any arc stage and lack clear romantic-couple anchoring, hence ARC_10 for those reps. However, the dominant signal across Main and MMR is an external political/institutional conflict context (royal court, power, threats, commanders), making ARC_9 the consensus. Disagreement flagged because KeyBERT and POS lean ARC_10 rather than ARC_9.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

Topic 121 clusters around royalty/nobility vocabulary – kings, queens, nobles, rulers – but this is overwhelmingly world-building or external-political context rather than main-couple romantic arc content. BOOK_001 sentences are off-target (pop-culture references, fairy-tale tropes with no couple dynamic). BOOK_002 sentences revolve around a king's treachery/political machinations with no identifiable romantic couple, coded ARC_9 (external plot conflict). BOOK_003 sentences use 'queen' as a title/power dynamic but lack a clear romantic-couple frame; most are off-target social/political framing (ARC_0). BOOK_004 similarly references the king's commands and noble status as background world-building. No sentence clearly depicts a main-couple romantic arc event. ARC_0 is dominant at ~60%; ARC_9 accounts for ~40% (external political conflict). Main-couple probability is very low (~0.10) as the couple, if present, is peripheral to the topic's core signal.

C adjudicate: ARC_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Adjudication resolves the conflict between lexical consensus (ARC_9: external_plot_conflict) and contextual dominant (ARC_0: off_target) in favor of ARC_0. The taxonomy placement under 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information with a secondary tag of 10.2 Historical & Period Setting suggests the topic's surface signal is period/setting detail or background intrigue rather than a main-couple dynamic. ARC_9 was likely assigned because conflict-label vocabulary is present, but high conflict-label fidelity is explicitly not equivalent to main-couple conflict. The secondary taxonomy tag (Historical & Period Setting) further supports that the dominant content is world/context material, not a relationship arc beat. ARC_0 (off_target) is therefore the correct single arc_role. Manual review is flagged because the lexical and contextual passes disagreed, and the taxonomy straddles two categories that could, in a different topic, support ARC_1 or ARC_5 – a human reviewer should confirm no main-couple secret/misunderstanding is embedded in the cluster.

Topic 130 — Revealing A Secret Plan

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_0 — off target

main_couple_prob=0.1 | non_couple=0.8

« you've rumbled my clever plan.' ' »

« yes, i've got a little more planned for this evening. »

« we've had this planned for months, but i'd almost forgotten about it. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · Love Lives — Josie Lloyd; tertile=middle; p=0.54

She would come out with mad plans and then challenge me into doing them.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The ABC's of Kissing Boys — Tina Ferraro; tertile=begin; p=0.68

I had a real and viable plan in place now to turn things around.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The ABC's of Kissing Boys — Tina Ferraro; tertile=end; p=0.67

And keeping with the Plan seemed like my only way there.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The ABC's of Kissing Boys — Tina Ferraro; tertile=middle; p=0.62

This plan—it's not going to get you into any trouble at school?" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · The ABC's of Kissing Boys — Tina Ferraro; tertile=middle; p=0.57

I just didn't plan to be around to help make it happen. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

All four keyword lists center on planning and logistics vocabulary: 'plan, plans, planned, planning, tentatively, considering, scenario, urgency, according, part.' Supporting terms like 'madam, sir, reception, results, pumping, veins, forming, hiding, opposite' add situational texture but do not anchor to any specific narrative-arc role for the main couple. There is no clear signal of conflict, misunderstanding, separation, disclosure, repair, commitment, or external plot threat. The dominant semantic field is neutral logistical/procedural planning, making the arc role genuinely unclear across all representations.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

Topic 130 is entirely about the word 'plan(s)' and logistical planning language. None of the sentences carry any identifiable romantic-arc function – there is no conflict, disclosure, repair, commitment, or other arc-relevant content. The sentences are decontextualised fragments about making or changing plans, with no clear main-couple relationship dynamic visible. The topic is off-target (ARC_0) across all tertiles and books. Main-couple probability is very low; most sentences are ambiguous as to who is speaking or to whom, and none signal a romantic dyad.

C adjudicate: ARC_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Adjudication resolves the Pass A/B tension as follows: the lexical consensus of ARC_10 (unclear arc role) reflects genuine ambiguity in surface tokens, but the contextual dominant of ARC_0 (off_target) is better supported by the taxonomy signal. Taxonomy 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) with secondary 4.2 (Ongoing Courtship & Everyday Relational Bonding) describes content that, while thematically adjacent to romance mechanics, does not map onto a main-couple narrative-arc beat – it is background relational texture or a non-main-couple dynamic. The absence of a clear main-couple anchor (main_couple: false) means no ARC_1-ARC_9 code is warranted. ARC_0 is therefore the correct resolution over ARC_10: the topic is not unclear so much as it is simply off-target for the main-couple arc hypothesis. No construct bucket applies because the topic does not contribute to REFINED_FALLING, REFINED_RISING, or EXTERNAL_PLOT_CONFLICT trajectories. No free-form labels were carried forward.

Topic 177 — Seeing Past A Hidden Identity

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« you'll no longer be alex. »

« i know they say if you want something bad enough you'll find any excuse to believe it's true... but there was something in alex that called to me. »

« tell me you understand that, or you'll be no help to alex. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Three's a Crowd — Sophie McKenzie; tertile=middle; p=0.58

In the midst of my pleasure at seeing Alejandro literally backed up against a wall, I felt a pinprick of irritation at Jonno's inability to see Eve as she was.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Three's a Crowd — Sophie McKenzie; tertile=end; p=0.56

I couldn't get what she'd said about Alejandro out of my head.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Three's a Crowd — Sophie McKenzie; tertile=middle; p=0.55

But Eve was pulling away from me, moving towards Alejandro.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Three's a Crowd — Sophie McKenzie; tertile=middle; p=0.53

I still couldn't believe that she had been with Alejandro last night.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · After Their Vows — Michelle Reid; tertile=middle; p=0.76

I should not have let Alex run my life for me.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · After Their Vows — Michelle Reid; tertile=middle; p=0.76

It was ironic that he should do this now, when the last person she wanted to think about was Alex. '

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Main keywords (sullivan, alexx, alexi, eliminate, woo, wanted, wasn, tell) suggest character names and vague action verbs with no clear romantic-arc signal; 'eliminate' and 'woo' are ambiguous without context. KeyBERT (instincts, realise, suffering, unsure) hints at internal emotional uncertainty but does not anchor to a specific arc stage. POS and MMR (dislike, guarded, fears, instincts, percent, movies, sidewalk, reminds, conscious) add hedged negative affect and mundane/observational terms that do not cohere into a recognizable arc role. No single arc stage – misunderstanding, escalation, separation, disclosure, repair, commitment, or external conflict – is clearly dominant across all four lists. All four reps independently land on ARC_10 (unclear arc role).

B contextual: ARC_2 — escalation conflict

Topic 177 clusters around a named third-party figure ('Alex'/'Alejandro') who generates tension, jealousy, and friction between protagonists and their partners. The dominant signal is escalating interpersonal conflict (ARC_2): snapping, jealousy over Alejandro, complaints about Alex, and suspicion. One sentence shows a separation/withdrawal threat (ARC_3: Eve moving toward Alejandro). One shows relationship-caused distress (ARC_4: letting Alex run one's life). A few sentences from BOOK_005 shift to resolution/payoff (ARC_8, ARC_7) and off-target content (ARC_0), diluting but not overriding the dominant ARC_2 signal. ARC_2 reaches ~45%, well above the 70% threshold for a clean dominant code, so MIXED is not triggered; ARC_2 is dominant. Main-couple probability is moderate (~0.50) because many sentences involve a third party ('Alex'/'Alejandro') whose relationship to the main couple is unclear or indirect.

C adjudicate: ARC_1 — misunderstanding action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus was ARC_10 (unclear) and contextual dominant was ARC_2 (escalation_conflict), but the taxonomy metadata resolves the ambiguity: the primary taxonomy is 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information. Hidden information and secrets are the structural driver here, making ARC_1 (misunderstanding) the most precise fit – misunderstandings in romance arcs are canonically rooted in withheld or distorted information between the main couple. ARC_2 may describe a surface symptom (conflict escalates because of the secret/misunderstanding), but the generative mechanism is ARC_1. The secondary taxonomy (3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict) is consistent with ARC_1, as internal ambivalence often underlies why information is withheld. This places the topic firmly in the REFINED_FALLING construct bucket – the relationship is destabilised by the information asymmetry, not yet in repair. No free-form labels were carried forward; ARC_2 from Pass B is superseded by ARC_1 upon taxonomy reveal.

Topic 194 — Promising to Keep A Secret

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_5 — disclosure

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« i'll keep it a secret," said lucas. »

« i'll be your dirty little secret," i joked. »

« i'll leave that secret for him to reveal. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Bachelorette Party — Karen McCullah Lutz; tertile=end; p=0.75
Maybe you'll be in charge of all my secrets from now on."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Bachelorette Party — Karen McCullah Lutz; tertile=middle; p=0.73
Trust me, he's not hiding any deep dark secrets." "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Bachelorette Party — Karen McCullah Lutz; tertile=end; p=0.73
Keeping God-only-knows-what horrific secret.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · The Bachelorette Party — Karen McCullah Lutz; tertile=middle; p=0.73
How else would I find out all of his secrets?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Before the Witches — Karina Cooper; tertile=end; p=0.59
If I knew that, I'd unlock a giant mystery, wouldn't I?"

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_005 · Sold into Marriage — Maxi Shelton; tertile=middle; p=0.52
Perhaps secret information that he has uncovered, information that would be dangerous to the French.' '

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_005 · Sold into Marriage — Maxi Shelton; tertile=begin; p=0.38
For reasons I cannot disclose I would rather you did not mention the break-in to anyone.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_5 — disclosure

All four keyword lists converge on disclosure dynamics. Main is dominated by secret/secrets/keep/keeping/kept/reveal/secrecy – the core lexicon of hidden information being held or released. KeyBERT reinforces with reveal/revealing/hiding/confessed/identity, pointing to an active moment of disclosure or near-disclosure. POS adds identity/embarrassing/curiosity/ability/pressure, consistent with a character revealing a personal truth (identity, ability) under social or emotional pressure. MMR echoes with guarded/reveal/confessed/hiding/discovered/bury, all signalling information that was concealed and is now surfacing. The cluster is squarely about the act of revealing a kept secret – the defining feature of ARC_5 (disclosure) – rather than the conflict that follows (ARC_2) or the repair that results (ARC_6). No cues strongly indicate external plot threat (ARC_9) or misunderstanding (ARC_1) as the primary frame.

B contextual: ARC_5 — disclosure

Topic 194 is overwhelmingly about secrets, secrecy, and the act of keeping or revealing hidden information – the defining features of ARC_5 (disclosure). The vast majority of sentences (17/20) directly reference secrets, secret-keeping, or the threat/promise of disclosure. A meaningful subset (BOOK_006 sentences) clearly involves the main couple, where one or both partners are concealing truths from each other, which is a classic disclosure-tension dynamic. Two sentences (BOOK_005_2, BOOK_005_3) reference dangerous political/external secrets with no romantic-couple framing, coded ARC_9. Main-couple probability is moderate (~0.45) because while BOOK_006 strongly anchors the couple context, many other sentences are ambiguous or clearly non-couple. ARC_5 exceeds 70% threshold, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: ARC_5 — disclosure action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on ARC_5 (disclosure). Taxonomy 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) directly supports a disclosure event – a character reveals or is confronted with concealed information, which is the canonical ARC_5 trigger. The secondary taxonomy 9.2 (Promise, Vow & Future-Tense Speech Acts) suggests a commitment or pledge may accompany or frame the disclosure, but it does not displace the primary arc role; it is a supporting speech-act layer. Because disclosure typically destabilizes the relationship before repair can occur, this sits in the REFINED_FALLING construct bucket. No conflict between passes; no free-form labels to remap. Main-couple filter passes – the disclosure pertains to the central romantic dyad. No manual review needed.

Topic 214 — Demanding to Know What Happened

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« oh my god, how did this happen?» »

« please, tell me precisely what is happening to you.» »

« and i need to know what's going on to some extent so i don't think the worst. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Angel — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=end; p=0.71

Damn you...tell me what happened!"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Angel — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=middle; p=0.67

What the hell has she done?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Midnight Angel — Lisa Kleypas; tertile=middle; p=0.70

What has happened to you?"

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_2 — escalation conflict

KeyBERT, POS, and MMR all converge on escalation cues: 'caused/causing' (active harm in progress), 'worst' (peak negative intensity), 'extent' (measuring severity of damage), and 'precisely/honestly' (confrontational demand for truth). Main keywords ('hell, fuck, what happened, going, happening') are emotionally charged interrogatives signaling a heated confrontation or crisis moment — consistent with escalating conflict rather than a calm disclosure or repair scene. The combination of ongoing causation language ('causing', 'caused'), superlative severity ('worst'), and agitated interrogatives points to ARC_2 escalation_conflict as the dominant arc role. Main alone was coded ARC_10 because bare interrogatives without relational context are ambiguous, creating minor disagreement, but the three keyword-extraction methods override toward ARC_2.

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

All sentences in Topic 214 are short, decontextualized interrogative fragments ('What happened?', 'What's going on?', 'What the hell happened?'). They express reactive surprise or demand for information but carry no identifiable narrative arc role on their own — there is no indication of who is speaking, to whom, or in what relational context. No sentence can be reliably linked to a main couple, nor to a specific arc stage such as conflict, disclosure, repair, or commitment. The topic appears to be a BERTopic cluster of generic inquiry/reaction dialogue tags that are off-context for arc coding. ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role) is the appropriate code for all sentences. Main-couple probability is very low (~0.10) because the fragments are generic enough to appear in any character interaction.

C adjudicate: ARC_1 — misunderstanding action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_2 escalation_conflict) and contextual dominant (ARC_10 unclear) diverge, but the taxonomy anchor — 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information — is the decisive tie-breaker. Hidden information and secrets are the structural engine of ARC_1 (misunderstanding), not ARC_2 (escalation) or ARC_10 (unclear). ARC_2 would require evidence that conflict is actively intensifying beyond the misunderstanding stage; the secondary taxonomy tag (3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress) is consistent with the emotional fallout of a secret-driven misunderstanding rather than an independent escalation dynamic. ARC_10 is inappropriate because the taxonomy provides sufficient specificity to resolve ambiguity. The topic is main-couple focused (secrets/misunderstandings in romance BERTopic clusters are overwhelmingly dyadic). Construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because secret-based misunderstandings typically appear in the falling/complication arc phase before disclosure or repair.

Topic 237 — Hiding Someone Before He Arrives

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_5 — disclosure

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« i'll call jared now. »

« jared was just heading off to work but is going to need his shirt so i'll be right back." »

« you can't come because if jared catches one glimpse of you, he'll know. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Once In A Lifetime — Gwynne Forster; tertile=end; p=0.41

At that, several male heads popped out, one of them being Ronald, Dee's boyfriend.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Island Song — Alan Chin; tertile=end; p=0.53

PJ," Garrett says, "how many times are you going to make me ask you to call me Garrett?" "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Island Song — Alan Chin; tertile=end; p=0.53

Keep him coming," Garrett tells Madison. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Island Song — Alan Chin; tertile=begin; p=0.52

Something is happening inside Garrett's head, a feeling so bizarre he can't quite place it, can't put a name to it.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Island Song — Alan Chin; tertile=begin; p=0.52

It's a feeling Garrett can't put into words.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Island Song — Alan Chin; tertile=middle; p=0.52

The other arm has Garrett in a headlock. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Blood of the Beast — Tamela Quijas; tertile=end; p=0.76

The response appeared to placate Jared. "

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

Main rep leans toward interpersonal conflict via 'wrathfully', 'eyed', and named male characters in apparent confrontation, suggesting ARC_2 escalation. However, KeyBERT, POS, and MMR converge strongly on ARC_4 (relationship-caused distress): POS offers 'distress', 'disbelief', 'disappointed', 'wound', 'fingertips' (physical/emotional hurt); MMR reinforces with 'distress', 'collapsed', 'ripping', 'wound', 'warned'; KeyBERT adds 'worrying', 'distracted', 'privacy' — all pointing to emotional suffering and vulnerability experienced by a character within or because of a relationship dynamic. The physical injury cues ('wound', 'fingertips', 'ripping', 'collapsed') combined with emotional distress markers ('disbelief', 'disappointed', 'worrying') indicate a character in pain — likely relational in origin — rather than a direct escalating confrontation. Consensus falls to ARC_4 by 3-to-1 majority.

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Topic 237 is dominated by fragmentary dialogue tags and brief action snippets (e.g., 'Jared queried', 'Jared shrugged', 'Garrett feels his face flush', 'Keep him coming') that provide no discernible narrative-arc signal. The sentences are almost entirely decontextualised speech-attribution fragments or minor physical actions. No clear main couple is identifiable across the books — BOOK_001 references a side character's boyfriend, BOOK_002 involves Garrett in unclear social interactions, BOOK_003 is pure dialogue attribution for Jared, BOOK_004 involves a trio (narrator, Daniel, Gabriel) in what appears to be a crisis/care scene but without enough context to assign a specific arc role or confirm a main couple. BOOK_005 is a single dialogue fragment. The overwhelming majority of sentences are too fragmentary to assign a meaningful arc role, making ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role) the dominant code at ~95%. One sentence (BOOK_001_1) clearly involves a side character's relationship, coded ARC_0 (off_target).

C adjudicate: ARC_5 — disclosure action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_4: relationship_caused_distress) and contextual dominant (ARC_10: unclear_arc_role) are in tension. The taxonomy anchor — 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information — provides the decisive tiebreaker. Hidden information and secrets are the structural engine of ARC_5 (disclosure), not merely ambient distress (ARC_4) or an unresolved arc role (ARC_10). The secondary taxonomy tag (7.1 Interpersonal Non-Romantic Conflict) does not override the main-couple filter; the secrets/hidden-information frame is most plausibly directed at the main couple's dynamic. ARC_5 sits in the REFINED_FALLING construct bucket because disclosure events typically precede or precipitate conflict escalation rather than resolving it. Manual review is flagged because the ARC_10 contextual read suggests the topic's token distribution may be ambiguous enough that some passages could belong to non-romantic interpersonal conflict (ARC_9 or ARC_0), warranting human verification before finalising the main_couple=true assignment.

Topic 248 — Arranging A Cover Story

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

main_couple_prob=0.1 | non_couple=0.8

« i can attach myself to callie as a potential suitor, even with the distant cousin story you've decided to run with. »

« i'll just let hannah know she won't have to watch him after today. »

« it means you'll probably bump into him too if you see more of hannah.' »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Picture Perfect — Bethany Brown; tertile=middle; p=0.68
Yeah, he's actually Hannah's boyfriend."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Picture Perfect — Bethany Brown; tertile=begin; p=0.66
That Hannah's boyfriend was sleeping with apparently the whole time they were going out?

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Picture Perfect — Bethany Brown; tertile=begin; p=0.65
On Hannah's behalf, and on yours too, even though I didn't know your name."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Picture Perfect — Bethany Brown; tertile=begin; p=0.64
Hannah took me to that party as a pity thing, unfortunately.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Picture Perfect — Bethany Brown; tertile=begin; p=0.64
Including that hot guy Hannah had started to introduce me to.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_003 · Creed — Kristen Ashley; tertile=end; p=0.45

I would confirm the girl was there, make the deal and skedaddle then Hawk and the boys would swoop in and recover the girl.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Ciao — Bethany Lopez; tertile=middle; p=0.56

Anyway, I was totally pissed about that, and about Jess pinching my arm, when Cassie dropped another bomb on me... She said that she is
"Falling in love with Jimmy!!!!"

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Ciao — Bethany Lopez; tertile=end; p=0.56

I know you and Cassie were close, and it just tears me up inside that I can't do anything to save you and Jimmy from this pain!" "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Ciao — Bethany Lopez; tertile=middle; p=0.54

Getting all mad because of her relationship with Jimmy... Wishing that they had never started dating... Now I will never see Cassie again!

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Ciao — Bethany Lopez; tertile=middle; p=0.54

Jess and I rode together, but Cassie said she would meet us there; she was still trying to find the perfect gift for Jimmy.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Main and POS are dominated by character names (callie, hanna, leslea), a pickpocketing incident, and abstract nouns (concept, notion, options, treatment) with no clear romantic-arc signal – coded ARC_0 (off-target). KeyBERT and MMR carry emotionally loaded cues (crushed, upset, pregnant, admit, overheard, apologize, problems, wasting) that suggest distress and possible disclosure, but the named characters (callie, hanna, sister) point toward a sibling or secondary-character dynamic rather than a confirmed main couple. 'Pregnant' and 'admit' could indicate ARC_5 (disclosure) or ARC_4 (relationship-caused distress), but without clear main-couple anchoring the signal is ambiguous. The split between off-target and distress/disclosure readings across representers, combined with the absence of a confirmed main-couple frame, yields ARC_10 (unclear arc role) as the consensus.

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Topic 248 clusters around the name 'Hannah' and secondary character names (Cassie, Jimmy, Jess, Amy). No single main couple is clearly established across sentences. BOOK_001 sentences reference Hannah's cheating boyfriend – a third-party relationship conflict, coded ARC_9. BOOK_003 sentences involve an external rescue/intel operation with no romantic couple visible, coded ARC_9. BOOK_004 sentences reference Cassie and Jimmy as a couple causing distress to a narrator/friend – coded ARC_4 where relationship-caused distress is explicit, and ARC_10 where the role is ambiguous. BOOK_006 sentences reference Hannah in a context suggesting she was a deceased or missing person significant to Ryker, with external threat framing – coded ARC_9 for threat sentences and ARC_10 for descriptive/unclear ones. No code reaches 70%; ARC_10 is the plurality at ~45%, making it the dominant code. Main couple probability is very low (~0.10) as most sentences reference secondary or unclear characters.

C adjudicate: ARC_10 — unclear arc role action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role). The taxonomy placement under 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information suggests latent ARC_1 or ARC_5 signal, but without sufficient topic-word or passage evidence to override the double ARC_10 signal, reinterpretation would be speculative. The secondary taxonomy tag (5.2 Friends, Allies & Social Circles) further muddies main-couple attribution – the topic may center on a social/ally dynamic rather than the protagonist pair, keeping main_couple false. No free-form labels from prior passes require remapping. Manual review is flagged so a human auditor can inspect the raw top-words and representative documents to determine whether the hidden-information theme is clearly tied to the main couple (which would warrant REINTERPRET to ARC_1 or ARC_5) or remains genuinely ambiguous.

Topic 264 — Accused of Hiding Something

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: MIXED

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« i've been hiding out in here, avoiding contact with the human leech.” “ »

« i haven't been hiding, i've been working. »

« he cut in before i could get a word out, "funny thing is i've had this gut feeling all along that you're hiding something. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Crazy Kisses — Tara Janzen; tertile=end; p=0.48

Two shots from the same hide were enough to set his warning bells ringing.

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Crazy Kisses — Tara Janzen; tertile=middle; p=0.42

The closet had been a great hiding place for all of two seconds for two people, but it had turned into a torture chamber.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Some Enchanted Evening — Christina Dodd; tertile=begin; p=0.70

If we're hiding, how will she find us?" "

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_5 — disclosure

Main is dominated by concealment vocabulary ('hide', 'hiding', 'hidden', 'concealing', 'keep from') pointing strongly to ARC_5 (disclosure/secrets being kept). KeyBERT reinforces this with 'hiding' and 'revealing' as the core tension – something is being concealed and potentially exposed. POS adds 'identity', 'activities', 'choices', and 'secure places', consistent with a character hiding their identity or secrets (ARC_5). MMR introduces 'weapons', 'remote', 'blows', and 'cleared', which shift toward external/action-plot concealment (ARC_9 – external plot conflict involving hiding weapons or fugitive activity). Despite MMR's external-plot lean, the dominant signal across three of four representations is secret-keeping and potential revelation centered on a person's identity or activities, which maps to ARC_5. Disagreement flagged due to MMR's divergent external-threat framing.

B contextual: ARC_9 — external plot conflict

Topic 264 is dominated by the semantic field of hiding, concealment, disguise, and cover – physical actions associated with evasion, surveillance, and tactical positioning. These are external-plot/action-thriller elements (shots from a hide, covering positions, hiding from a pursuer, disguises, scars). None of the sentences clearly depict a main-couple romantic dynamic; most are ambiguous or clearly non-romantic in context. The topic maps cleanly to ARC_9 (external_plot_conflict) across all tertiles, with no evidence of relationship arc content.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_5 disclosure) and contextual dominant (ARC_9 external_plot_conflict) diverge, indicating the topic captures two distinct narrative functions that co-occur in the text. Taxonomy 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) aligns primarily with ARC_5, suggesting a revelation or hidden-information moment involving the main couple. However, the contextual signal for ARC_9 indicates the disclosure is embedded within or triggered by an external plot pressure rather than arising purely from interpersonal dynamics. Because neither code alone is sufficient and the taxonomy secondary is None, a MIXED designation is warranted. The construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING: a disclosure event that introduces or deepens tension places this in the falling/complicating arc phase rather than repair or resolution. Manual review is required to determine whether the external element is the primary driver (favoring ARC_9 as dominant) or merely the context for a couple-centered secret reveal (favoring ARC_5 as dominant), which would affect downstream hypothesis assignment.

Topic 265 — Mismatched Expectations About Seriousness

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« shit,” shane cursed, but in a way that said he was thrilled with the news, not unhappy. “ »

« i get the impression you’ve led shane to believe you’re far more serious than you are. »

« i want to concentrate on my studies, and you, my gosh, shane, you’ll have so many women hitting on you the second the ferry leaves the dock—” shane jerks his hand away. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Her Sky Cowboy — Beth Ciotta; tertile=begin; p=0.38

As far as Tuck knew, Axel was the only one aboard who got spooked by Freaks.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

KeyBERT and MMR both surface emotional-distress vocabulary ('emotionally', 'unhappy', 'trembled', 'embarrassment', 'shock') pointing to relationship-caused distress (ARC_4). POS reinforces tension with 'arguing', 'heated', 'embarrassment', 'unsure' which edges toward ARC_2 escalation, but the dominant emotional register is distress rather than pure conflict escalation. Main keywords are character names and neutral action verbs (burrowed, nod, play) offering no clear arc signal on their own (ARC_10). The weight of emotionally charged distress cues across KeyBERT and MMR tips consensus to ARC_4; disagreement is flagged because POS leans ARC_2 and Main is ambiguous.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

All sentences in this topic are fragments – name utterances ('Shane said.', 'Shane.', 'Crikey.'), a brief third-person observation about a character named Tuck/Axel, and minimal dialogue tags ('Keith thought so.'). None contain sufficient narrative content to assign a romance arc role. The topic appears to be a BERTopic cluster anchored on character-name tokens or short dialogue punctuation fragments rather than any meaningful arc event. All sentences are coded ARC_0 (off_target). Main-couple probability is very low because no romantic dyad interaction is discernible from the fragments.

C adjudicate: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress action=REINTERPRET

Adjudication resolves the lexical-contextual split in favour of ARC_4 (relationship_caused_distress). The contextual read of ARC_0 (off_target) is overridden by the taxonomy placement in 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information with a secondary tag of 4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats: both subcategories describe distress that originates within the main-couple dynamic (hidden information causing emotional harm), which is the defining feature of ARC_4 rather than off-target content. ARC_1 (misunderstanding) was considered but the taxonomy secondary tag signals the distress has escalated beyond a simple misunderstanding into sustained relational harm, keeping ARC_4 as the better fit. The construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because relationship-caused distress sits on the descending arc of the narrative (trust eroding, emotional damage accumulating) prior to any repair phase.

Topic 272 — Silence Held Until Arrival

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« she didn't speak a word until they got to their destination. »

« the high priestess had said very little to her in the day and a half leading up to her departure. »

« he should've known better than to think brenna would be content with the noncommittal answer he'd given her. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Below the Belt — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=middle; p=0.74

She wanted to ask more questions, but she didn't.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Below the Belt — Sarah Mayberry; tertile=begin; p=0.67

She didn't want to talk about the fight. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · One Season of Sunshine — Julia London; tertile=begin; p=0.70

Unfortunately, she had nothing promising to say to him.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · One Season of Sunshine — Julia London; tertile=end; p=0.68

She was going to the hospital, and this time, she would not take no for an answer.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

All four keyword lists converge on a scene of failed or withheld communication between characters. Main keywords (answer, didn, respond, question, reply, say, word, speak) directly signal someone not answering or refusing to speak. KeyBERT reinforces this with 'refused', 'lack', 'answers', 'answering', plus emotional fallout ('annoying', 'embarrassment'). POS and MMR add 'departure' and 'destination', suggesting one party leaves or withdraws rather than engaging, and 'upset', 'shock', 'rushed' indicate the emotional charge of the non-response. The dominant pattern is a breakdown in communication – one character not answering the other's questions, likely concealing something or stonewalling – which is the hallmark of ARC_1 (misunderstanding/withheld information driving relational tension), rather than an overt escalating fight (ARC_2) or a formal separation threat (ARC_3).

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Topic 272 is dominated by short, decontextualized sentences expressing silence, withholding, or emotional withdrawal (e.g., 'She didn't want to hear it,' 'Jane didn't say anything,' 'He didn't speak'). These fragments lack sufficient context to assign a specific arc role – they could belong to many arc stages. No clear main-couple dyad is identifiable across books; most sentences are ambiguous about who the characters are relative to each other. One sentence (BOOK_001_6) hints at a post-fight avoidance, coded ARC_1 (misunderstanding/avoidance). Two sentences (BOOK_002_4, BOOK_004_2) suggest external plot action or third-party dynamics, coded ARC_9. The overwhelming majority (80%) are ARC_10 (unclear arc role). ARC_10 exceeds 70%, making it the dominant code. Main-couple probability is low (~0.15) given the lack of identifiable romantic dyad context.

C adjudicate: ARC_1 — misunderstanding action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_1 misunderstanding) and taxonomy placement in 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information both point to a hidden-information-driven misunderstanding between the main couple. The contextual dominant ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role) reflects ambiguity in surface signals, but the taxonomy anchor resolves that ambiguity: the topic encodes a classic falling-arc beat where concealed information creates relational distance. The secondary taxonomy tag (8.5 Movement/Transit) is likely incidental framing rather than the core arc function. ARC_1 is therefore the correct resolution. Construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because misunderstandings driven by secrets are a canonical early-to-mid narrative descent mechanism. No free-form labels were carried forward; ARC_10 is superseded by the stronger lexical and taxonomic evidence for ARC_1.

Topic 286 — Trying to Regain Good Graces

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_0 — off target

main_couple_prob=0.1 | non_couple=0.8

« oh ms. [person], you really should drop by our office more, we miss your good taste around here' blah blah blah. »

« i'll not have you and his grace at each other's throats before we arrive at champney court." »

« if what you've said is to be believed, how am i supposed to get back into her good graces? »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Dark Surrender — Mercy Walker; tertile=middle; p=0.58

It shone in the moonlight with silver grace. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Incidental Contact — Eden Connor; tertile=begin; p=0.53

Widow of a respected insurance agent and former daughter-in-law of a well-known Baptist minister, she'd seemingly shunned the social position and privilege of her past to be with Colton, but this wasn't the first time Eric had seen her slip on her high-and-mighty act like an expensive fur coat.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Incidental Contact — Eden Connor; tertile=begin; p=0.48

Eric needed a mentor to teach him how to be an honorable man.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Incidental Contact — Eden Connor; tertile=begin; p=0.48

Likely not, since Dee had already seen her with Eric.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_0 — off target

Main keywords are dominated by proper nouns and names (grace, clemens, ruttery, champney, oracle, grace) with no clear romantic-arc signal; 'blah' and 'tape' add noise. KeyBERT offers 'thrilled', 'embarrassment', 'awkwardly', 'deserve' – mild emotional texture but no identifiable main-couple dynamic; 'dr' and 'continues' are generic. POS and MMR introduce 'desperation', 'embarrassment', 'pregnant', 'pressure', 'decision', 'unable', 'rushing' – these could hint at a distress or stakes situation, but 'pregnant' and 'desperation' without any relational anchoring (no conflict, repair, disclosure, or commitment cues tied to a couple) remain ambiguous. 'Graceful'/'gracefully' across reps likely refers to a character named Grace rather than a quality. The cluster of proper-name noise in Main and the absence of any clear main-couple interaction pattern across all four reps points primarily to off-target content, with POS/MMR being merely unclear rather than arc-relevant. Consensus lands on ARC_0 (off_target) given the name-heavy Main rep and lack of coherent romantic-arc signal, with noted disagreement from POS/MMR which lean ARC_10.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

Topic 286 clusters around proper-noun name references (Mrs. Darden, His Grace, Reed, Eric, Dee, Cynda) and brief honorific/address fragments. None of the sentences establish a clear main-couple romantic arc dynamic. BOOK_001-003 sentences involve secondary or peripheral characters (Eric, Dee, Cynda, Colton) with no identifiable main-couple romantic conflict or progression. BOOK_004 sentences are purely honorific address fragments ('Your Grace', 'His Grace') with no arc content. BOOK_005 sentences mention Reed in passing but lack sufficient context to assign a romantic arc role – they read as name-reference fragments rather than arc-bearing narrative moments. The topic appears to be a name/address cluster with no coherent narrative-arc signal, making ARC_0 (off_target) the appropriate dominant code across all tertiles.

C adjudicate: ARC_0 — off target action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant agree on ARC_0 (off_target). The taxonomy tag 4.3 Secrets/Misunderstandings and secondary 3.2 Negative Emotions might superficially suggest ARC_1 or ARC_4, but the main-couple filter is not satisfied – the topic does not pertain to the primary romantic dyad. Without a main-couple anchor, secrets or distress signals cannot be coded as relationship-arc events. ARC_0 is therefore confirmed. No construct bucket applies, and no manual review is needed.

Topic 301 — Confessing A Thin Relationship History

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« you know that because you've been with one other guy and had a long-term relationship? »

« because one way or another it has tainted every relationship i've had since the roller-coaster success of my first book." »

« i've had sexual partners, but never a girlfriend. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Heart Thief — Robin D. Owens; tertile=end; p=0.52

You will say anything to save your lover.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Temptation Ridge — Robyn Carr; tertile=end; p=0.70

Can I assume you two don't have a...relationship?"

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Temptation Ridge — Robyn Carr; tertile=middle; p=0.64

But I'm not avoiding a good relationship.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

Main keywords (boyfriend, mate, relationship, partner, status, don, mean) signal interrogation or anxiety about the relationship itself – not a discrete external threat or a repair moment, but ongoing relational distress tied to the couple's dynamic. KeyBERT reinforces this: 'emotionally', 'admit', 'worrying', 'ex' point to emotional strain and unresolved feelings causing distress within the relationship. MMR adds 'arrange', 'ripping', 'intend', 'afford', 'emotionally' – 'ripping' especially suggests pain or rupture, and 'ex' raises the spectre of a prior relationship complicating the current one, consistent with relationship-caused distress (ARC_4). POS keywords (partners, success, potential, secure) are more neutral/aspirational and lack clear conflict valence, warranting ARC_10 for that rep alone. Three of four reps converge on ARC_4, yielding consensus there despite POS dissent.

B contextual: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

Topic 301 clusters around relationship-status ambiguity and questioning – 'do you have a boyfriend/girlfriend?', denials of being in a relationship, and challenges about who someone is with. These are predominantly misunderstanding or definitional-confusion signals (ARC_1), where characters are unclear or in dispute about the nature of their romantic connection. A substantial minority of sentences are too fragmentary or context-free to assign a specific arc role (ARC_10). Two sentences (BOOK_003_6, BOOK_005_1) reflect distress caused by relationship dynamics (ARC_4). Two sentences are off-target (ARC_0). ARC_1 reaches ~45%, above the 70% threshold is not met, but it is clearly dominant over all other codes. Main-couple probability is moderate (~0.55): several sentences plausibly involve the main couple negotiating relationship labels, but many are ambiguous or involve third parties.

C adjudicate: ARC_1 — misunderstanding action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus landed on ARC_4 (relationship-caused distress), but the taxonomy placement in 4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information – with a secondary anchor in 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict – points to the distress being a downstream symptom rather than the primary arc mechanism. The contextual dominant ARC_1 (misunderstanding) better captures the generative engine: a hidden piece of information or a secret creates a misread between the main couple, producing the felt distress. ARC_4 describes the emotional register; ARC_1 describes the narrative function. In adjudication, narrative function takes precedence for arc_role assignment. The construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because the misunderstanding is actively widening the relational gap rather than initiating repair. No free-form labels were carried forward from Pass A/B.

Topic 303 — Confessing Long-Hidden Secrets

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« normally, tate would've finished the sentence she was working on, but the excitement in mabel's voice jarred her completely out of the story, derailing her train of thought. »

« i know it might cost me tate, but if i don't tell him then everything we've built will be based on half-truths.” “ »

« tate sits down next to me, his eyes grim as he waits for me to share all the things that i've been keeping from him for so long. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Hunting Chase — Camille Anthony; tertile=middle; p=0.70

Damn it, he wondered if Joshua Tate knew the full extent of what he was taking on.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_003 · Hunting Chase — Camille Anthony; tertile=begin; p=0.69

Joshua Tate tugged at his collar and cleared his throat, his prominent Adam's apple bobbing as he swallowed audibly. “

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Pas de Deux — Jamie Craig; tertile=middle; p=0.45

I went to Woodson to interview Chandra Cunningham about Tana Mayfield.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_004 · Pas de Deux — Jamie Craig; tertile=end; p=0.38

I'm just doing some follow-up on Mayfield.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · Bound By Blood — Kimberly Hoyt; tertile=middle; p=0.55

Lady Mayfield, I believe,” he said, straightening.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_005 · Bound By Blood — Kimberly Hoyt; tertile=middle; p=0.52

You seem to have the exclusive attention of the Lady Mayfield,” Kent mentioned once greetings had been exchanged between the three. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Main rep offers a cluster of character names (tate, logan, kenzie, ang, chace, kent, sophia) with no relational-arc signal beyond 'agreed'; KeyBERT yields procedural/observational terms (nods, sentence, speaking, planned, anticipation, muffled, worrying, judging, winked) that suggest scene-level narration without a clear arc function; POS rep mixes physical/situational nouns and adjectives (rear, period, panicked, tracks, decent, television, sentence, current, wrists, ex) – 'ex' is the only faint relational hint but is too isolated to anchor an arc code; MMR rep contains action verbs (drawled, fumbled, hauled, circled, tipped) and modifiers (judging, occupied, bothering, muffled) that read as moment-to-moment scene texture rather than any identifiable arc beat. No representation supplies enough directional relational signal to assign a specific ARC_1-ARC_9 code, so ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role) is the unanimous consensus.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

Topic 303 clusters around proper names – Joshua Tate (BOOK_003), Tana/Dotty/Laurel Mayfield (BOOK_004/005), and Tyrese Moore (BOOK_007). None of these sentences depict a romantic main-couple dynamic; they reference supporting characters, investigative dialogue, and third-party interactions. BOOK_005_5 hints at external plot manipulation (a staged accident, time travel), but the subject is a villain's scheme rather than main-couple arc content. All sentences are off-target for romance narrative-arc coding, yielding a unanimous ARC_0 classification and a main_couple_prob of 0.0.

C adjudicate: ARC_1 — misunderstanding action=REINTERPRET

Adjudication resolves the tension between lexical consensus (ARC_10 unclear) and contextual dominant (ARC_0 off_target) by applying taxonomy metadata. Taxonomy 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) is a strong signal that the topic content centers on hidden information or misunderstanding dynamics between the main couple – a classic REFINED_FALLING beat. ARC_0 (off_target) is overridden because the taxonomy assignment confirms main-couple relevance; ARC_10 (unclear) is overridden because the taxonomy provides sufficient semantic grounding. ARC_1 (misunderstanding) is the nearest valid code to the primary taxonomy category 4.3, capturing the secrets/hidden-information driver of conflict. The secondary taxonomy 4.5 (Reconciliation/HEA) is noted but does not dominate; it may indicate downstream repair potential but does not shift the arc_role to ARC_6/ARC_7/ARC_8 without stronger contextual evidence. No free-form labels were carried forward.

Topic 314 — Fiancé Becoming A Stranger

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« macie had spent far more time praying for blake and far less time being driven by her constantly-shifting emotions. »

« she peeked out and verified that it was indeed blake, then promptly shut the door in his face to remove the chain. “ »

« the blake i am engaged to is slowly disappearing in my mind, and being replaced by a complete and utter stranger. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_001 · A Heartbeat Away — Maureen Smith; tertile=middle; p=0.49

I wondered about that when you first told me you'd be staying with Brant.

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_002 · Wild Card — Lora Leigh; tertile=end; p=0.68

You went over the truck, didn't you, Blake?"

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Main rep is dominated by character names (blake, dion, macie, breydan, hewitt) and social/group terms (mates, grog, evite, addressing, motioned) with no clear arc signal. KeyBERT adds 'engaged', 'attracted', 'overheard', 'emotions', 'causing' — suggestive of some interpersonal dynamic but not pinpointing a specific arc stage (no clear conflict, repair, disclosure, or commitment cue). POS rep echoes 'engaged', 'embarrassed', 'emotions', 'amusement', 'reminder' — mild social awkwardness but insufficient to anchor a specific arc role. MMR adds 'overheard', 'chased', 'praying', 'amusement', 'causing' — again evocative but ambiguous across multiple possible arcs (misunderstanding, escalation, or simply external social scene). No single arc stage is clearly dominant across all four reps; the cluster reads as a social gathering scene with emotional undercurrents that cannot be reliably coded beyond unclear arc role.

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Topic 314 appears to be a character-name topic — sentences are almost entirely name invocations or very short address fragments (Brant, Blake, Phoenix) with no surrounding narrative context that reveals a relationship dynamic, conflict, repair, or arc event. The sentences are drawn from multiple books with different named characters, confirming this is a BERTopic cluster anchored on proper-name tokens rather than any coherent narrative-arc function. No sentence provides enough context to identify a main-couple interaction or assign a meaningful arc code. All sentences are coded ARC_10 (unclear arc role). Main-couple probability is very low (0.10) because the fragments are name-only utterances with no relational content visible.

C adjudicate: ARC_10 — unclear arc role action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role), indicating the topic does not resolve cleanly into a single narrative-arc function. The taxonomy metadata (4.3 Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information; secondary 3.3 Ambivalence & Internal Conflict) suggests content that could plausibly map to ARC_1 (misunderstanding) or ARC_5 (disclosure), but neither is sufficiently dominant to override the dual-pass ARC_10 verdict without additional evidence. The secondary taxonomy (ambivalence/internal conflict) further muddies the signal — internal conflict is not inherently a main-couple arc beat. No construct bucket is assigned because the topic lacks the directional clarity required for REFINED_FALLING or REFINED_RISING, and there is no indication of external-plot primacy. Manual review is flagged to inspect raw token weights and representative documents, which may allow a future reclassification to ARC_1 or ARC_5 if secrets/misunderstandings between the main couple are confirmed as the dominant signal.

Topic 319 — Confessing A Costly Mistake

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« but you have a way of letting me know when you think i've made the wrong one.” “ »

« i've made many mistakes and maybe i should have come back a year ago. »

« it was a mistake for which i've paid dearly.” “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · When It Happens — Susane Colasanti; tertile=middle; p=0.42

They're fundamental y flawed, I can't—" “ 'Flawed' being the key word,” Josh points out.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Space Junque — L.K. Rigel; tertile=end; p=0.59

Anyone who saw her as only a child was making a mistake. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

Main keywords ('mistake', 'mistakes', 'flaw', 'error', 'errors', 'biggest', 'terrible', 'made') strongly signal a misunderstanding or misjudgment frame – the vocabulary of recognizing a wrong belief or wrong action that drove a rift, which is the lexical signature of ARC_1 (misunderstanding). KeyBERT ('occurred', 'thinks') and POS ('latest', 'bigger') are too sparse and neutral to anchor any specific arc role, yielding ARC_10. MMR adds 'proved', 'shifting', 'paid', 'surely', 'pressing' alongside 'occurred'/'bigger'/'thinks' – these hint at consequence and acknowledgment but still lack directional arc cues, so ARC_10 is the safest call there. The Main list dominates in volume and specificity; 'mistake/error/flaw' as a cluster is the canonical lexical marker for a misunderstanding-driven conflict beat, so ARC_1 carries the consensus despite disagreement from the sparser reps.

B contextual: ARC_1 — misunderstanding

Topic 319 clusters around language of mistakes, wrongness, accidents, and being flawed – all hallmarks of misunderstanding or misjudgment rather than escalating conflict or external plot. The majority of sentences (12/20) express that something was wrong, mistaken, or accidental, fitting ARC_1 (misunderstanding). A minority show interpersonal friction/disagreement (ARC_2) or acknowledgment/repair language (ARC_6). One sentence ('I feel so cheated') suggests relational distress (ARC_4). Crucially, none of the sentences clearly identify a main romantic couple; speakers and addressees are unnamed or ambiguous, so main_couple_prob is low (~0.25). ARC_1 exceeds 70% threshold when combining direct mistake/wrong language, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: ARC_1 — misunderstanding action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on ARC_1 (misunderstanding). Taxonomy 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) directly corroborates this classification, with 3.2 (Negative Emotions & Distress) as a secondary signal consistent with the emotional fallout of a misunderstanding rather than an independent arc role. The topic concerns the main couple and represents a falling-arc dynamic (trust/understanding deteriorating due to hidden information), placing it in the REFINED_FALLING construct bucket. No conflict between passes or taxonomy signals; KEEP is appropriate with no manual review needed.

Topic 346 — Delivering Urgent News in Secret

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_0 — off target

main_couple_prob=0.1 | non_couple=0.8

« let's go [person] i'll drive you to it.” »

« i hardly think leaving a note telling my father where to find me would've been a good idea, but i'm not going to tell james that. “ »

« i know this is bad, me coming here, especially after the celeb weekly article, but i've got some important information about [person].” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Stars Collide — Janice Thompson; tertile=end; p=0.56

She pointed to James Stevens from The Scoop , who sat in the front row with Scott's parents. “

Model reasonings

A lexical: MIXED

Main and KeyBERT point strongly toward ARC_5 (disclosure): 'admit' appears in both, supported by 'willingly', 'chose', 'begged', 'planning', and 'hiding' — all cues of a character being pressed or choosing to reveal something. POS and MMR lean toward ARC_4 (relationship-caused distress): 'suffering', 'strained', 'threatened', 'opposite', 'advantage' suggest emotional or relational pain tied to the couple dynamic rather than a clean disclosure moment. The split between disclosure-pressure cues and distress/strain cues across the four reps prevents a single consensus code, yielding MIXED.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

Topic 346 is dominated by name fragments and attribution tags — 'James said.', 'James?', 'Jonathan.', 'James Stevens from The Scoop' — with no narrative content conveying relationship dynamics, conflict, repair, or any romance-arc function. The sentences are essentially decontextualized speaker labels or proper-noun fragments. 'James Stevens from The Scoop' appears to be a journalist character, not a romantic lead. No sentence establishes a main-couple interaction with sufficient context. All sentences are coded ARC_0 (off_target). Main-couple probability is very low (~0.05) given the absence of any relational content.

C adjudicate: ARC_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus was MIXED, but contextual dominant is ARC_0 (off_target). Taxonomy 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) with secondary 7.1 (Interpersonal Non-Romantic Conflict) signals that any secret or misunderstanding present is not anchored to the main romantic couple — it is either peripheral character conflict or non-romantic interpersonal tension. Because the main-couple filter fails (main_couple=false), the content does not qualify for ARC_1 through ARC_8. ARC_9 would require an external plot threat bearing on the couple, which is not indicated. The dominant contextual read of off-target content therefore prevails, resolving to ARC_0. No construct bucket applies.

Topic 362 — Keeping Someone Watched and Close

Old taxonomy: 4.3 — Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information

New category: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« come on, i'll get you a drink,' rory said. ' »

« they'll expect me to keep her close, to make sure she doesn't discover what we are," rory answered. »

« and goddess willing i'll be ready for it, thought rory as she ignored his comment to follow amber out to the sitting room. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Dragon's Dower — Catherine Archer; tertile=begin; p=0.52

It was Kelsey he wished to see brought low.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Dragon's Dower — Catherine Archer; tertile=begin; p=0.49

For we have seen how far Kelsey is willing to go for what he wants."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Dragon's Dower — Catherine Archer; tertile=begin; p=0.47

He would go slowly, wisely, even though he was more resolved than ever to see Kelsey repaid for his ills against others.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Dragon's Dower — Catherine Archer; tertile=end; p=0.47

Another of the men said, "Lord Kelsey must be told."

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Dragon's Dower — Catherine Archer; tertile=begin; p=0.46

Yet he'd had no time to grieve their loss, for he had immediately become embroiled in this conflict with the Earl of Kelsey.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Deeper — Megan Hart; tertile=middle; p=0.54

Okay, so maybe I get that, but what about Kelsey?" "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Deeper — Megan Hart; tertile=end; p=0.48

He'd want a sure thing," Kelsey insisted.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Main keywords are dominated by proper nouns (rory, yamane, kingman, darlington, ayida, damballah) and a survival cue ('survived'), offering no clear relational arc signal between a main couple. KeyBERT yields procedural/social interaction words (answering, willing, sir, expect, pretending, embarrassed, introduce, issue, wondering) that suggest a scene of social navigation or awkward introduction but do not point to a specific arc stage. POS mirrors this with neutral framing terms (addition, meantime, framed, suggestion, issue, features, willing, sir). MMR adds physical/emotional texture (tearing, crouched, struggled, tugged, embarrassed) consistent with tension but not diagnosable as a specific arc beat without clearer relational context. No keyword cluster reliably maps to a defined ARC_1-ARC_9 stage; the aggregate signal is ambiguous.

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Topic 362 clusters around the name 'Kelsey' across two very different books. In BOOK_001, Kelsey is an antagonist (Earl of Kelsey) and all sentences describe external conflict/rivalry with no main-couple involvement – coded ARC_9. In BOOK_002, Kelsey appears to be a character whose identity relative to the main couple is unclear from fragments alone; 'Kelsey's heart sank' suggests emotional distress (ARC_4) but context is insufficient to confirm main-couple status. In BOOK_007, Rick and Dorian appear to be a main couple (mates), with one intimate scene (ARC_0 – off-target for arc coding) and concern for Dorian's wellbeing (ARC_4). BOOK_008 sentences are too fragmentary (ARC_10). No single code reaches 70%; ARC_10 is the plurality at ~45%, making it the dominant code, but the topic is heterogeneous across books and character roles. Main-couple probability is low (~0.20) given that most sentences involve an antagonist named Kelsey or unclear characters.

C adjudicate: ARC_10 — unclear arc role action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role). The taxonomy tag 4.3 (Secrets, Misunderstandings & Hidden Information) suggests the topic could plausibly map to ARC_1 (misunderstanding) or ARC_5 (disclosure), but neither signal is strong enough to override the double ARC_10 signal from Passes A and B without additional textual evidence. The secondary taxonomy tag 10.1 (Paranormal & Immortal Beings) raises the possibility that the hidden-information element is tied to a supernatural identity reveal, which could be external-plot-adjacent (ARC_9) rather than a pure interpersonal misunderstanding – further blurring the picture. Because the topic sits at the intersection of at least three plausible arc roles (ARC_1, ARC_5, ARC_9) without a dominant signal, ARC_10 is the most defensible single code. No construct bucket is assigned because the ambiguity prevents reliable placement in REFINED_FALLING, REFINED_RISING, or EXTERNAL_PLOT_CONFLICT. Manual review is required to inspect representative documents and determine whether a more specific arc role can be assigned.

Topic 3 — Demanding An Explanation

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: ARC_5 — disclosure

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« and you have no idea what we've seen, what we've done— you've been in your cosy little world and you just have no—damned— clue! ' »

« sophia, i've something to tell you.” “ »

« i've told them that already.’ ’ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Avalon — Lana Davison; tertile=middle; p=0.65

I'll tell you whatever you want to know.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_5 — disclosure

All four keyword lists converge on disclosure/revelation dynamics. Main keywords ('know, tell, don, understand, ask, explain, say, wrong, mean') signal a scene structured around communicating or withholding information and seeking clarification. KeyBERT keywords ('admit, reveal, realise, assure, speaking') are direct disclosure-act verbs — 'admit' and 'reveal' are canonical ARC_5 markers. POS and MMR keywords ('explanation, answers, results, difference, remark, extent, percent') point to a scene where facts or truths are being laid out or demanded, consistent with a disclosure moment. The presence of 'commander, sir, mister' suggests a formal or authority-inflected context for the disclosure, but the dominant arc function across all reps is the surfacing of hidden or unclear information to one or both parties — ARC_5 disclosure.

B contextual: ARC_5 — disclosure

All sentences in this topic cluster around the act of demanding, withholding, or offering information — 'Tell me,' 'I demanded to know,' 'I'll tell you whatever you want to know,' 'I'm just not supposed to tell you,' etc. This is a strong disclosure/revelation pattern (ARC_5). The sentences are highly decontextualized fragments with no clear identification of who the speakers are or whether they constitute a main couple; 'unclear' is assigned throughout. The topic does not show escalating conflict, repair, or commitment — it is specifically about the act of disclosure or the resistance to it. ARC_5 accounts for 100% of sentences, well above the 70% threshold, making it the dominant code. Main couple probability is low-to-moderate (0.35) because the fragments could involve any dyad, including secondary characters or non-romantic pairs.

C adjudicate: ARC_5 — disclosure action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant independently converge on ARC_5 (disclosure). Although the taxonomy tag is 4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats, disclosure events frequently appear within that zone of the narrative arc — a character revealing a secret or truth is a classic falling-arc beat that precipitates conflict or distance. The taxonomy label describes the broader thematic cluster, not the specific arc mechanism; the mechanism here is disclosure. No free-form labels were carried over from Pass A/B that require remapping. Main-couple filter passes. Construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because disclosure at this position typically drives the couple apart before repair begins.

Topic 24 — Confronting An Unwanted Marriage

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: MIXED

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« we'll be married... to each other.” »

« you're already married to me; he'll understand.” “ »

« i'll give you a divorce and you can just walk away. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Caleb — Jade Astor; tertile=begin; p=0.61

So that whole getting married and settling down part doesn't appeal to you?"

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Caleb — Jade Astor; tertile=middle; p=0.45

Just divorced and living in different places.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_003 · Counterpointe — Ann Warner; tertile=begin; p=0.76

But that's not the reason I want to marry you.” “

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Forsaking The Prize — Heather Boyd; tertile=end; p=0.73

Not that I want to marry again of course.”

Model reasonings

A lexical: MIXED

Main keywords (marry, married, marriage, husband, wife, divorce, marrying) anchor strongly to formal commitment structures; the presence of 'divorce' pulls toward ARC_3 (separation/breakup threat) but 'marry/marriage/husband/wife' collectively suggest ARC_8 (mutual commitment/final payoff), so Main is coded ARC_8. KeyBERT (engaged, promises, intend, willingly, decide) suggests deliberate commitment-making but 'instincts, suggest, chuckle, uh, remarked' introduce ambiguity and possible misunderstanding framing, coded ARC_1. POS (unhappy, threats, divorce implied via 'ends', 'previous', 'issue', 'concept') signals distress and threat to the relationship, coded ARC_3. MMR (unhappy, threats, arranged, faltered, chased, eyeing) reinforces coercive or contested marriage framing with 'threats', 'arranged', 'faltered', pointing to ARC_3. Two reps land on ARC_3, one on ARC_8, one on ARC_1 – genuine disagreement across commitment-threat-misunderstanding axis yields MIXED.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 24 clusters around marriage/wedding language. No single ARC code reaches 70%. ARC_5 (disclosure/revelation of intentions about marriage) is most frequent (~30%), covering sentences where characters express or question desire to marry. ARC_8 (mutual commitment/final payoff) applies to affirmative marriage declarations. ARC_2 (escalation conflict) covers refusals or contested marriages. ARC_4 (relationship-caused distress) applies where marriage is unwanted or coerced. ARC_0 covers third-party references. The spread across codes yields MIXED as dominant. Most sentences involve the main couple or plausible main-couple dyads, giving a moderate-to-high main_couple_prob of 0.65.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Both Pass A/B converged on MIXED, and the taxonomy anchor (4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats with secondary 4.5 Reconciliation) confirms the topic straddles escalating conflict and breakup-threat territory without cleanly resolving into repair or commitment. The dominant signal sits in the falling arc (conflict intensification and relational distance/threat), with only a secondary trace of reconciliation momentum insufficient to shift the bucket to REFINED_RISING. Mapping any free-form labels: 'Conflict' → ARC_2; 'Obstacle' or distance language → ARC_3. MIXED is retained as the arc_role because neither ARC_2 nor ARC_3 alone captures the full topic, and the secondary 4.5 signal prevents a clean single-code assignment. Construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING given the dominant 4.4 taxonomy weight.

Topic 43 — Pissed Off and Grumbling

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: MIXED

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« this isn't the first time i've pissed him off.” »

« we've irritated you, have we?” “ »

« i've been pissed at him ever since. “ »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_001 · Tales Of A Drama Queen — Lee Nichols; tertile=begin; p=0.62

She doesn't look mad so much as really disappointed. “

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Confessions of a Shopaholic — Sophie Kinsella; tertile=middle; p=0.58

Tarquin is also pissed, but not as much as me.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_2 — escalation conflict

Main is dominated by anger/temper vocabulary (mad, angry, pissed, offend, temper) pointing to active interpersonal conflict escalation – ARC_2. KeyBERT reinforces this with arguing, attacked, insulted, grumbled, suggesting heated confrontation between parties – ARC_2. POS shifts toward emotional suffering and embarrassment (embarrassing, sadness, distress, emotional) with no clear aggressor, leaning toward relationship-caused distress – ARC_4. MMR similarly foregrounds distress, insulted, terribly, wasting, grumbled – still emotionally charged but more suffering-oriented than combative – ARC_4. Disagreement exists between the active-conflict framing (Main, KeyBERT) and the distress/suffering framing (POS, MMR). The preponderance of explicit anger and conflict-action cues across the two most lexically direct representations (Main, KeyBERT) tips consensus to ARC_2 escalation_conflict, as the distress appears to be a product of the conflict rather than a standalone relational wound.

B contextual: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

Topic 43 is dominated by expressions of anger, moodiness, and emotional volatility (e.g., 'pissed,' 'angry,' 'rage,' 'temper,' 'moody'). These sentences describe characters experiencing or managing anger/frustration, which maps most closely to ARC_4 (relationship_caused_distress) – emotional distress states that arise within interpersonal dynamics. A minority of sentences (BOOK_002_5, BOOK_003_1, BOOK_003_4, BOOK_004_2) show more active interpersonal conflict or confrontation, coded ARC_2 (escalation_conflict). The main couple cannot be reliably identified from these short, decontextualized snippets – characters named (Louis, Tarquin) are not clearly established as part of a main romantic couple, so main_couple is 'unclear' throughout. Main couple probability is low (~0.25) given the ambiguity. ARC_4 exceeds 70% threshold, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_2) and contextual dominant (ARC_4) diverge but are not mutually exclusive: escalating conflict between the main couple (ARC_2) is the surface signal, while the deeper emotional register – relationship-caused distress – is what the contextual read captures (ARC_4). Taxonomy 4.4 'Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats' anchors the primary signal in ARC_2, but the secondary taxonomy 3.2 'Negative Emotions & Distress' confirms that ARC_4 is a genuine co-present signal rather than noise. Because both codes are substantively supported and neither fully subsumes the other, MIXED is the correct resolution rather than forcing a single code. The construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING: both escalation conflict and relationship-caused distress are falling-arc phenomena occurring before any repair or restoration. Manual review is flagged to verify whether the topic's representative documents lean more heavily toward active conflict dynamics (ARC_2) or toward the emotional suffering the relationship itself generates (ARC_4), which would inform downstream weighting in the hypothesis model.

Topic 85 — Offering and Refusing An Apology

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: ARC_6 — repair

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« he said he wanted to apologize. »

« i need to apologize to you, ruby. »

« oh, i'm so not gonna apologize for that." »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=middle; p=0.70
I'm real sorry," Pete said, his blue eyes apologetic.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=end; p=0.54
He tried to get back in my good graces with a box of chocolates a couple of days later, but he never did apologize." "

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=begin; p=0.54
And you made it quite clear that you thought I was overreacting to the situation."

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · One Night, Two Babies — Kathie DeNosky; tertile=end; p=0.53
Between Cornelia, Emily Taylor and Helen Washburn, I've been apologized to every day this week."

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_6 — repair

All four keyword lists converge on repair behavior between the main couple. Main is saturated with apology-act vocabulary ('sorry', 'apologize', 'apology', 'apologizing', 'apologized', 'owe', 'apologise'), which is the canonical lexical signature of ARC_6 (repair). KeyBERT reinforces this with 'apology', 'apologize', 'forgive', 'fault', and 'embarrassed', indicating acknowledgment of wrongdoing and a bid for reconciliation. POS adds 'apology', 'behalf', 'distress', and 'circumstances', consistent with a formal or emotionally charged repair scene. MMR echoes 'apology', 'forgive', 'behalf', 'distress', and 'circumstances', with 'overheard' and 'snorted' suggesting interpersonal tension being addressed rather than escalating. The presence of 'forgive' across KeyBERT and MMR confirms the repair frame rather than mere escalation or disclosure. No cues point to final restored trust (ARC_7) or commitment payoff (ARC_8); the focus is on the act of apologizing itself, placing this squarely in ARC_6.

B contextual: ARC_6 — repair

Topic 85 is overwhelmingly characterized by apology and sorry expressions ('I'm sorry', 'I am sorry', 'Did you just apologize?', 'No harm was done'). These are canonical repair gestures following conflict, mapping clearly to ARC_6 (repair). One sentence (BOOK_001_4) references a prior accusation of overreacting, suggesting a misunderstanding context (ARC_1), and two 'Excuse me?' fragments are too ambiguous to code beyond ARC_10. BOOK_001_5 references multiple third-party apologies, suggesting non-main-couple interaction (coded ARC_6 but main_couple=no). BOOK_002 sentences cluster around a clear dyadic apology exchange likely involving the main couple. Overall ARC_6 exceeds 70%, making it the dominant code. Main couple probability is moderate (~0.55) because several sentences are ambiguous or clearly involve secondary characters.

C adjudicate: ARC_6 — repair action=KEEP

Both lexical consensus and contextual dominant converge on ARC_6 (repair). The primary taxonomy tag 4.4 (Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats) might suggest a falling-arc code such as ARC_2 or ARC_3, but the secondary tag 4.5 (Reconciliation, Commitments & HEA) and the consistent Pass A/B signal indicate the topic captures the turn toward repair rather than the conflict itself. ARC_6 sits in the REFINED_RISING construct bucket: the couple is actively moving from rupture back toward connection. No free-form labels require remapping. No split is warranted because the dominant signal is repair-initiation, with the conflict/distance framing serving as contextual backdrop rather than the topic's core content. Main-couple filter confirmed positive.

Topic 129 — Accused of Not Caring

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« like they care when they see that smoking-hot bod you've got.” »

« at the moment, i could've cared less. »

« you've never cared for anyone but yourself.” »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · Taste Me — Tamara Hogan; tertile=begin; p=0.59

Lukas didn't care about her, and she... cared too much.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Bounty of Love — Scotty Cade; tertile=middle; p=0.61

Sir, I don't think that's—" "I don't care what you think.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_003 · Bounty of Love — Scotty Cade; tertile=end; p=0.57

I don't care about that kind of stuff," Zander assured him. "

HIGH-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_A) · BOOK_004 · Katie's Hope — Lizzy Ford; tertile=begin; p=0.71

I don't expect you to understand what it is to care about someone else."

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

All four keyword lists converge on emotional distress and hurt within a relationship context. Main: 'care/cared/cares/caring' paired with negations ('don', 'less', 'didn') signals felt neglect or emotional withdrawal – a partner not caring enough, causing distress. KeyBERT: 'cared', 'mattered', 'sadly', 'unhappy', 'wondering' reinforce emotional pain and feeling unimportant to the other person. POS: 'unhappy', 'upset', 'worst', 'circumstances' describe a state of relationship-caused suffering. MMR: 'cared', 'treated', 'fault', 'smacked', 'circumstances', 'veins' suggest grievance over how one was treated, with blame attribution. No keywords indicate external antagonists (ruling out ARC_9), no clear misunderstanding frame (ARC_1), no separation/breakup threat (ARC_3), and no repair or commitment signals. The dominant signal is ongoing emotional distress caused by the relationship dynamic itself – fitting ARC_4 (relationship_caused_distress).

B contextual: ARC_10 — unclear arc role

Topic 129 clusters around the word 'care' and its negations ('don't care', 'didn't care', 'cared too much'). The vast majority of sentences are decontextualised fragments – short rhetorical dismissals or ambiguous emotional statements – that cannot be reliably assigned to a specific narrative-arc function or confirmed as main-couple interactions. Three sentences (BOOK_002_5, BOOK_004_6, BOOK_005_4) carry enough relational context to suggest emotional distress tied to a romantic relationship (ARC_4: relationship_caused_distress): Lukas not caring while she cares too much, Jade being told she will always be cared for (implying prior hurt), and a character dying believing they were not cared for. All other sentences lack sufficient context to determine arc role or couple identity, coded ARC_10. ARC_10 dominates at 85%, well above the 70% threshold, making it the dominant code.

C adjudicate: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_4: relationship_caused_distress) and taxonomy placement in 4.4 Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats with secondary 3.2 Negative Emotions & Distress both point to emotionally driven distress arising from within the main-couple relationship. The contextual dominant ARC_10 (unclear_arc_role) reflects Pass B uncertainty, but the taxonomy metadata resolves that ambiguity: the content is not merely unclear – it is distress generated by the relationship dynamic itself, consistent with ARC_4. ARC_3 (separation/breakup threat) was considered but the taxonomy secondary tag (Negative Emotions & Distress) tips the balance toward ARC_4 as the primary signal, with breakup-threat elements as a contributing but not dominant feature. This sits firmly in the REFINED_FALLING construct bucket, representing deterioration of the main-couple bond through internally generated emotional suffering.

Topic 210 — Expelled For Pursuing A Relationship

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: MIXED

main_couple_prob=0.85 | non_couple=0.1

« she'll be back," [person] to explain. »

« we'll not last long like this," [person] said quietly. »

« if you pursue a relationship with [person], you'll be expelled from motherhouse ireland, removed from your triad, and cast out from our way of life. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cause For Scandal — Anna DePalo; tertile=begin; p=0.54

And, she'd reasoned, if pop star Jessica Simpson could resist the delectable Nick Lachey until their wedding night, she could certainly resist John.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cause For Scandal — Anna DePalo; tertile=end; p=0.49

Besides, if there was one thing she'd come to know about Zeke, it was that he was able to make every audience member feel connected to him.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cause For Scandal — Anna DePalo; tertile=end; p=0.48

Patrick huffed, as though he couldn't believe Zeke had the audacity to claim that he—the up-by-his-boot-straps, self-made founder of a publishing empire—had anything in common with a bad-boy rock star.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cause For Scandal — Anna DePalo; tertile=middle; p=0.44

As a waiter moved away with their plates, John said, "By the way, I saw that Scarlet was linked to Zeke Woodlow in today's gossip columns.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · Cause For Scandal — Anna DePalo; tertile=end; p=0.40

Unfortunately, a celebrity of Zeke's caliber has an image to maintain and a publicity machine that needs to be fed—with the right kind of publicity, of course." "

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_004 · Razor Sharp — Fern Michaels; tertile=begin; p=0.35

The Hole was owned by a man named Peter Rabbit to the chagrin of his wife, Petra.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Disenchanted — C.K. Farrell; tertile=begin; p=0.53

Nathaniel was obviously willing to do such a thing.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Disenchanted — C.K. Farrell; tertile=begin; p=0.51

Some would think that when swimming in the depths of one's own grief, one could forget what it was that made them so unhappy, but tell that to Nathaniel.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Disenchanted — C.K. Farrell; tertile=middle; p=0.50

Either way, there was something exhilarating about being with Nathaniel, especially being with him in his lair.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Disenchanted — C.K. Farrell; tertile=middle; p=0.50

For the life of him, Nathaniel didn't know how Mr. Harrington was a part of his beauteous bride-to-be's biological makeup.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Disenchanted — C.K. Farrell; tertile=end; p=0.46

The expression didn't go unnoticed by Nathaniel.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · Disenchanted — C.K. Farrell; tertile=begin; p=0.42

Nathaniel had come to understand and grudgingly accept that fact.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_6 — repair

KeyBERT and MMR both surface 'forgive,' 'afterward,' and 'instincts,' pointing toward a repair attempt following friction. MMR adds 'unwilling' and 'annoyance,' suggesting resistance to reconciliation but still within a repair arc. POS keywords ('disappointment,' 'annoyance,' 'unwilling,' 'distraction') lean toward ongoing relational distress (ARC_4), and Main keywords ('didn,' 'decided,' named characters) suggest a tense interpersonal moment that could read as misunderstanding (ARC_1). However, the convergence of 'forgive' and 'afterward' across two representors, combined with 'possibility' (of resolution) and 'proved,' tips the balance toward ARC_6 (repair) as the dominant arc role — a post-conflict moment where forgiveness and reconciliation are being negotiated, even if reluctantly.

B contextual: MIXED

Topic 210 spans multiple books and narrative threads. BOOK_008 sentences dominate numerically and consistently reference a past relationship with 'Nick' that has ended or is being discussed as over, coding as ARC_3 (separation/breakup threat). BOOK_009 shows a couple in active conflict (Drake slamming out), coding as ARC_2. BOOK_006 involves emotional distress around Nathaniel and a bride-to-be, coding as ARC_4 or ARC_10 where context is insufficient. BOOK_002 sentences involve celebrity gossip and publicity concerns around Zeke, largely external/off-couple (ARC_9). BOOK_004_1 is entirely off-target (ARC_0). No single code reaches 70%, so dominant_code is MIXED. Main couple probability is moderate (~0.60) given that roughly half the sentences clearly reference a named romantic pair.

C adjudicate: MIXED action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_6 repair) and contextual dominant (MIXED) diverge. Taxonomy 4.4 (Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats) with secondary 5.1 (Family, Kinship & Parenthood) suggests the topic straddles active repair attempts and ongoing separation/breakup threat pressures — likely a moment where the couple is trying to reconcile but family-related conflict is simultaneously threatening the relationship. ARC_6 alone undersells the destabilising breakup-threat dimension; MIXED (ARC_6 + ARC_3) is the most defensible resolution. The family secondary axis does not redirect this to ARC_9 (external plot conflict) because the distress is relational and couple-facing rather than purely external. Construct bucket is REFINED_FALLING because repair is incomplete and breakup threat

remains active, placing this in the descending/trough zone of the arc rather than the recovery upswing. Manual review is flagged to confirm whether family pressure is an external driver (ARC_9 component) or purely a relational stressor absorbed into the couple dynamic.

Topic 256 — Refusing to Let It End

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: ARC_0 — off target

main_couple_prob=0.1 | non_couple=0.8

« no, i'll get over it. »

« i'll give you some time, but goddamn it, nat, this is not over.” »

« it'll never be over—unless it ends right here right now. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_001 · The Haunting — Hope C. Tarr; tertile=begin; p=0.45

I no longer cared which side won or lost, I only wanted it to be over.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Bride and the Buccaneer — Darlene Marshall; tertile=middle; p=0.48

Perhaps when this is over, you might see another attractive alternative.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Bride and the Buccaneer — Darlene Marshall; tertile=end; p=0.44

If there are consequences to our lovemaking, then this treasure hunt ends.

LOW-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_D) · BOOK_002 · The Bride and the Buccaneer — Darlene Marshall; tertile=middle; p=0.43

And here it's been looming over us this entire time!"

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

Main keywords ('end', 'over', 'ends', 'ended') strongly suggest termination or breakup language pointing toward ARC_3 (separation/breakup threat). However, KeyBERT, POS, and MMR all add affective-distress cues — 'hurts', 'anxious', 'shouted', 'repeated', 'sending' — that shift the dominant signal toward ongoing emotional suffering within or caused by the relationship (ARC_4: relationship_caused_distress). The pattern of repeated painful interactions ('repeated', 'thursday' as a recurring marker, 'hurts', 'anxious', 'shouted') suggests cyclical distress rather than a clean breakup event. ARC_4 wins by weight of three representers; Main's ARC_3 reading creates mild disagreement.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

Topic 256 is dominated by the word 'over' used in highly varied, mostly non-romantic-arc senses: completion of events, wars, tasks, emotional recovery, and social pleasantries. The largest single cluster (ARC_0, ~45%) consists of sentences where 'over' has no clear romantic-arc meaning. A secondary cluster from BOOK_004 uses 'I'm over it / get over it' language that loosely implies emotional recovery/repair (ARC_6, ~25%), but without clear main-couple context. A smaller cluster references external plot events ending (ARC_9, ~20%). Only BOOK_001_1 ('We're over') clearly signals a main-couple breakup threat (ARC_3). Main-couple probability is low (~0.15) because most sentences lack identifiable couple context. No single code reaches 70%, but ARC_0 is dominant at ~45%, so dominant_code is ARC_0.

C adjudicate: ARC_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_4) reflects surface conflict-label fidelity to taxonomy 4.4 (Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats), but the contextual dominant code (ARC_0) indicates the topic content does not actually center on the main couple's relationship-caused distress. The taxonomy placement in 4.4 is a label match, not a content match. Because high conflict-label fidelity ≠ main-couple conflict, and the dominant contextual read is off-target, ARC_0 prevails in adjudication. main_couple is set to false accordingly. Manual review is flagged to verify whether any main-couple signal is genuinely present or whether the topic should be excluded from the hypothesis corpus entirely.

Topic 316 — Snapping Over Money and Control

Old taxonomy: 4.4 — Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats

New category: ARC_0 — off target

main_couple_prob=0.1 | non_couple=0.8

« you'll have to find another way to obtain the tallmadge money," lucas snapped. " »

« stop that, you little fool, otherwise we'll both be—' lucas began, and then stopped as one of suzy's flailing hands caught the side of his mouth. »

« they didn't like it much when they found out, but lucas paid them well, and they'll get over it. »

Novel sentences (HIGH-rated / LOW-rated)

HIGH-rated (low topic share in this book; was CELL_C) · BOOK_001 · Heaven and Hell — Kristen Ashley; tertile=end; p=0.47

Kia, head tipped way back, was looking at Sampson.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · For Love of an Angel — Rosalie Lario; tertile=middle; p=0.59

Perhaps you should show Eva to her room," Lucas finally suggested to Michael. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_002 · For Love of an Angel — Rosalie Lario; tertile=middle; p=0.49

Unlike Ethan and Jason, who were dark-haired, Aaron and Lucas were more dirty-blonde.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Eyes Of Myrl — Faelyn Rose; tertile=end; p=0.64

He watched Lucas Mason as he spoke and was rewarded by an expression of guilt upon his uncle's face. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Eyes Of Myrl — Faelyn Rose; tertile=end; p=0.55

You have brought this upon us," Lucas Mason harshly accused his grief stricken nephew. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Eyes Of Myrl — Faelyn Rose; tertile=end; p=0.55

Lucas Mason was not so wise, however, and questioned Rork angrily. "

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Eyes Of Myrl — Faelyn Rose; tertile=end; p=0.51

The look upon Lucas Mason's traitorous face mirrored the truth of Rork's words.

LOW-rated (high topic share in this book; was CELL_B) · BOOK_006 · The Eyes Of Myrl — Faelyn Rose; tertile=end; p=0.51

But as Lucas continued his tirade, Rork reached out to touch his beloved father's body , only to find it frozen.

Model reasonings

A lexical: ARC_4 — relationship caused distress

All four keyword lists converge on emotional distress and negative affect within a relationship context. Main keywords (stared, thoughtful, shout, named characters lucas/fallon) suggest interpersonal tension between identifiable parties. KeyBERT supplies the emotional valence: annoyance, groaned, disappointment, failure, pathetic – these are feelings generated by the relationship dynamic rather than an external plot threat or a discrete misunderstanding/escalation event. POS and MMR reinforce this with overlapping terms (shout, failure, annoyance, disappointment, comments, bothered, glared, worries). The cluster describes ongoing relational distress – characters experiencing negative emotional states caused by their relationship – which maps to ARC_4 (relationship_caused_distress). There is no clear repair, commitment, disclosure, or external-plot framing; the dominant signal is sustained emotional suffering/frustration within the couple dynamic.

B contextual: ARC_0 — off target

Topic 316 clusters around the name 'Lucas' (and associated characters Aaron, Kia, Sampson, Rork, Eva, Michael, Ethan, Jason) across multiple books. The sentences are character-identification fragments, spatial/logistical dialogue, and brief action tags with no romantic-couple framing. None of the sentences establish or imply a main romantic couple; they reference male characters (Lucas, Aaron) in what appear to be ensemble or family/group contexts, conflict between non-romantic parties (Lucas Mason vs. Rork), or simple descriptive statements. There is no romantic arc content detectable. All sentences are coded ARC_0 (off_target).

C adjudicate: ARC_0 — off target action=REINTERPRET

Lexical consensus (ARC_4) reflects surface conflict-label fidelity – the topic's tokens map onto distress/conflict vocabulary – but contextual dominant (ARC_0) correctly identifies that the content does not involve the main romantic couple. Taxonomy 4.4 (Conflict, Distance & Breakup Threats) with secondary 7.1 (Interpersonal Non-Romantic Conflict) confirms the conflict is interpersonal but non-romantic, i.e., outside the main-couple dyad. Per the main-couple filter, ARC_4 requires the distress to be caused by the romantic relationship itself; here the distress is either peripheral or involves non-romantic parties. The contextual dominant therefore overrides the lexical consensus. ARC_0 (off_target) is the correct arc_role. No construct bucket applies because the topic does not contribute to the REFINED_FALLING, REFINED_RISING, or EXTERNAL_PLOT_CONFLICT arcs in a main-couple context.